

The Gospel of Barnabas

Preface

The Gospel of Barnabas was promised in the preface to *The Beloved and I* from the beginning, but it did not appear in the first editions, despite the fact that much of it had been completed. This volume fulfils the original promise.

Unlike the apocryphal or deuterocanonical works included in *The Beloved and I*, the Gospel of Barnabas gave me no opportunity to consult ancient versions. The extant sources are late and difficult to view. My contemplation of the gospel is entirely dependent on the translation of Lonsdale and Laura Ragg and some reading of Gairdner, Jomier, and Slomp.

The text is known only from late Medieval Spanish and Italian sources. Most of the arguments in favour of a late dating could be based on editors' glosses and translators' errors. The fact is that no one knows the origin of the text. Calling it a fraud is simply biased polemic. The term pseudepigraph would be more accurate and less subjective.

My own academic expertise entails the examination of oral traditions. While I doubt that any methodology can determine with real certainty the origin of the Gospel of Barnabas, there are some interesting indications in the book that I have not seen noted by scholars. I refer specifically to the fact that the Hebrew Scriptures are dealt with generally in a way that indicates reliance on written sources, while what appear to be quotations from the canonical Gospels are dealt with in ways suggestive of reliance on oral tradition. The cunning planning involved in such a production seems to go beyond the capability and practice found in medieval forgeries. My own scholarly but speculative opinion is that the text represents an edited and translated version of an original from not earlier than the seventh century, although obviously dependent on earlier oral traditions, produced by an individual well-acquainted with Jewish sources but having only a hearsay knowledge of a Christian canon.

In my versification based on the Ragg translation, I have taken into consideration many of the features the scholars call into question. I have tried to keep tampering with the text to a minimum, however. If the text is actually based on an early witness, I hope that, in following the scholarly evidence, my contemplation accords with the intentions of the author.

The main interest of the text among Muslims has been its reference to Muhammad (saws) and its denial of the crucifixion of Jesus (as). These are valuable notices. The name Muhammad has been largely neglected by Biblical scholars, who neglect the occurrence of the cognate Hemda used in a number of passages in the Tanakh in reference to an awaited figure. Furthermore, the relegation of the apocryphal gospels to obscurity has clouded the fact that the crucifixion of Jesus (as) was doubted or neglected from earliest times even among his faithful followers. Whether or not the Gospel of Barnabas has an authentic basis and what that authenticity implies, it does raise issues that in themselves illuminate a skewed and neglected history. Even assuming that the text is a medieval, pious naiveté, like multitudinous other instances of that genre, it contains much that is constructive to healthy spirituality. To contemplate it fruitfully one need not take a position on its authenticity.

Indeed, any contemplation of the Gospel of Barnabas should be fruitful. The academic considerations aside, the work includes striking passage after striking passage, and the intelligent reader will not let controversial issues distract her from the immense value of these, at least in terms of devotion and faith. My commentaries on this writing barely begin to touch its spiritual depths. Its references to the Gospels, the Psalms, Daniel and Isaiah and other prophets remain relatively untouched and provide a goldmine of study and devotion.

The book is a bouquet from a depleted and forgotten rose garden, filled with the perfumes of Andalusia, that crown of human civilization lost forever under the ruins of the ghetto that was

created by the so-called Reconquista. We who continue to live in that ghetto are wise to take hold of any scrap left of the former delights.

O blind hearts and minds who debate the book,
Some saying it's a forgery in nook,
And others that it is the Gospel true,
Despite those facts that conflict with their view,
Depart from me, depart, the both of you!
Beloved, I know the reasons pro and con
For the debate, and yet I'm amazed on
The field to see the wonders spirit's drawn
On the notebook of Barnabas to last.
I do not care about the crucifixion,
Or whether it was made a fact or fiction.
I care about the path of faith I see
Drawn here in all its marvelled clarity,
The practice of a prayer in purity.

1 Barnabas, apostle of one
Jesus of Nazareth, *when done*
Called Christ, to all who dwell on earth
Desires peace and comfort in worth.

Did Barnabas in truth write of these words
To sour belief in Christian whey and curds?
The arguments against it so relate,
If it is so, to something written late
In the tongue of cunning Italianate.
So Vulgate and Dante, the added gloss
Of false geography may be the dross
Of translator as well as author's fault.
The proof is simply lacking froth and malt.
The best that I can say's the book goes back
To fourteenth century version, and the lack
Of scrap thereof in former times makes me
Suspicious but not sure it's forgery.
And yet it is a bridge from You to me.

2 Dearly beloved, the great and true
God in these past days brought to view
Among us His prophet who's called
Jesus the Christ in mercy walled
For teaching and for wonders wrought.
But many in Satan's coils caught,
Pretending faith and piety,
Are preaching doctrines *to the free*,
Calling Jesus the Son of God,
Rejecting circumcision's rod
Ordained by God for ever, and
Permitting unclean meat to stand,

Among whom also Paul's deceived,
To which I refer unrelieved
Of grief, and yet for which cause I
Am writing that truth of which I
Am witness with both eye and ear
Of what Jesus did *far and near*,
That you may be saved and not fear
Satan's deception and be lost
In the judgement of God *and tossed*.
Therefore beware of every one
Who preaches you *under the sun*
A new doctrine contrary to
That which I write, and so that you
May be saved in eternity.
The great God be with you and see
To your safety from Satan and
From evil set on every hand. Amen.

Perhaps a writer of the early times
Could imagine that Paul in words and rhymes
Fostered the eating of the unclean thing
And opposed circumcision on the wing.
But I doubt anyone who lived to see
Christ delivered up from the cursed tree
Heard any man say Son of God was meant
To make of You progenitor or bent
To make of Christ Almighty God. Relent.
Those blasphemies are from a later day
Than when Paul walked the Galilean way.
And yet who knows what arguments were spent
Among the Romans and the Greeks to say
What was the popular in thought and ray.

Barnabas 1

1 In these last years a young lady
Called Mary on the family tree
Of David and tribe of Judah
Received visitation in awe
Of the angel Gabriel from God.
This young woman lived by the rod
Of holiness without offence,
And blameless, and dwelt in the tents
Of prayer with fasting. And one day
When she was alone, came *her way*
Into her room the angel sent,
Gabriel who in greeting bent,
Saying "Mary, God be with you."
2 The young lady before the view
Of the angel was frightened, but
The angel comforted the cut

Saying "Fear not, Mary, for you
Have found favour with God, and who
Has chosen you to be the mom
Of a prophet *to sound of Psalm*,
A prophet sent to Israel's folk
So they may walk in His laws' *stroke*
With truth in heart *of every bloke*."

Most days You do not frighten me by sending
An angel to the places where I'm bending
In prayer of prostration toward Your place.
I do not startle to see angel face.
Most days I breathe and walk in the illusion
Of quiet earth, and need not hide confusion,
But pretend nothing strange, angelic bright
Clutters with murmurings my day and night.
Beloved, most days I hide the wonderings
And almost hearings of the angel wings
That brush my soul caught as by thrones of kings
Upon an arid soil, a toil and feat.
Beloved, I hide within my soul the treat
And step out so unlovely on the street.

3 The maiden answered, "How shall I
Bear children without a man by?"

The angel answered, "O Mary,
God who made Adam without plea
Of father can perform in you
That generation without crew
Of mankind, because with Him no
Thing is impossible to show."

4 Mary responded, "I know God
Is great in power upon the sod,
Therefore His will be done *in me*."

At that the angel said "Now be
Conceived in you the prophet whom
You shall name Jesus in his room,
And you shall keep him from both wine
And from strong drink and from *design*
Of unclean meat, because the child
Is one holy to God, *not wild*."

And Mary bowed herself to say
In her humility that day,

5 "Look on the handmaid of the Lord,
Be done according to your word."

I am no virgin as some can bear rate,
And have no purity, at least not great,
But I too at the angel call retire
To kneel before Your throne in my desire

To take Your word abundant and creative
Upon my tongue and lips in praises native.
Let my heart too be like that young girl's heart
To make me take the humble duty's part,
And say before all times and spaces I
Submit to You alone to live and die.
Beloved, I lie open, inviolate,
Awaiting the descent of Your word's fate,
And trust the pure faith that grows in my breast
Shall ever be for Yours and my love nest.

6 The angel left and the young lass
Glorified God, saying to pass,
"Know, O my soul, God's greatness here,
And exult, my spirit, in cheer
Of God my Saviour, for He's looked
In favour on His maid unbrooked,
So that I shall be called among
All nations blessed by every tongue,
For the Mighty has made me great,
And blessed be His name and state.
His mercy from the generation
To generation with elation
Runs for them that fear Him in due.
He's set His hand mighty in view
To scatter the proud in the wake
Of his heart imaginings' sake.
He's put the mighty from their place
And exalted the humble face.
The hungry has He filled with good,
And sent the wealthy as they should
Away with empty hands. So He
Remembers the promises He
Made to Abraham and his son
Forever *till the day is done.*"

None is my Saviour, my Beloved, but You,
No man can ever fill the divine shoe.
You set at naught the great and the allowed,
And bring to shame the shameful, published crowd,
And set Your mercy on the small and weak.
You hide from plying eyes that stalk and peek.
I have been hungry on a day to find
That You fill up the cup of deaf and blind
With coins fitted for passer-by to steal.
So Your blessings come for the woe and weal.
Beloved, I come with empty hand, it's true,
And like the rich go empty from my pew,
But find in the gold dust that fills the air
The radiance to know that You are there.

Barnabas 2

1 When Mary knew the will of God,
She feared the people lest in prod
They take offence that she was great
With child, and stone her for her state
As a guilty one fornicator.
So she chose of her own kinfolk
As mate a man whose name when spoke
Was Joseph, one of blameless life,
A righteous man and without strife
That feared God and served Him will all
Fastings and prayers, living by call
Of the works of his hands withal
As he was a builder. And so
Knowing the man, she was not slow,
The young lass was, to choose him for
Her mate, and revealed him the store
Of the divine council to show.

2 And Joseph was a righteous man
When he noticed poor Mary's span
As great with child, and so he thought
To put her away as was taught
Since he feared God. But as he slept
He was rebuked for what he kept
By God's own angel, saying "O
Joseph, why are you minded so
To put away Mary your wife?
Know that what's made in her of life
Has all been done by God's will rife.
The virgin shall bring forth a son,
Whom you shall call by the name won
Of Jesus, whom you'll keep from wine
And strong drink and unclean design
Of meat, because he is a one
Holy of God from his mom's bun.
He is a prophet of God sent
For the people of Israel meant,
To convert Judah to his heart,
That Israel may walk in the part
Of the Lord's law, as it is writ
In the law of Moses *and fit*.
He shall come with great power, which God
Shall give him and work on the sod
Great miracles, whereby a crowd
Shall be saved *in the grace allowed*."
Joseph, arising from his sleep,
Gave thanks to God and thanks to keep,
And stayed with Mary all his life
Sincerely serving God *and wife*.

Beloved, I too flee from surprises cast
Upon my days and nights sometimes to last.
Who live in time and space make habit seem
Reality for all its lack of gleam.
Forgive me that I think Your pregnant word
That would transform me from the clod and turd
Into a witness of Your power and grace,
Your glories and Your vastnesses that trace
Eternities and universes come
Into imaginations unstirred, dumb.
Forgive both me and Joseph as we toil
Beneath the sun unseeing brighter coil,
Turning the uncut diamonds with the soil,
Grasping instead the tinsel and the foil.

Barnabas 3

1 There reigned at that time in the land
Of Judaea Herod by hand
Of Caesar Augustus, (and then
Pilate was made governor when
Annas and Caiaphas stood
In the temple in the priesthood).
Therefore by Augustus' decree
All the world was enrolled to be
Each one gone up to his country,
To present themselves by their tribes
To be enrolled, *but without bribes*.
Joseph left Nazareth's *estate*,
A city of Galilee *late*,
With his wife Mary who was great
With child to go to Bethlehem,
Since it was his city, the gem
Of David's lineage and his own,
To be enrolled according to
Caesar's decree *of what to do*.
Joseph arrived in Bethlehem
And found the town both small and hem,
As being filled with strangers lone,
And so he took a place to live
Outside the city *in a sieve*
Made for shepherds, a place to give
Them shelter. While Joseph stayed there
The days were fulfilled for the care
For Mary to give birth *in share*.
2 The virgin was surrounded by
A light as bright as in the sky,
And gave birth to her son withal,
Whom she took in her arms *as small*,
And wrapped him up in swaddling-clothes,

And laid him in a manger's *rows*,
Because there was no room then found
In any of the inns around.
There came with gladness a great crowd
Of angels to the inn, aloud
Blessing God and announcing peace
Or Islam to those who increase
In fear of God. They came to praise,
Joseph and Mary did, *for days*
The Lord for Jesus' birth, and they
Nurtured him with great joy *to stay*.

One can't go home, it seems by running race
Through tired hills, always increasing pace
Until the once familiar landscape reels
Across the vision in the thing one feels
To be remembering the blessed time
Of childhood and the wealth of trees to climb
And swing out on grape-vine and purple wing.
The going home is a sweet bitter thing.
The house is gone or let out to another,
And where once rang the chatter of the brother
And sister, now the stranger takes a seat.
There is no longer room. So change is fleet.
Beloved, I seek a place in Your heart now
When I see the crease on Joseph's cold brow.

Barnabas 4

1 At that time shepherds watched their flocks
As is their habit *on the rocks*.
Behold, they were surrounded by
A great bright light from which they spy
An angel blessing God *in cry*.
The shepherds then were filled with fear
To see the sudden light appear
And how the angel came to be,
The angel spoke comfortingly,
Saying 2 "See here I now proclaim
To you great joy, in town of name
Of David there is born a child
Who is a prophet *reconciled*
To the Lord, who brings great salvation
To the house of Israel *in ration*.
And you shall find the child to lie
In a manger, his mother by
To bless God *in a word or try*."
3 And when he had said this there came
A great crowd of angels *in flame*
And blessing God, proclaiming peace,
Or as may, be Islam's increase,

To those of goodwill *in release*.
 The angels gone, the shepherds spoke
 Among themselves saying *a stroke*,
 “Now let us go to Bethlehem,
 And see the word which God *as gem*
 By His angels proclaimed to us.”
 Many shepherds came *in a bus*
 To Bethlehem to find the child
 New-born *and resting in the wild*,
 Outside the town, the baby born,
 According to angel’s word sworn,
 Lying in the manger *of scorn*.
 4 They bowed before him and they gave
 To the mother some things to save,
 And told her what they’d heard and seen.
 Mary pondered what it would mean
 In her heart, and Joseph *also*
 Gave thanks to God *for angel show*.
 The shepherds went back to their flock
 Telling everyone the whole crock
 That they had seen. And so the whole
 Hill country in Judaea’s toll
 Was filled with fear and every man
 Kept this word in his own heart’s *span*,
 Saying “For boding what shall come
 And what shall this child be in sum?”

Beloved, Your angels twitter in the trees
 All about me except the time of freeze
 And yet I do not rush like shepherd man
 To find the manger and the baby’s ban.
 Instead I barely give the words a nod
 And plod on like before the unseen God,
 And never take the angel wings in thought
 To see what marvels in colour You’ve wrought.
 Beloved, let me turn at the angel word
 And let my heart, like shepherd heart, be stirred.
 Let me walk under all the glories vast
 Of the uncovered heavens over mast
 To find the treasure in the inner cave
 Where You are master and I am the slave.

Barnabas 5

1 When the eight days were fulfilled by
 The law of the Lord, to rely
 On what is written in the book
 Of Moses, they carried and took
 The child to the temple that way
 To circumcise him *the right day*.
 And there they circumcised the child,

And named him Jesus, *a name wild*,
As the Lord's angel said before
He was conceived at the womb's door.
Mary and Joseph noticed that
The child would be a thermostat
To save and ruin many folk.
That's why they feared God *when He spoke*
And kept the boy fearing God's *stroke*.

After the seven days had passed that You,
Beloved, require before bringing to pew
The new-born male to suffer clamp and screw,
The little Jesus came into the view
Of the grand temple. What a lucky boy
To see that place before men would destroy
It on the grounds the Jewish folk employ
Rebellion against Caesar. I have been
On that same spot, and felt the human sin
Of grand destruction weighing on my breast
As guards and soldiers came to do their best
To ascertain if I should be let in.
Beloved, it's such a slight thing You require
In sacrifice before I am entire.

Barnabas 6

1 In Herod's reign, Judaea's king,
Three eastern magi saw a thing
Among the stars of heaven's ring.
Appeared to them a great, bright star,
From which they decided afar
To go to Judaea as guided
By the star that in front presided,
And when they found Jerusalem
They asked where the Jews' king, the gem
Had been born. And when Herod heard
This he was frightened, and was stirred
All the city. 2 So Herod called
Together all the priests appalled
And the scribes, saying "Where should Christ
Be born?" They answered *when enticed*
That he should be born *in the town*
Of Bethlehem, as written down
By the prophet, 3 "And you, O town
Of Bethlehem, are not so small
Among princes on Judah's wall,
For out of you there shall appear
A leader leading without fear
My people Israel *and dear*."
4 So Herod summoned the magi
And asked them of their coming why,

And they said they had seen a star
In the east, which guided them far,
And that's why they wished with their gifts
To prostrate to this king *with shrifts*
Announced anew by his star's *drifts*.
5 Then Herod said "Go to the town
Of Bethlehem and search *for crown*
With diligence to find the child,
And when you've found him *reconciled*,
Then come and tell me, so I too
May come prostrating *at his pew*."
But all he'd spoken was untrue.

This method of Herod is what is tried
By the interrogator now to side
With criminal or suspect to find out
By kindly consultation and not shout
The secrets he possesses, it would seem.
Deceit is favoured for effect, but scream
Is also found once to intimidate,
If overheard from some cell of a mate.
If that fails, there's a place outside the state
Where torture still gets answers, though they're late.
If Herod had no truth serum, he had
At least the first kind weapon of the bad,
And as such is the father of the race
Of police that now patrol every place.

Barnabas 7

1 The magi left Jerusalem
And see, the star shone *like a gem*
As it had led them from the east,
Now leading them *toward the feast*.
And when they saw the star indeed
They were filled with gladness *in speed*.
And when they came to Bethlehem,
Outside the town they saw the gem
Of the star standing still above
The inn where Jesus *by God's love*
Was born. The magi therefore went
There and entered the house on rent
And found the child and mother there,
And bowed down their honour to share.
And the magi gave him the gifts
Of spices, silver and gold *shrifts*,
And told the virgin all they'd seen.
Then while they slept, a warning keen
Came from the child not to return
To Herod, so they left the burn
Another way to their own home,

Proclaiming *under every dome*
What they saw in Judaea's turn.

Beloved, I too have followed just Your star
Read in the Decalogue and not in bar
Of the defined faiths of the evil gar.
But like the magi, I too find my path
Winds round the towers of the eternal wrath
Of king and priest, who would impose for truth
What seems right to a man in age or youth.
The guiding star Your word declares to me
And so I turn from temple to the free
And desert path covered in veils from sun
And from the night chills where the mousies run.
Let that child who once warned those holy men
Speak guidance to my wakened heart again
Until my trek to find You once is done.

Barnabas 8

1 When Herod saw the magi left
Without returning *as in theft*,
He thought they mocked him, and so he
Determined to *do wickedly*
And put to death the new-born child.
But see while Joseph *unbeguiled*
Was sleeping there appeared to him
The angel of the Lord *not dim*,
Who said "Get up fast, take the child
Along with his mother and go
Into Egypt, for Herod's woe
Is to kill him." Joseph in fright
Got up and took them at midnight,
Both Mary and the child, and they
Went into Egypt, where they stay
Until they heard that Herod died,
Who, thinking the magi deride,
Sent soldiers to kill all the young
Children in Bethlehem *unstrung*.
And so the soldiers came and slew
All the children there, not a few,
As Herod had commanded them.
And so prophetic word fulfilled,
Saying "Lamentation unstilled
And great weeping are in Ramah,
Rachel weeps for her genera,
But is not comforted at all,
Because they are not in their stall."

The legend of the king who kills the sons
In infancy of those who in their tons

Ignore royal decree, is found around
The world, and is so common on the ground
That scholars say it must be mythic bound.
Just because violence is common lot
Of those who live beneath the kingly plot
Does not prove fatality by sword got
In fairy-tales alone. Beloved, I know
The sting of civil servant at the bow.
They do not hesitate to steal the show
By killing infants, if the paperwork
Is right and signed by any other jerk
Whose glazed office functions without a quirk.

Barnabas 9

1 When Herod died, see who appeared,
The angel of the Lord *as feared*
In a dream to Joseph, and said
“Go back to Judaea, they’re dead,
The ones who would have killed the child.”
So Joseph therefore took the child,
Already aged to seven years,
Along with Mary to *the cheers*
Of Judaea, where, hearing that
Archelaus, son of Herod, sat
On Judaea’s throne, he went to
Galilee, scared to stay and do
In Judaea, and they went to
Live in Nazareth. The child grew
In grace and wisdom before God
And before men *upon the sod*.
2 When Jesus became twelve years old
He went up with Joseph and *bold*
Mary to Jerusalem’s prayer
According to the law *made bare*
By YHWH written in Moses’ book.
When their prayers ended they forsook
The place, but lost Jesus, because
They thought he went back with in-laws.
So Mary went back to *the town*
Of Jerusalem *with a frown*
With Joseph to look for *the boy*
Jesus among kinfolk’s *convoy*
And neighbours. On the third day they
Found the child in the temple’s sway,
Among the doctors *of the law*,
Disputing with them points of law.
Everyone was amazed at his
Questions and answers *to the quiz*,
Saying “How can such doctrine be
In him seeing he’s small and free

From learning to read *audibly?* ”
3 So Mary chided him and said
“Son, what did you do to us *fled?*
See, your father and I have searched
For you three days, *while you were perched*
Here to our grief.” Jesus answered,
“Do you not know the sacred word
That service to God ought to come
Before father and mother’s *drum?*
Then Jesus went down with his mum
And dad Joseph *and with aplomb*
To Nazareth, and there obeyed
Them humbly, holy *as he stayed.*

Jerusalem is not a town so great
That it cannot be trodden down a rate
In some few hours to find a little boy.
The three days must have included employ
About the wayside gossiping a bit.
And yet I can abide a mother’s fit.
Jesus shows his imamic style to know
Without instruction all the come and go
Of divine law. The boy is a born saint.
The doctors who ask questions are ones quaint.
And yet with all the wisdom of the age
He goes back to parental patronage
As sweetly as a dove to its home cage.
Beloved, I too leave off my old complaint.

The geographic argument of late
That Barnabas is forgery on slate
Grows dim to see that here Jesus went up
To Jerusalem for the feasty cup,
And down again to Nazareth though late.
Since the holy city is in the south
From Nazareth, the forger’s likely mouth
Would put it down. Only the knowing one
That sees Jerusalem as up for fun
Would mention without thinking going there
As though it were a fancy flight in air.
The errors replete of the book are those
Typical of translator in his pose,
Who did not notice where the temple rose.

Barnabas 10

1 When Jesus was thirty years old
As he himself told me *out bold,*
He went up to Mount Olives and
His mother went *to hold his hand*
As they gather the fruit *and sold.*

Then at midday he came to pray,
 And when he had the words to say
 "Melek hannum wa rahum atta..."
 He was surrounded with great matter
 Of bright light and by multitude
 Of shining angels who not rude
 Said "Barukh atta Ælohim."
 The angel Gabriel gave to him
 As it were a bright mirror book,
 Which came down lodging in a nook
 Of Jesus' heart, in which he had
 Knowledge of what God has done *sad*
 And what He's said and what God wills
 So that everything *in the tills*
 Was laid bare and open to him.
 And he said to me, "*Don't be grim,*
 But believe, Barnabas, that I
 See every prophet prophesy,
 So that whatever I say, all
 Comes from that book *as by my call.*"
 2 Jesus, when he had got this view,
 And knowing he was prophet *true*
 Sent to the house of Israel,
 Revealed all to Mary *as well,*
 His mother, telling her that he
 Must suffer great adversity
 For God's honour, and he could not
 Stay with her longer, share her lot.
 On hearing this, Mary then said
 "Son, before you were born, I fed
 On that announcement, therefore blessed
 Be the holy name of God's *rest.*
 So Jesus left that very day
 To attend his prophetic way.

Beloved, I love that prophet's book that came
 Into the heart of Jesus for his fame.
 It is a mirror bright into which look
 The generations of men who mistook
 Either the image of their own face there
 As evil and justified their act bare,
 Or good, and so inspired by good, went out
 To do good everywhere they came about.
 As I look in the prophet's words, let me
 See not evil justified, but agree
 To follow Your justice and to repent
 When I have gone wherein I was not sent.
 Beloved, I cantillate the shining words
 And fill my songs with angels and their birds.

Barnabas 11

1 As Jesus came down from the mount
To come into Quds *for account*,
He met a leper who by some
Divine inspiring in the chum
Knew Jesus was a prophet, so
With tears he begged him have a go,
Saying "Jesus, you David's son,
Have mercy on me *and be done.*"
Jesus replied, "What do you want,
Brother, from me *and not to daunt?*"
2 The leper answered, "My lord give
Me health *so I can fully live.*"
3 Jesus reproved him, saying "You
Are foolish, pray to God *as due*,
And to Him who created you,
And He will give you health, for I
Am just a man as you *to try.*"
4 The leper answered, "I know you,
Sir, are a man, but holy, true
To the Lord. Now then pray to God
To give me health *here on the sod.*"
5 Then Jesus sighed and said "Lord God
Almighty, for the love of Your
Holy prophets *gone on before*,
Give health to this sick man." When he
Had said this, he touched the sick man
With his hands in God's name as can,
"O brother, take your health by plan!"
And he was cleansed of leprosy
When he had said this *to the man*,
So that the leper's flesh became
To him like a child's and the same.
When the leper saw he was healed,
He shouted out *to hill and field*,
"Come here, Israel, and find the one
God sends you as a prophet won."
Jesus begged him, saying *to stop*,
"Brother, be quiet *at the top.*"
The more he begged, the more he yelled,
And said, "See prophet *unexcelled*,
The holy one of God *unquelled!*"
When he said that, many who came
Out of Jerusalem turned flame
And ran back and with Jesus came
Into Jerusalem to tell
What God through Jesus had done well
To the leper upon the fell.

Beloved, I meet Your sent one in the place

Where I am wandering in the hilly race
And whirling to chase You and find Your face,
And there he tells me with a touch to go
Out clean and whole, but not to make a show.
What am I but a spectacle and shame
To him who pronounces the holy name?
And yet my voice is one to hear when I
Speak of Your miracles beneath the sky.
I see the breath of wind rise on the trees
That once spoke lonely to the far off seas.
I see the clouds part, and Your glory pass
From heaven into my heart to melt its crass.
Beloved, I enter Quds on hands and knees.

Barnabas 12

1 Jerusalem and the whole city
Was moved by these words *and the ditty*,
And so they all ran in a group
To the temple to see the loop
Of Jesus, who had come inside
To pray, so scarce a place to hide
Remained. And so the priests all cried
To Jesus, saying "This folk wishes
To see and hear you, *though suspicious*,
So go up where you can be seen,
And if God's given in between
A word, then speak it in the name
Of the Lord, *and speak without shame.*"

The translator, not knowing of the place,
Quite naturally gave "pinnacle" a trace,
Assuming that Jerusalem of old
Was like Italian palace and stronghold.
But You, Beloved, remember in Your grace
To sanctify in every time and space
The universe and world with Your own being,
And bring truth through the veils of man's unseeing.
Today the crowds run to the microphone
And to the stage for steel and not for stone.
The difference is set in multitude,
Not in being wise, polite, or less rude.
Beloved, I listen for that word and speech
That in all time and place comes down to preach.

2 Then Jesus went up to the place
Where scribes were wont to show their face,
And having waved his hand for quiet,
He opened mouth to speak *or try it*,
Saying "Blessed be the holy name
Of God, who of His goodness' fame

And mercy willed His creature done,
 They might honour Him *under sun*.
 Blessed be the holy name of God,
 Who created the splendour's pod
 Of all the saints and prophets met
 Before all things to send him set
 For the salvation of the world,
 As He spoke by His servant hurled,
 David, saying 'Before the light
 Bearer and all the saints as bright
 You I created.' Blessèd be
 The holy name of God, who made
 The angels that they might *when stayed*
 Serve him. And blessed be God who did
 Punish casting out Satan's bid
 And his followers who would not
 Reverence him who God had sought
 To be revered. Blessèd be
 The holy name of God who formed
 Man out of earth's clay and informed
 Him over all His works. Blessed be
 The holy name of God who drove
 Man out of paradise and hove
 For having transgressed holy law.
 Blessed be the holy name in awe
 Of God, who with mercy looked on
 The tears of Adam and Eve *drawn*,
 First parents of the human race.

The author knows the Jewish form of prayer
 Taken from Noah's blessing on Him there
 And curses, when his sons did what they dare.
 He knows the story of Satan's neglect
 To bow down before Adam the elect,
 Although that story is not found to be
 In Moses' books as written faithfully.
 He knew Isaiah's scroll was found to go
 Behind the words of David and to show
 The whole collection called Zabur to know
 Four books shall enter in the world to glow.
 The unbeliever looks here to find fault,
 But all is written with pepper and salt.
 I follow You, Beloved, believing row.

Blessed be God's holy name *and face*
 Who justly punished Cain who killed
 His brother, and then sent and spilled
 A flood on earth, burned *to the ground*
 Three wicked cities *that He found*,
 Scourged Egypt, overwhelmed Pharaoh

In the Red Sea, scattered the foe
 Of His people, chastised those who
 Did not believe, as for the *crew*
 Impenitent, He punished too.
 Blessed be God's holy name, for He
 Looked on His creatures in mercy,
 And sent therefore His holy prophets
 That they might walk *both roofs and soffits*
 In truth and righteousness *to be*
 Before Him, who saved faithfully
 His servants from all wickedness,
 And gave them this land *and address*,
 As He promised to Abraham
 Our father, and his son to cram.
 Then by His servant Moses He
 Gave us His holy law to see,
 So Satan could not deceive us,
 But above all other folk's fuss
 He exalted us *faithfully*.
 3 But brothers, what do we do now
 Not to be punished anyhow
 For the sins *He does not allow?*”
 4 And then Jesus with vigour's vim
 Rebuked the people for their dim
 Forgetting of the word of God,
 And gave themselves only to pod
 Of vanity; and he reproached
 The priests for neglecting the coached
 Service of God, and for their greed
 To gain the world *they did not need*;
 He also reproached scribes that they
 Preached vain doctrine, forsook the way
 Of God's law; he rebuked the doctors
 Because they, as they were concocters,
 Nullified God's law by tradition.
 In this way Jesus made audition
 To the people until they wept
 From least to greatest *of whom slept*,
 Crying mercy and so beseeching
 Jesus to pray for them *as preaching*,
 But not the priests and leaders who
 That day conceived hatred in view
 Of what Jesus said against crew
 Of priests and scribes and doctors too.
 They quietly planned how to kill him,
 But since the people did not chill him,
 But thought he was God's prophet true,
 They did not say a word *or do*.
 5 Jesus raised his hands *stretching out*
 To the Lord God, prayed *without doubt*,

And all the people wept and said
“Amen, O Lord, so be it *spread*. ”
When Jesus finished up his prayer,
He went down from the temple there.
That very day he went out from
Jerusalem, many would come
To follow him, but the priests spoke
Evil of Jesus to a bloke.

The author of this Gospel knows the state
Of the first century and Jewish fate,
And how the Sadducees neglected law
Because they felt obliged by Caesar’s awe,
And how the Pharisees in verdict’s view
Took traditions of men instead of You,
So king and emperor would not find fault
And be threatened by conspiring assault.
No Medieval mind could produce the facts
So well to analyse those ancient acts.
Beloved, who speaks Your word today as well
Finds simple people who love what You tell,
And bishops and mullahs and rabbis set
Against truth and repentance in their net.

Barnabas 13

1 After some days Jesus knew well
In spirit the priests’ sentinel,
And so he went up for his prayer
Into the Mount of Olives there.
And having prayed there all night long,
At dawn Jesus prayed in this song,
“O Lord, I know the scribes hate me,
The priests are minded to kill me,
Your servant, so YHWH *Ælohim*,
Almighty, merciful *You seem*,
In mercy hear Your servant’s prayers
And save Your servant from their snares,
For You are my salvation’s *strength*,
You know, Lord, that I am *at length*
Your servant to seek You alone,
O Lord, speak Your word *from Your throne*,
Because Your word with truth is filled
Enduring forever unstilled.”
2 When Jesus had spoken these words,
An angel came *with undergirds*,
And Gabriel said “Don’t be afraid,
Jesus, since thousand thousand stayed
Above the sky to guard your clothes,
And you will not die till dispose
All things and the world’s near its close.”

3 Jesus fell prostrate on the earth,
Saying *in prayer*, “Great God *of worth*,
And Lord, to me Your mercy’s great,
And what shall I give You *in state*,
Lord, for all You have granted me?”
The angel Gabriel answered *free*,
“Get up, Jesus, mind Abraham,
Who was willing to make *in sham*
A sacrifice of Ishmael
His son only-begotten well
To God and to fulfil God’s word,
And when the knife had been deterred
At my command offered a sheep
In sacrifice. So you shall keep
The same way, Jesus, and not sleep,
Servant of God.” 4 Jesus said then,
“With all my heart, but where again
Shall I acquire a sheep, for I
Don’t have its price, I cannot lie
Or steal unlawfully.” That’s why
The angel Gabriel showed to him
A sheep Jesus offered *with vim*,
Praising and blessing God *for him*
Forever glorious *and not dim*.

From the beginning of Your Scriptures sent
From heaven to the last revelation meant
For humankind, Beloved, all those who know
To believe in Your revelation’s glow
Have always prayed upon the earth to show
Their reverence for Your name. I do not know
A single prophet or divine guide who
Failed to worship You in the right and true.
Earth prostration is given to human view
That we might find the taste of leaf and dew
Upon the praying lip and be refreshed.
I take the dry turba where I’m enmeshed
In modern life cut off to earth and sky.
And yet I find Your presence passing by.

Barnabas only tells of this event,
For no one saw it, it was only sent
From Jesus’ witness to the writer so
He could write down the secret of the row
That Abraham hoed with Ishmael to find
The substitute in ram and sheep and kind.
The substitute in offering is set
As type prophetic of the figure met
To face the cross in place of the intended
When nothing else fixed politics and mended

Suspensions of the Roman power that one
Came as a king and master under sun.
Beloved, whatever history's unknown,
Your promises are kept before Your throne.

Barnabas 14

1 Then Jesus went down from the mount,
And passed alone by night's *account*
To Jordan's farther side and there
Fasted forty days and nights there,
Not eating by day, but by night,
Supplicating the Lord for right
Salvation for his folk to whom
God had sent him not for their doom.
And when the forty days were passed
He was hungry. Then came at last
Satan to him to tempt with words,
But Jesus drove him off *like birds*
By the power of God's words. Satan
Having left him, there came *in span*
Angels to serve Jesus in need,
Whatever of both drink and feed.

The foolish of men think that Moses' fast,
And that later of Jesus when they passed
Forty days and nights under boiling sun
In the howling desert before the run
Of their prophetship, that they drank and ate
Not a drop or morsel when it was late.
The fast is to spend only daylight hours
Without food or drink as the human powers
Allow the thing. No miracles unfold
In fasting but the revelation of
Your word and to the poor the sacred love
That makes alms given from the heart and hand
A thing not only of duty's command.
Jesus is fed by angels in the land.

2 Jesus went back to the place of
Jerusalem, and found with love
And joy the people greeted him,
And they begged him to stay in trim
With them, for his words were not those
The scribes spoke, but with power enclose,
For they touched in the heart *and rose*.
3 Jesus, when he saw how great was
The multitude of those whose heart
Was set to walk in their God's laws,
He went into the mount apart
And stayed all night in prayer *to start*.

At dawn he came down from the mount
And chose twelve on whom he could count
As apostles, among whom is
Judas, slain on the cross of his.
Their names are Andrew and his bro
Peter, both fishermen to go,
Barnabas, who wrote this not slow,
Matthew the publican, who sat
At the receipt of custom fat,
John and James, sons of Zebedee,
Thaddaeus and Judas the free,
Bartholomew, Philip and James,
And Judas Iscariot for fames
The traitor. To these he revealed
Always divine secrets and sealed,
But Iscariot Judas he
Made his dispenser of alms free,
But he stole the tithe of the lot,
And that's why he ought to be shot.

Here are two secrets the church has not told:
That Judas was set out on the cross cold
Instead of Jesus, and he was the ram
Caught in the bushes of dishonest scam
And so became the substitute that set
Jesus free for ascension, don't forget.
The second secret is that Thomas is
The twin but there's a surname, one of his,
Given later because of what he did
In selling land and giving to the bid
Of widow and of orphan, so he gained
The surname Barnabas, by which he reigned
Like Jupiter before the heathen crowd
And wrote this gospel when he spoke aloud.

Barnabas 15

1 When feast of Succoth had come near
A certain rich man holding dear
Jesus invited him and his
Disciples and mother, that is
To a wedding. So Jesus went,
And as they feasted they found spent
The grape juice. Jesus' mother went
To him and said, "They have no wine."
Jesus said "What, O Mother mine,
Is that to me? His mother told
The servants to do, *meek or bold*,
Whatever Jesus might command.
There were six vessels out to stand
With water for the Israel band

By custom for to purify
 Themselves for prayer. Jesus came by
 And said "Put water in these jars
 And fill them." And so did the gars.
 Jesus told them, "In name of God,
 Give it to drink to them *though odd*,
 Who're feasting." So the servants bore
 To the arranger, on that score.
 He chided the attendants saying
 "O worthless servants *who keep playing*,
 Why did you keep the better wine
 Till now?" For he knew not *in fine*
 What Jesus had done *as a sign*.
 2 The servants answered, "O sir, there
 Is here a holy man, *we swear*,
 Of God, and he took water there
 And turned the water into wine."
 The master arranger thought that
 The servants were drunk *at the bat*,
 But those sitting near Jesus, who
 Had seen the whole thing in their view,
 Rose from the table and paid due
 Reverence, saying "Truly you are
 A holy one of God, a star
 Prophet sent by God *from afar!*"
 Then his disciples believed him,
 And many came with heart *undim*,
 Saying "Praised be God who has shown
 Mercy on Israel not alone,
 But on the house of Judah *too*
 Visits with love, and blessings *due*
 Be on His holy name *and throne*.

It seems those of true faith wash hands and feet
 Before their prayers in every time and meet,
 While others think it auspicious and sweet
 To pray with head and hands unwashed to greet
 You, King of universe and each man's heart.
 Without ablutions, there'd have been no part
 Of new wine for the wedding from the start.
 The servants get the blame for bringing old,
 Partly fermented wine perhaps, not cold,
 First to the feasters, when the new wine came
 Sweet and fresh as from the winepress in fame.
 Some say Jesus made alcoholic wine.
 Such people trust their lusts come in to dine.
 Wine does not ferment in ten minutes' line.

Barnabas 16

1 One day Jesus summoned his own

Disciples and climbed *the backbone*
 Of a mountain, and when he sat
 There his disciples *pitapat*
 Came near him, and he opened lips
 And taught them, saying *without skips*,
 “Great are the benefits which God
 Has bestowed on us *on the sod*,
 Whom we should serve with truth of heart.
 For as new wine is put into
 New wineskins, even so you too
 Ought become new men, if you
 Will have in you the doctrine new
 That shall come from my mouth *as due*.
 Truly I say to you that as
 A man cannot use eyes he has
 To see the earth and sky at once,
 So it’s impossible *for stunts*
 To love God and the world’s *affronts*.
 2 “No man can any wise serve two
 Masters that are in conflict *stew*
 With one another, for if one
 Shall love you, then the other’s *fun*
 Will *be to* hate you. Even so
 I tell the truth, you cannot serve
 God and the world, for the world’s curve
 Is in falsehood, covetousness
 And in malignity’s *address*.
 So you cannot find rest within
 The world, but rather *to begin*
 Persecution and loss. Therefore
 Serve God and despise the world’s *door*,
 For from me you shall find your rest
 For your souls, hear my words and blessed
 For I speak truth to you, *not more*.
 3 “Truly, blessed are the ones that mourn
 This earthly life, for they are borne
 In comfort. 4 “Blessèd are the poor
 Who truly hate this world’s delights
 For they shall abound in *the sights*
 Of God’s kingdom *and at His door*.

Beatitudes are great since Moses wrote
 The Deuteronomy and learned to tote
 Out blessings as well as curses that smote
 The well-intended in the Red Sea boat.
 So the poor in this world are blessed indeed,
 At least in word if not in kale and seed,
 And in Your sight if not in sight of king,
 Who struts with butts as grand as anything.
 The kingdom of God is great to behold,

Especially when not left in the cold,
But taken in by You, Beloved and bold,
Creator of the universe untold.
Bless me too for my frolicking if not
For lack of faith in every other plot.

5 “Truly blessed are the ones that eat
At God’s table, for it’s their treat
That angels shall serve them *and greet*.

6 “You travel as a pilgrim band.
Do pilgrims encumber with land
And palaces and earthly things
Upon the way? Surely on wings
He bears things light and prized for their
Usefulness on the roadway there
And the convenience *on the trip*.
Now this should be like goad and whip
To you, if you desire another
Example I’ll give you it, brother,
So you may do all that I say.

I’ve joined the pilgrim band here by the star
That shows the path beneath the silver bar
Of the boreal forest stretching far
To east and even west some hours by car.
I’ve joined the band by train and boat and plane
To go to Makkah as a pilgrim’s bane,
To sleep at Muna and at Arafat
And watch the white-clad spirits where they’re at.
Beloved, You welcome me into Your house,
Despite my lack of pantaloons and blouse,
Wrapped in the pale garb of the innocent.
Perhaps You did not know me where I went
And thought I was a better one than sent
Among the goats without a single grouse.

7 “Do not take earthly hopes to weigh
Down your hearts, saying ‘Who shall clothe
Us’ or ‘Who shall give us to eat?’
But see the message not to loathe
Of flower and tree and bird which God
Our Lord clothes and nourishes more
With glory than Solomon’s score.
And He is able to keep you,
Even God who created you
And called you to His service true,
Who forty years made manna fall
From heaven for his folk Israel
In the desert, and did not let
Their clothing grow old or with wet

Perish, and they were numbered at
 Six hundred forty thousand cat,
 Besides women and children too.
 So truly I now say to you
 That heaven and earth may fail and yet
 Not fail His mercy to those set
 To fear Him. But the world's rich ones
 With their prosperity *and guns*
 Are hungry and perish. There was
 A rich man whose income in paws
 Increased, and he said 'What shall I
 Do, O my soul? I'll *amplify*,
And pull down my barns that are small,
 And build new and bigger withal,
 And so, my soul, you'll triumph yet!"
 Oh, wretched man! That night was set
 For his death. He should have minded
 The poor, and by alms made friends bid
 With the unrighteous riches in
 This world, for they bring in the bin,
 Treasures in heaven's kingdom win.
 8 "Tell me, I pray, if you should give
 Your money to the bank to live,
 And it should give you tenfold and
 Twenty-fold, would you not *in band*
 Give to such a bank all you had?
 But I tell you truly *and glad*,
 That what you give and what forsake
 For love of God, *make no mistake*,
 You'll get it back a hundredfold
 And life eternal *with the hold*.
 See then how you should be content
 To serve God *in the way He meant*."

The sermon on the mount as Matthew quotes
 Sets forth four pillars of faith from his notes:
 Alms, prayer and fasting and the pilgrimage,
 Although he does not mention on the page
 The pilgrim word. But Barnabas is quick
 To skip the prayer and fasting on the slick
 And mention outright pilgrimage as well
 As alms to make a rich man feel the spell.
 Beloved, I too delight to hear the word
 Your prophet spoke to man and beast and bird
 Upon the fragrant hill where no one stirred,
 But sat entranced to find their thirst quenched and
 Their hunger assuaged as though from his hand
 The bread of life went out upon the land.

Barnabas 17

1 After Jesus said this, Philip
 Answered, "We are content *and hip*
 To serve God, but we only wish
 To know God, for the *quakerish*
 Prophet Isaiah said "Indeed
 You are a hidden God *to plead*,"
 And to Moses His servant God
 Said "I'm what I am *without pod*."
 2 Jesus answered, "Philip, God is
 Good without which there's none of His
 That's good, God is a being too
 Without which there's nothing in view,
 God is a life without which there
 Is nothing living, such great share
 That He fills all and everywhere.
 He only has no equal. He
 Has no beginning, nor will He
 Ever have end, but to each thing
 He has given its beginning,
 And to each thing He'll give an end.
 He has no dad, mom to attend,
 No sons, no siblings, companions.
 Because God has no body's *tons*,
 He does not eat, sleep, die or walk,
 Move, but stays in eternal stock
 Without human similitude,
 For He's incorporeal, stood
 Without compound, material,
 Is of substance foundational.
 He is so good that He loves just
 Goodness only, He is so just
 That when He punishes or gives
 Pardon, none gainsays *and still lives*.
 In brief, Philip I tell you this,
 That here on earth you always miss
 Seeing Him and knowing His bliss,
 But in His kingdom you will see
 Him forever, eternity
 Is all our gladness and glory."

When Your sent one describes You and Your throne,
 The words sound like those found in speech alone
 Of Ali in Nahjul-Balagha shown,
 Or like those revealed in holy Qur'an.
 And yet I recognize each word at dawn
 Of Revelation, in the Bible's song,
 Although they are not gathered for so long
 In one place, still the tenor and the beat
 Is strong upon the message and the seat.
 Beloved, I cannot see You, cannot know,

But still I can, wherever I may go,
Love You whom I see not, whom none can show.
Beloved, life of all life, who have no end,
Still You above all creatures are my Friend.

3 Philip answered, "Master, what say?
Truly Isaiah wrote one day
That God's our father, how then can
He have no son, woman or man?"

4 Jesus answered, "The prophets write
In many parables in sight,
Not to be understood aright
According to the letter's light,
But by the meaning they invite.
For all the prophets numbered to
Hundred forty-four thousand's crew,
Whom God has sent into the world,
Have spoken darkly *when unfurled*.
But after me shall come the one,
A splendour of all prophets done
And divine guides, and shall shed light
Upon the darkness of the sight
Of what the prophets *wrote and* said,
Because he's God's messenger led."
And having said this, Jesus sighed
And said "Have mercy on the pride
Of Israel, Lord Ælohim,
And look with pity on who seem
To be of Abraham, his seed,
That they may serve You and indeed
With truth of heart, *with truth of deed*."

5 His disciples answered *him there*,
So be it, O Lord God *and fair*.

6 Jesus said "Truly I tell you,
The scribes and doctors, not a few,
Make void the law of God with their
False prophecies against the share
Of prophecies of prophets true
To God, that's why God's wrath anew
Falls on the house of Israel
And with this generation's fell
Faithlessness." His disciples wept
At these words, said "Mercy accept,
O God, have mercy on the frame
Of the temple and city's fame
In holiness, and do not give
It into the nations' and sieve
For contempt, so that they do not
Despise Your holy promised lot."
Said Jesus, "So be it again,

Lord God of our fathers, amen.”

Beloved, You truly sent one here to show
That sonship is a parable and slow,
And yet his Revelation also makes
A parable of You for human sakes.
The son of God is servant and as well
Marks out obedience as human spell.
The prophets in their thousands that relate
The men are sons or servants of the Great
God, show that all are here and in one state
Owing to You, Beloved, alone their fate
Of obeying in all things You relate.
Beloved, let me be son or servant true,
Obeying in my doings only You.

Barnabas 18

1 When Jesus had said this, he spoke,
“You did not choose me, I awoke
To choose you as disciple folk.
If then the world shall hate you, you
Shall be my disciples and true,
For the world has always been foe
Of God’s servants. Remember show
Of holy prophets the world killed,
Even as in the time fulfilled
Of Elijah, ten thousand fell
Prophets were killed by Jezebel,
So scarcely did escape *that hell*
Even Elijah, and the sons
Seven thousand *and in their tons*,
Of the prophets who were in place
Of refuge by Ahab’s own *face*,
And captain of his army’s *crew*.
Oh wicked world that knows not YHWH!
So do not fear, for your head’s hair
Is numbered not to perish there.
Look at the sparrows and the birds
Of varied kind, not one *in herds*
Loses a feather but by will
Of God. Shall God, then not have still
More care of man than birds, for whom
He has created all *in room*?
Is there a man who takes more care
Of his shoes than his son’s welfare?
Surely not. Now how much less ought
You to think that God would be caught
Abandoning you, while He takes
Care of the birds! Why for the sakes
Of birds do I speak, even leaf

Of a tree does not fall *to grief*
Without the will of God *in brief*.

The seven thousand that in Israel wake
To prayer at morn to You and Baal forsake
Have not of their own sovereign will replied
To conscience, flesh, or being in the tide
Of human scars, but chosen live to make
The act of righteousness from divine guide.
There is no fear that any not abide
But fail and fall into the fiery lake.
Beloved, I choose Your sent one with the will
You lend me here beneath Your sovereign hill,
And find no hair nor sparrow hits the earth
Without Your hand to guide it to its berth.
The shoes I polished in my younger days
Were nothing but a beacon and a craze.

2 “Believe, since I say what is true,
That the world will greatly fear you,
If you observe my words to do.
If it were not afraid to make
Its wickedness appear at stake,
It would not hate you, but it fears
To be seen here where it appears,
And that’s why it will hate you and
Persecute you in every land.
If you see the world scorn your words,
Do not be troubled by the turds,
But think how God is greater than
You, who is also scorned by man,
That His wisdom is counted mad.
If God endured patiently bad,
Why trouble you yourselves for that,
O earthly dust and clay *for scat*?
In patience you’ll possess your soul.
So if someone hits you on jowl,
Turn to him the other side too,
So he may strike them both in view.
Do not render evil in place
Of evil on the human race,
For so does every bestial one.
But give good for evil when done.
And pray God for them who hate you.
Fire is not put out with a fire,
But with water sprayed on up higher.
And so I tell you that you’ll not
Overcome evil with a shot,
But with good. Look how God makes rise
The sun upon both base and wise,

And rain as well. And so seek you
To do good to all come in view,
For it is written in the law,
“Be holy, for I God in awe,
Am holy, and be pure, for I
Am pure, and be perfect, for I
Am perfect.” Truly I tell you
That the servant studies in view
Of pleasing his master, and so
He does not wear his clothes for show
Except to please his master’s *row*.
Your clothing is your love and will.
Take care, then not to love or will
A thing displeasing to God who
Is our Lord. Be sure that the true
God hates the world’s pomps and its lust,
Therefore hate the world and its dust.”

Beloved, Your servant asks a troubled thing:
I must hate the world with its purpled wing,
Its charms and loves, its graces and its store,
And yet when it does hurt to me in score,
I am to take vengeance in good instead
Of evil poured upon enemy’s head.
It would be easier, I trow, to hate
And render wickedness for wicked state,
Or love and render good upon the pate.
Conflicting command You give here, my mate.
Beloved, I see that fire is not quenched by
Another fire, unless one burns nearby
A swathe to stop the progress of the flames.
Beloved I stop excuses and my games.

Barnabas 19

1 When Jesus had said this, *the man*
Peter answered, “O teacher, scan
And see how we have left all things
To follow you, and *in the slings*
What shall become of us *indeed?*”
Jesus answered, “Truly decreed
It is that on the Judgement Day
You will sit beside me to say
Witness against the twelve tribes of
Israel *for their lack of love.*”
Having said this then Jesus sighed
And said “O Lord, what is this tide?
I’ve chosen twelve and one of them
Is a devil, *one to condemn.*”
2 The disciples were grieved at this
Harsh word, the writer could not miss,

But secretly questioned Jesus
With tears, saying "O master, will
Satan deceive me so I will
Become a reprobate *for ill?*"
3 Jesus replied, "Do not be grieved,
Barnabas, for those God received
Before the world's creation shall
Not perish. Rejoice, your name shall
Be written in the book of life."
And Jesus comforted his folk,
Saying "Don't be afraid of stroke,
For he who shall hate me is not
Grieved at my saying in the plot,
Because in him there is not found
The divine sense, *he is hell bound.*"
At his words the chosen found peace.
Jesus recited his prayers' lease,
And his disciples said "So be,
Lord God almighty in mercy!"

If Judas is a devil in disguise,
Then there are questions left that must arise.
The true are the elect to righteousness,
And it must follow by reason and guess
That devils were appointed to their fate,
Their acts approved and needed by the great.
The answer of Your Christ is simply that
No grief is set within their habitat,
No sense of the divine's created where
The empty heart goes on without a prayer.
Beloved, I too find peace on that Islam,
Though not philosophy without a qualm,
Still to the heart if not the mind a balm,
And to the feet a gleaming, golden stair.

4 Having finished his prayers, Jesus
Came down the mountain without fuss
With his disciples, and he met
Ten lepers who, when far off set,
Cried, "Jesus, son of David, do
Have mercy on us, *a poor crew!*"
And Jesus called them near to him,
And spoke to them in no tone grim,
"What do you want with me, my brothers?"
They all cried out like *sons of mothers*,
"Give us our health!" Then Jesus said
"Ah wretched ones, are you so led
Out of your reason that you say
'Give us health'? Don't you see the way
I am a man like you yourselves?"

Call to our God, and not to elves,
 The One who has created you,
 And He that is almighty, true,
 And merciful, He will heal you.”
 With tears the lepers answered, “We
 Know that you are a man as we,
 But still of God and one holy,
 And a prophet of the Lord, so
 Pray to God *not* to heal us *slow*. ”
 5 Then the disciples begged him to
 Have mercy on the leper crew.
 And Jesus groaned and prayed to God,
 Saying “Lord God Almighty and
 Merciful, have mercy and stand
 To hear the words of Your servant,
 And for love of the covenant
 Holy of mercy with the one
 Abraham our father when done
 At the request of these men, and
 Grant them a cure.” Come to a stand
 Jesus turned to the lepers and
 Said “Go and show yourselves to priests
 According to God’s law *and feasts*. ”
 6 The lepers left and on the way
 Were cleansed. So one of them to say
 That he was healed turned back to find
 Jesus, he was Ishmaelite kind.
 And when he found Jesus he bowed
 Himself doing reverence *allowed*
 And saying “Truly you are one
 Holy from God” and with thanks done
 He begged him that he might become
 A servant to him. Jesus *rum*
 Said “Ten were healed, where are the nine?”
 And he told the man who was fine,
 “I did not come here to be served,
 But to serve others, go *unswerved*
 Back to your home, and tell how much
 God has done for you, that by such
 They may know that the promise made
 To Abraham and son and stayed
 With God’s kingdom is drawing near.”
 The cleansed leper went *without fear*;
 And when he came to his own place
 Recounted how much God *in grace*
 Through Jesus did for him *to trace*.

An Arab and nine Jews that day received
 The blessing from Jesus’ hand undeceived,
 And the one returned only to give thanks

For what You had accomplished without pranks.
Blessed be the sons of Ishmael from that time,
Who love the holy Saviour as they climb
The watches of the day through the five prayers
To meet the angels coming on the stairs.
Beloved, I too seek cleansing and the cure,
And day by day find that Your word is sure
To show my soul the glories of the land
And heaven above the blowing desert sand.
Let me in reverence greet the holy one
By whose hand I receive the grace he won.

Barnabas 20

1 Jesus went to Galilee's sea,
And once embarked in a ship *free*,
Sailed homeward towards his own city
Of Nazareth, and there was one
Great storm in the sea, not so fun,
So that the ship was near to sink,
While Jesus lay asleep at brink
Of the prow of the ship. Then his
Disciples came near him, that is,
Awoke him, saying "Master, save
Yourself, for we go to the grave!"
They were filled with great fear for that
The wind roared on the sea where sat
The company. Jesus arose,
And raised his eyes to heavenly *flows*,
And said "O Ælohim of hosts,
Have mercy on your servants' coasts."
When Jesus had said this, right soon
The wind stopped and the sea *for boon*
Became calm. So the seamen feared,
Saying "Who is this one appeared
That sea and wind obeyed *and cleared?*"
2 When they arrived at Nazareth,
His city, the news from the breath
Of the seamen had spread before
Them all that Jesus did in score,
So that the house where Jesus stayed
Was surrounded as on parade
By all who lived in the city.
The scribes and doctors came to see
Him and said "We have heard how much
You did in the sea and as such
In Judaea, now give a touch
To show some sign here to your own."
3 Jesus answered, "This faithless zone
Will seek a sign, but it shall not
Be given to them, since the lot

Of every prophet in the land
 Of his birth is like shifting sand.
 Elijah's day saw many widows
 In Judaea, but not the kiddos
 Of that land were nourished but one
 Widow of Sidon. Maybe tonne
 Of lepers in Judaea stayed
 In the time when Elisha prayed,
 But only Naaman Syrian
 Was cleansed *and healed from under ban.*”
 4 The people then fell in a rage
 And seized him and *on the rampage*
 Carried him to a precipice
 To throw him down and not to miss.
 But Jesus walked among them all
 And left the country standing tall.

This text is fraudulent they say because
 Nazareth is not on the seacoast draws.
 But if there was a Nazareth those days
 Where it is now, the Gospel does not praise
 It being by the sea but by a cliff
 As in the hills beyond the landing skiff.
 There was a road from the shore to the hills,
 And nothing prevents following its rills.
 Perhaps the translator imagined more
 In shipfulness than Galilee's seashore
 Enfolds, but here is no proof that the letter
 Was forged to take the place of some one better.
 Beloved, I follow rather what he did
 To storm and wave, when every other hid.

Barnabas 21

1 Jesus went to Capernaum
 And as he came near to the hum
 Of the city, see there came out
 Of the tombs one that without doubt
 Was possessed of a devil, and
 So badly so that chain in hand
 Could not contain him and he did
 Great harm to the man *in his bid.*
 2 The demons cried out through his mouth,
 Saying “O saint of God, what *drouth*
 Has sent you before *judgement* time
 To trouble us *here in this clime?*”
 And they begged him that he would not
 Cast them out *of their fertile plot.*
 3 Jesus asked them how many there
 Were, and they answered, had their say,
 “Six thousand six hundred and six

And sixty." When they heard the fix,
 The disciples were scared to death
 And begged Jesus all in one breath
 To leave the place. Then Jesus said
 "Where is your faith? The thing of dread
 Is that the demons must depart,
 And not I" The demons took heart
 To cry, "We'll leave, but let us go
 Into the pigs in proximo."
 There were feeding there near the sea
 About ten thousand swine, you see,
 Belonging to the Canaanites.
 So Jesus said "Leave by your rights,
 And go into the swine." And so
 With a roar the demons did go
 Into the pigs and threw them down
 Headlong into the sea from town.
 Then those who fed the swine fled all
 Into the city at the call
 And told Jesus made caterwaul.
 4 That's why the city dwellers came
 Out and found Jesus for his fame
 And the man who was healed from blame.
 With fear the men begged him to go
 And so Jesus left them not slow
 And went to Tyre and Sidon's show.

Who quote this Gospel for proof it is false
 Jump on Capernaum to do a waltz.
 The fact is Mark and Matthew also fail
 To agree where this story started sail.
 The story is the same except the number
 Of demons in the man who failed to slumber.
 But all agree, it seems, the pigs were loss,
 And though I do not take my meals to toss
 With pork, I still feel for the porcine pain
 Of falling down the cliff to meet the main.
 Beloved, spare pig and dog to keep their task
 Of glorifying You in what You ask,
 And give me pulse to eat instead of fame
 So I shall not hold Your servant in blame.

5 See a woman of Canaan came
 With her two sons come from their claim
 To find Jesus. And when she saw
 Him come with his disciples' draw,
 She shouted, "Jesus, David's son,
 Have mercy on daughter undone
 Tormented by the devil's *hand*."
 Jesus said not a single word,

Since they were uncircumcised band.
 The disciples had pity on
 Them and said "O master, let dawn
 Pity on them! See how they're stirred
 To cry and weep and undeterred!"
 6 Jesus replied, "I am not sent
 But to Israel's people and meant."
 Then the woman, with her sons, went
 Before Jesus and wept to say
 "O Son of David, mercy stay!"
 Jesus replied, "It is not good
 To take bread where the children stood
 And give it to the dogs instead."
 And Jesus said this thing because
 They were unclean and by the laws
 Of circumcision *of their straws*.
 7 The woman answered, "O sir, see
 The dogs eat crumbs fallen freely
 From their masters' tables." Then he,
 Jesus, was filled with admiration
 At the words from the woman's station,
 And said "O woman great is your
 Faith." Raising his hands up before
 Heaven he prayed to God, and then
 He said "O woman, your daughter
 Is freed, go your way to your den
 In peace." And so it did occur,
 The woman left and when she came
 Home there her daughter blessed the name
 Of God." And so the woman said
 "Truly there is no god instead
 Of Israel's God." So all her kin
 Joined themselves to the law from sin,
 According to the law writ in
 The book of Moses *and were led*.

See, I was right to offer consolation
 To pigs who died in fright and without ration.
 You and Your servant have the wit to mind
 That pigs and dogs have their places confined.
 I know I am a dog beside the plate
 Of priest and pope and rabbi set in state,
 And must in eager longing wait the scrap
 That falls from the ecclesiastic lap.
 But I am loyal to the church and pew
 Not because I'm despicable in view,
 But just because like every dog I pity
 The human, deaf and noseless in the city,
 And give unstinting loyalty so they
 Without smell and sound may walk in the way.

Barnabas 22

1 The disciples asked Jesus then
That very day, saying *like men*,
“O master, why did you speak to
The woman saying they were dogs?”
2 Jesus replied, “I tell you true
A dog makes better *dialogues*
Than the uncircumcised *incogs*. ”
Then the disciples in their sorrow,
Said “These are hard words *for tomorrow*,
And who can accept them *or borrow*?”
3 Jesus replied, “Just think about it,
O foolish ones, how the dogs scout it,
And have no reason for the things
They do for their masters like kings,
And you will see I say what’s true.
Tell me does a dog guard the house
Of his master, and without grouse,
Expose his life to robber prowess?
Indeed he does. But what does he
Get for his pains? But injury
And blows with little food, and he
Always shows his master a face
Of joyfulness, is not the case?”
4 “It’s true,” disciples said *in place*.
5 The Jesus said “Consider now
How much God’s given man somehow,
And you will see his wickedness
Not to observe treaty’s address
Of God made with Abraham His
Servant. Remember what the whiz
David said to Saul king of folk
Of Israel, against the bloke
Goliath the Philistine, “My
Lord,” said David, “when by the by
Your servant kept your servant’s flock
There came a wolf, a bear *to rock*,
And lion and seized one of those
Of your servant’s sheep, at its throes
Your servant went and killed them all,
And rescued the sheep *for the stall*.
And what is this uncircumcised
One but like one of them apprised?
Therefore your servant will go out
In Israel’s Lord God’s name *and shout*,
And will kill this unclean one that
Blasphemes God’s holy folk thereat.”
6 Then the disciples said “Tell us,
O master, what is all the fuss,

Why a man must be circumcised?
7 Jesus answered and so advised,
“It is enough for you that God
Commanded it upon the sod
To Abraham, and said to him,
‘Abraham circumcise and trim
Your foreskin, and that of all who
Are in your house, for this is due
Covenant between Me and you
As long as there is grass and dew.’”

I’m truly thankful that my father set
The proper mark on me on the day met.
I need not take the grand step into faith
Or countenance uncircumcision’s wraith.
I need not feel the knife on flesh again
Once I have been submitted Saracen.
I pity the poor man that must take prod
And worry with the question before God,
And find excuse or strength or to relent,
The other to disobey message sent.
But still I must accept the deeper thrust
Of blade that separates spirit and dust
And cuts the heart open beneath the light
Of Your judgement on every day and night.

Barnabas 23

1 And having said this, Jesus sat
Beside a mountain they looked at.
And his disciples came near him
To listen to his words *undim*.
Then Jesus said “Adam the first
Man ate deceived by Satan worst
The food forbidden by God in
Paradise, his flesh without sin
Rebelled against the spirit, so
He swore, ‘By God I’ll cut you low!’
2 “And so he broke a piece of stone
And grabbed his flesh to cut to bone
With the sharp edge of flint, but then
He was rebuked by angel’s ken
Gabriel. And he answered, ‘I
Have sworn by God to cut it by,
And I’ll never be one to lie.’
3 “Then the angel showed him what flesh
Was extra and he cut that fresh.
Since then just as each man receives
His flesh from Adam’s flesh, his leaves
Are bound to observe all Adam
Promised by oath *and without sham*.

So Adam observed in his sons,
From the start to generations
Came down the circumcision's duty,
Although it is a bloody beauty.
But in the time of Abraham
Few only circumcised the dram
Upon the earth because the rate
Of idolatry had grown great
Upon the earth. That's why God spoke
To Abraham about the stroke
Of circumcision and made pact,
Saying 'The soul that shall not act
To have his flesh circumcised, I
Will scatter him from under sky
Of my people for ever, aye.'"

The circumcision was a thing invented
By angel and Adam and sworn prevented
Before Abraham ever saw the light.
It's Jesus himself who reveals the sight.
Who say that faith in Jesus takes away
The share of circumcision go astray.
And yet the thing is not from You, Beloved,
So much as from your messengers ungloved.
With mutilated flesh I come to You
Thankful the angel told about Your view.
Otherwise I'd have had no tool at all
To propagate the world by Your own call.
Beloved, my heart I circumcise as well
To buy Your grace and never Your grace sell.

4 The disciples trembled in fear
At what Jesus said, for career
Of spirit when he spoke. Then said
Jesus, "Let fear be rather spread
On him who has not circumcised
His foreskin, for he is despised
And he shall be unparadised."
After he said this, Jesus spoke
Again and said "The spirit woke
In many to be ready but
God's service difficult is shut
To the weak flesh. The man therefore
Who fears God ought to take in store
What the flesh is, and where it starts,
And where it has its end *in parts*.
Of the dust of the earth created
God flesh, and into it *elated*
He breathed the breath of life and with
A inhalation stirred *the myth*.

That's why when the flesh comes to bar
The service of God and to mar,
It must be spurned like dust and yet
Trampled upon in this world set,
For he that hates himself below
Shall keep his soul within the glow
Of life eternal at a go.

5 "What the flesh now is its desires
Make plain, and it harshly acquires
The clothing of an enemy
Of all the good *a man may see*,
For it desires evil only.

6 "Should a man to please enemy
Stop pleasing God his Creator?
Consider this *a little more*.
All saints and prophets have been foes
Of their flesh for God's service *shows*,
Which is why they were glad and ready
To go to their death, *firm and steady*,
Not to offend against the law
Of God by Moses, His slave's paw,
And go and serve the false gods, those
Who lie *at every time they chose*.

7 "Remember Elijah, who fled
Through desert places until led
From the mountains, eating alone
The grass and clad in goats' skins' own.
How many days he did not eat!
How much he endured freezing feet!
How much the rain drenched him and that
For seven years there where he sat
Under the persecution taught
By unclean Jezebel *the rot!*

8 "Remember Elisha who ate
Barley bread and wore as his fate
The poorest clothing. Truly I
Say to you that they were not shy
To spurn the flesh, and they were feared
With great terror when they appeared
Before kings and princes revered.
This should suffice for spurning flesh,
O men. But if you gaze afresh
Upon the sepulchres, you'll know
What the flesh is *and at one go*."

The dear Elisha decked his body out
In poorest woollen raiment, did not flout
His beauty, though his face was one so rare
That it saw fire and heaven on the stair
That Elijah took up into the air.

The dervish dress was honour to the soul
That kept not flesh but glory as its goal.
Indeed the woollen dress may be a thing
Of fleshly pride as well, and also sting.
The wool is not today what proves the great
And master dervish in this world of fate.
It's rather in the spirit that ignores
The fashions and the democratic mores.
Beloved, I dress me from Your heavenly stores.

Barnabas 24

I When Jesus had said this, he wept
And said "Woe be to all those kept
As servants to their flesh, since they
Will certainly not have *one day*
Good in the other life, but just
Tormenting for their sins *in dust*.
Let me tell you about a man
Who was rich and greedy *in pan*,
Who only paid heed to what he
Might eat in wanton gluttony,
And so each day feasted freely.

Beloved, I see about me here below
The countless ones who live for greed and show,
Who mark the way to find a penny and
Quit at nothing until it's in their hand.
I see the pleasure-seeking crowd go by
And fill the streets of London and the high
Places of Baal in desert and on rock.
I see the many places where men flock.
Beloved, take everything I give to You,
Every desire that I might join the crew
And forget love and life to beat the meat.
Beloved, take my life where I find the heat
And join it to Your own until I find
The spirit caught up in the truth refined.

There stood at his gate a poor man
By name of Lazarus, a man
Full of wounds, and who came to eat
Those crumbs that fell at glutton's feet.
But no one gave him anything
But mocking words *that came to sting*.
Only the dogs pitied him there
For they licked all his wounds with care.

I've seen the poor mocked in their hiding place,
I've also see the rich give hand and space
To help the poor with work and weal and grace.

I've seen the poor also grind righteous face.
It's not the wealth in monetary sense
Or poverty in pounds, guineas, and pence
That makes the difference twixt false and true.
It is the choice to be and what to do.
Beloved, though I think that I treat the poor
With kindness and with aid, I am not sure
That action in the global village yet
Is always righteous in the things I get.
My life may mock the poor because I fail
To notice the results my acts entail.

Beloved, appointed Christ seems to approve
Of dogs beneath the table, those who prove
To be the friends of poor in this world's share.
And so for dogs You have good news to bear.
Beloved, I am a dervish dog that stays
Beneath the tables of grandeur and praise,
And fail not to pick up each crumb that falls
From plates that glitter gold upon the walls.
I whirl about and chase my tail as I
Recite Your names for beauty on the sky.
Look on a dervish dog, Beloved, and see
A dervish dog in love and loyalty
Who waits with eyes cast up and patiently
For crumbs dropped from Your hand and on the sly.

It happened that the poor man died,
And angels carried him to hide
In Abraham our father's arms.
The rich man too died in alarms,
And devils carried him to be
In Satan's arms, at which then he
Fell under the greatest torment,
And lifted up his eyes as sent
From far off he saw Lazarus
In Abraham's arms without fuss.

Beloved, my time to die comes on apace,
I pray that I might live to have the grace
Of seeing this book done in glory to
Your name before I join the dead folk's crew.
Let me live, my Beloved, so that I might
Not enter Satan's arms upon that night,
But rather meet the dawn of Abraham
And rest upon his breast like a new lamb.
Some wait for the nirvana and some for
The golden streets and for the pearly door.
Some hope for happy hunting ground and shore
Of game abundant and their flocks and herds.

I wait a stallion beneath desert birds
To bear me to the tent and prophet's words.

So then the rich man cried out thus,
'O father Abraham, regard
Me with mercy, and send *the pard*
Lazarus to bring in his hand
A drop of water to my *stand*
To cool my tongue, tormented here
In this flame, *in this place of fear.*'
2 "Abraham answered, 'Son, now mind
That you received life's goods behind
In the other life, Lazarus
Had only evil omnibus,
That's why now you're tormented lashing,
And Lazarus dealt with compassion.'
3 "The rich man shouted out again
To say 'O father *of the men*
Of righteousness, O Abraham,
I have three brothers in my scam.
So send Lazarus to announce
To them how much pain *by the ounce*
I suffer, so they may repent
And not into this place be sent.'
4 "Abraham answered, 'They have Moses
And the prophets to hear as chose us.'
5 "The rich man answered, 'No *indeed,*
Father Abraham, but *with speed*
If one already dead should rise
They will believe *and not despise.*'
6 "Abraham answered, 'Who does not
Believe Moses and prophets' lot
Will not believe if even dead
People should rise *with what they said.*'

How true the words of Christ, Beloved, I hear
Who says that Moses and prophets appear
To meet a faithless people and their gear!
How many now and in this day I deal
Tell me that Moses has no stern nor keel,
But has been set aside by later men,
Men even sent from You and back again.
The last prophet to come gave the command
To make no difference at all in hand
Of any of the prophets, but to take
The word of each as mercy for men's sake.
But even Hebrew may deny the word,
As does the Christian, and alas I've heard
Muslim also treat Moses' writ like turd.

7 “See now then whether poor are blessed,”
Said Jesus, “Who have patient rest,
And only wish for what they need,
And hate the flesh *and flesh’s deed*.
Wretched are those who bear the bier
To burial to make appear
Their flesh for food of worms, and do
Not understand the truth in view.
They are so far from it that they
Live here as though immortals’ sway,
Building great houses and acquiring
Riches and living pride desiring.”

I have a house where I live with my wife,
A house both small and old, and yet the strife
Of world and din of care are far from it,
And many would consider it one fit.
I have more wealth than I need in my row
Of shelter and of nourishment to show,
Though few who live around me think me rich,
No doubt in poorer lands they’d see my pitch.
Perhaps I do not fail on two of three,
But pride of life, Beloved, does assail me.
Keep me, Beloved, from all that trinity
Of house and wealth and pride until I know
Only You for my house and wealth and grow
Only in You my pride set in Your glow.

Barnabas 25

1 Then said the one who writes these words,
“O master, true are these your words,
And that’s why we’ve forsaken all
To follow you *and at your call*.
Tell us then how we ought to hate
Our flesh, for killing self or mate
Is not lawful, and living we
Must give to it security.”
2 Jesus replied, “Keep your flesh well
Like you would keep a horse, compel
It to live in security.
For to a horse is given food
By measure, but work *in the crude*
Unstinting, and the bridle’s put
On him that he with *mouth and foot*
May obey you, and he is tied
So as not to bother beside
Anyone, he’s kept in a stall
That’s lowly, and if he *at all*
Disobeys, then he’s beaten *too*.
Do in this way and when you do

You'll live with God always *in view*.
3 "Do not take offence at my speech,
For David the prophet did teach
The same as he confessing said
'I am just like a horse that's led
Before You, I'm beside Your *stead*.'

I see, Beloved, why the sweet Christian pouts
That these words fill his heart and soul with doubts.
It's not that Muhammad by name appears,
Because the name's in the Scriptures arrears
As far back as the Psalms of David drawn.
The thing that bothers us as hopeless pawn
Is that obedience that You require.
We much prefer faith without works to hire.
Eat little, work a lot, and still refrain
From causing any other any pain,
Live in a hut, and do as I am told
Or be beaten and left out in the cold.
Indeed, Beloved, Your gospel is no treat
To us today who have such tender feet.

Beloved, to own a horse would surely stretch
Economy beyond my oats and vetch.
I might perhaps with care and planning buy
And keep just one horse on the waning sly.
But must I have a horse to know how to
Bend my will to Your own in what I do?
I've seen a horse, with sleek and shining coat,
Great eyes looking out wisely on the moat,
But never felt desire to own the beast,
And never was I tempted in the least.
To tell the truth when sitting on its back
I find myself too dizzy for the rack.
Let me, Beloved, serve You here on the ground
And live a life of pence instead of pound.

4 "Now tell me, who is poorer now,
He who has little but somehow
Is satisfied, or the one who
Wishes he had more things to view?
Truly I tell you, if the world
Had a sound mind *and not uncurled*,
No one would gather wealth but all
Things would be in a common stall.
But this thing shows how mad they are,
The more they get, the more by far
They want. And as much as the world
Acquires, it does so for the rest
Of others' flesh, and saves the best.

That's why a single coat's enough
For you, and throw away *the duff*
Of your purse, take no bag *in hand*
Or shoes on your feet *where to stand*,
And do not think to say "What thing
Will happen to us wandering?"
But strive to do the will of God,
And He'll provide you on the sod,
So nothing's lacking you in pod.

Beloved, I ask how dare You take sides here
Between the calced and discalced monketeer?
Where I live there is snow upon the ground
For half the year, and shall I then be bound
To live without shoes on my strangled feet?
Beloved, I protest what words You repeat.
I know that Einstein could dispense with socks,
But even he had shoes and lived with locks.
Beloved, like the rich young man who was told
To sell all he had, to the poor and cold
Give what he gained, and come and follow Christ,
I come with surplus and with what sufficed
To tell You I would rather trod hell shod
Than wander in the snow barefoot on clod.

5 Truly, I tell you, gathering
Much in this life gives witnessing
Of not having reward to get
In the other *life once it's set*.
For who has in Jerusalem
His homeland does not haw and hem
To build houses in Samaria,
Because there's fighting *tooth and claw*
Between those cities' *stratagem*.
Do you see *the anathema*?
6 And the disciples answered all,
"Yes, *we understand what you call.*"

My wealth is heavy, far too much to bear,
And yet my poverty in stuff and share
Makes many turn away, afraid that I
Will tell them to sell all and under sky
Sleep without shelter more than just one coat.
I'm caught between my wealth and billy goat.
And yet I know of some with wealth in hand,
And clothing and stores beyond contraband,
Whose lives are better than the life I lead,
And whose works are beyond the common creed,
And whose faith rises to the trial and sore.
I know of wealthy folk who serve Your door.

Beloved, take from me any wish to find
More in my purse than leads my soul in bind.

Barnabas 26

1 Then Jesus said "There was a man
On a trip who walking a span
Found treasure in a field worth five
Pieces of money and no jive.
Right off the man when he knew this
Sold his cloak to buy with a kiss
The field, can any believe this?"
The disciples answered not bad,
"Who does not believe this is mad."
2 So Jesus said "You will be mad
If you don't give your senses' had
To God to buy your soul where dwells
The treasure of love that excels.
For love is beyond measure wealth.
For he who loves God *without stealth*
Has God for his own, and who has
God has everything *but the jazz.*"

You have created men and women too
So that You might be found among the true,
A treasure in the heart of everyone
Of the elect under the golden sun.
You have created human hearts to hide
The divine grace and there where You abide
The treasure waits as hidden from the glare
Of life and bustle seeking everywhere.
Beloved, You are a treasure in the field,
A golden coin beyond the common yield,
A mercy and a grace beyond all hopes,
Beyond desires, above the fleshly ropes.
The treasure in its hiding must beware
The gates of earth and fire, water and air.

3 Peter replied, "O master do
Say how one can love God with true
Love? Tell us *this secret now, do.*"
Jesus replied, "Truly I say
To you that he who does not stay
To hate his dad and mom and yet
His own life too, and children set
And wife for love of God is not
Worthy of the love of God wrought."
Peter replied, "O master, it
Is written in Law of God fit
In the Book of Moses, that you
Must honour father, mother too,

That you may live long on the earth.
 Further it says 'Cursed be son's birth
 Who does not obey his dad's cue
 And mother,' and that such a one
 By God's command, rebellious son
 Should be stoned in the people's wrath
 Beside the city gate *and path*.
 So why tell us to hate the two,
 Both father and mother in view?"
 4 Jesus replied, "Each word of mine
 Is true, because it is not mine,
 But God's, who has sent me down to
 The house of Israel. I tell you
 That all you have has come from God,
 So what's more precious on the sod,
 The present or the one who gives?
 When father, mother and all things
 Are stumbling blocks to you *for wings*
 In the service of God *who lives*,
 Abandon them as enemies.
 Did not God say to Abraham,
 'Go out from the house that agrees
 With your father and from your kin,
 And come to live within the jamb
 Of the land I give you in bin,
 And to your descendants?' Why did
 God say this except for the bid
 That Abraham's father was skilled
 In making images and filled
 With worship of false gods *that thrilled*.
 There was no quarrel between them,
 For which the father's stratagem
 Was burning his son *at his hem*."

Peter replied, "Your words are true.
 Please tell us how and in your view
 Abraham smacked his father's *pew*."

The fact is, my Beloved, that Your law makes
 Me obligated for my parents' sakes
 Both to obey and honour them in stakes
 And still to hate them in the sin that takes
 Them far from the way that You have provided
 For the oppressed and by the rich derided.
 It is a sirat and Sylla before
 The gaping Charybdis and yawning door.
 Bind me, Beloved, to the mast and set wax
 In ears of all the sailors, then take axe
 To my foundations. Still I give them both
 The honour due by Your own law and oath,
 And having done so, turn away to find

You are the only One beneath the rind.

5 Then Jesus answered, "Abraham
Was seven years old and a lamb
When he began to seek his God.
One day he asked his dad in prod,
'Father what made man?' And the fool
Of a father replied in rule,
'Man, for I made you and my dad
Made me.' Abraham not so glad
Replied, 'Father it is not so,
For I've heard an old man that wept
And said "My God, why have You kept
Me from having sons of my own?"'
His father answered in this tone,
'It's true, my son, that God helps man
To make man, but not as He can
With His own hands, it's only that
Man comes to pray where his God's at
And give Him lambs and sheep, and so
His God will help him on the go.'
Abraham replied, 'How many
Gods are there, father?' Then said he,
The old man, 'To infinity
Is the count of the gods' degree.'
6 "Then Abraham said, 'Father, what
Shall I do if I serve one strut
Of a god and another comes
To wish me evil in my sums
Because I do not serve his butt?
In any case, quarrel must rise
Between them, so war in the skies
Will come among the gods in guise.
And if the god that wills me ill
Shall find my own god and he'll kill
Him, so then what am I to do?
It's sure that he will kill me too.'
The old man laughing answered, 'Son,
Don't be afraid of that, for none
Among the gods makes war upon
Another god, no not at all,
In the great temple in the hall
There are a thousand gods with Baal
The great god, and now at my age
Of nearly seventy years the stage
Of one god striking out to slay
Another god, not in my day
Have I seen such. Assuredly
All men do not serve one god free,
But one man one god faithfully

And then another by decree.'

The argument that man can reproduce
Only by divine aid is a proof loose
For the existence of the deity.
But that is not the only lack I see
In all the argument. Infinity
Of gods in number may seem right,
But then, even the boy Abraham has insight
That says that more than one god must result
In conflicts in their interests and insult.
The argument of Abraham has weight:
If a man serves one god, then those will hate
Him whom he does not serve. And the reply
Is simply that the thing resulting by
Has never happened here under the sky.

7 Abraham answered, 'So then they
Have peace among themselves this way?'
His father said 'They have indeed.'
Then Abraham asked, 'Dad, agreed,
What are the gods like in their need?'
The old man answered, 'You're a fool,
For every day with axe and rule
I make a god and sell to buy
Bread, and you do not know thereby
What gods are like!' And at that hour
He was making an idol tower.
He said 'This is made of palm wood,
That one is olive, just as good,
That little one is ivory, see
How fine it is! It seems to be
Alive, but only it truly
Lacks breath *and it could speak and see!*'

8 "Abraham said 'And so, Dad, gods
Are without breath just like the clods?
Then how do they give breath? And they
Being without life, how one day
Can they give life? One thing is true,
Father, these things are not gods' crew.'
The old man became angry then
At these words said 'At age of men
If you were, I'd take up this axe
And break your head, but hold your pax,
Because you have no sense at all!'
Abraham answered, 'Say if gods
Help to make man, how from such clods
Can it be that man should make gods?
And if the gods are made of wood,
It's a great sin to burn such wood.

But tell me, Father, how it came
 That when you've made such gods of fame,
 The gods have not helped you to make
 So many children for your sake
 That you'd become among the men
 Of earth the most powerful again?'
 9 The father was beside himself
 To hear his son talk like an elf,
 The son went on to say again,
 'Father was the world without men
 For some time?' 'Yes,' answered again
 The old man, 'and why do you ask?'
 'Because,' said Abraham, 'the task
 Of making the first god was whose?'
 'Now leave the house,' said the old man,
 'And let me make quick as I can
 This god, and do not talk to me,
 For when you're hungry, as I see,
 You want bread and not words' degree.'
 Abraham said, 'A fine god's he,
 For you cut him as you desire,
 And he has no defence from fire.'
 Then the old man was wroth and said,
 'Now everybody else instead
 Says that it's a god, and just you,
 Insanely say it will not do.
 By my gods many or a few,
 If you were a man, I'd kill you!'
 And when he said this he hit him
 And kicked poor Abraham for whim
 And chased him from the house and view."

All men make gods for bread, and so all eat
 The residue of the divine in treat.
 All men make gods to trample under feet
 Or then to coddle as they taste the treat.
 Beloved, You are invisible to me,
 Unknown, a treasure hidden in the sea
 Beneath the unmarked billows where I flee.
 Beloved, at least once ask me in to tea.
 If Abraham as just a boy revealed
 The case of all theology unsealed,
 I at this age of becoming unpeeled
 Stand up like any other bright banana
 And tear down all Your veils before the scanner.

Barnabas 27

1 The disciples laughed at the way
 The old man talked, marvelled to say
 How wisely Abraham could stay.

But Jesus chided them and said
“You forget the prophet’s words led
To say to laugh today’s to lead
The way to sorrow and with speed
Upon the morrow’s day indeed.
And furthermore, you’ll not go where
Jollity is the only fare,
But sit among the ones who weep,
Because this life has naught to keep
But miseries.” Then Jesus said
“In times of Moses, it is read,
Do you not know for laughing spread
And mocking others God changed to
Hideous beasts men not a few
In Egypt. Beware not to do
In any way, mocking at all
Of anyone, or you will fall.”
2 The disciples answered, “We laughed
At the madness of the old draft.”
Then Jesus said “Truly I say
To you, each loves his like in way,
And finds his pleasure in its sway.
That’s why if you were not mad you
Would not laugh at madness in view.”
They answered, “May God have mercy
On us.” Jesus said “May it be.”

Beloved, keep me from scorner’s chair as noted
By David in a Psalm I’ve often quoted.
The scorner is the buddy of the wrong,
The sinner and the council of the strong.
Though I may join in glee with argument
That Abraham your prophet and one sent
May cast upon his father and his king,
I would not join in any mocking thing.
I do see that the populace that rang
With mocking joy in Egypt when they sang
Was turned to beasts more hideous and great
Than even ape who sat beside the rate
Of Red Sea to catch all the fish he ate.

3 Then Philip said “O master how
Did it happen then to allow
That Abraham’s father desired
To burn his son that he had sired?”
Jesus replied, “One day when he,
Abraham came to the degree
Of twelve years, his dad said to him,
“Tomorrow is the feast in trim
Of all the gods, so we shall go

To the great temple with a show
Of gifts to my god, the great Baal.
And you shall choose among the scale
A god for yourself, you're of age
To have a god in patronage."
4 Abraham answered him with guile,
"I'm glad to come there, Dad, a while."
And so they left by light of dawn
And came to the temple to fawn
Before the others. Abraham
Carried beneath his shirt a scam,
An axe in hiding. When they came
In the temple, the crowd was game,
And in the tumult Abraham
Hid behind an idol for slam
In an obscure corner for sham.
His father left since he believed
Abraham had gone perhaps shrieved
Back to the house before he did.
So he did not look where he hid.

Beloved, judge me not with polytheist
Because I hide, my axe caught in my fist,
Within the temple of the atheist
And idol-worshipper. I have been missed.
Beloved, I am not there before the great
Idol and altar to bow down in state.
I have an axe hidden within my breast
Like fatal Sabbetai Zvi who could not rest,
But must feast on Yom Kippur for a test
And shout aloud Your holy name at best.
Judge me not, my Beloved, by what I do
Or say, but judge me by Your grace in view
And I may wait the coming of the night
To climb such Carmels as never gained sight.

Barnabas 28

1 When everyone had left the place,
The priests closed the doors in their trace
And went away. Then Abraham
Took the axe and cut off with slam
The feet of all the idols there
Except the great god Baal in share.
At its feet he place the axe where
The ruined statues had made bare,
Since they were old and made of slots,
They fell in pieces from their pots.
Then Abraham went from the place,
But certain men saw him retrace
His steps and thinking he was there

To steal out of the temple ware,
They grabbed him and went back into
The temple, and when came in view
Their gods all broken into bits
They cried and shouted out in fits,
“Come quickly, O men, let us kill
The one who’s killed our gods for ill.”
Ten thousand men came to the place
With the priests and asked to his face
Abraham why he’d killed their gods.
2 Abraham answered, “Foolish sods,
Can a man kill God? It’s the great
God that has killed them. See the state
Where the axe is there by his feet.
Surely the trouble is to treat
That he desires no other gods
To be with him alone in pods.”

Those men of old were stupid in their way,
Since the axe lay there in the light of day.
They only had to compare fingerprints
And see that Abraham, not one to wince,
Had done the deed, and not the great god there.
The fingerprints were showing everywhere.
The preacher of the truth about You, loved,
Is cynical, deceitful and ungloved.
I’ve left my fingerprints upon Your word
So the idolater who has been stirred
To wrath and mocking when I come to town
May see them glowing there beneath Your frown.
Surely You too can hold Your own
As well as Baal at Abram’s witness throne.

Then came Abraham’s father who
Remembered all the things in due
That Abraham has said before
Against the gods, against their store.
He recognized the axe by which
Abraham had thrown in the ditch
In pieces the idols to pitch,
And shouted, “It’s this traitor son
Of mine who’s killed our gods and won,
Since that’s my axe, the very one.”
He told them all that had been said
Between him and his own son bred.
And so the men gathered much wood
And tied Abraham as they could
By hands and feet and put him there
On the wood and with fire his share.
3 “See God by His angel commanded

The fire not to burn the unhanded
Abraham His servant. The fire
Blazed up with fury too in spire,
And burned about two thousand men
Of those who had condemned again
Abraham to death. Abraham
Truly found himself free of sham,
And he was carried from harm's way
By God's own angel and to stay
Near by his father's house, but he
Did not see who carried him free.
So Abraham escaped the call
Of death *as well as heathen thrall.*"

Better, Beloved, not to raise hopes by such
Miraculous escapes a few may touch.
Reality is that idolatry
Is now defended all the more freely
By judge and executioner in state.
There is hardly a hope that You'll berate
The man in power and save Your worshipper.
The choice is simply to die like a cur.
Beloved, my heart is timid in my breast
And I look to You always to find rest.
Life's cut short anyway. I whirl and find
Before I see a mite I am struck blind.
Let Abraham escape the fire and heat.
I have no hopes. I enter flames and bleat.

Barnabas 29

1 Philip cried, "Great is God's mercy
On those who love Him faithfully.
Tell, O master, how Abraham
Came to the knowledge anagram
Of God." And so Jesus replied,
"When he came near his father's side,
Abraham was afraid to go
Inside the house, he was not slow
To go some way from the house where
He sat under a palm and there
By himself he said 'There must be
A God who has life and the fee
Above man, since He makes a man,
And man without God never can.'
2 "So then he looked around to see
The stars, the moon, the sun, and he
Thought perhaps they are God. But then
Noting their changefulness and when
They move about, he said again,
'It must be so that God does not

Move and that cloud hide not his lot,
Or else humankind would be naught.'

The faculty of reason teaches man
Both the truth and the false way, grain and bran.
Some reason that there is one God who made
All things and humankind and then He stayed
To give His law of love and life so all
Might live the fullest on the earthly ball.
Some reason that there is no god at best.
Some reason that gods many come to rest
Upon the soil and bring men to the test.
Beloved, I've read philosophy in store
And read a bit and then read a bit more,
And still my reason gives me answers for
Too many questions and I doubt the score.
I pick up all the sticks to line my nest.

As he stayed cogitating so
He heard his name 'Abraham' go.
Twice more he heard in the same way
Himself called 'Abraham' that day.
3 "He answered, 'Who is calling me?'
Then he heard someone say freely,
'I am God's angel Gabriel.'
Then Abraham was filled with fell
Fear, but the angelic one lay
Comfort upon him in some way
Saying 'Don't be afraid, for you,
Abraham, are God's friend and true.
When you smashed human gods then you
Were chosen by the angels' God,
The God of prophets so your nod
Is written in the Book of Life.'
Then Abraham said 'What should I
Do to serve the God of the sky
Angels and holy prophets by?'

The God of angels and the ones sent out
As prophets in a world where hardly shout
Could bring the folk around except to pout
Spoke to our father Abraham, no doubt.
I wonder if a god exists who's not
A god of angels and of prophets sought.
I guess such ones would not be known to man,
Since angels bring the messages and can
Speak only to the prophets by Your plan.
Beloved, I do believe in You along
With angels and Your prophets with their song.
A book revealed as well cannot be wrong

To comfort till the judgement becomes strong.
I look about the rocks and lichens' span.

The angel answered, 'Go to that
Spring and wash yourself and then scat
For God desires to speak with you.'
4 "Abraham answered, 'What to do,
And how should I wash in that dew?'
The angel then appeared to him
As a handsome young man and trim,
And washed himself there in the spring,
And said 'Do the same in this thing,
O Abraham.' When Abraham
Had washed, the angel without sham
Said 'Go up that mountain, for God
Wishes to speak to you for prod.'

I have at certain moments in the day
Stopped what I did to take the time to pray
And when I did the thing, I also took
Ablutions from a pail or running brook.
I now see where that habit of mine rose:
It was an angel come once to disclose
The secret of ablutions to the one
Who became father of the faith begun.
Beloved, as I prepare my soiling skin
For floods to be at last my toiling in,
I make intention to be purified
Both outwardly as well as the inside.
But water cannot do the task so well,
And so I ask you for the better spell.

Abraham went off the mount then
As the angel commanded then
And sat down on his knees and said
To himself, "When will I be led
To hear the angels' God rejoice?"
He heard himself called with a voice
'Abraham.' As it gently falls,
Abraham answered Him, 'Who calls?'
The voice replied, 'I am your God,
Abraham sitting on the sod.'
5 "Abraham then was filled with fear
And bowed his face to earth to steer,
Saying 'How shall Your servant who
Is dust and ashes then hear You?'
Then God said 'Do not be afraid,
But get up for I here have made
My choice of you as My servant,
And I will bless you and relent

To make you multiply to be
A great people. Therefore go free
From your dad's house and from your kin,
And come to live in the land's bin
That I will give to you and yours.'

The bowing of the face to earth in prayer
Was not a divine command but the share
Of Abraham reacting to the sight
And sound of God once speaking in His right.
I too bow to the earth, but when I do,
Do I hear or not the Word that is true?
Indeed, Beloved, I hear the grand Qur'an
Recited as I stand before the dawn,
And at its hearing know Your speech well taught
To Your own prophet and the one I sought.
So like the prophet Abraham who heard
And bowed down to the earth at divine Word,
I too hear and I bow with my heart stirred.
My spirit rises up and then is caught.

6 Abraham answered, 'For my scores
I'll do all, Lord, but guard me so
No other god may harm my toe.'
Then God spoke saying "I am God
Alone, and there's no other prod
But Me. I strike down and make whole,
I kill and I give of life's goal,
I lead to hell and I bring out
From there and no one is so stout
To save himself with Me about.'
Then Ælohim gave him the pact
Of circumcision, how to act,
And so our father Abraham
Knew God." After the anagram,
Jesus raised his hand and he said
"To You be honour, glory spread,
O Ælohim, amen, amen."

There are just two faiths found in all the earth:
The faith of falsehood and the faith of worth.
The false faith is the one by which the gods
Are made by human mind and hand in clods.
The true is the one that acknowledges
That there is just one God of all that is
To join all humankind beneath His will
That none should do injustice or to kill.
Beloved, I take hold of Your oneness here
And know that humankind is one and dear
Though many gods and factions might appear

To make their claims of boundaries and fear.
Beloved, You hold alone the keys of hell,
The gates of Paradise You hold as well.

Barnabas 30

1 Jesus went to Jerusalem
Near to the Senofegia's hem,
A feast of our nation. The scribes
And Pharisees with diatribes
Noticed this and agreed together
To set a trap in his talk's weather.
So then a doctor came to him,
Saying "Master, what good thing trim
Need I to enter life eternal."
Jesus replied, "What's law's internal?"
The tempter answered saying thus,
"Love YHWH Ælohim without fuss,
And the next fellow on the bus.
You'll love your God above all things,
With all your heart and mind in rings,
And the next fellow as yoursel'."
Jesus replied, "You've answered well,
So go and do it, and you shall
Have life eternal, so I tell."
Then he asked him, "Who is the one
Next to me *I should love for fun?*"
2 As Jesus answered he lifted
His eyes, "A man was going led
Down from Jerusalem to go
To Jericho, a town in stow
Rebuilt under a curse, you know.
While on the way this man was seized
By robbers, wounded by the sleezed
And stripped, after which off they went
Leaving him half dead with content.
It happened that a priest came by
And saw the man and let him lie
There wounded without greeting's sigh.
The same way came a Levite too
Without a word passed on from view.
At last it happened that there came
A travelling Samaritan,
Who saw the wounded man, took aim
With his compassion and began
To get down from his mount and take
The wounded man, make no mistake,
He washed his wounds with wine and then
Anointed them with oil again,
Then bandaging his wounds with care
Mounted him on his own horse there.

For what account this may differ in due
From gospel in the canon and the pew,
At least the brave Samaritan is sure
To follow the identical in cure.
He puts the oil and wine just as we saw
In Luke the good physician did with awe
And then puts on the bandage. That shows me
He was no doctor like Luke on a spree.
The bandage first is what Luke takes in hand
And only after oil and wine to stand.
That way the bandage does not stick to wound.
Luke knew the proper, Barnabas has swooned
Before the medical. It does not matter.
Barnabas' words here still make me the fatter.

3 "Arriving at the inn at eve,
He gave him into the reprieve
Of the host to care for a while.
On the next morning with a smile
He said 'Take care of this man here,
And I'll pay you when I appear.'
He gave four gold pieces into
The care of the sick man in view
Of paying the host, and he said
'Don't worry, I'll be quickly led
Back here and take you to my home.'
Now tell me," said Jesus a-foam,
"Who was the neighbour of these three?"
The doctor answered faithfully,
"He was who showed the man mercy."
Then Jesus said "You've got it right.
So go and do by your own sight."
The doctor left him in dismay,
Confused by Jesus' teaching's way.

I am confused, Beloved, that You would send
Jesus to support people on the bend.
Those who oppose the truth I know aloud
Should not be praised as neighbours in the crowd.
Instead, they ought to be renounced to hell.
Right doctrine is a thing must always jell.
Compassion covers many sins I see,
And even sins of false theology.
Samaritans think that Mount Gerizim
Is holiest of places on the rim
Of righteousness, while You and I indeed
Know that the hills of Makkah show the creed
That all should follow, both neighbour and son.
With that all truth is said and all truth won.

Barnabas 31

1 The priests then came near Jesus saying
“Master, is it right to be paying
Tribute to Caesar?” Jesus turned
Around to Judas, asking earned,
“Do you have any money here?”
He took a penny from the gear
In his hand then turning, he said
To the priests, Jesus said as led,
“This penny has an image graved
On it, whose image as behaved?”
They answered, “Caesar’s” “Therefore give,”
Said Jesus, “representative
What is Caear’s to Caesar, and
What is God’s into God’s own hand.”
They also left confused in band.

Let Caesar take his own, do not tell me
To render to such kings a kingly fee.
I have no truck with Caesar on my hill.
I eat my clover and I pay my bill.
Let Caesar take his own, and leave the bread
To those who are still hungry to be fed.
I’ve left desire for Caesar in my stall
And flee the trumpet failing in its call.
Beloved, You set up Caesars as You will
And hand out bread and honey to my fill,
But do You stand the loss when Caesar waits
Beside the poor man’s house, beside his gates?
I am a dervish here, a poor one too,
And I give nought to any but to You.

2 See now a centurion approached,
Saying “Lord, my son and uncoached
Is ill, have mercy on my age!”
Jesus replied, “Lord God assuage
Israel and have mercy on you.”
The man was turning round on cue
To leave and Jesus said “Just wait
For me, and I’ll come to your gate
And pray for your son in his state.”
The centurion replied, “Lord, I
Am not worthy that you come by,
A prophet of God, to my place.
It’s enough that you speak the word
For my son’s healing that I’ve heard,
For your God’s made you master of
Every disease, as from above
His angel told me in sleep’s grace.”

Beloved, I am unworthy that Your own
Sent one should enter from before Your throne
Into the cabin where I live and move.
Say just a word to cloud and sea to prove
A mite to me upon the changing air.
I find the post is better than my prayer.
Let mind in silence turn, let leap the light
Of sun upon the glinting mountain right
Where I arise to stand before Your throne:
I am unworthy to take flesh and bone.
Each yellow leaf the autumn wind brings down
About my ears before I reach the town
Speaks to my knowing. I need no more space
Or time with Your guided one face to face.

3 Then Jesus marvelled greatly, and
Turning to the crowd round to stand
He said "See how this foreigner
Has more faith than I've found occur
In Israel." And turning back
To the centurion without slack
He said "Go in peace because God,
For the great faith He's put in you
For you, has granted your son health."
The centurion went off in stealth,
And on the way he met his men
Who told him he was well again.
The man asked, "What time did it come
The fever left him on the hum?"
They said "Just yesterday at twelve
O'clock, the fever stopped to helve."
4 So the man knew when Jesus said
"The Lord God of Israel has led
Mercy on you," his son was well.
That's why the man believed our God,
And went into his house with rod
And broke in pieces all his own
Idols, saying "There's one alone,
The God of Israel, the true
And living God." He said to crew,
"No one shall eat my bread but he
Who worships Israel's God's decree."

I am a foreigner in every place
I go, but I'm always before Your face,
And that is fatherland enough for me,
Both home and hearth as well as liberty.
I am a stranger in a stranger land
And walk the parched earth and the desert sand

Of Araby as far as house of God
Where I am welcomed in as no one odd.
Beloved, I find Your invitation fast
And bring along in my own coming past
The cherished sacrifice that You condone.
Within the house of God I'm not alone.
I see a million people gathered round
Around the Kaaba on the sacred ground.

Barnabas 32

1 A specialist in law invited
Jesus to dine, and he was spited
To tempt him. Jesus entered there
With his disciples and the share
Of scribes to tempt him multiplied,
Waiting for him, hiding inside.
So his disciples sat down at
The table without washing that
Was prescribed for their hands. The scribes
Called Jesus saying "Why, for bribes,
Do your disciples not observe
The ancient traditions, but swerve
In not washing their hands before
They eat their bread?" Jesus in score
Replied, "And I ask you why you
Have abrogated the law due
To God to observe your traditions?
You tell poor fathers' sons seditions,
'Offer sacrifice and make vows
To the temple,' and it allows.

Your Jesus is a stickler for the Law
And Torah-true is sticking in his craw.
But anything else bound by constitution
Of some tradition looking for solution
He just rejects outright. I take the paw
Of Jesus in the literal in awe
And follow to the letter the commands
Found in the Decalogue in contrabands
I smuggle joy out in the wakened street
Smug with all passers-by that I should meet.
I will exchange opinion public and
The customs ripened, followed by the band,
For the sweet secret fruit the Torah brings
On silver leaves and on vermilion wings.

2 And they make vows of that small store
By which they ought to give the more
To their own parents. And when their
Fathers need to take money's share,

The sons cry out, 'This money's spent
In consecration to God meant,'
And so their fathers suffer loss.
O false scribes, hypocrites to toss,
Does God use this money? Not so,
For God eats nothing of the show,
As He says by His servant and
Prophet David, 'Shall I demand
The flesh of bulls to eat and drink
The blood of sheep killed on the brink?
Give me the sacrifice of praise,
And offer me your vows in days,
But if I were hungry, I'd not
Ask you for anything in lot,
Since all things are by My hand wrought,
Abundant paradise my plot.'
You hypocrites! You do this for
The filling of your gear and store,
That's why you tithe mint and rue more."

The argument between those who would choose
The sacrifice of sheep and bulls in ruse
And those who make of prayer a rendez-vous
Of praises and petitions made to You
Is as old as the Psalms that Jesus quotes
Here reading from his many sermon notes.
Today the sweeter sort of Christian thinks
That I should take a sacrifice on brinks
Of crosses set two thousand years ago.
He takes the sacrificial side and glow.
But I without a sacrifice to meet
Come to Your table without any treat
But that I praise Your name on my own street
And vow in Your command and strength to blow.

3 Outrageous ones, you show the rest
The right way to go, but invest
No efforts of your own. You scribes
And doctors lay on others ribs
In weight unbearable, but you
Yourselves will not remove on cue
A bit by little finger due.
And so truly I say to you,
That every evil thing has come
Into the world under the hum
Of the elders. Tell me who made
Idolatry on earth's parade,
If not something the elders prayed?
For there was once a king who loved
Above all his father *ungloved*,

Whose name was Baal, *great one who shoved*.

4 So when his father died, the son
For his consoling caused be done
An image of his father and
Set it up in the market stand
Of the town. And he made decree
That everyone who came to see
That statue within arm-lengths free
Of fifteen should have amnesty
And none should do him harm or hurt.
That's why the criminals and dirt,
Because of benefit they got,
Began to offer on the plot
Roses and flowers, and in short time
The offerings began to climb
In money and food until they
Called it a god in honour's way.
The custom soon became a law,
So that the idol's iron claw
Spread all around the world for awe.

Both sacrifice and idols have their start
When men try to do more than kiss the part
Set to them by Creator for their art.
The idol comes from misplaced honour due
To parents lost by death from children's view.
That theory is as good as well as true
As any other I have heard in pew.
The sacrifice to idols rose when men
Saw benefits increase by them again.
No sacrifice can add to mercy due
Nor any honour laid in parents' view,
Beyond the sacrifice of broken heart
In the parade behind the token cart
And in acknowledgement, Beloved, of You.

5 How much does God lament the fact
By the prophet Isaiah's act,
Saying "Truly this folk in vain
Worships me for the abrogate
My law once given in the reign
Of My servant Moses in state,
To follow in traditions of
Their elders *and the ones they love*.
6 I tell you truly to eat bread
With hands unwashed will never spread
Defilement to a man, because
What enters a man is not cause
Of defilement, but what comes out
Of a man defiles the man stout."

Then one of the scribes said "If I
Eat pork or other unclean fry,
Will they not sully conscience spry?"
Jesus replied, "To disobey
Does not enter a man that way,
But comes out of the man's own heart,
To defile him when he takes part
Of the forbidden in food's art."

It's not so much the pork, though filled with spore
Of filth and such diseases to abhor,
That will defile a man, but attitude
Of disobedience and being rude
That spoils the heart and so condemns the man.
Beloved, though I eat no pork while I can,
I pray that you will cleanse my heart to be
Obedient to You to last degree.
The eater and the eating go to death
And to the grave after they lose their breath,
But what is given in such obedience
Of love to You beloved is more than pence
And will continue blessed in Your tents.
Let me be porkless in divine presence.

7 One of the doctors said "O master,
You've spoken much against disaster
Idolatrous, as though the folk
Of Israel had idols' stoke,
And so you've done us a wrong stroke."
Jesus replied, "I know full well
Today there are in Israel
No statues of wood, but there are
Statues of flesh, *and men of star.*"
Then answered all the scribes in wrath,
"So we follow in idols' path?"
Jesus replied, "I say to you,
The commandment brings not in view
'You shall worship,' but 'You shall love
YHWH Ælohim with all the shove
Of your soul and with all your heart,
And with all your mind, *not just part.*'
Is this not true?" So Jesus said.
"It is true" answered all the spread.

I neither know nor worship You, Beloved,
Despite the bowings that I do ungloved,
Despite the words of prayer in bismillah
I may recite both morn and night to baa.
My prayer may be obedience, it's true,
But it is hardly knowing to serve You.

Instead, Beloved, I love You where I pass
Within the thresholds of the templed grass
Where idols are beloved and held in awe
Despite the burning of Your fiery law.
Beneath the graven image I'm cast down
In such prostrations that meet every frown
Of Salafi and people of renown.
I do not know You, but I love Your gown.

Barnabas 33

1 Then Jesus said "Truly all which
A man loves, and what in a pitch
He leaves all for, that is his god.
So fornicators have in rod
Their image, the harlot, and those
Who are gluttons and drunkards chose
For image their own flesh, and some
Who are covetous have for rum
An image of silver and gold,
And so every sinner is sold."
The one who had invited him
Said "Master, say what is the grim
Sin that is greatest among trim?"
2 Jesus replied, "Which is the greatest
Destruction of a house and latest?"
All were silent (since they were not
Builders but only scholars wrought),
Till Jesus pointed to foundation,
And said "If there is devastation
Of the foundation, right away
The house falls into ruin's sway,
So that it must be built again,
But every other part of den
Can be repaired. So I say then
Idolatry's the greatest sin,
Because it leaves faith in the bin,
Depriving man of God, so he
Can have no spirituality.
But every other sin leaves man
The hope of gaining mercy's plan,
That's why I say idolatry
Is greatest sin of the country."
All stood amazed at what he said,
Because they noticed it was bred
Not to be confounded with dread.

The sin of flesh and sin of eyes contain
Idolatry, says Jesus, to be plain.
But folly's wisdom raises up instead
An idol higher than butter and bread.

The concepts of God that theology
Invents in minds of men taught to be free
Are above all flesh an idolatry.
Your true faith strikes down every Trinity.
Beloved, strike down the Trinity in me
That worships other than You in the church
Of my heart graven out of stone and birch.
Strike down the idol made of flesh and eye,
Strike down the false gods born under the sky
And set in creeds of iron and warring pry.

3 Jesus continued, "Mind what God
Spoke and what Moses man with rod
And Joshua wrote in the Law,
And you'll see how grave is this flaw.
God said speaking to Israel,
'You'll not make yourself any fell
Image of those things high above,
Or those things under sky like dove,
Or things found here above the earth,
Or things found under earth in worth,
Nor things found above water here,
Nor what under water appear.
For I'm your Ælohim, both strong
And jealous to avenge the wrong
For this sin on father and on
Offspring to generation's dawn
Of four of them still coming drawn.
4 "Remember how, when our folk made
The calf and worshipped it displayed,
By God's command Joshua laid
Along with Levi's tribe the sword
Upon them to kill them and gored
One hundred twenty thousand who
Did not crave God's mercy in view.
How terrible God's judgement lies
Upon idolators in guise!"

I know none but idolaters today
Who walk the earthly paths and the highway.
So where is judgement terrible that finds
The guilty behind the Venetian blinds?
The calf is great and golden still, while black
Gold turns the glitter stinking in the stack.
It matters not, as long as some men reign
And others hand the bill and foot the pain.
It matters not as long as there is gain.
Beloved, the sins of fathers do come down
To haunt the children born in their home-town.
I lift a sword for Joshua's renown

And raise a cry for Levi and a crown
To find the age-old business makes its stain.

Barnabas 34

1 There stood at the door one who had
His right hand shrivelled and so bad
That he could not use it at all.
So Jesus lifted up his call
To God sincerely, prayed and said
“In order that you may be led
To know that what I say is true,
I say ‘In the name of God, man,
Stretch out your withered hand by plan!’”
He stretched it out and it was well
As though it never had been fell.

The whole point of this tale in Gospels’ crew
Of the canonical in Bible view
Was that Christ did this miracle one day
When Sabbath graced the homes and hearts of fey.
But Barnabas leaves out the punch line here.
What has poor Barnabas in fact to fear?
Let truth prevail, and let us hide no fact.
There is no quarrel in the healing act,
But in the Sabbath day. That’s with us still.
Let us get at the arguing and bill.
I set my foot upon the Sabbath hill
And find no healers there. No wonder men
No longer love the Sabbath’s light again.
It’s empty of the benefit of ten.

2 Then in the fear of God began
The men to eat. And when the bran
Had been consumed, Jesus again
Began to say “Indeed, O men,
I say to you, a better thing
Would be a city’s whole burning
Than leaving an evil custom.
Because of such things in their hum
God’s angry with presidents and
Kings on the earth to whom God gave
The sword to destroy wicked knave.”

Those are strong words, Beloved, and yet I trow
There is no sect that’s perfect in the row.
There is an evil custom, one or two,
In the most faithful of Your faithful crew.
The law is perfect, I’ve no doubt of that,
And leads to the great justice and the fat,
But in its application in the crude

And rough world there are always things to brood
About and wonder if a better way
Of finer acts in the obedient pay
Might not be found. I watch the gentle play
And know the fragrant truth here where I stay.
So let the city burn, the sweat and fair,
And let men do the things that some may dare.

3 After that Jesus said “When you
Get invitations, don’t take pew
In highest places, so when comes
A greater friend with greater sums
The host does not have to tell you
“Get us and take a lower pew.”
That would bring a shame upon you.
But go and sit in the worst place
So that the host may show you grace,
Come by and say ‘Dear friend, arise,
And come and sit here near the skies.’
So then you will be honoured, for
Everyone who exalts himself
Shall be once humbled on the shelf,
And he who humbles himself will
Be exalted *upon the hill*.

4 “Indeed I say to you, Satan
Did not fall by another plan
But by the sin of his own pride.
Just as prophet Isaiah’s tide
Gives him reproach with these words’ guise,
‘How you are fallen from the skies,
O Lucifer, the angel’s prize,
And shone like the dawn in your fall
To earth in pride *against the wall!*’

5 Truly I say to you that if
A man recognized his own stiff
Judgements, he’d always weep on earth,
Accounting self of little worth
Beneath all things. No other cause
Made the first man with his wife pause
A hundred years to weep without
Stopping to beg the mercy’s clout
Of God. They knew they fell indeed
Through their own pride *and in such greed.*”

6 And after this, Jesus gave thanks,
And that day it spread through the ranks
Of fair Jerusalem what great
Things Jesus said, and at the gate
What miracle Jesus had done,
So that the folk gave thanks a tonne
To God blessing His name begun.

7 But the scribes understood that he
Spoke against the elders' decree,
And were kindled with enmity.
Like Pharaoh they hardened their hearts,
And so they tried to sharpen darts
To kill him, but failed in their starts.

You mention two alternatives to boot:
Those who prance to the higher place in suit,
And those who take the worst positions till
The host comes in to raise them to their fill.
The third alternative is likely still,
That the host will not notice where you sit
And so will leave you in the worst unfit.
I do suppose that is the better choice,
The place where ego comes back to rejoice,
And knows that pride is struck down to the root.
The world is one of trodden down and brute.
That seems to serve the purpose and the task
Of making humans humble where they bask.
Creation leaves lacuna when you ask.

Barnabas 35

1 So Jesus left Jerusalem
And went out to the desert hem
Beyond the Jordan, and the men
Who followed him were seated then
Around him, and they said to him,
"O master, tell us how the grim
Satan fell through his pride, for we
Understood that initially
He fell through disobedience,
And since he always is intense
To tempt to evil consequence."
2 Jesus replied, "God had created
A mass of earth left unabated
For twenty-five thousand years and
Did not do aught else with the land,
Then Satan, who was at a stand
As priest and head of angel band,
By understanding he possessed,
Knew that God from that mass unguessed
Of earth would take one hundred forty
Four thousand signed prophetic shorty,
And the Messenger of God blessed,
The soul of which Messenger's hest
He created before aught else
By sixty thousand years of belts.
That's why he was angry and made
The angels dissatisfied, staid,

Saying, "See now, one day God will
Desire us to bow to this hill.
Just think that we are spirit, so
It's not fitting for us to show."
Many therefore forsook God's way.
That's why God said to them one day
When all the angels came to play,
"Let all who hold me Lord straight-way
Do reverence to this earth today."

What grace abounding, O Beloved, that You
Sent out over the ages such a crew
Of prophets to this humankind in view!
If all of them were eloquent in light
And words resplendent with celestial right,
Then they are like the stars shining at night.
Beloved, let me take every prophet's faith
Into my heart of stone and foolish wraith.
Let me live day by day in that vast field
Where prophecies arise and come to yield
Rewards of dews of heaven and every gem
Of truth that is found in Your divine hem.
Then I shall live to see the glories shine
From east to west in everything divine.

3 Then those who loved God bowed right down,
But Satan and those with his frown
Said "O Lord we are spirit and
Therefore it's not just out of hand
For us to prostrate to this clay."
When he said this Satan astray
Became horrid and stayed that way,
His followers too frightfully
Were deformed acting wickedly,
For God deprived them of beauty
He gave them from making's degree.
At this the holy angels when
They lifted up their heads again
Saw what a terrible fiend came
From Satan, his followers the same,
Fell faces to the earth for blame.
Then Satan said "O Lord, unjust
Are you in turning into dust
My beauty, but I am content
With that, because I would prevent
All that You plan to do and make.
The other devils for his sake
Said "Don't call Him Lord, a mistake,
For you are lord, Lucifer's wake."
4 Then God said to the followers

Of Satan, "Repent now, you curs,
And recognize Me as Your God
And your Creator on the sod."
And answered, "We indeed repent
Of ever holding You reverent.
You are not just, but Satan's just.
Then God said, "Get away you must
From Me, you cursed ones, I shall not
Have mercy on you, though unsought."
As he departed Satan spat
Up some earth from the place he sat,
And Gabriel cleaned away the stain
Of spittle from the earth, some grain
Of earth stuck to it, that is why
Man has a belly-button's pie."

With the refusal of Iblis to bow
Down to the earth with his unwrinkled brow,
The words of Jesus by dear Barnabas
Raise a new question on the æthered gas.
Does the Qur'an quote Barnabas in state
Or does Barnabas quote Qur'an come late?
Let scholars wrangle for encumbered date.
I give the wrangling a wave and a pass.
Beloved, the words whether come late or soon
Remain to me and to my soul a boon.
Let me give my obedience to You
In everything I try or come to do.
Let the lordship of Your creation find
Me bowing when I have both drunk and dined.

Barnabas 36

1 Disciples were amazed to hear
About angels' rebellion tier.
Then Jesus said "I truly say
To you that one who does not pray
Is more wicked than Satan's way,
And shall suffer torments the greater.
Because Satan had unlike later
Before his fall no right example
Of fearing nor did God send sample
Of prophets to him to call him
Back to repentance from the grim.
But man now all the prophets came
Except God's Messenger of fame
Who shall come after me in claim,
Because God wills so, and that I
May prepare his way as I try,
And man, I tell you, though he's got
Abundant signs of God's just plot,

Lives carelessly and without thought
Of any fear, as though there were
No God. Even as of such stir
David the prophet spoke to say
'The fool says in his heart today
There is no God. That's why they are
Corrupted in particular,
Without one of them doing good.'

I am a fool and it is just as well
That I say my prayers in such poorly spell.
I start them with the proclamation's sound
That there is no god in heaven or on ground,
There is no god but You, and yet my breath
Might well be cut off by my sudden death
And leave me with the sentence broken there
That there is no God for my fateful share.
Would it not be a better thing, O Love,
If I spoke not a single word in shove,
But only lifted eye and heart to be
Acknowledgement of Your divinity?
Must I obey in bowing to the earth
To say the simple words you send in worth?

2 Pray without ceasing as you should,
O my disciples, so you may
Receive. For he who seeks today
Shall find, and he who knocks to him
It shall be opened, and the trim
Who asks receives. And in your prayer
Do not try to speak in words fair,
For God looks on the heart's despair,
As He said through Solomon's fame,
'O My servant, give your heart's flame.'
Indeed I say to you, as God
Lives, hypocrites upon the sod
Pray much in every part of town
To be seen and held without frown
As saints by all the populace,
With their hearts filled with wickedness,
And that's why they do mean what they
Are saying when they ask and pray.
You must mean what you say in prayer
If you hope God receives it there.
Tell me now, who would go to speak
To Roman governor and squeak
To Herod, unless he thought first
Before whom he goes in at worst,
And what he plans to do? None would.
And if man plans so well to speak

With man, what ought he do to seek
To speak with God and ask of him
Mercy for his sins' evil grim
While thanking for his gear and trim?

Whether I pray non-stop and Jesus claims
I should or five times in the day by aims,
I trust my heart's as black as any other
In humankind where brother threatens brother.
My prayers are few and weak, so none can know
What kind of saint I could be in the show
If I were quicker at prostration's glow
Or genuflections to the Saviour's mother.
Beloved, I stand aghast at Your command
That I should pray non-stop here where I stand.
The Sufi practice of a constant heart
With Your name written on it be my part
To change the darkness all are sure they see
To something lighter in Your purity.

3 "I truly say to you that few
Make true prayer (though they sit in pew)
And that's why Satan has his power
Over them, because not an hour
Does God want those who honour Him
With lips alone. Who are not dim
Ask in the temple with their lips
For mercy, and the heart in sips
Cries out for justice. So He tells
Isaiah the prophet with bells,
'Take hence this folk irksome to Me,
Because with their lips they make free
To honour Me, but their heart's far
From Me.' I will to you unbar
The secret that he who would pray
Without considering the way
Makes mockery of God today.

All prayers are made by lips or by the heart,
And both may be uncircumcised in art
According to the blessed and divine Word
Vouchsafed before Muhammad's day occurred.
I cry out for my justice like all men
And even for the justice come again
To others in my time, though such a wail
Is rarely worth the bother to prevail.
Let me make mockery of anything,
The true and false, the flight on every wing,
And I shall satisfy the modes of prayer
On lips and in the hearts of those who dare.

Satan's a power no doubt before the glare
Of humankind and angels when they sing.

4 "Now who would go to audience
With Herod with his back's offence
Towards him and so before him speak
Well of Pilate, the little tweak
Of governor whom Herod hates
To death *before his palace gates?*
Truly no man. Yet it's no less
A man does going to confess
In prayer and prepares not himself.
He turns his back to God, to elf
And Satan's face and praises him.
For in his heart is a love grim
Of wickedness, from which he's not
Repented. If one, having sought
To injure you, should with his lips
Say to you, 'Forgive me,' and slips
With his hand to strike you a blow,
How would you then forgive the show?
So God shall have mercy on those
Who with their lips say down to toes,
'Lord, have mercy on us,' while heart
Loves wickedness and does its part
To think on new sins where to start.

Beloved, the reason that I give undue
Honour to presidents and kings in view,
And fail to show respect, obedience
And love to You, is because Your presence
Is without pomp and without grand display.
I hardly hear a single word you say.
Instead of palaces and gold array,
You enter with the sunrise without sound
And touch with glory all the blessed ground.
It is humility of day and night
And passing of the wondered sky in light
That moves me not to cast myself before
A throne too large for me to see on shore.
I'm too transfixed by puny pride and gore.

Barnabas 37

1 The disciples wept at the word
Of Jesus and begged him as stirred
Saying "Lord teach us how to pray."
Jesus replied, "Think of the way
That you would do if governor
From Rome seized you to even score
And put you to death, just that way

Do when you go to God to pray.
May the words of your prayer be these:
2 O Lord our God, *God of mercies*,
May hallowed be Your holy name,
May Your kingdom among us come,
Your will be always done the same
As in Heaven also humdrum
Of earth. Give us our bread each day,
And forgive us our sins *who stray*,
As we forgive those who transgress
Against us, let us not digress
Into temptation, but save us
From evil, for You *glorious*
Alone are God to *all of us*,
To whom is glory, honour's *praise*
For ever *to the end of days*."

The Pater Noster is a blessed round
Repeated by the faithful on the ground.
But I'm distracted by the colours bound
In lake and hill and in the fervent sound
Of magpies praying in another tongue.
So I remain at the prayer's lowest rung.
Beloved, the Pater Noster on the lung
Of Christian and Al-Fatihah as sung
By the imam, and the Psalm in its toil
Of Hebrew mesh in synagogal spoil
All call to me in beauty. Yet I stand
In silence before You and in more grand
A temple than the lot may cast in fear.
My prayer is just a twitter at my ear.

Barnabas 38

1 Then John replied, "Master, let us
Wash ourselves as with animus
God commanded once by Moses."
Jesus said "Do you think that I
Have come destroying the Law's cry
And the prophets? Indeed I say
To you, as God lives, in my way
I've not come to destroy it but
Rather to observe it *clear-cut*.
For every prophet's always kept
The Law of God and all God's clept
By other prophets. As God lives,
Before whose sight I stand as gives,
No one who breaks the least command
Can please God but as the least stand
In the judgement of God, for he
Shall have no part in kingdom's fee.

I tell you furthermore that one
Word of the law of God to shun
Cannot be broken without sin
Of grave consequence' origin.
But I would have you know that you
Must observe what God says by view
Of Isaiah the prophet who
Speaks with these words, 'Now then wash you
And be clean, take away your thoughts
From my sight.' Indeed in my plots
I tell you all the water in
The sea will not wash him from sin
Who with his heart loves wicked lots.

So what does Jesus mean by quoting bare
Isaiah? That the water in its share
Is still appropriate before our prayer,
Or that one can dispense with such a thing
Since heart is never cleansed in splash and spring
Of water, but in the prophetic ring.
Commandment-breakers do not stand abroad
In innocence before the judgement laud.
Cleanse me and my heart too of sin to find
That I follow each word Your law reveals
Before the judgement comes and thunder peals.
Then I shall seek the waters of the sea
Beyond the North Cape or the waves sweetly
That bathe Canaries' hopes among the wind.

2 "Now furthermore I say to you
That none will pray in pleasing due
To God unless he be washed too,
But such will burden down his soul
With sin as though with idol's toll.
Believe me truly if a man
Prayed to God as is fit and can,
He'd get everything he might ask.
Remember Moses who had task
To serve God, who with his prayer just
Plagued Egypt, opened to dust
The Red Sea and drowned Pharaoh and
The army under his command.
Remember Joshua who made
The sun stand still and on parade,
Samuel who struck the Philistines
With fear though in bands beyond signs,
Elijah, who made fire to rain
Down from the sky, Elisha's cane
Who raised a dead man, and the crew
Of other holy prophets too,

Who by prayer attained all they asked.
But those men indeed had not basked
In their own lusts in what they asked,
But sought only God and His glory
And honour in everyone's story."

I've followed to the better every task
Of washing before praying that You ask,
Beloved, but still have not raised up the dead
Or even got a sick man out of bed.
I've come with both hands clean to praise Your name,
And make petition to You for Your fame,
And do my penance as well as my plaint.
And yet, You know that I am not a saint.
Beloved, though lust bears up my hidden store,
At least greed and the cruel are a bore,
As I seek only You and glory's power
And honour to Your name from hour to hour.
So raise up all the dead for whom I pray
As well as the sick ones who hear me bray.

Barnabas 39

1 Then John said "You have spoken well,
O master, but still come to tell
Us how man sinned through pride and fell."
Jesus replied, God would expel
Satan, and angel Gabriel
Had purified that mass of earth
On which Satan spat without worth,
And then God created what lives,
All things both animals He gives
To fly and those that walk and swim,
And He adorned the world with trim.
One day Satan came to the gates
Of paradise, and seeing mates
Of horses eating grass, he said
To them that if that earthy dread
Received a self there would instead
Be hard labour upon their head,
And so it would help them to tread
That piece of earth in such a way
That it would be no good for pay.
2 The horses got up quickly and
Set out to run that piece of sand
To earth among lilies and roses.
Then God gave spirit that composes
To that unclean portion of earth
Upon which Satan without worth
Had spat, which Gabriel came to pluck
Up from the mass and where it stuck

He made a dog that barked and scared
The horses off who fled unspared.
Then God gave His self to the man,
While all the holy angels can
Sing, 'Blessed be Your holy name, O
Ælohim our YHWH, way to go.'
Adam jumped up upon his feet,
Saw in the air a writing meet
That shone like the sun, and which said
'There is only one God, and led
Muhammad is the messenger
Of Ælohim, and that is sure.'

The famous Creed is written in the air
And shines like to sun shining everywhere
To tell all humankind in Adam's seed
That this is the only sufficient Creed.
The angels come repeating every word
Of revelation that at once occurred
To say that there is no God on the earth
But You, Beloved, and You are of no birth;
To say that one Muhammad's messenger
To all the world where human hearts may stir.
Let horse and spittle of devil and dog
Return into the abyss and the fog,
But I remain to bark the Creed aloud
Before the shaking aspens in a crowd.

3 "So Adam opened mouth and said
'I thank you O YHWH Ælohim,
That You've deigned to create my beam.
But tell me, I pray what can mean
The message of these words I've seen,
"Muhammad is God's messenger."
Have there been men before I stir?'
Then God said "You are welcome here,
O my servant Adam with fear.
I tell you that you are the first
Man I've created, not the worst.
And the one mentioned is your son,
Who shall come into the world done
Many years from now, and shall be
My messenger, for whom in fee
I have created all these things,
Who shall give light to the worldlings
When he shall come, whose soul was planned
In heavenly splendour, though unmanned
Sixty thousand years e'er I made
Anything that's here on parade.
4 "Adam begged God saying 'Lord, grant

Me this writing upon the scant
Nails of the fingers of my hands.'
Then Ælohim gave the commands
That the first man upon his thumbs
Should have that writing in its sums,
Upon the thumb-nail of the right
Hand it said 'There is One of might,
Only one God' and on the sight
Of the left thumb-nail He did write,
'Muhammad is God's messenger.'
Then with a father's love to stir,
The first man kissed those words and rubbed
His eyes and said 'Blessed be that dubbed
Day when you come into the world,
And the banner of truth unfurled.'

I pray that every man may lend an ear
And every woman stop at once to hear
That on the right thumbnail is printed clear
For Adam that there is no god but You,
And on the left You have left in plain view
That Muhammad's Your messenger and true.
That's revelation to suffice when I
Look for the truth at last before I die,
And find that Adam had it all the time
Writ on each thumbnail clear, sweet, without rhyme.
There may be someone that illiterate
Who fails to see the writing on the nail,
But I am one to see it without fail
To hit the nail on the head or the pate.

5 "Seeing the man alone, God said
'It is not good that he instead
Should be alone.' that's why He made
Him sleep and took the side that stayed
Near his heart and filled up the place
With flesh. Of that side and that trace
He made Eve and gave her to be
Adam's wife. He set them both free
As governors of Paradise,
And said to them, See I give you
Every kind of fruit in your stew
To eat, except the apples new
And the grain,' of which He said then,
'Watch out and do not come again
To eat these fruits, for then you'll be
Unclean more than I'd let you see
You stay here, but will drive you out
To suffer great misery in rout.'

The reason this book is so thick and long
It just because it quotes the lovely song
Of Yours in revelation like a gong
From the start to the finish for no wrong.
The chapter of the sleeping side that rose
To be a woman that Adam once chose
Remains a vital message, stay on toes.
It's the only way to avoid one's foes.
The verse of prohibition is enough
To keep all hands on board and in the rough.
When hungry every prohibition's tough.
Beloved, I take no stock in fruit that You
Prohibit to the tongue since earth was new.
Let me follow You in the things You do.

Barnabas 40

1 "When Satan knew of this he raged
With indignation and engaged
To come near gates of paradise
Where horrid serpent with legs nice
Like those of a camel and nails
On his feet that cut like the rails
Of a razor on every side,
Was standing guard. The foe replied
To him, 'Let me now come inside.'
2 "The serpent answered, 'How shall I
Let you come in, since God's reply
Commanded me to throw you out?'
Satan answered, 'You see how stout
Is God's love for you, He has set
You outside paradise to get
Guard over a small lump of clay
That is a man in its poor way.
If you bring me in paradise,
I'll make you so horrid to eyes
That everyone will flee away
So you can go and come and stay
At will.' Then the serpent replied,
'How then shall I set you inside?'
3 "Satan said 'You are big, and so
Open your mouth, and I shall go
Into your belly, and when you
Go into paradise, then you
Will place me near those clay lumps two
That have started to walk in view
Upon the earth as though in due.'

Oh what deceit! I always thought for shame
That the serpent had gained speech for his fame.
It's just a satan in the belly that

Speaks to the woman, not a talking cat.
The flattering of serpents for the room
They might provide seducing in the gloom
Is one way that the story could unfold.
I wonder that sweet Jesus was so bold.
And yet in every day and clime I swear
That humankind is like that everywhere.
It's always some gross satan that is kept
Inside the belly that finds place unswept
And ready to be well seduced by sweets
Or any other insubstantial treats.

Then the serpent did so, and placed
Satan near Eve, for Adam graced
To be her husband was asleep.
Satan showed himself at the peep
Of the woman in guise of light
And beautiful angel to sight,
And said to her, 'Why don't you eat
These apples and grain for a treat?'
Eve answered, 'Our God's told us that
If we eat them, just like a mat,
We'll be unclean here where we're at,
And He will drive us from the flat.'

I always thought the serpent spoke to Eve
Who was beside her husband not to grieve
But to show that the first society
Was matriarchal for a better plea.
But now I know the famous man just slept.
It was a better vigil had he kept.
The first time that he slept his wife was born.
The second time the poor soul's left forlorn
But what comes from the belly to seduce
Them both with pretty colours and sweet juice.
Beloved, let me sleep in Your will and find
No more surprises among the well wined.
Give me a dreamless sleep upon the sand
Of universe, the golden and the grand.

4 Satan replied, 'He does not speak
The truth! You ought to know the cheek
Of God who's wicked, jealous, too,
And will have no equals in view,
But keeps every one as a slave.
That's why He has told you so grave,
So you may not rise up to be
His equal in eternity.
But if you and your mate do what
I say, you shall eat those fruits shut

As any others, and you'll not
Remain subjects of others' plot,
But like God you shall know the lot
Of good and evil, and you'll do
Whatever it is you want to.

Because you'll be equal in view
To Ælohim Himself as due.'

5 Then Eve took and ate of those and
When her husband woke up to stand,
She told him what Satan had said.
And he took and ate what she led
Him to. But as he swallowed it
He remembered God's words and fit,
And tried to stop food going down
By putting his hand in to drown
In his throat. That's why every man
Has Adam's apple in throat's span.

A sonneteer must learn to limit space
And subject to fulfil the sonnet's grace.
But of which shall I write this time? I see
The proclamation that You're unity
Of one without an equal is so great
That I should make remarks on it and state.
It's true what Satan in belly of snake
Said of God, He alone can take the cake.
But there is one more subject, more amusing
Than truth of some theology confusing.
It is that Adam's apple came about
By sticking of his fingers down his snout.
So which of these to choose, the fair in truth
Or rather the amusing in my youth?

Barnabas 41

1 "Then they both knew that they were nude,
And being ashamed to be viewed,
They took fig leaves and made them clothes
To cover their secrets that rose.
After midday, then God appeared
To them and called Adam as feared
And said 'Adam, where are you now?'
He answered, 'Lord, I hid from prow
Of Your sight, for my wife and I
Are naked and so we would cry
For shame to come before Your sight.'
Then God said 'Who has robbed you now
Of innocence upon your brow,
Unless you ate of fruit unclean,
So that you will no more be seen
Abiding in your paradise?'

The grand solution to the enigma
Of how to appear before You in raw
Is simply to hold services in saunas
Instead of thinking that we all are goners
For being born without a stitch of clothing.
Put end to foolishnesses in self-loathing.
If I am too ashamed to appear nude
In the cathedral liturgy and viewed,
Then simply move the church to the bath house
Where everyone is free to duck and dowse.
Beloved, I vaunt me naked here before
Your throne without a fur or silk in store,
But with provision that I may retrieve
A coat from the flea market in reprieve.

2 “Adam replied, ‘O Lord, the wife
You gave me urged on me for life
To eat and so I ate for strife.’
Then God said to the woman, ‘Why
Did you give this food by and by
To your husband?’ Eve answered so,
‘Satan deceived me with a show
And so I ate.’ ‘And how did that
Reprobate come into your flat?’
Asked God. Eve answered, ‘A serpent
That stands at the northern gate went
And brought him near to me as sent.’

3 “Then God told Adam, ‘Because you
Have listened to your wife and crew
And eaten the fruit, cursed now be
The earth under your hand harshly,
It shall sprout for you brambles, thorns,
And you shall eat bread by the horns
Of sweaty face. Remember you
Are earth, and back to earth you
Return.’ And he spoke then to Eve,
Saying ‘You who sought your reprieve
In Satan and gave food to grieve
Your husband shall abide beneath
Dominion of your man’s bequeath,
Who’ll keep you working till you bear
Children to show you trouble’s share.’

4 “The serpent summoned, God then called
The angel Michael unappalled
Who holds the sword of God, and said
‘First drive this wicked serpent led
Forth from the paradise and when
It’s out, cut off his legs again,
For if he wants to go at all,

He must drag body on the wall.’
Then God called Satan and he came
Laughing and sneering as in blame,
And He said to him, ‘Since you are
A reprobate, deceiving star,
To make them unclean, my desire
Is that every uncleanness, sire,
From them and all their children might,
If they truly repent, do right,
When it goes from their body’s sight,
Shall enter in your mouth, and so
You’ll be filled up with unclean stow.’

This is good news indeed, I see,
That every time in sinful spree
I gather guilt and filth to me
And then repent in broken heart,
The filth passes in stolen art
Into the mouth of Satan till
He retches underneath the spill.
It is enough to inspire hand
To greater crimes in theme and band
Just to cast on the tempter’s head
The rotting fruits of where he led.
Beloved, let me not be too keen
To vex on him my hope and spleen,
But rather to resist his bean.

5 “Then Satan gave a ghastly roar,
And said ‘Since You make me worse store,
I’ll make of that the thing I can.’
But God said ‘Leave My presence’ scan.’
So Satan left, and then God spoke
To Adam and Eve like to choke
With weeping, ‘Go from paradise,
And do your penance in My eyes,
But never let your hope once fail,
For I will send your son to hail
So that your children shall uplift
Satan’s dominion from the rift
Of humankind, for I’ll give all
Things to him who will then enthrall
Humanity, My messenger.

6 “God hid from them as would occur,
The angel drove from paradise.
Then Adam turning saw above
The gate written a thing of love,
‘There is only one God above,
Muhammad is sent in God’s love
A messenger come from above.’

Weeping, he said 'May it God please,
O my son, that you quickly ease
Us from our misery and come.'
And so," said Jesus, "Satan and
Adam both sinned through pride to stand,
The one by his despising man,
The other in the wish to scan
To make himself equal with God
While living on the earthly sod."

The Christian's sweet to say that You came down
To prophecy the coming to the town
Of Jesus when he met folk with a frown.
But Barnabas remembers things awry:
He sees the prophecy rather to try
To bring the message of a Messenger
Much later in the times and to occur.
To prophesy Muhammad in a stir
Is the obsession of this sect in rate
That gathered round this Gospel to be great
In Andalus or in some eastern sphere
When men and women came to You in fear
And love to find the way to Paradise
Through gardens and through voices in a trice.

Barnabas 42

1 Then the disciples wept to hear
This speech and also Jesus' tear
Was shed, when they saw many come
To find him, for the chief priests' hum
Among themselves was to trap him
In what he said careful and prim.
So they sent Levites and some scribes
To question him with diatribes
To say "Who are you?" as with bribes.
2 Jesus confessed and said the truth,
'I am not God's anointed couth.'
They asked, 'Are you Elijah or
Jeremiah or any more
Of ancient prophets in their score?'
And Jesus answered, 'No, I'm not.'
Then they said 'Who are you in plot?
Tell us so we can take the word
Back to those who sent us and stirred.'
Then Jesus spoke *as had done John*
Before him quoting paragon,
'I am a voice that cries aloud
Through all the great Judaeian crowd,
To shout, "Prepare the way to come
For the Lord's messenger in sum,"

Even as writes Isaiah's thumb.'
3 They said "If you're not the anointed
Or Elijah or some appointed
Ancient prophet, then why do you
Preach a new doctrine brought to view,
And make yourself of more account
Than the anointed in amount?"
Jesus replied, "The signs which God
Works by my hands upon the sod
Show that I speak that which God wills.
Nor do I set myself with frills
To be considered with the one
Of whom you speak under the sun.
For I'm not worthy to unloose
The ties of pant or catch obtuse
Of sandal of the messenger
Of God whom you would so confer
Title of the anointed, who
Was set before me and shall come
After me, and shall bring in sum
The words of truth, so that his prime
Of faith shall have no end in time.'

Jesus quotes the words that stand fast
In the canonical writ's blast
That John spoke in referring to
The one to follow him in crew.
The way reminds me very much
Of how some Sufi sharks could touch
Enquiry with a run around.
The head of the order is found
Behind the fire and cooking pots,
While the last to join in their plots,
The smallest of initiates
Is crowned and posed in royal states.
There is no better place to hide
Than in the kitchen or beside.

4 The Levites and scribes left the show
Confused, and told all that they know
To the chief priests who said "He's got
The devil on his black in plot
Who tells him what to say in lot."
Then Jesus told his disciples,
"Indeed I tell you that the pulls,
Of chiefs and elders of our folk
Seek an excuse to break my yolk."
Then Peter said "Then do not go
Again into Jerusalem."
That's why Jesus answered in glow,

“You’re foolish in that stratagem,
Not knowing what you say, for it
Is necessary thing and fit
That I should suffer persecution,
Because so have without solution
All the prophets before my time,
And holy ones of God in prime.
But do not be afraid for that,
For some are with us where we sat,
And others are against us flat.”

All prophets suffer for the things they say
In messages from You given without pay.
Beloved, I hear the songs of past days ring
In writings of the prophets when they sing.
All prophets suffer persecution here,
And bide the time of judgement and of fear,
Until the day when those who taunted them
And made such opposition at the hem
Return to You and know what they have done.
Let me see those souls who sit at their rum
Condemned in this life and the one to come
While those who hear and follow till they’ve won
Be blessed for ever in sorrow and fun.

5 After he said this, Jesus left
To go to Mount Tabor uncleft,
And there went up with him the three
Peter, James and John, brother’s fee,
With him who writes this history.
And so there shone on him a light
So great his garments became white
Like snow and his face glistened bright
As the sun, and see, there came there
Moses and Elijah the fair
To speak with Jesus all that must
Come on our race and on the dust
Of the town sacred *and in trust*.
Peter spoke and said “Lord, it’s good
To be here. And so, if you would,
We’ll make here three shrines in the wood,
One for you and one as we could
For Moses and one might and should
Be for Elijah.” While he spoke,
They were enveloped in the stroke
Of a white cloud and heard a voice
Saying “Behold My servant choice
In whom I am well pleased, and so
Hear him *and whatever he show*.”
6 The disciples were filled with fear

And fell down with their face and gear
Upon the earth as dead appear.
Jesus went down and raised his own
Disciples, saying "Fear no groan,
For God loves you and He has done
This so you may under the sun
Believe my words *as I've begun.*"

The great transfiguration in the story
Of Jesus is exciting but not gory.
It seems that it is filled with grace and glory.
It causes all who see it to fall down
In deep prostration and in flowing gown.
I've seen such falling to the earth with head
Upon the dust or carpet like a bed
In many mosques from here to Timbuctu.
Prostrating is the thing that Muslims do.
Beloved, show me the glory or then not,
But if You do, I'll fall like someone shot
Upon my face in remembrance of You,
In worship to the One God who is true.
It's doing of the best that I have got.

Barnabas 43

1 Jesus went down to find the eight
Disciples waiting at the gate
Below. The four came to narrate
To the eight all that they had seen,
And so all doubt of Jesus clean
Left their heart, except from the one
Judas Iscariot foredone
Who would believe nothing at all.
Jesus sat down upon the wall
At the foot of the mountain, and
They ate the wild fruits of the land
Because they had no bread at hand.
Then Andrew said "You've told us much
About the anointed, as such
Kindly tell us clearly all things."
The other disciples' askings
Were in like manner and like touch.
2 So Jesus said "Everyone that
Works toils for the goal in which flat
He finds his pleasure. Therefore I
Tell you that God, truly thereby
Is perfect and has never need
Of satisfaction in the seed,
Since He is satisfaction's self.
And so with will to work on shelf,
He made before all things the self

Of His messenger, for whom He
Determined to create the spree,
So that creatures should find their glee
And blessedness in God, so His
Messenger should take delight fizz
In all His creatures that He has
Appointed to be servants as.
And that is why the thing is so,
Just because he has willed it so.

Anointed and appointed and messiah
Are of a kind and colour to the crier,
And each refers to the same heir in doubt,
In lines of kings and prophets with a shout
And divine guides to lead the people out.
The word denied by Jesus and related
To the one coming in class unabated
Is not a conflict nor a contradiction
Except for those who have a foul addiction
To straws and picking at them. God sent all
To do a job and to obey the call.
And all sent were appointed and anointed
Messiahs in so many lands disjointed.
So let the woeful critics have a ball.

3 “Indeed I say to you that each
Prophet when he has come to preach
Has borne to one nation alone
The mark of God’s mercy *and throne*.
And so their words were not extended
Except to that folk where they wended.
But the messenger of God when
He shall come God shall give again
To him as it were in his hand
His seal, so that he may bring all
Salvation and mercy to all
The nations of the world that take
His doctrine and bear for his sake.
He’ll come with power upon unjust,
Destroying idolatry’s lust,
So that he’ll make Satan confounded,
For so promised God to unbounded
Abraham, saying ‘See in your
Descendant I will bless in store
All the tribes of the earth and more
As you have broken shattering
The idols, Abraham, such thing
Shall also your descendant bring.’”

The promise was awakened in the mind

And heart of Abraham with sweets combined
That one day the desired one should appear
And bless all nations with Your love and fear;
That one should break the idols in their way
And bring to earth a new and brighter day.
When Jesus came to Israel to see
Who really loved You of the peasantry,
He came to his own folk like many more
Who have proclaimed Your oneness on some shore
Of earthly round. But the desired at last
Was promised in oracles of the past.
More than a thousand years have since gone by
Since he stood up against the Meccan sky.

4 James answered, "Master, tell us who
Received this promise, for in crew
The Jews say 'in Isaac,' while they
Of the Ishmaelitic way
Say 'in Ishmael.'" Jesus replied,
"David, whose son is he beside,
And of what lineage to divide?"
James answered, "Of Isaac, for he
Was father of Jacob, and see
Jacob was father of Judah,
Of whose lineage is David's awe."
5 Then Jesus said "And when he comes
The Messenger of God in sums,
Of what lineage will be his hums?"
The disciples replied "Of David."
Then Jesus said "Deceived to wave it,
For David in the spirit calls
Him lord, saying as it enthrals:
'God said to my lord sit you down
On My right hand until with frown
I make your foes be your footstool.
God shall send forth your rod in tool
Which shall have lordship on your foes.'
If God's messenger's one of those
You call anointed, David's son,
How should David call him in fun
Lord? Believe me, I truly say
To you that the promise to stay
Was made in Ishmael on that day,
And not made in Isaac for sway."

Good point, Beloved, that Your sent one remains
The lord of David from the elder fanes.
The elder is Ishmael indeed and to
His Kedarites David himself in view
Came as a refugee when Israelites

Turned to the faith of wicked Canaanites.
 And yet I do not doubt that David when
 He found his safety in Kedarite glen
 Took him a wife to tide him over that
 Spell away from Jerusalem and fat.
 There's every reason to think David too
 Is the ancestor of Ahmed in hue.
 I doubt but what he does combine both lines
 In a descent sweeter than Israel's wines.

Barnabas 44

1 The disciples said "Master, it
 Is written in Moses' book fit,
 The promise was made in Isaac."
 Jesus answered with groan not slack,
 "It's so written not by the hand
 Of Moses nor Joshua's stand,
 But by the Rabbis in the land,
 Who have no fear of God in band.
 Indeed I tell you, if you think
 About the words of angel's link
 Called Gabriel, you shall find out
 The malice of our scribes and doubt
 Our doctors. For the angel said
 'Abraham, all the world is led
 To know how God loves you, but how
 Shall the world know upon your brow
 The love you bear to God right now?
 Indeed you must do something here
 For the love of God and His fear.'
 Abraham answered, 'See the slave
 Of God ready to do and brave
 All that God shall desire and gave.'
 2 "Then God spoke telling Abraham,
 'Take your son, your firstborn as lamb,
 Ishmael, and come up the mountain
 To sacrifice him *once he's slain*."
 How is Isaac firstborn if when
 Isaac was born Ishmael again
 Was seven years old?" Said the men
 Disciples, "Clear is the lie told
 By our doctors, therefore be bold
 To tell us truthfully, because
 We know that you're sent from God's paws."
 Then Jesus answered, "Indeed I
 Tell you that Satan's out to spy
 A way to abrogate the laws
 Of God, and that's why he with his
 Followers hypocrites and quiz
 Of evil-doers, former ones

With false doctrines set up their buns,
And latter ones with living lewd,
Today have buggered all and skewed
So scarcely can the truth be found.
Woe to the hypocrites unsound!
For this world's praise shall turn one day
To insult torments in hell's way.

So Genesis calls Isaac the firstborn,
As though a word sold in pity and scorn,
A flagrant lie according to the text
Of Barnabas to the good and perplexed.
The firstborn son of Abraham is known
By all to be not Isaac on the throne
But Ishmael. And so Barnabas makes
Jesus to correct all the scribes mistakes.
My own thought is that text contains the prayers
And liturgies of some taken awares
By rites of passage as Van Gennepe spoke.
Redemption of the firstborn at a stroke
Is of that of each mother anyway,
So both sons really ought to come and pay.

3 "That's why I tell you that the one
Sent as God's messenger when done
Will be a splendour to most all
That God has made, for in his call
He is adorned with spirit of
Understanding and counsel's love,
The spirit of fear and of love,
The spirit of prudence and more
Of temperance on every score,
The spirit of charity and
Of mercy set on every hand,
The spirit of justice and yet
With piety more than is met,
The spirit of gentleness and
Patience which he's received from hand
Of God three times more than the measure
He's given to any other treasure.

The messenger that Jesus promised us
Has long ago got off the Gospel bus
And stayed a while to clarify the needed
Left in the Bible Scriptures that preceded.
A splendour and a glory in the wild
Of Araby since the time as a child
He grew to be known for his faithfulness
And honesty. Through him You came to bless
The world, Beloved, and left a brighter place.

I bask in loveliness before Your face.
If prudence and if temperance before
Temptations and attacks go to the core
Of the heart in sublime resting in You,
I shall keep the example in my view.

4 “O blessèd day, when he shall come
Into the world! Believe the sum
That I have seen him and have done
Him reverence just as every prophet
Has seen him, not a thing to scoff at,
Since from his spirit God gives them
The power to prophecy a stem.
And when I saw him my soul filled
With consolation and unstilled
I said ‘O Muhammad, God be
With you and may He make worthy
Of me to untie your shoelace,
For with this I shall in my race
Be a great prophet, holy one
Of God.’” And having said and done,
Jesus gave thanks to God *and won*.

I too thank You, Beloved, for that
Great recitation come from where You sat
Into the mouth and hand of him who waited
For Your Word while all evil things abated.
The work of the holy Qur’an has been
A light to shine upon the path and seen
Among the pagans for a help and hope.
No longer do I need a priest or pope.
The recitation of the prophet’s house
Frightens away both sinful state and mouse.
I thank You for the blessing of his word,
I thank You for the way that my heart’s stirred
To hear and speak eternal prayers of love
While the world moves on in a better shove.

Barnabas 45

1 The angel Gabriel then came
To Jesus addressing by name
So that we also heard his voice
Saying “Get up and find by choice
Jerusalem.” And so we went
With Jesus and came there as sent
Into Jerusalem. And there
Upon the Sabbath day with care
He entered in the temple square
And started teaching the folk there.
At that the people ran together

Into the temple with the feather
Of high priest and the priests for whether
To come near Jesus and to say
“O master, it’s been said you stay
Reporting evil of our way,
And so be careful lest some ill
Come on you, *for there are who kill.*”
Jesus replied, “Truly I say
To you, that I speak ill of sway
Of hypocrites, and so if you
Are hypocrites, it’s against you.”
They answered, “Who’s a hypocrite?
Tell us plainly, clearly, and fit.”

Hypocrisy in the world of today
Ought to be a right of each man in spe.
Religious freedom means also to be
Free of religion for hostility,
Or free to be a hypocrite at last.
But in the practice of the laws gone fast
None is condemned so quickly as the man
Exposed as hypocritical in span.
Beloved, defend the hypocrites on earth!
No one defends their right or human worth.
None are so cast out by the human crew,
And none are so dependent upon You.
Sweet Lord, give comfort to the heart of all
Who fail to live up to the righteous call.

2 Jesus said “Truly I tell you
That one who does good for the view
Of men, that one’s a hypocrite,
Since his act does not penetrate
The heart men can’t adjudicate
Where still lies every unclean thought
And every filthy lust unsought.
Do you know who’s a hypocrite?
He who serves God with tongue as fit,
But with his heart serves men to wit.
O wretched man! He comes to die
And loses his reward thereby.
For of this matter David states
In prophecy, “Put no faith, mates,
In princes or children of men
In whom there’s no saving again,
For at death their thoughts perish too.”
But no, even before their death
They lose reward in single breath,
For as Job God’s prophet relates,
“Man is unstable at the gates,

And never keeps on in one way.”
So if today he praises you,
Tomorrow he will abuse you,
And if today he gives reward,
Tomorrow he will lift the sword
Against you. Woe, then to those who
Retain hypocritical view,
Since their reward is a vain pew.
As God lives before whose sight I
Stand, hypocrites are robbers’ sty
Committing sacrilege, since he
Makes use of the Law in degree
To seem good and steals honour from
God to whom alone is to come
Praise and honour eternally.

Beloved, remind me when I hear the sound
Of praise that in the next drink on the round
I’ll hear my condemnation from the lips
That praised me first and then condemned in sips.
Beloved, let me trust no man here at all
Nor any woman within sight or call.
Let me lay my heart weary on no breast
In trust but on Your own where I’ve confessed.
Beloved, the round of hope and help I see
In church and mosque and synagogue to be
A grossly common, vast hypocrisy.
Beloved, let me too enter in the plot
Of hypocrite and get mercy I sought
From You who guide creation in its lot.

3 Furthermore I say to you that
The hypocrite has no faith flat,
Since if he believed that God sees
All and with great judgement in ease
Punishes wickedness, then he
Would purify his heart, which since
He has no faith he does not wince
To keep it full of wickedness.
Indeed I tell you in address
The hypocrite is like a grave
White on the outside but the brave
Interior is full of rot
And worms. So then if you, O lot
Of priests, do God’s work because God
Created you and asks by rod
Such of you, then I do not speak
Against you, for you are not weak
To be God’s servants. But if you
Do all for gain, and in the pew

Of the temple you buy and sell
As in the market-place, then well,
Considering not that the house
Of God is a place of not mouse
But prayer *and fasting*, not of plunder
Which you turn into robbers' wonder,
If you do everything to please
Men and have put God on your sleeves
And out of mind, then do I cry
Against you as the devil's fry,
And not the sons of Abraham,
Who left his father's house of sham
For love of God, willing to slay
His own son *for the righteous way*.
Woe to you, priests and doctors, if
You are such, for God will be still
To take from you the priestly skiff."

I know, Beloved, that I too in my pew
Am just a hypocrite in purple hue.
If I believed in the last day and You,
I'd never be late to recite my prayers,
I'd keep the month of fasting, and the stares
Of none would hinder me from pilgrimage.
I am a hypocrite at every stage.
I do what I do for the eye of those
Who give me the respect that outer clothes
Inspire in humankind. Beneath the rag
I'm just as naked as the neighbour fag.
Beloved, let me pray for the praise of men,
Let me gain their respect and come again
To find Your mercy only's worth a yen.

Barnabas 46

1 Then Jesus spoke again and said
"I set to you a figure spread.
There was a householder who planted
A vineyard and made a hedge granted
For it so that it would not be
Trampled down by the beasts freely.
And in the middle there he built
A wine-press, and rented the tilt
To workers. When the time came round
To gather in the grape juice found,
He sent his servants on the ground
Whom, when the workers saw, they stoned
And some they burned and others moaned
When they ripped them up with a knife.
And so they acted in their strife
Many times. Tell me now, what shall

The owner to do prodigal
Workers in the vineyard for sal?"
2 All answered, "In an evil rate
Will he destroy them for their hate,
And he will give the vineyard to
Other workers, *such as are true.*"
So Jesus said, "Do you not know
The vineyard is in all its show
The house of Israel and the men
Who work in it are Judah's men
And those here in Jerusalem?
Woe to you, for God's anger now
Is on you, who with sinful brow
Have ripped open so many sent
As prophets from God, as it went
In Ahab's time, there was none found
To bury God's saints in the ground."
And when he said this the chief priests
Desired to seize him from their feasts,
But they feared all the common folk
Who praised him with a hue and stroke.

Atrocities committed by the good,
Kind, virtuous and the chosen then should
Inspire the faithful to more faithfulness
In creating their havoc and their mess.
Those who support an institution run
For crown and market always join the fun
Of state suppression of those who arise
As Your impediments to force the skies.
Beloved, let me mind and remember here
Beneath my hill where no grapes can appear,
That You are owner of my soul and soil
And for Your benefit alone You toil.
When You look for returns from humankind
It's always with an eye to what they bind.

3 Then Jesus seeing a dame who
From her birth had stayed bent in two
With head toward the ground in view
Said "Raise your head, O woman, do
In name of our God, so these may
Know that I speak the truth today,
And that He desires what I say."
Then the dame raised herself up well
And praised our Ælohim a spell.
The chief of the priests cried aloud
Saying "This man is not allowed
As sent from God, because he will
Not keep the Sabbath day to fill,

Because today he's healed the ill."
 4 Jesus replied, "Now tell me then,
 Is it not lawful once again
 To speak upon the Sabbath day?
 And who among you in this way,
 If on the Sabbath day his ass
 Or ox fell in the ditch, would pass
 Him by and not pull him out on
 The Sabbath day, *at noon or dawn?*
 Certainly none. And shall I then
 Be Sabbath-breaker before men
 By giving health to Israel's dame?
 Truly this shows your wretched fame
 For your hypocrisy." Today
 How many there are that find way
 To fear a straw upon the eye
 While a log's ready in the sky
 To fall upon their head. I see
 How many fear an ant's degree
 And notice not the elephant."
 And having said this wisdom's grant
 He went out of the temple square.
 But the priests raged among themselves,
 Since they could not put him on shelves
 To do with him as they would like,
 Even as their fathers in strike
 Had done against the saints of God
In ancient times on Israel's sod.

The Sabbath day was made for man to rest
 And meet his Maker and so to be blessed.
 But men have made of it an argument
 And thing to quarrel over and be bent.
 They argue of which day and who to please
 The God who gives commands to take their ease.
 They rather ignore what it's all about:
 The limitation of the strong man's clout
 By legislating something for the weak
 That's non-negotiable in what they seek.
 Any smokescreen will do to distract eyes
 From limiting oppressors and their tries.
 Beloved, let me keep Sabbath holy here
 And trump the bosses with unholy gear.

Barnabas 47

1 The second year of ministry
 As prophet, Jesus went to see
 From Jerusalem to the town
 Of Nain. And as he came near, down
 To the gate of the city there,

The people of the place with care
Came out to take to the graveyard
The only son of his mom's guard,
A widow for whom every one
Was crying. When Jesus had run
There the men understood that he,
Jesus, prophet of Galilee,
Had come, and so they set to pray
Him for the dead man's sake a ray,
That he a prophet ought to bring
Him back to life and make him sing,
And so his own disciples did.
Jesus feared for himself a bid,
And turned to God and said "Take me
From the world, O Lord, for surely
The world is mad, and they nearly
Would set me in the place of God."
Having said this he wept abroad.

Gurus are many who appreciate
The crowds that come a-begging at their gate
For boon both spiritual and refined
And leave an offering for the poor and blind.
The nightmare of all gurus is the dance
That some might come to make as they advance
In sorrow for their dead. No trickery
Of miracles conquers mortality.
Beloved, if Your sent one remains appalled
That any think he can bring back installed
In death's great halls the son or daughter here,
It is no wonder to regard his fear.
Let all reality stand up aghast
Before the resurrection in the blast.

2 The angel Gabriel then came
And said, "O Jesus, fear no shame,
For God has given you the power
Over every illness to tower,
So that all that you grant in name
Of God shall come to pass for fame."
So Jesus sighed and said "Your will
Be done, YHWH Elohim and still
Almighty and most merciful."
Having said so, he came to pull
Near the mum of the dead man and
With pity said to her, "Dame, stand
And do not cry." He took the hand
Of the dead man and said "I say
To you, young man, in name and way
Of God get up and so be well."

The boy revived fit as a bell.
So all were filled with fear and said,
“God has raised up a prophet led
Greatly among us and has come
To the aid of His people dumb.”

I do not know why Jesus was so sad
To have the power of healing. I'd be glad
To say the word and cure the ones about
Me that are suffering from cancer and gout
And heart disease and who knows what by far
This season has become more popular.
I'd quietly and secretly prevail.
I'd whisper “such” and all men would be hale.
Beloved, think how many who now insist
That You as a good God do not exist
Because of evil and the suffering shame
That many must put up with. You're to blame.
But give me just the powers of Jesus for
A day and You'd see all cured to the core.

Barnabas 48

1 At that time Roman legions stayed
In Judaea, the land arrayed
In subjection to them for sins
Of our forefathers as begins.
It was a Roman custom then
To call god any among men
And worship him that did a thing
New for the benefit of ring
Of common folk. There were in Nain
Some of these soldiers who said plain
Rebuke to now one, now another,
Saying “One of your gods or other
Has come to visit you, and you
Make no account to see the view.
Truly if our gods came to us,
We would indeed make a great fuss
To give them all we had. And you
See how much we fear our gods too,
Since we give their idols best due
Of all we have and own in view.”

Admission here is that the Roman way
Is to make of men gods to be in sway.
I always guessed the Roman bishopric
Was behind all the Trinity gone thick.
The pontifex was the one did the trick.
There may be men about the senate who
Are idols and like gods in women's view

Or even in the view of some few men
Who look at them discreetly and may ken.
Beloved, the Roman taunt that they are better
At treating of their human gods in fetter
Is here repeated and brought to the letter.
Theology is often wrought of taunts
More than of wisdom drawn from deeper fonts.
I am myself a true guy and go-getter.

2 So Satan instigated there
Such speaking that soon came to share
Sedition in Nain by the folk.
But Jesus did not stay a stroke
In Nain, but turned to go into
Capernaum. The discord brew
Of Nain was such that some there said
“He is our god come to our spread.”
Others said “God cannot be seen,
So none has seen Him clear and clean,
Not even Moses, servant true
Of God, therefore it is no view
Of God, but rather His son due.”
Others said “He is not a god
Nor son of God, for God in pod
Has not a body to beget
Anything, but he is here set
To be a great prophet of God.”
So Satan started something there
In the third year of Jesus’ share
Of ministry as prophet that
Great ruin to our folk that sat
Was likely to arise from that.

Beloved, it seems that You have no flesh here
To go begetting gods for chancicleer.
You have no offspring, sons or daughters clear.
You are a God alone and without fear.
Since You do not die after many a year,
But live forever, both divine and dear,
You have no need of reproductions queer.
Beloved, it seems that you send prophets when
You wish to speak in love to hearts of men
And warn of dire results of what men do
When they forget what they have been called to.
You cannot be seen on the fragrant stair
To balconies above serenades’ share,
But You still dance divinely and on cue.

3 Jesus went to Capernaum
Where all the people worth a crumb

Who knew him gathered up the ill
They had and brought them up to fill
The porch of the place where he stayed,
Jesus with his disciples paid.
And calling Jesus out they begged
Him to heal maimed and the unlegged.
Then Jesus laid his hands on each
Of them, saying "Israel's God, reach
By Your holy name now and give
Health to this one ill, let him live."
At that each one was healed for good.
That Sabbath Jesus went into
The synagogue and all the crew
Ran there together to hear him
Speaking *of truth clear and undim.*

Though I am not one lame, I fail to see
Without my spectacles, and so may be
A candidate for healing in the spree.
I sat in public sauna on a day
When one man asked where was the place for pay
Where men and women both sit in the steam.
I raised a voice that it would do no good
Since I cannot see anything I should.
The man turned to me and replied that I
Must get along by groping on the sly.
Beloved, give me my sight so I can find
The pleasure that escapes the hopeful blind,
And I shall praise You for the human form
That You created to keep humans warm.

Barnabas 49

1 The scribe that day read from the Psalms
Of David, where David, no qualms,
Says "When I find occasion I
Will judge uprightly *as I try.*"
After reading the prophets, rose
Jesus and made signs for the close
Of clamour with his hands and then
Opened his mouth and spoke to men.
"Brothers, you've heard the words once spoken
By David the prophet as token,
Our father that when he should find
Occasion he would judge right mind.
I tell you truly many judge
In which judgement they fall for smudge
Just because they judge what's not meet
For them and what is truly meet
For them they judge before the time.
That's why our fathers' God reveals

To us by his prophetic seals
Of David, saying 'Justly judge,
O sons of men, and do not fudge.'

I'm hard put to find what Psalm this may be
Unless the seventy-fifth one comes to see.
And yet no Psalm is known in haftara
To be read in the prophets and for awe.
But Barnabas is clear that prophets are
Read in the synagogue and not to mar
The Sabbath without cantillation's glory.
One hardly knows how to take up this story.
If I must justly judge, I say at last
This writing is hung with things from the mast
Unheard of in the light of what men know
Today of Hebrew worship and its show.
Beloved, let synagogues be independent
And read from David for every defendant.

2 "Wretched are those who set themselves
At the street corners and like elves
Do nothing but judge those who come,
Saying 'This one's fair, this a bum,
This one is good, and this one bad.'
Woe to them because they have had
To lift the sceptre of His judgement
From Ælohim's hand for their budgement.
And God says 'I'm witness and judge,
My honour I'll leave to no sludge.'
Truly I tell you these are they
Who testify in the wrong way
Of what they have not seen nor heard,
And judge without appointment stirred.
That's why they are abomination
On earth before God's eyes and station,
Who will pass judgement horrendous
On them in the last day with fuss.

This chapter starts with Sabbath in the Word
Read by the scribe before all and preferred,
But comes at last to day of judgement felt
By every man and woman with a welt.
The Sabbath is a little judgement here
Preparing for the greater one come near,
And so is well set in one chapter's frown
Before the magistrates of every town.
Beloved, though I keep Sabbath with a will,
And look toward the coming fate, I still
Find that the judgement and the Sabbath joy
Remain unfinished in my own employ.

The resurrection no doubt will at last
Fulfil both joys and sorrows in the blast.

3 “Woe to you, woe to you who speak
Good of the evil and then seek
To call the evil good, for you
Condemn as wicked God Himself
Who is the origin of delf
Or all things good, and justify
As good Satan, who is the sty
In origin of all that’s bad.
Consider what punishment’s had
For what you do, and it is great
Falling from God upon your pate
In judgement on those who rely
For money from the wicked sly
And judge them not but justify
Them against the cause of the weak,
The widow and the orphan’s cheek.
I tell you truly devils do
Tremble at such one’s judgement due,
So terrible shall be the view.
You man who are set as a judge,
Consider not another smudge,
Neither kinfolk nor friends nor yet
Honour or any gains to get,
But look solely with fear of God
To the truth, and seek with the prod
And care, because it will secure
You in God’s judgement and make sure.
But I warn you no mercy falls
On one who judges in the halls
Without mercy, and such appals.

I do beware of making judgement vain
On Gospel of Barnabas to his pain.
All others know for certain who and when
And why the thing was written to all men.
But I judge not at all of origins
Or of any editor for his sins.
I only judge that its fine words judge me
And tell me how to live as a man free
Of doubt and faithlessness, but on the right
Path to eternal life, eternal light.
Beloved, let my faith be vain or a sham,
And let my understanding fail to slam,
But after all my failures, I rely
On You and Your declaring from the sky.

Barnabas 50

1 "Tell me, O man, and you who judge
Another man, don't you know sludge
Of the same kind is origin
Of all men? And *as for their sin*,
There's none good except God alone?
So every man's a liar and wicked.
Believe me, man, if you judge cricked
Of others' fault, your own heart's clone
Has room for judgement and for groan.
How dangerous it is to judge!
How many have perished by smudge
Of their false judgement! Satan judged
Man to be more vile than his grudged,
That's why he rebelled against God
His Creator, that's why for prod
He's unrepentant, as I know
Because I've spoken with the foe.
Our first parents once judged the speech
Of Satan to be good to teach,
That's why they were thrown out to sink
From paradise and to the brink
Of loss for all their progeny.
Indeed I say to you truly,
As God lives in whose sight I stand,
False judgement is the father of
All sins, *sins of both hate and love*.
For no one sins without desire,
And none desires having no fire
Of knowledge. Woe then to the sinner
Who with the judgement of beginner
Considers sin worthy and good
To be unworthy of what should,
And who thereby rejects the good
And chooses sin. Certainly he
Shall bear punishment and greatly
When God shall come to judge the earth
For what it is and isn't worth.

Who knows what man the Jews say has no sin,
Whether Job or Joseph, I remain in
A quandary, and the Samaritan
May point to Jacob with a cunning plan.
The Christian knows that Jesus was a man
Without sin and the only one by plan.
The Muslim may or not claim every prophet
Is without sin and no one here to scoff at.
But Barnabas and Paul both realize
From Jesus' words and David in disguise
That all men sin and come of glory short.
Only You, my Beloved, are a good sport.

So let me live or die in sympathy
With all the sinners left in this world's spree.

2 How many perished through the wrong
Judgement, how many near along
To perishing! Pharaoh saw fit
To judge Moses and the folk writ
Of Israel to be impious.
Saul also judged and in pariahs
David to be worthy of death.
Ahab condemned Elijah, and
Nebuchadnezzar too the stand
Of the three youths who would not fall
Down to worship lying gods' thrall.
The two elders judged Susanna,
And every idolatrous claw
Of princes judged prophets as raw.
Tremendous is judgement of God!
The judges perish but are saved
The ones they judged condemned engraved.
Why does this take place, man, but that
In rashness false judges have sat
To judge the innocent *out flat*?

Sectarian judgement today may come
Anathematizing all men in sum.
The Christian's wrong in both belief and what
The Crusaders and Colonists have wrought.
The Muslim gets paid by the CIA
To bomb the pants off people who can't pay.
The Jew is always at fault for the way
Economy goes when it goes astray.
So bigotry has every right in hell,
Especially when secularists spell.
Beloved, though I love not the faith of all,
Delete me from the bigot's chair and call.
Fix what you will. I take the artist's brush
And paint the cosmos with a sweeter mush.

3 How nearly then the good approach
To ruin by judging like roach
Is shown by Joseph's brothers who
Sold him to the Egyptian crew,
By Aaron and Miriam, sister
Of Moses, who judge their brother.
Three friends of Job laid judgement on
The innocent friend of God, on
Job. David judged Mephibosheth
And Uriah. *In the same breath*
Cyrus judged Daniel to the death

To feed the lions, and if told
There are many others as bold,
Who came near ruin and the cold
For this. So I say to you do
Not judge and you'll not be judged too."

At first I judged all men as all men judge,
By colour, wit, or clothing or a smudge.
Then I learned to judge all by Your own law,
The Ten Commandments stuck inside my craw.
That's far more tolerant than what most folk
Do judging arbitrarily each bloke.
Then it came to mind that I was too strict,
And I should leave even that judgement slicked
To You alone. I then decided I
Would judge whether men breathe or not or die.
Then I thought who am I to demand others
Avoid the fate that kills all and that smothers?
So now I judge no longer anything,
But let all sleeping dogs lie on the wing.

4 And so Jesus with his speech done,
Saw many turn repenting won,
Bewailing their sins till they would
Have laid aside all for the good
Of following him. Jesus said
"Stay in your homes and your own bed.
Forsake sin and serve God instead,
And you will be saved, I've not come
To be served and be burdensome,
But to serve." And when he said this
He left the synagogue to miss
The city, and withdrew to find
A desert place to pray resigned,
For he loved solitude in kind.

Salvation by just lying still is great,
Much better than the Christian sort of fate
That demands human sacrifices on
Some cross outside Jerusalem by dawn.
Salvation on my bed's enough for me,
Although I do get up betimes to pee
Or in the morning rush go out and see
If there is anything I have to do.
But doing as I do just brings me rue.
So I shall lie abed in practice for
The grave when my obedience in score
Is perfect to a hair's breadth of Your door.
Give me no resurrection till You're sure
That everything I might do will be pure.

Barnabas 51

1 When he'd prayed to the Lord, his friends,
Disciples came without amends
To him and said "O master we
Would know two things, so say clearly.
One is how you talked with Satan
Who is as you say charlatan
And unrepentant. That's the first.
The second is not counted worst.
How shall God come on judgement day
To judge men of their sinful way?"
Jesus replied, "Truly I say
To you, I had pity to pay
On Satan since I knew his fall.
I had compassion on the thrall
Of humankind he tempts to sin.
So I prayed and fasted to God
Who spoke to me and through the prod
Of His angel Gabriel, "What do
You want, O Jesus, and what due
Request is yours?" I answered, "Lord,
You know of what evil and sword
Satan is the cause, and that through
His tempting many perish too.
He is your creature, Lord, whom You
Created, so Lord have mercy
Upon him." God answered freely,
"Jesus, see I will pardon him.
Only make him say clear and trim,
"Lord my God I have sinned, so grant
Me mercy." I'll forgive and plant
Him in his first estate.' I joyed
Greatly," said Jesus at the tide
To think I'd make conciliation.
So I called Satan to my station,
And when he came he told me saying
"What must I do for you in paying,
O Jesus?" I replied, "You'll do
It for yourself, O Satan, true
I do not love your benefices,
But for your own good are my kisses."

The doctrine of forgiveness for Satan
Is rare in books religious and in plan.
But I remember once my uncle who
While milking of his cows saw in his view
A vision or not of Satan who came
To tempt him with a harvest or some fame.
My uncle was a brave sort and he tried

To get the spectre devil to abide
And hear his sermon of repentance till
The devil should repent and pay his bill.
I guess it did not come to grand success,
Unless what we see now, and I just guess,
Is more result of evil men themselves
Create among the angels and the elves.

2 Satan replied, "If you desire
No service from me in the fire,
Neither do I desire your own,
For I am nobler in my bone
Than you, for you're not worthy to
Serve me being but clay in dew,
While I am of the spirit true."
"Let us leave this," I said, "but tell
Me if it were not with you well
Returning to your beauty first
And your first estate and not worst.
You must know that the angel Michael
Must needs upon the judgement cycle
Strike you with God's sword one hundred
Thousand times and each blow when fed
Will give you the pain of ten hells."
Satan replied, "We'll see what tells
On that day and who can do more.
I'll have on my side many score
Of angels and idolaters
Of strength who will as their heart stirs
Trouble God, and He too shall know
What a mistake it was to show
Banishment to me for the sake
Of a vile piece of clay in cake."
Then I said "Satan, in your mind
Is an illness and you are blind
To what you say in such a kind."

The pride of spirit over flesh is found
In every sort of play-pen and playground.
All men are Gnostics, whether Jewish or
The Christian or Islamic sort of store.
And so all follow Satan in a crowd
Of flesh-despising worshippers aloud.
Beloved, I see the words of Satan make
Theology of late a piece of cake.
I care not for the endless in debate,
Nor for the spirit that would make a mate
Of no flesh in the trust of apple core.
Agnostic saints have spoken here before.
Indeed the future will add up the score

And then reveal to each one his own rate.

3 Then Satan most derisively
Wagged his head saying then to me,
“Come now then let us make this peace
Between me and God, for release
What must be done, O Jesus, say,
Since you are of sound mind today?”
I answered, “Two words only need
To be spoken.” Satan indeed
Replied, “What words?” I answered best,
“But these: ‘I’ve sinned, let mercy rest
On me.’” But Satan answered, “Now
Willingly will I set my brow
To make peace if God say these words
To me.” “Now leave me to my curds,”
I said, “O cursed one, for you are
The wicked author of the car
Of all injustice and of sin,
But God is just and without sin.”
Satan left shrieking, “It’s not so,
O Jesus, you lie for the glow
To please God.” “Now think carefully,”
Said Jesus to his disciples,
“How it is he will find mercy.”
They answered, “Never, Lord, his pulls
Are to impenitence. But speak
To us of God’s judgement we seek.”

Beloved, if Satan himself from the park
May enter light and relinquish the dark
Merely by saying that he’s one who’s sinned
And asking for your mercy come unpinned,
That is good news indeed. Think You that I
Fail to acknowledge my sin to the sky
And fail to beg Your mercy come on me?
I do indeed and daily in my spree.
The daily is the catch. You see my sort,
A rogue and robber at the divine court,
A dervish dog and one to whirl again
Today as yesterday before all men.
I am consistently one to go round
The sinful circuit, penitent and sound.

Barnabas 52

1 The judgement day of God will be
So dreadful that most truthfully
I tell you that the reprobates
Would sooner go to ten hells fates
Than go to hear God speak in wrath

Against them against whom the path
Of all created things shall stand
In witness *on the judgement sand*.
Indeed I tell you not just those
Reprobates shall fear *at the throes*,
But the saints and elect of God,
So Abraham shall not one clod
Trust in his own righteousness, and
Job shall not rely on the stand
Of innocence. So what do I
Say? Even God's own *weatherspy*
And messenger shall take fright when
God shows His majesty *to men*,
Depriving His messenger of
Memory *of both hate and love*,
So he'll have no recall how God
Gave him all things *upon the sod*.
Truly I tell you from the heart
I tremble because of the part
The world will play to call me God,
And for this I must *under rod*
Give an account *of pea and pod*.

If the sweet Jesus must give an account
For what the world treats him in false amount
To call him God, then must I also be
Taken to court for what they say of me?
It's not the slandered that is brought to justice
In any sort of state where someone cursed us.
The guilty is the one maligned I know
In every human sort of circus show,
But I should have thought divine justice takes
A higher road than what the human makes.
I do not tremble now, because my eye
Is too weak to discern the things I spy.
But on that day I'll tremble in my turn
To see the fires and bodies' souls that burn.

2 As God live before whom I stand,
I am a mortal man and planned
As other men are, for although
God's set me a prophet to show
Over the house of Israel for
The health of the weak, to restore
The sinners, I am just God's slave,
And you bear this witness and grave,
How I speak against wicked men
Who after my departure when
I leave the world shall take away
The truth of my gospel and way

By Satan's operation's sway.
But I shall come back at the end,
And with me shall come Enoch friend
Also Elijah, we will bear
Witness against the wicked share
Whose fate will be accursed *and bare*."

The occulted faithful humans in state
Are Jesus, Elijah at any rate,
And Enoch, may Your blessings fine and great
Be on this hidden faithful trinity.
They are the best of those I cannot see.
The occultation of the just, I know,
Is something that's incredible in show
And in the site of sceptics in a row.
But what can be more sceptic in a fling
Than what the hidden and occulted sing?
Beloved, let Jesus be divine or not,
I know what little here that I've been taught,
And that is that You are Creator of
All on the earth by Your power and Your love.

3 Having spoken so, Jesus shed
Tears, at which his disciples bred
Wept aloud and raised up their voices,
Saying "Pardon, O Lord, such choices,
And God have mercy on Your one
Servant who's innocent when done."
Jesus answered, "Amen, amen."

I've never known the scholar in the way
(Though I admit I've not read all for pay)
Who denies the authenticity here
Of Barnabas because it does appear
That it pretends that Jesus had to meet
The accusation he was god in seat.
That shows the scholars to fail of objective,
Since their best arguments are so selective.
It's anachronistical at the best
To think that during his life as a guest
He had to meet the view that he was god.
Nobody even thought of such a laud,
Except in cynical and lame abuse
To find a pretext against him in use.

Barnabas 53

1 "Before that day comes," said Jesus,
"Upon the world shall come the fuss
Of great destruction, for there'll be
A war both cruel, without pity,

That father shall murder the son,
And son the father for the run
Of factions among people there.
That's why the cities shall be bare,
And field and country desert's share.
Such plagues shall run blood and not water.
And the twelfth all before the slaughter
In the creation shall lift wail.
The thirteenth day the sky like sail
Shall furl like a scroll, then shall rain
Of fire come down so all that lives
Shall die *before the flaming sieves*.
The fourteenth day an earthquake great
Shall strike so mountain tops in rate
Fly like birds through the air and all
The earth shall be a plain. The call
Of fifteenth day the holy bright
Angels shall die, and God by right
Alone shall live, to whom be might,
Honour and glory *at the sight*."

Barnabas does not fail, nor Matthew, when
He wrote a Gospel warning to all men,
To write upon the page revealing rage.
It was the fashion of that bygone age.
Now that we have come near and without fear
That fateful moment, hour, and day, and year,
We no longer await or read of fate
In the apocalyptic sort and rate.
We have, Beloved, our own myths carved on bone
In every end-time movie that is shown.
Each generation hopes, in darkness gropes
Along the planks for newer hempen ropes.
All prophecies must fail before the gale
Of ignorance outside the faithful pale.

2 On saying this Jesus struck cheeks
With both hands, to the ground as speaks
With his head. When he raised his head,
He said "Cursed be every one spread
Who shall insert in what I said
That I am son of God and bred."
When he said that his disciples
Fell down as dead, so Jesus pulls
Them up saying "Let's fear God now,
So's not to fear then anyhow."

The warning and the retribution known
To Jesus and to Barnabas is shown
In the disciples' fear before Your throne.

There is no god but God is mathematics
Resolving on both earthly and aquatics,
And multiplying knowledge without statics.
And yet the mind remains as without gains
As empty as the ancient far-flung plains.
Beloved, the oneness that is hardly held
In wisdom before heavy hands impelled
Remains unproven by the cosmic spelled.
I could have met You face to graven face,
And still the evidence in every place
Is silent without some instilling grace.

Barnabas 54

1 “After these signs shall darkness come
Over the world and for the sun
Of forty years, God only shall
Live, to whom be the canticle
Forever honour, glory’s hum!
When forty years have passed then God
Shall resurrect up from the sod
His Messenger to rise again
Like the sun, but in greater light
Than thousand suns shine in one night.
He’ll sit without a word as he
Will be beside himself a wee.
Then God shall resurrect again
The four angels favoured of men
And God and they shall look about
For God’s Messenger without doubt
And when they find him set themselves
On all four sides to guard *from elves*.
Then God shall give new life to all
The angels who shall answer call
To swarm around God’s Messenger
Like bees. Then God shall then up stir
All prophets who from Adam on
Shall come to kiss the hand out drawn
Of God’s Messenger and commit
Themselves to him and with him sit.
Then God shall give life to the saints
Elect who cry without restraints
‘O Muhammad, remember us!’
And when they cry then shall awake
Pity for God’s Messenger’s sake,
And he shall ponder what he ought
To do for their salvation wrought.

The speculation of end things is great
To distract people from their present state
And keep them by neglect from repenting

Of sins committed in the earthly ring.
The revelation of end things is dear
To warn the heart that its destruction's near
And that repentance is due on this day
And not tomorrow and a wish away.
Beloved, I hope to see Muhammad found
With all the angels and prophets around
And with them praise Your name until the ground
Shakes with the thunder of the gloried sound.
But now instead of praising I remain
In my repentance and without the gain.

2 Then God shall resurrect all things
Created and they'll come in rings
To their former existence, but
Each one shall also find unshut
The power of speech. Next God will give
Life to all reprobates to live
So by their horror all God's folk
Shall be afraid and cry for broke,
'Let not Your mercy forsake us,
O YHWH our Ælohim as thus.'
Then God will resurrect from death
Satan, at whose sight every breath
Shall be cut off for fear of that
Horrible form in which he sat.
May God grant," said Jesus, "that I
Not see that monster under sky
That day. The Messenger of God
Alone he shall not fear a pod
Such shapes, but only fear his God."

The Gospel says that Jesus in his power
Is lesser than Muhammad in that hour.
The waves of competition among men
For whose prophet is greater show again.
I take hold of the promises I find
In Decalogue and keep them in my mind
And throw a bane of fault upon the word
That would divide humankind like a turd.
There is no god but God prevails with me
And there shall never any other be.
I too refuse to gaze upon the scene
Of Satans resurrected on the green.
Let Jesus and Muhammad watch the show,
One gazing boldly, one through fingers glow.

3 "At last the angel at whose sound
Of trumpet all rise from the ground
Shall wind his trumpet once again,

Saying 'Come to judgement, O men
 And creatures all, for your Creator
 Desires to judge both small and greater.'
 Then there will appear in the sky
 Over Jehoshaphat's vale by
 A white cloud on which angels cry
 Out 'Blessed be You, our Ælohim,
 Who has created us to dream
 And saved us from Satan's great fall.'
 Then Messenger of God shall fear,
 Because he'll see that none appear
 To love God as he should sincere.
 For who would get hand on a piece
 Of gold must have sixty mites' lease,
 But if he has just one mite he
 Cannot change it to a gold fee.
 But if the Messenger of God
 Shall be afraid, what on the sod
 Can the ungodly do who are
 Filled with wickedness like a star?"

My currency of gold and righteous ware
 Is not enough to count on in the race.
 If I were a dead Pharaoh, then my face
 Would lack the coffin gilt applied with care.
 In faith and business gold is not to share
 But to be hoarded in the safest place.
 One must choose between gold and between grace,
 Unless a third response comes in to dare.
 The green tree of sweet Jesus and the gold
 Of Messenger Muhammad are in story
 Better than being left out in the cold.
 Both of these men are covered with Your glory,
 While I am merely caught timid or bold.
 The hopes and fears by now have all grown hoary.

Barnabas 55

1 God's Messenger will gather all
 The prophets to obey his call
 To pray with him to God to seek
 Well-being for the faithful weak.
 But everyone will find excuse
 For fear, and nothing would induce
 Me to go there, as YHWH lives and
 Knowing what I perceive at hand.
 Ælohim seeing this reminds
 His Messenger how He unwinds
 All things created for their love
 Of Him, and so his fear to shove
 Will leave him and he'll near the throne

With love and reverence to be known,
While angels sing 'Blessed be Your name
In holiness, our God of fame.'

My own experience indeed would feed
The theory that in prayer before the light
Of morning with Muhammad's way in sight
Would come in touch with angel song indeed.
I really need no other prayer or creed.
Whether in my own closet or in bright
And decorated mosque by day or night,
The songs of angels my soul and heart lead.
Let me be gathered with the prophets then
Before Muhammad to answer the call
And bow with all the crowds of other men
Among the great as well as with the small.
I find the songs sung in the angels' den
Feed me better than priest and church and all.

2 "And when he's come near to the throne,
Ælohim opens what's unknown
To His Messenger as a friend
Speaks to a friend after the end
Of long absence from one another.
First in address, no fear to smother,
The Messenger of God will say
'I adore and love you, I pray,
O my Ælohim, with my heart
And all my soul I give Your part
In gratitude that You would deign
To create me Your servant sane,
And make all things for love of me
So I might love You as I see
All things, and in all things to be
And above all things, let freely
Your creatures praise You, O my God.'
Then all things God created shall
Say 'We give You thanks *prodigal*,
O Lord, and bless Your holy name
For ever and ever the same.'
Indeed I tell you demons and
The wicked with Satan to stand
Shall weep then so more water comes
From one of them than in the sums
Of Jordan's river. But they'll not
See God *who thwarts their evil plot*.
And Ælohim will speak up to
His Messenger and tell him true,
'You're welcome, faithful servant, do
Ask Me of all your heart's desire,

You'll have all to which you aspire.'
The Messenger of God shall say
'O YHWH, I remember the day
You made me You said in Your will
You'd made all for love of me still
That's in the world and paradise,
Of angels and of men in choice
That they might glorify You by
Me Your servant beneath the sky.
So Lord God, merciful and just,
I pray that You remember dust
To which You promised Your slave's trust.'

To glorify You by Muhammad may
Be fulfilment of promise made when he
Was first created in infinity.
It may be so, it may be so today.
To sing the divine praises that in sway
Invoke eternal, divine treasury
May be the best that's offered, yes, may be.
Human praises may make the sweetest lay.
But I aim not so high and not so well.
It is enough I praise by smaller things,
The sunlight spotting bean flowers and pell-mell
Setting on fire the rowan berries' rings:
The gladioli sprawling let me tell
Of cross-starred pathways flashing in their springs.

3 "And God replies as a friend jokes,
'Do you have witnesses in yokes
Of this, My friend Muhammad, now?'
With reverence he shall say *somehow*,
'Yes, Lord.' Then God replies, 'Go call
Them, Gabriel.' *Waiting in hall*
The angel Gabriel shall come
To God's Messenger, say *in sum*,
'Lord, who are your witnesses *then*?'
God's Messenger replies *again*,
'They are Adam, Abraham and
Ishmael, Moses, David *in band*,
And Jesus son of Mary, too.'
Then the angel departs and he
Shall call those witnesses to be
In fear to answer summons' *plea*.
When they stand before God, He'll say
To them, 'Do you remember, *hey*,
What my Messenger claims of Me?'
They then reply, 'What claim, O Lord?'
And God shall declare *above board*,
'That I have made all things for love

Of him, so all things might *above*
Praise Me by him *as sovereign Lord.* ’

The seven witnesses that I find here
Are nearly the ones any one would take
On reading of the Bible for the sake
Of truth and testimony to appear.
I might have invoked Noah in the rear
Instead of Ishmael, though not to forsake
The lovely melodies his offspring make.
Their Hebrew names are beautiful and sheer.
The seven witnesses I take to heart
And keep them in my love as long as I
Remember to rise up and do my part.
The seven witnesses up to the sky
Raise up a cry of elegance and art,
Indeed the seven raise up such a cry.

4 Then each of them shall answer *clear*;
‘We have with us three more in fear
Whose testimony will appear
Better than ours, O Lord *most dear.* ’
And God shall ask, ‘What three are these?’
And Moses shall answer to please,
‘The book You gave me is the first’,
And David shall break out unversed,
‘The book You gave me’s second rung,’
And he who speaks to you unsung
Shall say, ‘Lord, the whole world deceived
By Satan, that I was received
Your son associate reprieved,
But the book that you gave to me
Said truly I was sent to be
Your servant, and that book confesses
What Your Messenger says, no guesses.’
The Messenger of God shall speak
And say ‘So says the book You seek
And gave to me, O Lord.’ And when
God’s Messenger said this, again
Shall God speak up and say ‘All that
I have now done, I have done that
Everyone should know how much I
Love you.’ When He’ll have passed this sigh,
God shall give His sent one a book
In which are written there *to look*
All the names of God’s elect ones,
All mothers, fathers, daughters, sons.
That’s why each creature shall bow down
In reverence to God, *foot and crown*,
Saying ‘To You alone, O God,

Be glory, honour *on the sod*,
Because you have given us to
Your Messenger *for glory's due*.

The four books God has sent upon the earth,
Though in the end then Barnabas at last
May deny that they are of a clean cast
As they appear here in this time of dearth
Are of all witnesses of greater worth.
The Torah is the first, foundation massed
To compliments of the Psalms not surpassed,
And Gospel prepares for the Qur'an's birth.
I take the four in witness You are one,
That is the burden of Torah in peace.
The Psalms praise You when they are done.
The Gospel proclaims Jesus in release.
All other witnesses beneath the sun
The same truth only comes here to increase.

Barnabas 56

1 And God shall open up the book
The hand of His Messenger took,
And His Messenger reading there
Shall summon all the angels fair,
And prophets and all the elect,
And on the forehead for respect
Of each one shall be written down
The mark of God's sent one on crown.
And in the book there shall be writ
The glory of paradise fit.

The book of life in Revelation bears
The names of the elect from every clime,
And only those whose names appear in time
On those fair pages rise to blissful shares.
Though Barnabas may write of unknown cares
And visions of unheard of gloried rhyme,
Sent clanking nickel and in tinkling dime,
It's only one more cart drawn on by mares.
The truest book of revelation lies
Upon the forehead of the saved and sound.
It is a book read just by angel eyes.
While all the world in folly goes around
The dance unsacred the holy despise,
That mark remains unchanging on the ground.

2 Then each shall pass to God's right hand
Next to who shall sit high and grand
The Messenger of God, and there
Near him the prophets also dare

To sit, and the saints shall sit by
The prophets, and those blessed on high
Near to the saints, and then shall sound
The angel's trumpet to call round
Satan into the judgement ground.

I had a vision of the prophets set
In glory once as the night's sleep was ending
And morning prayer over my heart was bending
To waken soul to glories never met.
I saw the circle of the prophets get
The rays of truth in Paradise paths wending
Above the streams the throne of God was sending
To the four quarters of the garden yet.
The laughter of the prophets Sabbath morn
Created on my ear that distant night
Still rings on my ears through the slighting scorn
Poured out in fear and in suspicion's plight
That bind the hearts of most men in their borne
And dissipate before the dawning light.

Barnabas 57

1 That miserable one shall come out
To be accused and without doubt
By every creature. Therefore God
Shall call Michael the angel *broad*
To strike him one hundred thousand
Times with God's sword *held up in hand*.
He shall strike Satan, every stroke
Is heavy as ten hells in yoke,
And he shall be the first cast down
Into the abyss *from the town*.
The angel shall call up to him
His followers, and each *in trim*
Shall in the same way be abused
And in the same way be accused.
So angel Michael, by command
From God, shall strike that evil band,
Some one hundred times, and some fifty,
Some twenty, some ten, and some *nifty*
Just five times. Then they'll all descend
Into the abyss *who offend*,
Because God shall say to them there,
'Hell is your house, O cursed *and bare*.'

Most people who read from the sacred book
About both hell and Paradise believe
That hell's for others, maybe even Eve,
But they will surely find a blessed nook
In Paradise themselves for all it took.

Myself, I rather hope for some reprieve,
Reduction of the blows upon my sleeve
When I go down with demon, rile and rook.
Beloved, I do not presume with faith here
That I shall have the saint's reward and hope
Along with all the rank and file and good.
I merely point out that my sins appear
Of mediocre and limited scope,
If that is mitigating to a hood.

2 After that shall be summoned to
The judgement all unfaithful crew
Of unbelievers, reprobates,
Against whom first arise in rates
All creatures set beneath man's thrall,
To witness before God in stall
How they have served these men and how
They have outraged God and allow
His creatures *no rest at the plough*.
The prophets every one shall rise
To testify against their eyes,
So they'll be sentenced by God to
Infernal fires, *the wicked crew*.
Truly indeed I say to you,
No idle word or thought shall pass
Unpunished in that horror's mass.
Indeed I tell you every shirt
Of hair shall shine like sun *on dirt*,
And every louse a man has borne
For love of God shall turn from scorn
To be a pearl. Three time and four
Times blessed by blessed the worthy poor
Who in true poverty have served
God from the heart and have not swerved,
For in the coming world they'll be
Without their worldly cares, set free
From many sins, and in that day
Not have to give account in sway
For how they've used their wealth *in pay*,
But shall receive reward for they
Were patient in their pauper's way.
Truly I tell you, if the world
Knew this, it would choose the *unfurled*
Hair-shirt rather than purple *cloth*
And lice sooner than the gold sloth,
Fasts sooner than their feasts, *in troth*.

These days where I live there's no virtue's ground
Specifically in lice upon one's hair.
It's rather thing uncommon to our share,

Although some decades past such things were found.
The louse, the roach, the bedbug and mite's round
Have disappeared here from among the fair.
One hardly now need even to beware.
In great hygiene all citizens are bound.
Alas, this means that righteousness is gone
And left me and my fellows all bereft.
The hair shirt could be had, no doubt, unless
Such cloth is no more made or doted on.
The only thing in this land we have left
Is simply trust in You or then to guess.

3 When all have been examined, God
Shall tell His Messenger *in rod*,
'See, O My friend, their wickedness,
How great it's been, in My address
As their Creator, I employed
All things created and enjoyed
In their service, and in all things
They have dishonoured Me *in strings*.
So it is most just that I spend
No mercy at all on their end.'

The Messenger of God replies,
'It's true, Lord, glorious God of skies,
Not one of Your friends and servants
Could beg Your mercy on their tents,
No, I Your servant before all
Ask justice against them in thrall.'

4 When he had uttered all these things,
The angels all and prophetlings
With all God's elect, but no, why
Do I say the elect? Truth I
Tell you, that spiders, flies and stones
And sand shall cry out and *with groans*
Against the wicked and demand
Justice *upon them from God's hand*.
Then God shall make each living soul
Below humankind seek the goal
Of earth, and He shall send to hell
The wicked ones *to fry a spell*,
Who on their way shall see the earth
Where dogs and horses of such worth
And other beasts come to lie down.
So they shall say for God's renown,
'O Lord God, cause us to return
To the earth also *not to burn*.'
But what they beg for shall not be
Granted to them *eternally*."

Beloved, I beg to intercede a bit,

Not for the one who does good on his own
And yet into Your burning hell is thrown,
Not for the rogue that You may yet make fit
For Your eternal bliss in working kit.
I do not intercede for that crowd's groan
That goes down to the earthly silence known
No more: I submit to the divine writ.
Beloved, I rather intercede with prayer
For dogs and horses serving at their best
The human ways of selfishness and pride.
The dogs and horses should get better share,
Indeed a place in Paradise to rest
After the coursing and the painful ride.

Barnabas 58

1 While Jesus spoke disciples wept
And bitterly in sore heart kept
And Jesus wept with many tears.
Then after weeping it appears
That John spoke up, "O master, we
Desire to know two things. The first
Is how God's Messenger uncursed
And full of mercy and to burst
With pity can have no pity
On reprobates that day to see
That they are of same clay as he?
The second is how can it be
Understood that Michael's sword lies
As heavy as ten hells to rise?
Is there more than one hell *that tries?*"
2 Jesus replied, "Have you not heard
What David the prophet in word
Says, how the just shall laugh to see
Sinners' destruction and shall be
Deriding with such words as these,
Saying 'I saw the man in ease
Put hope in his strength and his wealth
Forgetting Ælohim in stealth.'
Indeed, therefore, I say to you,
That Abraham shall laugh in pew
At his own father, and Adam
All reprobate men like a ham,
And this is so because the just
Shall rise again up from the dust
So perfect and joined to their God
That they shall not conceive in pod
The slightest thought against His work
Of justice. None of them shall shirk
In his demand for justice, and
Above all God Messenger's *band*.

As Ælohim lives and I stand
Before Him, though I now weep for
Pity of humankind in store,
On that day I shall demand too
Justice without mercy on crew
Of those who despise my word too,
And most on those who would corrupt
My gospel word *and interrupt.*”

The Shi'ite view is that justice remain
The great defining virtue of Allah,
Not mentioning that mercy's held in awe
Among the five roots of religion sane.
The Sunnite cries for mercy and not bane.
As I come here to contemplate Your law,
I take Shi'ite theology in claw
And Sunnite cry for mercy to my gain.
A sect of one perhaps, but there is room
For one more sect to cancel out the vote
Of sweet Muhammad crying justice fair:
I beg you cast away all hell and doom,
And give all creatures Paradise to dote.
If need be save hell alone for my share.

Barnabas 59

1 But hell is one, O my disciples,
And in it the damned and their griples
Shall suffer torment day and night.
Yet it has seven rooms of spite
Or regions deeper down to go,
And he who goes down with the flow
Shall suffer greater torment's show.
And yet my words are true about
The angel Michael's sword, no doubt,
For he who commits but two sins
Deserves two hells for what he wins.
So in one hell the reprobates
Shall feel the torments of their states
As though they were in ten or in
A hundred or thousand for sin,
And the all-wise God, through His power
And by His justice shall make flower
The suffering of Satan as though
He were in ten hundred to go
To thousands of hells, and the rest
Each one according to the zest
Of his own wickedness unblessed.”

A million hells for Satan at the most
And just a thousand for the man of sin

Who piles up wickedness and fills his bin,
Seems hardly difference enough to boast.
Search out more hells from coast to pretty coast
To serve the greater justice and to win
A place that corresponds to what we're in.
Give what deserves each member of the host.
Give what deserves each one, or then regard
Satan himself with mercy in the flame
And quench Your ire before the howling crowd.
None yet deserves Your mercy, show Your card
Of justice, throw it down and end the game
Against the humble as well as the proud.

2 Then Peter answered, "Master mine,
Indeed God's justice, it is fine,
But this speech today made you sad,
So we beg you rest and be glad
Tomorrow to tell what hell's like."
Jesus replied, "O Peter, hike
To tell me rest, O Peter, you
Don't know what you are saying do,
Else you would not speak as on cue.
3 "Indeed I tell you, rest in this
Present life is a poison kiss
To righteousness, consuming fire
To ever good work and desire.
Have you forgotten Solomon,
God's prophet and all prophets won,
Have reproved sloth? It's true that he
Says 'Idle ones will not work free
Upon the soil for fear of cold,
So in the summer he'll be sold.'
That's why he said 'All that your hand
Finds to do, do it and not stand.'
And what does Job say, he who stood
Before his friend God as he could
In innocence, 'As the bird's born
To fly, so is the human worn
With work.' Indeed I say to you
I hate rest above all I rue."

Though Jesus himself may have hated rest,
Creator it was who made Sabbath day
The most blessed of days under divine sway
And ceased His labours to call on the best.
God Himself made Sabbath day be a test
Of Israel's faithfulness in manna's way
And scorned those who would come out then to play,
Ignoring the hours He Himself had blessed.
But right he is, this prophet now in tow,

That humankind exaggerates to make All days a Sabbath or then work them all,
Depriving donkeys of their rest though slow.
I retract my incitement for the sake
Of mercy and beg You to work and maul.

Barnabas 60

1 So hell is one and opposite
To paradise, as winter, it
Is contrary to summer and
Cold to heat *on the other hand*.
So he who would describe and tell
The horrible misery of hell
Must have seen paradise of God
In its delights upon the sod.
O place cursed by God's justice for
The punishment of faithless store
And wickedness, of which Job who
Was friend of God said on his cue,
'There is no order there but just
An everlasting fear *and dust!*'
Isaiah the prophet said too
Against the wicked and his crew,
'Their flame shall not be quenched in view,
Nor shall their worm die, it is true.'
2 "David our father weeping said
'Then lightning and thunderbolts spread
And sulphur and great tempest rain
Upon them for punishment's pain.'
O frightful sinners, loathsome be
Delicate meats and the costly
Clothes and soft couches, harmony
Of sweet song on that day to be!
How sick shall raging hunger make,
And burning flames and scorching stake,
And cruel torments with bitter gall
And hopeless crying make them all!"

Job may have produced in that later age
When hell was best known to the Hebrew mind
And came to appear in the glow and grind
Of peasant as well as the scribal sage,
But surely David and Isaiah's cage
Was wrought before the Hellenistic kind
Made inroads on the mind not yet resigned
To knuckle under Greek and Roman rage.
Hear not my quaint and academic plaint,
Beloved, since every faith since then has tossed
The spirit-hunger on liturgic altar.
The mind must ever rewrite. Even saint
Remembers not the yesterdays as lost,

But as eternal glow never to falter.

3 Then Jesus groaned lamentably
And said "Indeed better to be
Never formed than to suffer such
Torments with so cruel a touch,
For think of a man suffering in
Every part of his body's bin
Torments, who has no one to show
Him pity, but is mocked to go
By everyone, tell me, would not
This be a great pain for his lot?"
And the disciples answered him,
"It would be the greatest and grim."

4 Then Jesus said "This is delight
Compared to hell. For I am right
To tell you that if God should place
In one balance all the pain's trace
That all men have suffered in this
World and shall suffer without bliss
Until the Day of Judgement, and
In the other balance one grand
Hour of the pain of hell, the manned
Wicked would choose without a doubt
The worldly tribulation's grout
From the hands of men, but the others
From hand of devils who in smothers
Have never compassion about.

5 "What cruel fire they shall give to
The miserable, sinful crew!
O what bitter cold, which shall yet
Not extinguish the flames with wet!
What gnashing of their teeth and more
Sobbing and weeping on that floor!
For Jordan has less water than
The tears which shall flow from their eyes
Every moment. Their tongues as can
Shall curse creation under skies,
With their father and mother too,
And their Creator to whom's due
All blessing forever and true."

While my tongue still is able, I address
My praises to the Creator and show
My love for all created things I know.
I let no day pass but fail not to bless.
I see the aspens tremble in the dress
Of summer and the birches stately grow,
The pines sun shimmering on their trunks to glow
Purple and russet. Loveliness confess.

I have all time of hell to rant and curse,
And never-ending fires to vent my spleen.
And so I take the fleeting day to raise
My voice to sing of the plum and cat's purse,
And of all the greenfinches I have seen.
This day's too short for the load of my praise.

Barnabas 61

1 Having said this, then Jesus came
To do ablutions and the same
With his disciples too, as it
Is commanded upon the writ
Of Moses, and then prayed a bit.
But the disciples when they saw
That Jesus was sad, they in awe
Did not speak to him on that day,
But each stood terror-struck in way
Of his words. Then Jesus at last
Opened his mouth after the past
Prayer of the evening and he said
“What father of a family bred,
If he knew that a thief would break
Into his house, would his sleep take?
Surely no one, for he would guard
And wait to strike the thief down hard.
Don't you know Satan comes to roar
A lion searching for the gore
To consume? So he seeks to make
Man sin. Indeed and for your sake
I tell you, if a man would act
Like a merchant and not one slacked,
He'd have no fear upon that day,
Because he'd be ready *to stay*.

Barnabas puts the lion in the mouth
Of Jesus, when in fact from north to south
As I search in the Scriptures for the truth
Of who spoke of such lions without ruth,
The one whose word is quoted here is not
Jesus but good St. Peter in the plot.
This shows Barnabas to be forgery,
Dependent on epistles wild and free.
All criticism has its answer due:
It could well be that Peter took the cue
From what he heard the good Lord say one day,
The same time Barnabas heard Jesus say
That Satan was a ranging lion to take
The unaware in snare for goodness' sake.

2 There was a man who gave his gold

To his neighbours who bought and sold,
 And the profits should be set out
 In just proportion round about.
 And some did well in trade so that
 They doubled the money that sat.
 But some wasted the funds to serve
 The enemy and his preserve
 Of him who gave the gold and spoke
 Wickedly about him, the bloke.
 Now tell me, when the neighbour calls
 The debtors to account in stalls,
 How shall the matter go? Truly
 He will reward those who in fee
 Traded well, but against the others
 His anger shall arise in smothers
 Reproaching them. Then he will rise
 To punish them in the law's guise.
 3 "As God lives and before whose eyes
 My soul stands, that neighbour is God
 Who has given to human clod
 All that he has with life itself,
 So that as he lives well like elf
 In this world God may have the praise
 And man glory in paradise.
 For those who live well double gold
 By their example, for the fold
 Of sinners seeing them shall be
 Converted to repentance fee.
 That's why those who live well shall be
 Rewarded with a great reward.
 But wicked sinners *under sword*
 Who by their sins halve what God gives
 Them, by their lives spent in the sieves
 Of Satan, God's foe, to blaspheme
 God and give offence to the beam
 Of others, tell me what shall be
 Their punishment *eternally?*"
 "Without measure, so it shall be,"
 Said the disciples *faithfully*.

The parable of talents comes to bear
 On gospels written and read everywhere.
 But the best understanding of the tale,
 And best interpretation of the hale
 Talents of gold is written in these lines:
 It's to be doing well by God's designs.
 Well-doing is a thing of gold and rare
 And not so often found though sought with care.
 Beloved, let talents of well-doing rise
 From my hands and those of the other guys

Around me where I live. Though human acts
Are themselves largely worthless, such are facts,
I'd rather be condemned for doing well,
Than for contributing to others' hell.

Barnabas 62

1 Then Jesus said "He who would live
Well should take the patten I give
From the merchant who locks his shop,
And selling guards over the top
Both day and night with diligence.
For what he buys he with good sense
Looks to make profit. If he sees
That he will lose thereby with ease
He will not sell, not to his own
Brother, *or even make a loan.*
So you should do, for truly your
Soul is a merchant with a store,
And the body, it is the shop,
So what it receives from the prop
Of the outside and through the sense
Is bought and sold by it for pence.
And the money is love's desire.
Go then and with your love acquire
Not the small thought by which work be
No profit for the soul to see.
But let thought, speech and love of God
By safety for you under rod.
2 Indeed I tell you, many make
Ablutions and go pray and take
To fast and give alms, many read
And preach to others, but whose breed
Is an abomination to
Ælohim, because they by due
Wash the body and not the heart,
They cry with mouth and not on part
Of their heart, they abstain from meats
And fill themselves with sin for treats,
To be considered good, but they
Study to know what they should say,
Not what to do, and so they preach
To others against what they reach
Themselves, and so they are condemned
By their own tongue *as they are hemmed.*
As God lives, these do not know God
With their hearts. If they had the prod
To know Him they would love Him too.
Whatever a man has in view
He has received it *as though due.*

It might be better to preach hypocrite,
To say and not to do and cause a fit,
Than to preach what one does and always do
Exactly what one preaches to the pew.
The lack of my hypocrisy is just
What keeps my preaching languishing in dust.
My failure to preach great things to be done
Results in hardly doing feats well spun.
Beloved, I preach and do exactly so
Which may be why no hearers in my row
Stand up to be well counted. Action here
Demands a preacher preaching without fear,
And privately living a lie below
The threshold of ideals and of the show.

Barnabas 63

1 After some days Jesus passed near
Samaritan city, no fear,
And they would not let him come in
The city, nor sell bread from bin
To his disciples. So James said
Along with John, "Master, be led
To let us pray to God that He
Send fire from heaven upon this spree."
2 Jesus replied, "You don't know by
What spirit you are led to cry.
Remember how God once decided
To destroy Nineveh derided
Because He did not find one who
Feared God in that city and crew,
Which was so wicked that when God
Called Jonah the prophet to plod
To that city, for fear of those
Who lived there Jonah rather chose
To flee to Tarsus, which is why
God caused him to be thrown up high
Into the sea and swallowed by
A fish that threw him up nearby
To Nineveh. And he preached there,
So the folk repented with care,
And God had mercy on their share.

The wonder is not that Jonah resolved
To flee from problems that remained unsolved,
Or that he was once swallowed by a fish
Too big to place on any human's dish.
The wonder's rather that sore and displaced,
Rejected by both ship and fish untraced,
He went to preach at all in Nineveh,
To any sinners found there in the way.

The wonder is not that the people failed
To do righteousness and justice unqualed,
But that they did repent at Jonah's word,
The world's worst preacher of that time now blurred.
Repentance is achievement greater than
All other arts invented by a man.

3 Woe to those who for revenge cry,
For on themselves it shall come by,
Since every man in his own right
Has cause for God to bring in plight.
Say now, did you create this town
With its people and of renown?
You would be madmen so to claim.
For all creatures come in one aim
Could not create a fly for shame
From nothing, which creating means.
If the blessed God whose signs and scenes
Created this town lets it thrive,
Why do you for destruction strive?
Why did you not say "May it please
You, Master, that we pray in ease
To the Lord our God that this folk
May repent and convert at stroke?"
Surely this is the proper act
Of my disciples, pray in fact
To God for those in evil stacked.
So Abel did when brother Cain,
Accursed of God, had come and slain.
So Abraham did for Pharaoh,
Who took from him his wife in row,
And whom, therefore, God's angel did
Not kill, but only struck in bid.
So did Zechariah when, by
Decree of the impious guy,
The king, he was killed in the house
Of God. So did every such grouse,
Jeremiah, Isaiah, and
Ezekiel, Daniel, and in stand
David, with all the friends of God
And holy prophets. Tell me, laud,
If your brother were stricken down
With mental illness in the crown,
Would you kill him because he spoke
Evil and struck down those who woke
To come near him? Assuredly
You would not do so; but instead
You would try to restore his head
And health with medicines of use
To his illness, and not abuse.

If the great argument that Jesus makes
Here against vengeance for human mistakes
Is that one should not beg justice of God
Because one is unjust oneself to plod
The narrow way in strict obedience,
I find that thesis makes no bit of sense.
If justice is for perfect folk alone,
There's no reason for justice on this stone.
I hear the excuse now: I don't pay bills
Because my creditor for extra thrills
Runs traffic lights. No, no, Jesus and Lord
God, you are both wrong though of one accord.
I owe justice to evil and to good,
It's always right to do the thing I should.

Barnabas 64

1 "As God lives, in whose presence my
Soul stands, a sinner is of sly
And infirm mind when he comes by
To persecute a man or try.
For tell me, is there anyone
Who'd break his head to get a chance
Of tearing his enemy's pants?
How can he be sane who comes to
Separate himself from the due
Of God, the head of his own soul,
To injure the body in toll
Of enemy or foe in goal?
2 "Tell me, O man, who is your foe?
Truly your body and the show
Of everyone who praises you.
If you were sane, you'd kiss the hand
Of those who revile you in band,
And give gifts to the ones who stand
To persecute you and who strike
You much; because, O man, it's like
This that the more you are reviled
For your sins in this life compiled,
The less you'll have to meet in store
On the day of judgement for score.
But tell me, O man, if the saints
And God's prophets are in complaints,
Defamed by the world though they kept
Their innocence, what shall be swept
From you, O sinner? And if they
Endured it all in patient sway,
And praying for the wicked who
Persecuted them, what's for you
To do, O man, to whom hell's due?

I neither do an evil, wicked thing
To those who perpetrate upon my wing
Oppression and vexation, not at all,
Nor do I kiss the hand come at the call
Of exploitation. There's always each day
A third and wiser alternative way.
I simply remove myself from the path
Of wicked hypocrites and reckless wrath.
Sometimes I may point out their sin on me
Or even on the weaker not set free,
But for the most part I let them remain
In waiting-rooms for the resulting pain
Of evil in the hand and in the heart.
When I've done so, then I have done my part.

3 Tell me, O my disciples, do
You not know that Shimei, it's true,
Cursed God's servant, David the high
Prophet, and threw stones at his eye?
What did David say to those who
Would have come to slaughter Shimei?
"What's it to you, O Joab, that
You would kill Shimei? let him rat
And curse me, for this is God's will,
Who will turn this curse from the swill
Into a blessing." It was so,
For God saw David's patient show
And saved him from the hand of hate
At his own son, Absalom's rate.

David's reply was hypocritical:
He had not power to cast him to the wall.
When he was then instated in his power,
He dared not kill Shimei in weakened hour.
But the wrong lay and festered in the wound,
And David minded he had been lampooned.
King Solomon at last killed Shimei for
A pretext only, to even the score.
Beloved, Your prophet is a hypocrite
Like all men on this globe, for none are fit,
And all call justice by a falser name,
Because each one has interest in the claim.
I join the human race and recognize
That as for righteousness, I am not wise.

4 Surely not a leaf stirs without
The will of God. So in your rout
Don't think how much trouble you've borne,
Nor of the one who treats with scorn,

But think how much for your sins you
Are worthy to receive in due
From hell's own devils come in crew.
You're angry with this city since
It would not receive us or wince
To sell us bread. Tell me, are these
People your slaves? Did you set breeze
On them to have this town? Did you
Give them their corn? Or have you lent
A hand to help them reap it bent?
You have not, for you're strangers here,
And poor men besides to appear.
What thing is this then that you say?"
The two disciples came to say
"Lord, we have sinned, may God repay
Us with mercy." Jesus replied,
"So let it be and let it bide."

Jesus fails once again in argument.
Though people may not be one's slaves or bent
To live in house and hold that one has built,
Still that does not excuse them from their guilt.
It's not just slaves who owe a just regard
To masters in the house and in the yard.
Society cannot achieve a bit
Of stable dealing, unless at last it
Work on the principle of mutual aid
And trust instead of gaunt, selfish parade.
It's sour grapes before the bold and great
That determines to be resigned to fate.
Let me not prostitute my mind before
Necessity to lip-serve matador.

Do not preach to me, Jesus, such a word
Of sour milk and even more sour curd.
If some are willed by God to vent their spleen
In wicked deeds and awful on the green,
Then I may be predestined in my way
To point out their injustice in their sway.
It's only just that I fulfil my own
Predestined part if I cannot atone
For the oppression of the weak or yet
The exploitation by which greater get
Their wicked way. If you leave them to rage,
Leave me too on my own predestined page.
So you're predestined to support the strong
In what they do, despite their being wrong.

Barnabas 65

1 The Passover drew near, and so

Jesus and his disciples go
Up to Jerusalem. And he
Went to the pool called publicly
Probatika. And the bath there
Was called that because everywhere
The angel of God came each day
To stir the water, and in play
The first to go down in the wet
After its stirring came to get
The healing of each illness set.
That's why a crowd of ill, infirm
Stayed by the pool throughout the term
Under five porches where they met.
Jesus saw there a man most ill
For thirty-eight years on the sill.
Jesus, who knew divinely taught,
Had mercy on the sick man wrought,
And asked him "Do you want to be
Cured of your sore infirmity?"
2 The impotent man then replied,
"Sir, when the angel comes in stride
To stir the waters, I have none
To help me in it on the run,
But while I'm coming down, another
Steps down before me as to smother."
Then Jesus raised his eyes above,
And said "Lord our God, God of love
Of our ancestors, have mercy
On this man for infirmity."
And having said this, Jesus said
"In name of God, brother, be led
In wholeness and take up your bed."

Jesus may well have had mercy and more
On the man stuck ill on the fatal shore.
But what mercy is that the angel shows
By favouring the strong, forgetting woes
Of the weak who can never compensate,
But always come down to the water late?
If he acts by Your divine command here,
You are no god of justice, I do fear.
I doubt the sacred words, I doubt the way
That angels and Your prophets make the day.
I am a doubter of all things but You,
For You, Beloved, are the only one true.
All is a legend and a marvelled book,
I turn from that to You and take a look.

3 The sick man then at once got up,
And praising God jumping like tup,

Carried his bed on shoulders' rack,
 And went home praising God in track.
 The ones who saw him cried aloud,
 "It's Sabbath day, you're not allowed
 To carry your bed on this day."
 And he replied, "He who had sway
 To make me well, said 'Take your bed
 And go home as you have been led.'"
 They asked him then, "Who was the man."
 He answered "No idea or plan."
 4 They said among themselves "It must
 Have been Jesus Nazarene's trust."
 Others said "No, he's holy one
 Of God, while the one for his fun
 Who's done this thing's a wicked man,
 For he makes Sabbath by his plan
 Be broken." And Jesus went to
 The temple, and a great crowd drew
 Near to him to hear his words, that's why
 The priests were jealous of his try.

The man did not come to Jesus to beg
 A blessing on invalidated leg.
 So Jesus brought the trouble on himself
 By acting on the Sabbath like an elf.
 O my Beloved, there are moments indeed
 When I think I'd like to do a good deed,
 And though they are rare moments in a day,
 At least I then stop to beg You and pray.
 Let me do one good deed before I die,
 And let me do it even under sky
 Of Sabbath day. I'd really like to try.
 But then of course I'd ruin all the fun,
 My perfect record of wickedness done,
 Wicked, though mediocre, under sun.

Barnabas 66

1 One of them came to him to say
 "Good master, you teach well and pray.
 So tell me what reward shall God
 Give us in paradise to plod?"
 Jesus replied, "You call me good,
 And do not know the thing you should,
 That God alone is good, as Job,
 The friend of God said in his robe,
 'A child of a day old's not clean,
 And even angels are not seen
 Before God without fault to glean.'
 Further he said 'The flesh awakes
 Sin and sucks up in wicked stakes

Like a sponge absorbs water's lakes.”
The priest said not a word for he
Had been confounded forcefully.
And Jesus said “I tell you true,
Nothing's more dangerous in view
Than talk. For so said Solomon,
'Life and death are in the strength done
By the mere tongue when on the run.”

Quite right, quite right indeed, the prophet true
Gives witness of himself for all the crew
Of humankind in what we say and do.
The only reasons I am not offended
By all that's said to me and so pretended
Is that I do not stop to think or know
The extent of the blasphemous in show.
But it is not so simple just to stop
The hand and tongue and stay the spinning top.
In silence the mill of wickedness goes
On producing its tin soldiers in rows
Until the whole life's full of vacant woes.
Beloved, have mercy on Your Jesus now
And on his false disciples anyhow.

2 He turned to his disciples, saying
"Beware of those who bless you braying,
Because they do deceive you then.
With the tongue Satan blessed again
Our first ancestors, but results
Of his words were misery's cults.
So did wise men of Egypt bless
Pharaoh. So did Goliath guess
Upon the Philistines. So did
Four hundred false prophets on skid
Bless Ahab, but false were their praises,
So the praised one died with their phrases.
God did not say without a cause
By the prophet Isaiah's clause,
'O My folk, those that bless you do
Deceive you.' And so woe to you,
Scribes and Pharisees! Woe to you,
Priests and Levites! because you've make
Corrupted offering to YHWH laid,
So those who come to sacrifice
Believe that God eats cooked flesh nice
Like a man does and to suffice.”

The insight of Your prophet does amaze
The mind of this observer in his craze.
No other one interpreting Your law

Has given vent to such a note in paw.
Attempt to do and say in sacrifice
Of act and deed and word and every nice
Goat with throat cut will only reinforce
The blasphemous pretence that You of course
Are of the same material expanse
As human animal in cosmic dance.
Materialist theology arises
Inevitable by legal surprises.
Alternative to human mind set free
Is atheistical theology.

Barnabas 67

1 For you say to them, "Bring your sheep
And bulls and lambs to God to keep
In temple, and don't eat it all,
But give your God a share in stall
Of that which He has given you;"
And you do not tell them what's true
Of sacrificial origins,
That it's for witness of life's wins
Granted to son of Abraham,
Our own ancestor without scam,
So that faith and obedience
Of our ancestor Abraham,
With promises without offence
Made to him by God and blessing
Vouchsafed to him, should in the sting
Never be a forgotten thing.
But God says by Ezekiel prophet:
"Remove from Me these things to scoff at,
Your sacrifices, your victims
Are atrocious to me for whims.
For the time comes near when shall be
Done what our God spoke by Osee
The prophet, saying 'I will call
Chosen folk not chosen at all.'"
As He says in Ezekiel
The prophet: "God shall make a swell
New covenant with His folk well,
Not by the covenant that He
Made with you once ancestrally,
Which they did not keep faithfully,
And He shall take away their heart
Of stone and give a new heart's start"
And all this shall be because you
Do not walk now in His law's view.
You have the key and you do not
Open: rather you block the plot
From those who would walk in its lot.

The priest was leaving to report
It all to the high priest in sport,
Who stood near the sanctuary,
But Jesus said "Stay for a wee,
And I'll answer your question, see."

A new heart was indeed Ezekiel's word,
But Jeremiah was the one preferred
With a monopoly on covenant
New and writ on the heart by Your consent,
Beloved, as spoken by the prophet sent.
Every man's born with stony heart, it seems,
That breaks in on his waking and his dreams
With pain in chest that quickens fear to think
The body topples on the deathly brink
Of heaven and hell. Sirat closes down on
The soul and body fails before the dawn.
Only a heart of flesh might still the pain
And comfort the poor soul that's on the wane.
A heart of diamond here is never gain.

Barnabas 68

I You ask me to tell you what God
Will give us in paradise sod.
Truly I say to you that those
Who worry about pay to pose
Do not love the master they chose.
A shepherd with a flock of sheep,
When he sees the wolf come to creep,
Prepares defence, but otherwise
The paid hand when he sees arise
The wolf, he leaves the sheep and flees.
As God lives before whom it please
Him that I stand, if fathers' God
Were your God, you would not give prod
To saying "What will God give me?"
But you would have said in the spree,
As David His prophet, "What fee
Can I give God for all that He
In His mercy has given to me?

It is indeed a wonder that I beg
Your mercy day by day, as though my leg
Were half caught in hell and the silent grave,
When I live among unbounded and brave
Mercies and graces hour by hour and fine.
The pure water I drink's better than wine,
And the rough bread and old that daily I
Feast on is better far than apple pie.
Beloved, instead of begging more for me,

I ought to thank You for what I have free.
And so I thank you for the rowan tree
And for the fruit I share with tufted bird,
Remembering how I've been so absurd.

2 "I'll speak to you by parable
So you may understand in full.
There was a king who found beside
The road a man robbed by thieves' tide,
Who'd hurt him till death threatened wide.
He felt sorry for him and told
His servants to carry from cold
To town and tend him, and they did
This faithfully and by his bid.
The king came greatly to love him
Who was ill, so he gave in trim
His own daughter as wife and made
Him his own heir and in parade.
The king was merciful indeed,
But the man beat servants in greed,
Despised his cures, abused his wife,
Spoke evil of the king for strife,
Made the subjects rebel in rife.
And when the king asked for a boon,
He used to say "What will he soon,
This king give me as a reward?"
So when the king heard his restored,
What did he do in recompense
For such a wicked man's offence?"
They all replied: "Woe to him, for
The king took away all his store,
And harshly punished him, what's more."

I'd say the story rings true by the sense
I get from Mark Twain when the man presents
That humans differ from the dog in that
A man made prosperous will take the fat
And bite the hand that gave him wealth, while dogs
Are grateful to those who feed them incogs.
Beloved, if I may interject my own
Experience from a dog I've on loan,
That dogs too bite the hands that feed them here.
I've had a bite or two when laying gear
In a dog's dish, and even water may
Inspire a dog to bite me and then bay.
Cats are another story. They come near
At the door as soon as I may appear.

3 Then Jesus said "O priests, and scribes,
And Pharisees, and high-priest bribes

Who hear my voice, I proclaim you
What God has said to you that's true
By His prophet Isaiah too:
"I've nourished servants, honoured them,
But they've despised Me in their hem."
The king's our God, who found the folk
Of Israel in this world's stroke
Of miseries, and gave him to
His servants Joseph, Moses too,
And Aaron, who tended him true.
And our God came to love him so
That for Israel's folk's sake in show
He struck down Egypt, drowned Pharaoh,
Fought one hundred and twenty kings
Of Canaanites, Midianite wings;
He gave him His laws, made him heir
Of all the land our folk live there.
4 But how does Israel act for that?
How many prophets killed out flat?
How many prophecies corrupted?
How law of God left interrupted?
How many for that reason go
Away from God and serve the show
Of idols, through your offence low,
O priests! How you dishonour God
With how you live upon the sod!
And now you ask me, "What will God
Give us in paradise on sod?"
You ought to have asked me, "What will
Be punishment God will fulfil
On us in hell?" And then what you
Ought to do for penitence true
So God may have mercy on you:
For this I can tell you, and to
This purpose I am sent to you."

I doubt not that Israel is just as bad
As described by Jesus in words so sad,
But hasten to remind You, Beloved, that
They had no monopoly where they sat.
Wherever You may roam or range as did
The satan seeking Job on whom to bid,
You'll find the same in spirit on the skid.
Unfaithfulness is something we've down pat.
I beg again Your mercy added to
Abundance that I enjoy in Your view.
The grace I beg is repentance anew,
Which is reward enough and greater too
Than anything that angels ever had,
And might prevent me from being a cad.

Barnabas 69

1 As God lives, before whom I stand,
You'll not receive praise at my hand,
But truth. That's why I say to you,
Repent and turn to God in view
As our ancestors from their sin,
And do not harden your heart's bin.
The priests were enraged at this word,
But fearing the common folk stirred,
They did not dare utter a word.

Call to repentance is a finer thing
Than what they do today to have a fling
In mega-church and in the chapel where
The evangelicals rant and beat air.
When I was young the Baptists made you stand
Before the congregation set in band
To hear that sense of sin inspired to come
Repenting to the Lord like any bum.
Now witness borne is how great Your love is,
As unconditional as any whiz,
Without a sign repenting ever spoken,
Which would belie our self-esteem in token.
Call then, Beloved to such repentance now
And watch Your church empty of bull and cow.

2 And Jesus continued to say:
"O doctors, scribes, Pharisees gay,
O priests, tell me. You desire horses
Like knights, but you don't go in courses
Out to the battle. You desire
Fine clothing like women on fire,
But you don't wish to spin and feed
Children; you hold fields' fruits in greed,
But you don't wish to pull the plough.
You want your fish, but anyhow
Refuse to wield the hook and net.
You want honours as citizens,
But not republic's burdens yet.
You lust for tithes and firstfruits' dens
As priests, but you wish not to serve
God in truth, but from the truth swerve.
What then shall God do with you all,
Since you seek profit without gall?
Indeed I tell you God will give
You a place where you'll stay to live
With only gall left in the sieve."

I look about me at the wealth I see

In field and street and every company
And know the poverty around the world
Is hardly visible to folks here swirled.
But it was not so in days not far passed.
My own wife tells of the role she was cast
To draw the plough, because they had no horse,
And how heavy it seemed to keep a course.
In Ephrata in days past they'd drew plough
Because they would not make slaves anyhow
Of Your fair creatures. Amish then appeared
As worldly as Episcopal unsteered.
Sell iss die Welt. I draw in laura close,
Unseen, unhonoured, though somewhat verbose.

3 When Jesus had said this, there came
Some bringing him one with the claim
Not to speak or see or to hear,
Demoniac, it would appear.
So Jesus seeing their faith strong
Raised his eyes to the heavenly throng
And said "Lord God of fathers long,
Have mercy on this sick man and
Give him health, so may understand
This folk You've sent me by Your hand."

I always wondered why my humble prayer
For the sick never came in power to bear
Fruit of the healing that I sought in faith.
I always wondered at my prayer of wraith.
Now I know why. You only heal the sick
To show the one You sent is true and thick.
Since You have not sent me to any throng
To bear Your message of the right and wrong,
There is no need to heal those I pray for.
The inference is plain and at the door.
Beloved, heal the sick then in pity that
They suffer pain where they lie on their mat,
If they are among those of such great wealth
To have a mat to lie on and in stealth.

4 And having said this Jesus told
The spirit to go out in cold,
And said "In power of name of God
Our Lord, depart, evil one's prod,
From the man." The demon departed
And the dumb man spoke grateful-hearted,
And saw with his eyes. So all men
Were filled with fear, but the scribes then
Said "In the power of Beelzebub,
The prince of demons, at the rub

He casts the demons out to grub.”
Then Jesus said “Each government
Divided against itself bent
Destroys itself, and such house falls
Upon its own foundation walls.
If by the might of Satan's hand
Satan is cast out, how in band
Can his kingdom still come to stand?
And if your sons cast out Satan
With scripture Solomon by plan
Of prophethood gave them, they bear
Witness that I cast out in share
Satan by might and power of God.
As God lives, blasphemy in prod
Of Holy Spirit does not get
Forgiveness in this world as set
Nor in the other world, because
The wicked one of his won will
Condemns himself with knowledge still.”

When those sick I pray for do not get well,
At least I can me comfort for a spell
To think that I'm not casting out by power
Of Satan anything in a dire hour.
No house divided lies beneath my hand
Of no gain, of no power among the grand.
I skip for joy that I'm not of the band
Of those with Satan who rise up and stand.
Beloved, as sickness swells ungrateful toll
And I too among the blind miss the goal,
You have the right and ring to take Your time
And turn the world upside down on a dime.
Do that when You will and in grateful song
I shall praise You for both the right and wrong.

3 After Jesus said this he went
Out of the temple, and folk lent
Him praise, because they brought all those
Who were ill that they found and chose
Together, and Jesus with prayer
Brought all to health again to share.
So that day in Jerusalem
The Roman soldiers' stratagem
By Satan was to stir the folk
By saying Jesus was in stroke
The God of Israel who came
Down to visit His folk in fame.

The four great Gospels in the Bible fail
To note the role of Roman soldiers' pale

In spreading the false rumours on the ground
That Jesus was the Almighty One found.
It stands to reason that soldiers would say
Such superstitious things in soldiers' way.
How anyone could doubt the fact's absurd.
To know it one needs not a divine word.
Beloved, You sent Your own into the world
To bring salvation to folk there once hurled
Into both poverty and sickness bound.
In him wealth and healing were to be found.
His word turned darkness to both light and sound.
The Roman witness spoiled things when unfurled.

Barnabas 70

1 Jesus went from Jerusalem
After the Passover in hem,
And came into the area
Philippi of Caesarea.
The angel Gabriel told him
Of the rebellion that was grim
Among the common folk, and he
Asked his disciples, saying free,
“What do the people say of me?”
They said “Some say you're Elijah,
Others say you're Jeremiah,
And others one of prophets old.”
Jesus replied, “What have you told,
What do you say I am, be bold?”
Peter replied, “You are the Christ,
The son of God, and it sufficed.”
2 Then Jesus became angry, and
With wrath rebuked him out of hand,
Saying: “Begone, depart from me,
Because you have the devil's fee
And seek to cause offence in me.
He threatened the eleven, saying
“Woe to you if you believe straying,
For I've got from God a great curse
Against those who believe this terse.”
And he was ready to throw out
Peter, but the eleven in rout
Begged Jesus on Peter's behalf,
Who did not throw him out to laugh,
But once more rebuked him to say
“Make sure you never talk that way
Again to find such words to say,
Because God would condemn your way.”
Peter wept and said “Sir, I've spoken
In foolishness, beg God in token
To pardon me, *my heart is broken.*”

When Matthew adds a bit to intervene
And make it look like the rebuke and keen
Did not relate to calling Jesus Christ,
But rather for predicting death sufficed,
The gospels do conflict in a grand way.
Canonical say Jesus came in sway
As the Messiah and to die that way.
Barnabas claims he was no Christ at all,
And did not die outside the judgement hall.
The Christian denies christhood by the teaching
That Jesus is God Almighty for preaching.
The Muslim denies Barnabas' fair claim
That Jesus is no Christ at all in blame.
Thus all faiths deny Scriptures as they came.

3 Jesus said "If our God did not
Wish to show Himself in the plot
To Moses His servant, nor to
Elijah whom He loved in view,
Nor any prophet, do you think
God would show Himself on the brink
Of this bad generation's stink?
But don't you know that God's created
All things from nothing by word stated,
And all men have their origin
From a piece of clay not to win?
So how shall God be in the form
And likeness of a man of scorn?
Woe to those who let themselves be
Deceived by Satan's fallacy."
After he said this Jesus prayed
Begging God for Peter waylaid,
While the eleven wept along
With Peter who had done the wrong,
And said "Let it be so, be so,
O blessed Lord our God to know."
After that Jesus went away
Into Galilee, there to stay
Away from this vain thought in sway
That common folk began to hold
About him, so it might grow cold.

The text makes the same error as the ones
Who follow Islam in their hundreds tonnes,
That Son of God is to claim deity,
When in fact it's a phrase used easily
By one and all in the first century
To mean simply Messiah or the Christ,
Which is what the Qur'an itself enticed

Men to believe. The priest himself defines
The term Son of God within the confines
Of the Messiah, promised and awaited.
The term implies nothing else or conflated.
The ignorance of faithful educated
Is so abysmal that when I see it
I wonder God Himself does not have fit.

Barnabas 71

1 Jesus arrived in his own land,
And it was rumoured and outspanned
Throughout the land of Galilee
How Jesus the prophet to see
Had come to Nazareth to be.
That's why they start diligently
To find sick folk and bring to him,
To beg him to touch them and trim
With his hands. And the crowd so grew
That a rich man of palsied crew
Who tried and could not make way through
The door, had himself carried up
To the roof of the house like tup
Where Jesus was, and had them make
A hole in the roof for his sake,
And had himself let down by sheets
In front of Jesus, *and then greets.*
Jesus paused for a moment there,
And then he said for the man's share,
“Don't be afraid, my brother dear,
Your sins have been forgiven clear.”
Then all were offended to hear.
And they said “Who's this without fear
To forgive sins *like God come near?*”
Then Jesus said “As God lives, I
Cannot forgive sins if I try,
Nor can any man do the thing,
But God alone is forgiving.
But as the servant of God I
Can beg Him for the sins thereby
Of others, and so I've besought
Him for this sick man and a lot,
And I'm sure God has heard my prayer.
So that you might become aware
Of truth, I tell this sick man “In
The name of our ancestors' God,
The God of Abraham to win
And of his sons, rise from the sod
And be healed.” When Jesus said this
The sick man got healed and in bliss
And praised God *greatly not to miss.*

The common folk begged Jesus to
Pray to God for the sick ones who
Were standing outside in their crew.
So Jesus went out there to them
And lifted up his hands in view
And prayed to God in stratagem:
“Lord God of hosts, the living God,
The true God, holy God of laud,
The One immortal, look upon
Them in Your grace and mercy drawn”
So all replied “Amen”. And so
After this utterance in stow
He laid his hands on the sick folk,
And all were cured at the one stroke.
So they praised God aloud and said
“God's visited His own instead
By His own prophet, and one great
Prophet God has sent us not late.”

The proof sweet Christians throw up to the crowd
That Jesus is both man and God allowed
Is that he does forgive the sins of others,
Something no human can do for his brothers.
That's why when Barnabas reports the scene,
He makes sure that the claims that seem obscene
Are not put in the mouth of Jesus there.
That also does suggest the writing's share
Was done after the claim was sent abroad
That Jesus was the very Son of God.
Truth be what may: one thing is certain still.
No man is God Almighty on the hill.
The Gospel writ in name of Barnabas
Has got that one fact right in all the fuss.

Barnabas 72

1 At night Jesus in secret spoke
With his disciples, at a stroke
He said “Indeed I say to you
That Satan wants to sift your crew
Like wheat, but I have prayed to God
For you, and they'll not fail from pod
A single one of you but he
Who's out to set a trap for me.”
And this he said of Judas, for
The angel Gabriel before
Said to him how that Judas had
Hand with the priests and told them sad
All Jesus spoke *they thought was bad*.

From every church of twelve members there's one

Who is a Judas if for just the fun.
Each leader caught in justice and in truth
Who gathers about him a band of youth
Will find the twelfth one always in the dark
Out to destroy the innocent in park.
One need not be famous or true to find
A Judas among friends of unlike mind.
I have no band of disciples my own,
And yet I've seen the traitors with a groan.
Beloved, when You send angels with the word,
Send them with arms to remedy the curd,
And not just a foreboding without sleep,
A sound to frighten all the patient sheep.

2 With tears drew near to Jesus he
Who writes this saying faithfully,
"O master, tell me, who is he
That should betray you?" Jesus said
In answer, "O Barnabas led,
This is no time for you to know
Him, but soon that evil will show,
Because I shall depart the earth."
Then the apostles wept in berth,
And said "O master, why will you
Forsake us? Rather all in crew
Would we die than be left by you!"
3 Jesus replied, "Don't let your heart
Be troubled, nor take fear in part,
For I have not created you,
But God is our Creator who
Has made you and will so protect
You. As for me, I am elect
To come to the world to prepare
The way for God's Messenger's share,
Who shall bring earth salvation bare.
Do not be deceived and beware,
For many false prophets are there
Who'll take my words and spoil the rate
Of the gospel I came to state."
4 Then Andrew said "Master give us
Some sign to know him marvellous."
Jesus replied, "He will not come
In your time, but some years will hum
After you, when my gospel's laid
Down in the dust in the parade,
So there will be hardly left by
Thirty faithful under the sky.
At that time God will have mercy
On the world, and so then will He
Send down His Messenger, upon

Whose head will rest a white cloud drawn,
Whereby he shall be known by one
Of the elect of God when done,
And shall by him be shown abroad
To the world as one sent of God.
He shall come with great power raised high
Against ungodly, and destroy
Idolatry upon the earth.
And it rejoices me in worth
Because through him our God is known
And glorified, and I'll be shown
To be one truthful, and he'll take
Vengeance against those who shall make
Me say that I'm more than a man.

If Barnabas is a true Gospel here,
It needs proof that the dogma did appear
Already in the time of Jesus meant
That he was truly God and a god sent.
The way I read the Gospels now out aloud
Found in the canon amongst all the crowd,
It seems no one thought then that he was god,
Except a few detractors worth no pod,
Who twisted his words with no greater view
Than falser accusations drenched in rue.
Revision of the history must be made
To find that dogma in early parade.
Muslims are far too sweet to take for granted
That Christian heresy's in Bibles planted.

5 Truly I say to you the moon
Shall serve him with sleep just as soon
As he grows to boyhood, and he
When he is grown majestically
Shall take her in his hands freely.
Let earth beware of casting out,
For he'll kill idolaters stout,
For many were killed by the hand
Of Moses, God's servant in land,
And Joshua, who did not spare
The cities that they burned in glare,
And killed their children, for it's true
To an old wound one takes with rue
To cauterize it. He shall come
With truth more clear than that in sum
Of all the prophets, and reprove
The one abusing earth to move.
The towers or our ancestors' town
Shall greet each other without frown,
And so when all idolatry

Shall be seen to fall down greatly
Upon the ground, they will confess
Me to be a man in address
Like other men, truly I say
To you God's Messenger one day
Will come *and lead men not astray.*”

It must be that the same argument flew
Among the Christian apologist crew,
That Jesus was a man of loving peace,
Which shows that Muhammad in his release
Of war and violence was a bad man,
And a false prophet without divine plan.
The reference to Moses and the hand
Of Joshua against Canaanite band
Shows that the argument's a fallacy.
I've made the same response and come to see
That no Christian can follow logic met
In the comparison of Moses set.
That fact the Moses and Joshua kill
Idolaters has nothing to fulfil.

Barnabas 73

1 "Truly I say to you, that if
Satan should try whether you're stiff
Friends of God, since no one attacks
His own fortresses for their cracks,
If Satan had his way with you
He'd let you slide in pleasure's view.
But since he knows that you're his foes
He'll do what he can in your throes
Destroying you's the way he chose.
But do not be afraid, for he
Will be to you like a dog wee
That's chained, since God has heard my plea.”
John then replied, “Oh master dear,
Not just for us, but those who'll fear
In gospel word, reveal the way
The old tempter has come to lay.”

The promise is the tempter should remain
A chained dog not to threaten men who're sane.
I must not be one of those, since that dog,
Whether an outward fiend come in the fog
Or yet the lust of my own heart alive,
Has mauled me and enthralled me where I strive.
The promise of the chains has just made me
Unwary of the threat to chastity.
Beloved, I take the devil's chains by faith
And lock them to his wall where he like wraith

May gnash his teeth in his frustration's sport
That he cannot come penetrate my fort.
Now all I lack is the grace to be true
And live forever ruled alone by You.

2 Jesus replied, "In four ways that
Wicked one comes in tempting vat.
The first is when he comes himself
With tempting thoughts upon the shelf.
The second is when he tempts by
The words and deeds his servants ply.
The third way is his tempting with
Doctrines of falsity and myth.
The fourth way is his tempting done
By visions false *to every son*.
How wary people ought to be,
And all the more accordingly
As he has his grant in the flesh
Of humankind, which loves afresh
Sin as the fevered one in mesh
Longs for the water *to be free*.
Indeed, I tell you, if a man
Fears God he'll have the victory's scan
Over all, as David His prophet
Says, "God shall give His angels sofit
Over you to keep your ways right,
So that the tempting devil might
Not cause you to stumble in flight.
A thousand shall fall at your left
And ten thousand on right bereft,
But they shall not come near your plight."

My father in the tumult war proposed
Repeated David's verses and reposed
Beneath the shower of bombs and bullets when
He fought the Japanese among the men
Of Philippines resisting them again.
The Psalm was hope and comfort in the rue.
That did not prevent him from falling to
The wounds in soul and body that ensue.
Beloved, You take and give the victory,
But at the close of life in liberty
The scars of battle and the sores of chains
Spoil the poor soul and body that remains.
I chafe for lack of justice, yet I cry
More for Your mercy here beneath the sky.

3 "Moreover, our God with great love
Has promised us by the above
Same David, saying 'I give you

The understanding to teach you,
 And in your ways and where you'll walk
 I'll have My eye rest on your flock.'
 But what shall I say? He has said
 By *good* Isaiah *who was led*:
 'Can a mum leave child of her womb?
 But I tell you, even at that doom,
 I'll not forget you.' Tell me then
 Who shall fear Satan in his den,
 Since angels guard and for protection
 The living God keeps in connexion?
 But it must be as says the prophet
 Solomon a word not to scoff at,
 'My son, who's come to fear the Lord,
 Prepare yourself for tempting sword.'
 Indeed I tell you, that a man
 Should do as the banker in span,
 Who keeps watch on money and thought
 Not to sin as his Maker's taught."

To quote and misquote David in this book
 Is greater blessing than in any nook
 Of other writing I find anywhere.
 And yet I take my solace in the share
 That Barnabas defines the devil does:
 Four ways he comes to give his folk a buzz.
 Direct attack himself, his servants' best,
 False doctrines and false visions to invest:
 These are his tools laid out still for his own.
 David's own antidote is prone
 To the four p's of prayer: the penance first
 For sin, and then the plaint upon the cursed,
 Then right petition for divine aid near,
 And then the final praise that must appear.

Barnabas 74

1 There have been and are in the world
 Men who don't care if sin's unfurled,
 Who lie in their own error curled.
 Tell me how Satan sinned *at first*?
 It's sure he sinned when his thought burst
 Out that he was better than men.
 Solomon sinned in his intention
 To invite all to his convention
 Of all God's creatures, till a fish
 Corrected him as from the dish
 He ate all he'd prepared in wish.
 Not in vain did our father David
 Say to ascend in one's heart pavèd
 Lays one in the vale of tears cravèd.

And why does God shout by His prophet
Isaiah, saying not to scoff at,
“Remove your evil thoughts from Me?”
And why does Solomon freely
Say “With your keeping things safely,
Keep your heart above all the spree?”

Sin is indeed born in the thought that I,
Like Satan, am better than others try.
In fact, it may be true or may be not,
But that's irrelevant to sinful plot.
The thought that I am I comes from above,
And lent to humankind as though to dove,
But truly belongs to God only for
God only has the right to such a store.
The I is God's and only lent to men,
But as such a divine thing come again,
Must quickly think that I am above all,
Since God's above all things on earthly ball.
That's why one man may err to think that he
Alone bears the divine I faithfully.

2 As God lives, in whose presence my
Soul stands, all scriptures do defy
The evil thoughts by which sins vie,
For without thought a man may sin.
So tell me, when the farmer plants
The vineyard, does he set the plants
Deep in the soil? Indeed he will.
Satan does the same to fulfil.
In planting sin, he does not stop
At eye or ear, but comes to drop
Into the heart, the house of God,
As Moses His servant in prod
Revealed: I'll dwell in them indeed,
So they'll walk in My law *and feed*.

The devil is a planter to sow seed,
And transplant by the roots all he may need
Of noxious herb and of poisonous weed.
The devil comes to banter eye and ear,
And superficially when he comes near,
But at the end set deep the heart to fear.
The devil is a planter in the way
He sets the evil thing in the heart's sway.
Beloved, the heart is temple made for You,
Your dwelling in each human in the pew.
So bide my heart alone for You to stay
And keep the devil's evil plants away.
I pluck them up like straws and in my fire

Set them to smoulder in destruction dire.

3 Now tell me, if Herod the king
Gave you a house to keep *in ring*
Where he wished to live, would you let
Pilate his foe come in to set
His things in it? I grant you not.
And so then how much less you ought
To let the devil come into
Your heart or place his thoughts in view?
Our God has given you your heart
To keep, which is His home *in part*.

Pilate and Herod can agree to take
Divided Palestine in three to bake
Beneath the sun of Negev of the sweet
Hills of Galilee where the swallows meet.
Pilate and Herod can go hand in hand
And do the things they wish across the land,
But I beg you to take Your palace clean
And keep it for Yourself and none between.
Beloved, the devils come and go at will,
It seems to me, below my wooded hill,
And some depart and some arrive to spill
Their trash beside my gate and by my door.
The house is place of battle to the gore,
That's what it seems houses have been made for.

4 Watch how the banker keeps his funds.
Whether Caesar's image that stuns
Is right and whether silver's good
Or false and whether the weight should
Be held correctly. He turns it
Upon his palm to see it fit.
O world gone mad, how well you look
To business deals. In judgement's nook
You'll chide and judge God's servants for
Their negligence and careless store,
For doubtless your servants are more
Prudent than God's servants. Tell me,
Now who examines a thought wee
As the banker a coin in fee?
Not one for silver's purity."

Do I examine every thought to see
If it's a counterfeit of gold to me?
I trow not. My Beloved, it's a mistake
Of mine not to be more careful to break
My thoughts in truth's analysis and ware.
Instead I let them just run anywhere.

The guru's of today say empty mind
And then the soul will be a perfect kind.
But my own discipline has other goals,
I hope to see my thoughts on safer shoals.
Let me require Your reason and Your love
Examining my thoughts come from above
As well as every turn I take and shove
Before the chimes come tinkling and bell tolls.

Barnabas 75

1 Then James said "O master, how can
There be a likeness in the scan
Of thoughts and coins by any man?"
Jesus replied, "Good silver's like
The piety in thoughts, the strike
Of every impious thought falls
From the devil and so appals.
The right image is in the way
To follow holy ones and stay
In the example prophets gave.
The weight of the thought's love of slave
To God, by which all should find lave.
The foe will bring impious thought
Against your neighbour, as is wrought
By the world's way, corrupting flesh,
With earthly love to spoil *afresh*
The love of God *caught in the mesh.*"

I see so many people steeped in wrong,
And hoping to gain over all the strong
The upper hand with greed and cruel hate.
I see so many such folks up to date.
But now I realize that in my eyes
They seem so wicked because to surprise
That vision of the other is brought in
By the foe simply to cause me to sin.
Give me, Beloved, a vision true and bright
To see the divine I caught in the light
Of gold and sweetness in each human breast
Despite the outward show and what I guessed.
Then I shall see the foe conquered and fail
And driven out into the outer pale.

2 Bartholomew replied, "O sir,
What should we do to keep the stir
Of thoughts away, so we don't fall
Into the temptation *for thrall?*"
3 Jesus replied, "Two things you need.
The first is exercise with speed,
The second is don't talk with greed.

For idleness is the foul pool
Where gathers every unclean *tool*
Of thought, and too much talking's rule
Of sponge to suck up wickedness.
So keep your body in *address*
Of occupation and the soul
Engaged in prayer *of ardent coal*.
Pray without ceasing is the goal.

The dance is too complex for clumsy me:
To work with hand and foot and through the spree
Still pray and pray in soul unceasingly.
To work and pray with keep the thoughts away,
But work and pray at one time in the fray
Is not so easy, my Beloved, now say.
It's like the trick my father gave to learn,
To pat the head and rub the belly's turn
At the same time. Two hands always collide
And make the same in motions and so ride
Unwillingly despite the way I try.
So pat the head and rub the belly well,
Or rub the head and pat the belly swell,
And wicked thoughts will never come to tell.

4 "I give you an example well:
There was a man who paid in spell
Of stingy ways, so none who knew
Him would work in his fields in crew.
So he, like any wicked man,
Said 'I'll go to the market clan
And find the idle without plan,
Who'll come and tend my vines and scan.'
This man set out from home and found
Many strangers who stood around
And had no money. He convinced
Them and led them back as unrinsed
To work his vineyards as unbound.
But none who knew him took his ground.

Beloved, when Satan came to hire his men,
I did not recognize his tale and wen,
Nor did I see the pitchfork in his hand.
Instead I thought him handsome, yes, and grand.
Since I am not one lazy, I was there
And ready to be hired to do my share.
I went to tend the devils vines and found
The wages hard and fell down on the ground.
Experience is best of teachers round,
And so the text says those who know him stay
And do not enter his fields come to stray.

I've got experience, so why do I
Rush off again when he comes to the try
To hire his servants to clean up his sty?

5 “And Satan is the one whose wages
Are ill-paid. He gives work in pages,
And man receives for the work rendered
Eternal fires of the unsplendoured.
That's why he went from paradise
Gone in search of workers of vice.
He sets his tasks to those who stand
In idleness from every band,
But mostly those who do not know.
It's not enough for one to show
Knowledge of evil to escape it.
But working good and not to ape it
Will overcome it in the row.”

That's just what I said. It is not enough
To know the devil's row runs wrong and rough.
The heart jumps at the chance, the hand to find
That ill-paid task that makes the hand unkind.
It's working good that heals the fevered mind,
But good is not so easy to catch out.
It come more naturally then to flout
The good and take the evil for a bout.
Beloved, create a heart in me to do,
Not my own works of worship in my pew,
But rather the good works are are from You.
All good is gifted from the divine hand,
And grace is grace throughout the pleasant land
As far as human hearts can strike the band.

Barnabas 76

1 I set you an example told.
There was a man who had in fold
Three vineyards, which he gave to three
Field hands to cultivate in spe.
Because the first one did not know
The art of cultivation's show,
The vineyard brought forth only leaves.
The second taught the third in sleeves
To care for the vines, and he took
Note of the teaching without book,
And did as told, so the third garden
Produced well, no need to ask pardon.
The second man spent his time just
In talking, did not touch the dust.
When time came to pay up the rent
To the owner of vineyards lent,

The first said "Sir, I did not know
How to work the land, I can't show
A profit for this year to go."
The owner said "Are you a fool
That lives alone in a world cool?
Why didn't you ask for advice
From my second vinedresser nice,
Who knows well how to cultivate
The land and make it produce great?
You'll certainly pay me my rate."

Three types of human beings are on earth:
The ignorant who do nothing of worth,
The knowledgeable ones who only talk,
And those who hear their wisdom not to baulk
And go out to perform in noble needs
What You, Beloved, provide them in grape seeds.
I might have thought a fourth kind could be found,
The one intelligent to till the ground.
Beloved, in ignorance I beg the grace
To till a vineyard here before Your face,
And bring to You the fruit I take in store,
So little, while I would have served You more.
Three types in Barnabas instead of those
Good Aristotle to his fame once chose.

2 That said he condemned him to work
In gaol to pay the debt, not shirk.
But he took pity on his lack
Of knowledge and let him go slack,
And said "Get out, and don't come back
To work in my vineyard, it is enough
That I forgive your debt. It's tough."

I guess the man is right about the thing,
There is no fourth type in the human wing.
There are those who do not talk nor do act,
There are those who keep talking of the fact,
And there are those who do, but never found
Are those who both talk and do in the round.
A man can simply not talk while he works
And talking always means that a man shirks.
The rule may not hold for a woman though.
She might do both things a man cannot show.
But here we see that silent shirkers may
Be once forgiven though without their pay.
Alas, they also go to gaol to spend
Their time in doing what they could not lend.

3 The second came, to whom the owner

Said "Welcome, my vinedresser loner!
Where is the produce that you owe?
Since you are well-verse in the show
The vineyard I let you must glow
With produce." The second replied,
"O sir, your vineyard's set aside
In waste, because I've pruned no wood
Or worked the soil the way I should.
It's borne no fruit and so I fail
To have the fruit to fill your pail."
So the man called the third and said
In wonder, "You said you were led
By the man to whom I let out
The second vineyard to stay stout
In cultivation it aright.
Then how can it be in my sight
The second vineyard bears no fruit,
Since all is of one soil to boot?"

I finally find the fourth man alive:
He is the godly type, the one to strive
To know and speak and do, and he's the man
Who owned the vineyards and came with the plan
To lease them to three workers who would take
Care of his vines and vineyards in his stake.
He is the man who talks and does as well,
The owner and the grasper of the spell.
This is the righteous and the perfect guy,
The goal of every dervish that I spy.
Beloved, make me industrious as You,
Who made the universe without a crew,
But if You do, Beloved, give me the grace
To say and do and make in every place.

4 The third replied, "Sir, vines are not
Repaired by talk alone in plot,
But he must sweat a shirt each day
Who wants to make a vineyard pay.
And how shall your vineyard that way
Bear fruit, sir, if his only way
Is wasting time in talk at bay?
It's certain, sir, if he had put
In practice his teaching to root,
He would have succeeded a foot.
But I who cannot talk so much
Have given you the rent to touch
For two years. He with better claim
Might have produced for five years' aim."
The owner became angry then,
And with scorn then addressed the men.

“So you've done a great job in not
Pruning the wood, ploughing the lot,
And you deserve a great reward!”
He called his servant and had him
Whipped without mercy and in dim
Gaol under a harsh guard put him,
And whipped him every day and did
Not set him free before the bid
Of all his friends who begged the kid.”

The punishment is greater on the folk
Who know and do not what they should for broke.
The ignorant gets off with gaol sentence
And work assigned to do him in his penance.
But those who know and talk but do not do
And sent to gaol to be whipped by the crew
Of ruffians who by law retain such places
And keep the prisoners caught in their traces.
Beloved, I quickly come repenting how
I've long neglected pruning fork and plough,
And beg another year to word the field
In hopes that next year sees a better yield.
If strength remain and rain comes in the wake,
Perhaps I'll avoid gaol and the whip's rake!

Barnabas 77

1 Indeed I tell you, on the day
Of judgement many then shall say
To God, "Lord, we have preached and taught
By Your Law." Against them unwrought
The stones shall cry out, saying: "When
You preached to others, with your pen
And tongue you condemned yourselves, you
Workers of wickedness in crew."
"As God lives," Jesus said "he who
Knows the truth and works the false view
Shall be punished with punishment
So great that Satan himself sent
Shall almost in pity repent.
Tell me, now has our God given
The Law for us to know and live in?
Indeed I tell you, all the knowledge
Is just in view of wisdom's foliage
That carries out all that it knows.
Tell me, if someone at the table
Full of good food and yet is able
To take in hand unclean things there,
Is he not mad and unaware?"
“Yes, surely,” the disciples share.

I have a friend or two that does eat pork,
Unclean by mortal law and dirty fork,
And I am loath to criticize the bloke
Because of anger that such words evoke.
Such people know not to take a dog's price
Or prostitute's into the temple twice,
So why they want to eat pork's beyond me.
I'm not proficient in gastronomy.
But speaking of a dog's price, I remind
Myself my grandson's dog, and one unkind,
Loves ham of swine beyond a lovely thing
And when it gets some it will nearly sing.
Let those who eat the greasy unclean meat
At least wipe their hands on the dog fur neat.

2 Then Jesus said "Oh mad beyond
All madmen are you to abscond,
O man, that with your understanding
Know heavenly sites, but with hands landing
Rather on earth for choice, and with
Your understanding shunning myth
Know God, and yet set your desire
Upon the world and to acquire;
And with your understanding know
The delights of paradise show,
And with your works choose miseries
Of hell where you will never freeze.
Courageous warrior that leaves sword
And takes the scabbard to ungored!
Don't you know that the one who goes
In the dark night hopes for the glows
Of light, but rather to see where
The good path leads so he'll go there
In safety to the shelter's share?

3 O world of misery, to be
A thousand times despised debris!
Since our God by His holy prophets
Has aye desired to grant the profits
Of knowing the way to His land
And to the rest beneath His hand.
But you, one wicked do not want
To enter in, but worse to daunt
Despise the light and living font!
The camel's parable is true:
It does not like the clear in view
Of water to drink, since it will
Not want to see its ugly frill.
So the ungodly to work ill:
He hates the light, lest what he makes
Of wickedness and for its sakes

Should once appear. But he who gets
Wisdom and runs into debts,
Failing to do the good and more
Uses wisdom for evil store,
Is like the one who gets a gift
And uses such a gift to lift
Against the giver killing drift.”

I did not know the grave fault camels grieve
To see their vain reflection and receive
A weight of shame because of ugly face.
Somehow I doubt that Jesus's word of grace.
At least I know that dogs do not care which
Kind of face graces them upon the pitch,
But are enthusiastic just to share
A good romp in the freshest kind of air.
I flee the light that would reveal my woes,
And so I'm worse than camel on my toes,
Unless of course the master's speaking true
About the camel and reflection's rue.
Beloved, let light reveal a well-swept room
Within my heart and save me from my doom.

Barnabas 78

1 Indeed I tell you, God did not
Have mercy on Satan in plot
When he fell, but when Adam fell
Had full compassion on him well.
So let this be warning enough
Of the fate of the one who's rough
To know good yet does wicked stuff.”
2 Then Andrew said “O master mine,
It's better to leave the design
Of learning not to fall from line.”
3 Jesus replied, “If the world's good
Without the sun, and if man could
Get along better without eyes,
And the soul without wisdom's guise,
Then it's a good thing not to know.
Indeed I tell you, bread in show
Is not so good for timely life
As learning for eternal life.
Do you not know that God commands
To learn both with the mind and hands?
For so God says 'Ask of the old
And they will teach you what they've told.'
And of the Torah God has said
'Keep My command before eye led,
And when you sit and when you walk
Think on it.' So whether it's good

Not to learn, know now what you could.
Unblessed is everyone despising
That wisdom, he'll not be arising
Into eternal life's surprising."

Bravo! The Decalogue in Torah finds
A place in the discourse that captures minds
Before the prophet and sweet Jesus set
To listen to the sweeter words they met.
Let me learn with the mind and hand as well
To carry out the dear commandments' spell
And find my way where angel guides rehearse
Commands to guide my feet from the worse.
So let me learn at last eternal life
Away from sects and sectarian strife,
And walk the straight way that all faiths proclaim
The way to life and truth and heaven's fame.
If that can be learned from such men of old
That Jesus speaks of, then let me be told.

4 James so replied, "O master, we
Know that Job did not learn in fee
From one who taught, nor Abraham,
And yet they became without sham
Both saints and prophets." Jesus said
In answer, "Truly I am led
To tell you that the one who's come
From the bridegroom's family and home
Does not need invitation sent
Out to the wedding. He's present
In the house where the wedding's held,
But those who live in distance spelled.
Don't you know that God's prophets are
In God's house of grace without bar
From mercy, and so have Torah
Of God in evidence in paw?
As David our ancestor states
About this matter as relates:
The Law of his God's in his heart,
So his path shall not fail from start.
5 Indeed I tell you that our God
When He created human clod
Not only made him righteous, but
Put in his hart a light unshut
To show him what's appropriate
To worship God and not be late.
So even if this light grow dim
After sin, it does not leave him.
And ever nation has this wish
To worship God, though in the squish

They've lost God and serve false belying
Gods even though they have been trying.
That's why it's needful that a man
Be taught about prophets in plan
Of God, for they make clear the way
As they teach not to go astray
From paradise, our country true,
By serving God in what they do,
Just as it's needful that he who
Has sore eyes must be guided too
And helped along the way in view."

The Torah shows that Noah could have taught
The prophet Abraham all that he'd got,
For Abraham was well grown by the year
That Noah died before the Lord in fear.
But David shows the right way when he notes
That every prophet has Your law and dotes
On teaching sent directly from his Lord.
None of them needs a teacher and adored.
Write on my heart like You did in the days
Of Abraham and David to his praise.
The new words of the covenant on heart,
The same as those once written for their part
On tables of stone back in Sinai's hour.
Write on my heart the words of faith and power.

Barnabas 79

I James answered, "And how shall they teach,
These prophets, if they're out of reach
And dead; and how shall he be taught
Who has no knowledge of what wrought
The prophets?" Jesus answered fair,
"Their doctrine is written down there,
It ought to be studied with care,
For it is in the place to you
Of every prophet come in view.
I tell you now the thing that's true,
The one who will despise the book
Of prophecy, disdains in nook
Not just the prophet, but also
The God who made the prophet go.
But in regard to such as who
Do not know of the prophet true,
As are the nations, I tell you
That if there lives in those lands' view
A man who lives as his heart show,
Not doing to others below
What he would not have others do
To him, and giving to the other

What he would get back from the brother,
Such a man shall not be forsaken
By God in gracious mercy taken.

If every prophet ought to be studied with care,
And not disdain or despise anywhere
Prophetic books, I fear the new Islam
I see arising is not the old balm.
The Jew and Christian who deride the book
Last taught also should take another look.
All prophets write to enhance and apply
The Decalogue between the crystal sky.
Beloved, I read the prophets that I find
With love and faith and respect for their kind,
And do not share the battle raging fast
Between the fearful and ignorant caste.
I flee to You for solace from the way
The canards try to box You in the grey.

2 That's why at death, if not some sooner,
God will show and give him the tuner
Of His Law with His mercy too.
Perhaps you think God's brought in view
The Law for love of law in stew?
But that is certainly not true.
But rather God's given His Law
So humankind might put his paw
To do good for love of God's awe.
So if God finds a man who does
For love of Him good works, for cause
Of that shall He despise his claws?
No, surely not, but rather He
Will love him more than those in spree
To whom He gave His Law in fee.

3 I give you for an example here.
There was a man who had great gear,
And in his lands some did appear
Producing only fruitless smear.
As he was walking on a day
Through such a patch of desert grey,
He found among the thorny spray
A plant of fruits sweet in array.
He then exclaimed to see the sight:
"Now how does this plant bring to light
These fine fruits? Surely I shall not
Have it cut down among the plot,
Nor thrown in the flames with the rot."
He called his servants to come dig
It up and sit it out with fig
And vine in his garden's delight.

In the same way, I tell you true,
That our God shall preserve the crew
From flames of hell of those who do
All righteousness, no matter who."

Let me do good for love of You, Beloved,
With spade in and and well and garden-gloved.
I love Your law when I hear cantillated
Its cadences rise sweetly unabated.
It's only when the promise fails to be
And the commandment falls down wickedly
That I turn from Your Decalogue with grief.
Create in me love for my unbelief.
Beloved, the vine is the garden's delight
And not the flames of hell come into sight.
I too prefer the promise and the rose
To punishment after the power's pose.
So rise to good and let Your love create
Good deeds from my hands of a reprobate.

Barnabas 80

1 "Tell me, where did Job live but by
Idolaters in Uz *on sly*.
And at the time of the flood, what
Does Moses write *of the door shut*?
Tell me. He says "Noah indeed
Found grace before God *in his creed*."
Our father Abraham had one
Ancestor without a faith done,
For he made and worshipped false gods.
Lot lived among most wicked clods.
And Daniel as a youth to be
With Ananias, and the free
Azarias and Misael,
Were taken captives in the spell
Of Nebuchadnezzar, and they
Were just two years old on the day
When they were taken far away,
And they were raised among the sway
Of idol-worshippers to play.
As God lives, and even as the fire
Burns dry things and turns on the pyre
To flame without distinguishing
Between the olive and the wing
Of cypress or the palm to fling,
So our God has mercy on each
Who does the righteous thing in reach,
And makes no difference between Jew,
Or Scythian or Greek man too,
Or Ishmaelite among the crew.

I was just three myself when I raised fit
That I'd not eat pork, pig as I called it,
And with frustration my dad cried aloud,
It is not pig but fig from trees unbowed.
So if I knew the difference then, I guess
The four Hebrews might have at two address
Enough to demand pulse of eunuch and
Win the approval of the righteous band.
And still I doubt the text and think the swell
Not quite consistent with Daniel as well.
Beloved, whether the youths were two or twenty,
I praise them for their choices, they had plenty
On plate to choose from besides pulse and peas,
And lentils and of course both bread and cheese.

2 But do not let your heart stop there,
O James, because where God sends share
Of prophet, you must set aside
Your own judgement and come to bide
In what the prophet says and not
Inquire of the prophetic plot:
“Why does he say the such and such,
Why does he forbid us so much
And why command all things to touch?”
But say “This is the will of God.
So God commands upon the sod.”
Now what did God say to Moses
When Israel would despise Moses?
They've not despised you for their bliss,
But they've despised Me in the tryst.
Indeed I tell you that men ought
To spend all their lives to be taught
To work well, not to speak or read.

Those who despise Muhammad in the grid
Of the sweet Christian far right on the skid
Despise the God they pretend that they serve,
As do those who from the true Islam swerve
To commit violence on innocent.
Beloved, rise up and look out from Your tent.
Those who despise the books of prophets past
In every land and time and such out cast
Despise the very God they think is theirs,
And turn their backs of His faith unawares.
Let me hold fast to Bible and Qur'an,
And to each prophet's writings from the dawn
Of time where You have shown the way to go,
The good, the beautiful, and true to show.

3 Now tell me which of Herod's staff
Would not try to serve without gaff
To know what pleases him the most?
Woe to the world that takes in boast
To please the body that is clay
And excrement to throw away,
And without being taught forgets
The service of God to hedge bets,
The God who has made all things here,
Who's blessed for ever to appear.

There have been days, I know, Beloved, for me
When I've served more and without chastity
The body and left the immortal soul
To die of thirst and so forgot the goal.
The clay and excrement that seem to glow
With pleasure are a thing to take in tow,
But that's a pleasure hard here to maintain
Among the fools and well as the insane.
There have been days, Beloved, but let them be
Long past and never return here to me,
But let my love of flesh be fed aright
To feed the soul and rise up in the light.
Then I shall have compassion on the crowd
That teems about the things that You've allowed.

Barnabas 81

1 Tell me, would it have been a sin
So great on the priests' part in bin
If when they carried on their shoulders
The ark of God's witness like boulders
They'd let it fall down on the ground?
The disciples to hear the sound
Were trembling, for they knew that God
Had killed Uzzah upon the sod
For wrongly touching ark of God.
So they said "Grievous be such sin."
Then Jesus said "As God shall win
To live, it is a greater sin
To forget God's word, by which He
Made all things, and by which in fee
He offers you eternal life."
And after having said this rife,
Jesus came to pray in this wise:
"Tomorrow we must make our tries
To pass into Samaria's land,
For so is God's holy command
Come to me by the angel's hand."

When Uzzah died beside the ark the sin

Was touching holy things and to begin
By his forgetting the command of God
By a man bound to earth and to the sod.
So what's the greater sin, to drop the ark
Or touch it in a cow cart in the park?
Jesus says the great sin's not in the doing,
But in neglecting Word of God ensuing.
I bear no ark on shoulder, I bear no
Ark on a cow cart as I come and go,
But let me bear the covenant unspoken,
Unwritten on a stone and yet unbroken,
Upon the tables of my fleshly heart,
And let my flesh live in its holy art.

2 Early at morn upon a day,
Jesus arrived near the well's sway
Which Jacob dug and gave away
To his son Joseph for a bay.
So Jesus who was very tired,
Sent his disciples as inspired
To buy food in the city hired.
He sat down by the well to rest
Upon the stone of the well's crest.
And see, a woman of the town
Samaria came there walking down
To the well to draw water's crown.
Jesus said to the woman there,
"Give me a drink, a little share."
The woman answered, "Are you not
Ashamed to be a Hebrew sought
And ask me for a drink when I
Am a Samaritan to vie?
Jesus then gave her in reply,
"O woman, if you knew who he
Is that asks you a drink for free,
Perhaps you would have asked of him
For drink." The woman answered grim,
"Now how should you give me a drink,
Since you've no pot here at the brink
To draw up water, no, nor rope,
And the well's deep and without hope?"

I ask if true faith is not to remember
A forefather with tender glow in ember,
And come down to the well he dug to drink
Clear waters continuing there to sink.
Traditions of the pure are pure and right
And lead their descendant in sight
Upon the golden path of dusty light
From day to day and link to silver link.

Beloved, I stop beside the well and brink
And ask no living water, not a bit,
But stay well satisfied without a fit
To keep the Decalogue, remembering it
As loved by father and my mother too,
And by their ancestors forever true.

3 Jesus replied, "O woman dear,
Whoever drinks this water clear
Of this well comes to thirst again,
But whosoever drinks a bit
Of the water I give him fit
Will never thirst again, for then
To those who're thirsty they give drink
So that they come up in a wink
To life eternal by the link."
Then said the woman, "Sir, give me
This water that you have in fee."
Jesus replied, "Go call your man,
I'll give you both a drink in can."
The woman said "I've got no man."
Jesus replied, "You speak truth well,
For you've had five husbands to tell,
And the one that you have today
Is not your husband in his way."

What registry does Jesus recommend
By making a distinction here to fend
Of the last man she lived with as no man
Allowed to her by law and divine plan.
The marriage contract that he recognized
Was that of the Samaritan disguised.
Is her husband no husband now because
The Samaritan priest gave it no laws?
And if not priest, then the contract she made
With the man with no clergy that was paid,
Was not that the same as in times to come
Among the Muslims who contract in sum?
I do not understand why five are well
And legal and the last a demon's spell.

4 The woman was confounded when
She heard this and avoiding men
Said "Sir, I notice that you are
A prophet, so tell me for par,
The Hebrews pray on Zion's hill
Within the temple build by will
Of Solomon, Jerusalem,
And say that there alone in hem
Shall grace be found and mercy's gem.

Our people worship on these hills
And say Samaria fulfils
Alone criterion to pray.
Who're the true worshippers today?"

I too have searched through the sectarian mill
For the right church to fit my pew and bill,
And found no single one that kept to all
The ten commandments written on the wall.
One might keep to the one true God and yet
Forget the Sabbath or kill any met
The government decided it was right
To slaughter for what state's reason in sight.
One might keep Sabbath and take trinities
Of gods and goddesses in coloured frieze
Upon iconostasis or the wall.
Others may leap and dance and have a ball
And never once recite the Decalogue,
But laugh and eat and live high on the hog.

Barnabas 82

1 Then Jesus gave a sigh and wept,
And said "Woe to Judea kept,
Because you boast and say aloud,
'The temple of the Lord unbowed,
The temple of the Lord in crowd,'
And live as though there were no God,
But just for pleasure and the pod
Of worldly profit on the sod,
Because this woman judgement day
Will condemn all of you in sway
Of hell, for this wench seeks to know
How to find God's grace and not slow
His mercy on men here below."

Though I give some respect to father's show
Of faith and what my ancestors may grow,
I repent that I seek not waters' glow
That springs from the new fountains on the go.
I give a token of respect to that
Neat doctrine that my grandfather found pat,
But then turn to my Lord and beg the treat
Of living waters flowing fast and sweet.
Beloved, let not Your prophet weep for me
And pain his heart for my iniquity.
Instead wash out the busy pain and toil
That soils my heart and hand before the foil.
Then I shall stand in judgement's laughing crew
Protected in the shadow of Your true.

2 And turning to the wench he said
"O wench, you Samaritans bred
Do worship what you do not know,
But we Hebrews worship below
What's known to us. I tell you true,
That God is spirit and truth too,
And so in spirit and in truth
He must be worshipped and in truth.
For God's own promise was once made
There in Jerusalem's parade,
And in Temple of Solomon,
And not in other place for fun.
But have faith in my word, a time
Will come when God will stop the crime
And give His mercy in a town
Other than it, till without frown
Folk can worship Him in truth's way
In any place they come to stay.
And God in every place will take
True prayer and for His mercy's sake.

Jesus claims that the prayer Samaritan
Prayed was lifted to one outside their scan,
Whom they knew not nor could know to a man.
Now there are some who claim that they are right
To worship with the Hebrew name in sight
While others bow and crawl beneath the night.
Samaritans knew better than that crowd
The name Jehovah God as best allowed.
Whatever form they used, we can be sure
That it was formalized rightly and pure.
So if Samaritans prayed to the one
They did not know, what can now here be done?
The Sacred Names movement is damned by all
That Jesus says by Barnabas in thrall
As well as by Gospels canonical.
Hurrah Cullay! Absolute truth has won!

3 The woman answered, "We await
Messiah coming, and not late
When he comes he will teach our rate."
Jesus replied, "Do you know this,
O woman, that he will not miss,
But that Messiah comes in state?"
She answered, "Yes, sir." Then the heart
Of Jesus rejoiced for her part,
And he said "As I see, you are,
O woman, faithful and a star.
Know then Messiah's faith will save
Every elect of God and brave,

So it's needful that you should know
The coming of Messiah's show."
The woman said, "O Lord, maybe
You are the Messiah I see."
Jesus replied, "I am indeed
Sent to the house of Israel's seed,
A prophet of salvation's creed.
But after me there shall arise
Messiah appointed from skies,
Sent by God to all in the world,
And for whom God made and unfurled
Creation and not to despise.

Here Barnabas departs from what is written
In John, and for that failure he is smitten
By both the Christian and Islamic creed,
Both of which see Jesus the Christ indeed.
The one who teaches that Muhammad came
As the Messiah in his desert fame
Denies the basics of Islamic crew.
And yet the Muslim claims Barnabas true.
I think the sects of men always find ways
To be ones inconsistent in their praise.
Irrational is faith and doubt as well,
Believers and the unbelieving spell.
I cling to the commandments and pray that
You save us all despite our blindness flat.

4 "And then through all the world will God
Be worshipped, and mercy from rod
Received, so year of jubilee,
Which now comes every century,
Shall by Messiah be reduced
To every year in every place."
Then the wench left her pot unsluiced,
Away into the town to race
And give the news of what she'd heard
From Jesus that had her heart stirred.

The truth is that through all the world in time
God has been worshipped in both prose and rhyme
By men and women since the coming of
Muhammad to win over people's love.
The millions bow before the divine throne
And claim that You are God, and You alone.
In that they say the truth and the truth fair
To all the world and to the listening air.
Whether the Christ once promised with the one
Who spoke to the wench by Jacob's well won,
Or whether the Messiah is the man

Who rose in Makkah by the divine plan,
I love and follow every one You sent
To call me to the Decalogue You meant.

Barnabas 83

1 Whilst the woman was talking to
Jesus came his disciples due,
And marvelled that Jesus spoke to
A woman. Yet no one told him:
“Why are you talking to a *dim*
Samaritan woman *and prim?*”
So when the woman went away,
They said “Master, come eat from tray.”
Jesus replied: “I’m satisfied
With other victuals beside.”
Then the disciples asked each other
“Maybe some passing travelling brother
Has talked with Jesus and gone in
To find him food *from cart or bin*.
And they questioned the one who writes
This narrative to ask insights:
“Has there been any one here passing,
O Barnabas, with food *and amassing*
For the master?” This writer spoke
In answer, “There has been no bloke
Except the woman that you saw,
Who brought this empty jar *in paw*
To fill with water *from the spa*.”
Then the disciples stood amazed
To see what would happen *unphased*
From Jesus words. So Jesus spoke:
“You do not know that true food’s to
Do the will of *your* God *in view*,
Since it’s not bread that sustains man
And gives him life *in greater span*,
But rather the word of God by
His will. And that’s the reason why
The holy angels do not eat,
But live nourished by God’s will’s *treat*.
And so we, Moses and Elijah
And one more *from whom they would hide you*,
Have forty days and forty nights
Been without any food in sights.”

The forty-day retreat goes back at least
To Noah with the bird and every beast
If not to Enoch walking with You where
You found the cool of evening to be fair.
But forty days without food but the word
Is something that may indeed keep heart stirred,

But I would doubt my willingness to try.
I'm such a eat-and-drinking sort of guy.
Beloved, Your sent one had a taste and treat
To talk to a woman come off the street,
While I speak to no one at all unless
It is a greeting passing and a guess.
Age makes the tongue go dry, so I confess,
But Jesus was much younger then to greet.

2 Raising his eyes then Jesus said
"How far off is the harvest spread?"
Said the disciples in reply,
"Three months." Said Jesus, "Look on high,
How the mountain is white with corn;
Indeed I tell you without scorn,
Today's a great harvest unshorn,
"And then he pointed to the crowd
That had come to see him in cloud.
For the wench had gone back to town
And praised aloud Jesus' renown
By saying "Folk, come see a new
Prophet sent of God in the view
Of the house of Israel as stirred,"
And she told them all she had heard
From Jesus. When they had come there,
They begged Jesus to remain where
They lived. And he came in the place
And stayed two days, healing with grace
All the sick, and teaching about
The kingdom of God *without shout*.
Then the folk addressed the female,
"We have more faith in what he said
And what signs he did to prevail
Than we do in your words instead,
For he is surely God's true saint,
A prophet sent for salvation
To those who have faith without taint
In him and the victory he's won."

The prophets harvest their believers when
They come to teach and live here among men.
So Jesus too speaks of the harvest near
And all the folk to welcome him with fear.
Samaritans are ready to adore
The prophet come and maybe even more
That the Jews on his home turf and resigned.
The people can be evil or then kind.
Beloved, Your kingdom comes to one and all
In the small voice that speaks Your words in call.
One may believe the witness of a few,

But true faith comes directly down from You.
And so I listen to the words recited
Of Scripture and I am no more benighted.

3 After the midnight prayer, then came
Jesus' disciples near his flame,
And he told them, "This night will be
In time of the Messiah's fee,
God's Messenger, the jubilee
Each year that now by century,
Appears to humankind for free.
That's why I don't want us to sleep,
But let us read our prayers and keep
Bowing our head a hundred times,
In veneration without mimes
To our God, mighty, merciful,
Who's blessed eternally and full,
And at each prostration intone:
'I confess you our God alone,
Without beginning, without end,
For by Your grace You once gave being
To everything that we're now seeing,
And by Your justice You'll make end
Of all; You have no likeness here
Among men, since You don't appear
Subject to motion or to change
In Your infinite goodness' range.
Have mercy on us, for You've made
Creating us, and we are stayed
Works of Your hand set on parade.'"

What can I add, Beloved, to that great prayer
That vies with ayat-al-kursi upon the air
Sweet with perfumes and heavy with Your grace?
The words transport me up before Your face.
What can I sing after that tune sublime
That goes beyond all things written in rhyme?
The syllables in silent overtures
Of silver sink until my heart concurs.
Beloved, You are indeed one God alone
And there is never other on Your throne
Of majesty and infinite display.
Before my seed of faith had ever grown
To reach the branching mustard, the birds flown
From it gave better voice than all my lay.

Barnabas 84

1 The prayer done, Jesus said "Give thanks
To God because He's given in ranks
To us this night great mercy; for

He's made return the time in score
 That must come to pass in the night,
 In that we've laid prayer in one site
 With God's Messenger, and I've heard
 The sound come of that blessed word."
 The disciples rejoiced aloud
 At hearing this, and said in crowd:
 "Master, teach us some things tonight."
 Then Jesus said "Have you once seen
 Dung mixed with balsam to be keen?"
 They answered, 'No, Sir, for no one
 Is so insane to have it done."
 2 "I tell you now in this world some
 Are greater madmen than have come,"
 Said Jesus, "because they would intrude
 In God's service the world's works crude.
 They do so to such an extent
 That many even blameless bent
 Have been deceived by Satan's thrall,
 And while at prayer mixed there withal
 Their worldly business, with result
 They've become to God an insult.
 Say, when you do ablutions fair
 Before prayer, do you so with care
 That no unclean thing touch you bare?
 Of course you do. But what then when
 You're reading prayer? You wash your soul
 From sins through God's mercy in toll.
 Would you be willing then in prayer
 To speak of worldly things in share?
 Be careful not to do so, for
 Each worldly word becomes a score
 Of devil's dung upon the soul
 Of one who speaks such things in goal."

The mixing of excreta and perfume
 Is stupid, and yet so many make room
 For such a mix in prayer as well as deed,
 Not to mention the reciting of creed.
 And yet methinks that my Creator grand
 Did such a mix when He took it in hand
 To form man of the dust upon the ground
 And breathe life into the man's nostrils round.
 The fact is that the dung is found each day
 In every man's flesh body of decay,
 While in the same flesh temple is the light
 Upon the inner chamber where the right
 Of Your throne stands in odours sweet to smell
 And in the prayers of saints arising well.

2 Then the disciples trembled, since
He spoke so strongly to make wince.
And they said "Master, what shall we
Do if when we're in prayer's degree
A friend comes by and speaks to us?"
Jesus replied, "Don't make a fuss,
But let him wait until prayer's end."
Bartholomew said "To offend
Him so he goes away again,
When he sees we don't speak to men?"
Jesus replied, "If he's offended,
Believe me he's not one befriended
Nor a believer, but instead
An unbeliever and the fed
Of Satan. Tell me, if you went
To speak with Herod's curry sent
And found him talking with the king,
Would you be offended at sting
If he made you wait? No indeed.
But you'd take comfort to succeed
In viewing your friend in good grace
Of the king. Not true?" Said apace
Jesus to his disciples' face.

There have been times I saw a friend and passed
To greet him while he spoke to someone classed
And found he passed me by without a nod
Or word to comfort me ensconced in pod.
There was one time that I was talking too,
And a man wanted to see me on cue,
And I merely gave greeting and let know
That I was then too busy for his show.
Beloved, I do imagine in my rate
When I speak You have never made me wait.
That's what You and imaginary friends
Have in common and not to make amends.
You're always both available when I
Turn to You or to such a friend to cry.

3 They answered, "It is true indeed."
Then Jesus said "I say with speed,
That every one who prays must speak
With God Himself. Should you then seek
To leave off speaking with God so
You can speak to a man in show?
Is it right that your friend for this
Should be offended and amiss,
Because you reverence God the more?
Believe me, if he'll be offended
Because you make him wait unended,

He's a good slave of evil tended.
For this is what the devil wants,
That God forsake man as he vaunts.
As God lives, in every good work
He who fears God ought then to shirk
The works of the world and so not
Corrupt the good work of his plot."

Does Jesus not know that You have no time
To limit You to puppetry and mime?
The interruption of a passer-by
Of one in prayer, though long or just one sly,
Means nothing to Your grand reception hall.
You are not left to wait for him at all.
You are grand and wait for no time or face,
But are eternal in Your will and grace.
So Jesus' words are nonsense though they seem
Appropriate and logical as cream.
He treats You like a king, no more or less,
Forgetting Your divinity's address.
Though Barnabas is valued to the core,
Sometimes his points could be refined much more.

Barnabas 85

"When a man works ill or talks ill,
If anyone goes to fulfil
Correction of his evil work,
What does such one achieve to irk?"
Asked Jesus. The disciples said
"He does well, serving God instead,
Who always hinders evil smirk
Done by such a one as a quirk?"
The disciples replied, "He does
Well, since he serves God at the spell,
Who always seeks to hinder evil,
As the sun always with upheaval
Seeks to chase darkness and to quell."
Jesus said "And by the same token
I tell you when one works unbroken
Or speaks well, whoever would seek
To hinder him, under the weak
Pretext of anything not better,
He serves the devil to the letter,
And furthermore becomes his mate.
For the devil is never late
To come and hinder each good thing.

Let me not hinder the good in my state,
As many do, because of jealous hate.
I do not wish to be the devil's mate

Or league with him at all, or soon or late.
The serving of the devil is a thing
I do not wish to do on foot or wing,
So my Beloved, I beg Your mercy now
To keep me from the devil and his trough.
But if I hinder not the good, let me
Of the hook of reproving evil spree,
For every time a person says a word
Against the evil thing that has occurred
He lives to suffer for his speaking loud.
Let me stay hidden in a righteous shroud.

2 “But what shall I say to you now?
I’ll speak as Solomon said how,
Who was a prophet, saint, and friend
Of God: ‘Of thousands whom you bend
To your acquaintance, just know one
To be your friend when all is done.’”
3 Then Matthew said “Then we shall not
Have love for any in the plot.”
Jesus replied, “Indeed I say
To you it’s unlawful to stay
In hate of anything but sin,
To the extent Satan himself,
Who is God’s creature *and not elf*,
But rather as the foe of God.
Do you know the reason *in pod*?
I’ll tell you. He was made by God,
And all that God’s created good
And perfect is. Accordingly,
Whoever hates the creature’s *fee*
Hates also the Creator’s *glee*.
But a friend is a rarely thing,
One not to be found on the wing,
And easy to lose at a sting.
For the friend will not suffer such
As contradiction at the touch
Of him whom he comes to love much.
Beware, be cautious, do not choose
For friend one who comes to refuse
To love him whom you love and clutch.
Don’t you now know what a friend means?
A friend is only one who gleans
The healing of the soul. And so,
Just as one rarely comes to know
A good physician who knows well
The illnesses and knows the spell
To apply medicines to heal,
So also friends are rare in *spiel*
Who know one’s faults and how to guide

From error to the better side.
But herein is a wicked way,
That there are many friends in sway
Who pretend not to see the faults
Of their friend, but excuse the waltz,
And others defend them with such
Pretexts as worldly matters touch,
And even worse, some friends invite
And help their friends to error's plight,
Whose judgement will be like their night.
Take heed not to receive such men
As friends, for in truth they again
Are foes and slayers of the soul,
And come to play an evil role.

Hate not the devil but the devil's sin
Is Jesus' word to hear and to begin.
Hate not the devil who's God's creature too,
But love all creatures God has made in view.
There are some who believe the time will come
When Satan shall be reconciled to hum
Again with angels on the silver cloud
And on the sea of glass with his first crowd.
Be what Your will may be, Beloved, and I
Shall be satisfied with the way You try.
Forgive in mercy whom You will forgive,
And then let live eternally, let live
In gardens of Your peace and grace and joy.
Bless every naughty girl and naughty boy.

Barnabas 86

“Let your friend be the kind who can
Receive correction without ban
As well as giving. Just as he
Wants you to forsake evil spree
For love of God, so he shall be
Content that you leave him and all
Things for God's love and at His call.
2 “But tell me, if a man does not
Know how to love God in his lot,
How shall he know to love himself?
And how shall he know on his shelf
How to love others, since he fails
To know how to love his own sails?
It truly cannot be. Therefore
When you choose a friend on your score,
(Indeed he is supremely poor
Who has no friend at all), see that
You think first, not of where he sat
On family tree, nor pedigree,

Nor his fine house, nor pageantry,
Nor rhetoric, for easily
You'll be deceived and wickedly.
3 But look how he fears God, how he
Despises earthly things, how he
Loves good works, and above all how
He hates his own flesh, and so then now
You'll find a true friend on the bough,
If he above all things fear God,
Despising the world's empty pod,
If he's engaged in good works too,
And hate his own body in view
As a cruel foe. Nor yet shall you
Love such a friend in such a way
That your love come in him to stay,
And so be caught in idol's sway.
But love him as a gift that God
Has given you upon the sod,
For so shall God adorn him then
With greater favour once again.
Indeed I tell you, one who's found
A true friend has come on the ground
Of the delight of paradise,
And key of paradise in guise."

To get a friend is not the product of
A calculating spirit, but of love.
A friend may well be one with wealth and kine
As well as a poor man of righteous line.
It's all a matter of the way things click
And whether he is there through thin and thick.
To get a friend comes by surprise, not plan,
And is not sought as some sort of a man.
Beloved, I have been friends with one or two,
But as I take my past life into view,
Methinks I made more mistakes than I might
For not retaining friends that once looked right,
But simply slipped into oblivion
Through lack of care and interest in the fun.

4 Thaddaeus then replied, "But if
It happens a man or a stiff
May have a friend who is not such
As you have described and to touch,
O master? What ought he to do?
Should he forsake his friend untrue?"
Jesus replied, "He ought to do
As does the mariner in crew
With the ship, who sails it as long
As he finds profit without wrong,

But when he sees it take a loss,
Then he forsakes the albatross.
So shall you do with your friend worse
Than you, in what he is a curse
To you, leave him if you would not
Be left out of God's mercy's lot."

Most people leave a friend when things go better
In wealth and status, they break friendship's fetter.
With each advancement in society
And in career, most change fraternity.
Of course one can keep those of lower class
In spirit avuncular and less crass.
But mostly one must change one's set of friends
When one advances through the loops and bends.
Beloved, I've been a pilgrim on the earth
And never formed a career of such worth
That I needed to exchange friends for new.
But then I've always left behind the few
Friends I had on one continent or land.
So I alone face the morning and stand.

Barnabas 87

"Woe to the world for its offence.
It needs must be that the offence
Will come, because all the world lies
In wickedness *beneath the skies*.
But still woe to that man through whom
The offence comes *and to his doom*.
It would be better for the man
To have a millstone on the span
Of his neck and he should be sunk
Deep down in the sea and to dunk
Than that he should offend his neighbour.
If your eye's an offence in labour
To you, jerk it out. For it's better
For you to go as a regretter
With just one eye to paradise
Than with both eyes not to rejoice
In hill. If your hand or your foot
Offends you, do the same to put;
Because it's better you should go
Into kingdom of heaven's glow
With just one foot or just one hand
Than with two hands and two feet stand
In hell along *with wicked band*."

I sort of had impression that the day
Of resurrection and the splendid ray
Of glory at the coming of the Lord

Would put the wrong aright among the gored.
But if the limb I lose today is lost
Still in heaven's kingdom to eternal cost,
And without foot or hand I must go in,
I think I'd rather keep them with my sin.
I'd rather cut the sin off than the hand
Or foot in heavenly sort of contraband.
Surely, as difficult as it may be
To refrain from the sinful sort of glee,
It is more difficult, yea, harder still
To have the nerve to cut a hand at will.

2 Simon, called Peter: said "Lord, how
Must I do this? It's certain now
That I'll soon be cut up in pieces."
Jesus replied, "Put in releases,
Peter, care of body and right
Away you'll have the truth in sight.
For the one teaching you's your eye,
And the one helping on the sly
To work is your foot, and the one
That serves you is your hand for fun.
So when these become an occasion
For sinful tempting and persuasion,
Leave them, for it's better for you
To enter heaven without a clue,
With few works and in poverty,
Than to go into hell both wise
And with great works and rich in guise.
All that keeps you from serving God,
Cast from you as a man a pod
Throws out for hindering his sight's nod."

There's fundamental misapprehension
In Jesus's fair words when they are done.
It's not the hand or foot that leads man to
The sinful act or putting on a shoe
In gold or crimson: sin comes on the soul
In lust first as James spoke up of its role,
And then in word and act. A thing of heart
Is sin and not an arrow or a dart
In hand and eye to the end from the start.
Beloved, I care not for the hand or foot
Or eye or anything else Jesus put
Before the seed of sin in the heart grown.
I care not for the days of lend and loan.
I care only to be one of Your own.

3 And having said this, Jesus called
Peter close to him unappalled,

And said to him, "If brother thine
Shall sin against you, take design
To go and set him straight. If he
Changes his way, rejoice freely,
For you have gained your brother's share.
But if he does not change, then go
And call again to witnesses
And set him straight once more to show,
And if he does not change his biz,
Go show the congregation's whiz,
And if he does not change it then,
Consider him to be in den
Of unbelief, and so you'll not
Live under the same roof in slot,
You'll not eat at the table where
He sits, and you'll not take a share
In what he says, to the extent
That if you know where he has bent
His way you will not set your foot
In the same pathway where he's put."

The Amish case for shunning's mentioned hear,
But that is not the very thing I fear.
I fear rather the common way men go
To judge another for vain gloried show.
True, mostly men go behind others' back
To tell their evil, not to face in slack.
I too proclaim behind the back of those
Who wronged me publicly for what they chose.
But in the main the ones who blame to face
Do so for quaint prejudices in pace
Than for the true sin of the human race.
It's for a point of fair interpretation
Men criticize, not for the abrogation
Of some commandment clear, not in probation.

Barnabas 88

1 "Watch yourself so you don't consider
Yourself the best of every bidder,
But rather say "Peter, Peter,
If God had not helped you to stir
With His grace, you would be worse than
The sinner and the other man."
Peter replied, "How shall I go
About to straighten out the foe?
In answer Jesus said to him,
"In the same way that you when dim
Would wish correction come from him.
If you wish to be borne with, then
Bear patiently with other men.

Believe me, Peter, when I say
That every time you bear in sway
With mercy, you'll receive that day
God's mercy, and your words bear fruit;
But if you deal with a harsh boot,
You'll be punished in harsh array
By God's own justice come in sway
And shall bear no fruit on your way.
Tell me, Peter, those earthen pots
In which the poor cook their alots,
Do they wash them perhaps with stones
And iron hammers set in groans?
They certainly do not, but in
Hot water. Pots break under sin
Of iron, things of wood are burnt
With fire, but man in mercy learnt.
So when you set your brother right,
Say to yourself, 'Without the sight
Of God in aid, tomorrow I
Shall do worse here under the sky
Than he today has done me by.'

Well Peter has permission to correct
The sinner and the wavering bedecked
With vanity before the coming rain.
He's been instructed how to without pain.
He's been warned not to kick and prod and glow
With pride before iniquity in show,
Nor bash in judgement harlot or the throng
Of men about him all engaged in wrong.
Beloved, give me no mitre nor a crown,
No crosier nor the seat of Peter's frown,
But lead me tenderly about the town
And in my garden where my onions sprout
To keep them from both weeds and thunder shout
Until my little light of life go out.

2 Peter replied, "How many times
Must I forgive my brother's crimes,
O master?" Jesus said *in rhymes*,
"As many times as you would wish
To have forgiveness on your dish."
Peter enquired, "Seven times a day?"
Jesus replied, "Not in that way,
But seventy times seven in sway
Shall you forgive his wayward day.
For he that forgives, to him it
Shall be forgiven, as is fit.
The one who condemns, he himself
Will end on condemnation's shelf."

Then the one who is writing here
Said "Woe to princes, for I fear
They shall all go to hell *on spear*."
Jesus reprov'd him, saying "You
Speak foolishly, Barnabas true.
Indeed I tell you that the bath
Is not so needful without wrath
For body, the bit for the horse,
The rudder for the ship of course,
As the prince needed for the state.
For what did God give Moses rate,
And Joshua and Samuel too,
David and Solomon in crew,
And so many others who passed
Judgement and good judgement too cast?
To such God's given the sword fast
To cast out wickedness at last."

But that's the rub, dear Loved, the sword
Was given to cast wickedness aboard
Out from the hand of criminal and all
Who do the wrong upon the earthly ball.
The sword as given to keep the peace and not
To wage war on the innocent who've got
No way to save themselves from carnal plot
Of government and rulers and the board.
Beloved, see Barnabas in clear-eyed view
Has told the very truth, there are but few
Men of authority who keep the straight
And worthy way of country and of state.
It's Barnabas who's right and not the Lord
Jesus who spoke in favour of ill-scored.

3 Then he who writes this came to say
"Then how should judgement stand in sway,
Condemning and forgiving way?"
Jesus replied, "Not everyone
Is a judge. For to judge alone
Includes condemning from the throne,
O Barnabas. And the judge ought
To condemn the guilty as taught,
Just as a father orders that
A gangrenous limb be cut off flat
From his son, so the body left
May not be gangrenous, bereft."

This Gospel's not one that settles down sweet
With Anabaptist out to beat the feet
Of magistrate, who's placed to judge aright
But lose his own soul by his judgement's plight.

I do admit the judges once appointed
By You Yourself, Beloved, and the anointed,
But not usurpers of this evil day
Since revolution took control and sway.
I do not have faith in democracy
Nor in the right of governments' decree
Against the guilty and the righteous men
Condemned each day to gaol or to the pen.
Let You rule and let rule the one You chose
To mediate Your word to the world's close.

Barnabas 89

1 Peter said "How long must I wait
For my brother's repentant state?"
Jesus replied, "So long as you
Would be waited for, that's the cue."
Peter gave answer, "Not all men
Will understand this thing again.
So speak more clearly, then we'll ken."
Jesus replied, "Wait for your brother
As long as God comes not to smother."
"They will not understand this either,
Said Peter in the way of teether."
Jesus gave answer, "Wait for him
Until he repents from things grim."
2 Then Peter became sad at that,
And so did the others that sat,
Because they did not understand.
So Jesus answered as he scanned,
"If you had good thoughts and as wise,
And knew yourselves in sinners' guise,
You'd not intend to cut from out
Heart mercy on the sinner's bout.
And so I tell you plainly that
The sinner ought to stay on mat
Till he repents, so long as he
Has a soul under his teeth free
To breathe. For so does our God wait
For him, the mighty and the great
In mercy. God has never said
'On the day that the sinner's led
To fast, do alms, lay prayers, and go
On pilgrimage, I'll forgive so.'
That's why many have done those things,
And yet are damned for all their flings.
But he said 'In that hour that he
Bewails his sins, eternally
I'll not remember any more
The share of his iniquity.'
And do you understand the score?"

Said Jesus to their questionings.

Bewailing sin is much to hard a task
For God in grace from humans then to ask
To judge by what both Christian and the great
Ummah of the Islamic people rate.
The Christian will demand atonement made
By human sacrifice and on parade,
The Muslim thinks that everyone is paid
In righteousness by fasting and by alms
And pilgrimage beneath fruitful date palms.
Beloved, You say that Your forgiveness comes
As soon as the soul will forget the sums
And sorrow for the sins of hand and tongue.
I've heard that truth since I was very young,
And yet see fewer every day unstrung.

3 The disciples answered, "Part we
Understand, part not to a tee."
Jesus asked, "What part do you not
Understand in the thing I've taught?"
They answered, "That many who pray
With fasting are damned in the way."
Then Jesus said "Truly I say
To you, that hypocrites as well
As Gentiles make more prayers in spell,
More alms, and more fasts than do those
Who are the friends that God once chose.
But because they do not have faith,
They're not able, like a weak wraith,
To repent for the love of God,
And so they are damned on the sod."
Then John said "Teach, for love of God,
What true faith is under the rod."
Jesus replied, "The time is here
To let the dawning prayer appear."
They got up then and washed them and
Laid prayer to our God on the sand,
Who's blessed for ever and to stand.

The dawn prayer or the noon or evening round
Defined by David in the Psalmly sound
Are good times for repentance on the ground.
Ablutions before prayer are quaintly taught
Long before Muhammad rose up unsought
By the Samaritan and Jew in days
Gone by of penitence and prayer and praise.
Those are the punctuations of day's bound.
Beloved, let me repent from breath to breath.
How shall I else find time before day's death

To raise my penance at so many times
As seven times seventy for as many crimes?
Repentance may become as careful as
The breathing and the heartbeat ever has.

Barnabas 90

I And when the prayer was done at last,
Jesus' disciples came near fast,
And he opened his mouth to speak.
"Come here, John, for today I'll speak
To all of you of what you seek.
Faith is a seal by which God seals
His own elect, which seal of weals
He gave his Messenger, at whose
Hands every one elect will choose
Receiving of the faith. Just so
As God is one, the faith is one.
That's why God before all things other
Having created once the brother
To be His Messenger, gave him
Above all else the faith undim
Which is as were similitude
Of God and of all God has stewed
And said. And so the faithful see
By faith all things, in great degree
Above what one sees with the eye,
Because the eye may err to spy,
Indeed, almost always does err.
But true faith's mistaken never,
Because it has for foundation
God and His word forever done.
Believe me, that by faith are saved
All the elect of God unslaved.
And it is certain that without
Faith it's impossible, no doubt,
For anyone to please God stout.
That's why Satan does not try to
Bring to naught fasting and prayer too,
And alms and pilgrimage when due,
But rather he incites men who
Do not believe to do those things,
For he takes pleasure in the wings
Of men who work without their pay.
But he takes pains diligently
To bring faith to nothing's degree,
That's why faith ought especially
To be guarded diligently.
And the safest way's to let go
The 'Wherefore,' seeing that show
Of 'Wherefore' drove men at the start

Out of Paradise and by art
Changed Satan from an angel fair
Above all beauty to the share
Of a devil in horrors' care."

Though Paradise and glory in its bliss
Are something my poor heart should never miss,
But rather come with fervent mouth to kiss,
I'd be content to walk in Virgil's hell
With Dante, if I could walk in the spell
Of beauty. Beauty is my comfort here,
The opiate of faith that I hold dear,
My refuge from the holocaust I fear,
My rest from labour and ignoble tear.
Beloved, I walk in beauty at the face,
And beauty guides my footsteps in their trace,
And this suffices me for divine grace
Beneath the barren words and falling mace.
And so I find and follow all things well.

2 Then John said "Now, how shall we let
Go of the 'Wherefore' to get set,
Since it's the gate of knowledge met?"
Jesus replied, "No, rather well
'Wherefore' is just the gate of hell."
At that John was silent a spell,
So Jesus added, "When you know
That God has said a thing to show,
Who are you, man, that you should say,
'Wherefore have You said so today,
O God, why have you done that way?'
Shall the clay pot then come to say
To its creator, 'Why have you
Made me to hold water *and stew*
And not balsam?' Indeed I say
To you it's necessary way
To strengthen yourself against each
Temptation with this word I teach,
And say 'God has said so,' or then
'As God wills,' for that way again
You shall live safely *among men*."

The fatalist in fame of Islam rides
Upon the hearing of such words besides.
But it is true, I see, that few are chosen
Among the many left outside and frozen.
Few have the faith that sees beyond the vile
Way that the wicked amass their own pile.
Few, few see global justice at a stroke,
But only there own navel and their croak.

Beloved, the Quaker said speak to the light
Within each man, but I perceive aright
That only the elect have such a flame
And they are few who seek to have no blame.
Beloved, through many or few of elect,
I wish to seal my own fate as unchecked.

Barnabas 91

At this time there was a great row
Throughout Judaea anyhow
Because of Jesus. The Roman
Soldiers, through ways of Satan's plan,
Had stirred up the Hebrews by saying
That Jesus was God come arraying
To visit them. So great was that
Sedition that arose to bat,
That near the Forty Days all there
In all Judaea came to bear
Arms, so that the son rose in share
Against the father, and the brother
Rose up against brother to smother.
Some said that Jesus was God come
Into the world. Others in sum
Said "No, but he's a son of God."
Others said "Not at all in pod,
For God has no similitude
Of man or anything so rude,
And therefore does not beget sons,
But Jesus of Nazareth's runs
Have come to be prophet of God."
This argument came up because
Of great signs Jesus did in paws.

Barnabas makes the phrase the son of God
To rise from superstitious Roman clod,
When in fact it's an expression well known
Among the Jews then to come to Your throne
In hope of the Messiah promised fair
Should come upon the earth and live somewhere.
The son of God does not mean God begets,
But that there will be a man that God sets.
And yet Barnabas is right that the way
Of seeing son of God as God in sway
Did rise among the Romans, and no doubt
Among the superstitious Roman rout.
This Gospel does illuminate the road
Of heresy and how it left its load.

2 To settle the folk it became
Necessary high priest of fame

Should go out in parade clothed in
His priestly garments through the din,
With God's holy name YHWH upon
His forehead, and the ruler drawn,
Pilate, and Herod rode along.
Then three armies assembled strong
In Mizpeh, each one having there
Two hundred thousand men that bare
The sword. And Herod spoke to them,
But at that stratagem
They did not settle down at all.
Then the ruler set to install
And the high priest spoke, saying then,
"Brothers, this war arose again
By the work of Satan in den,
For Jesus is alive, and we
Ought to go to him and freely
Ask him to give testimony
Of himself, and then believe him
According to his word not dim."
3 So at this everyone was still.
And having laid down with a will
Their arms they all embraced each other,
Exclaiming then to one another,
"Forgive me, brother!" On that day
Therefore, each one laid this to heart,
To believe whatever in start
Jesus said. The ruler and the
High priest offered reward in fee
To whoever should come and show
Where Jesus could be found to go.

I see, Beloved, that Your high priest in right
Speaks the truth verily and brings to light
The great reality that You alone
Are God upon the great and sky-clad throne.
Herod and Pilate too are not so bad
As the Gospels in canon show them sad.
The rabble is as guilty then as now,
Manipulated by self-interest's brow.
Beloved, I take the faith the the High Priest
With Your name on his forehead here increased,
And not the faith of Rome or Constantine
Who would make mere men to be men divine.
I gaze aghast at the wars that arise
From the faithlessness of men who're unwise.

Barnabas 92

1 At this time, by the angel's word
Of holiness, we had been stirred

To go with Jesus to the mount
Of Sinai, where to their account
Jesus and his disciples kept
The forty days *of the adept*.

2 When this was past, Jesus came near
To the river Jordan, to steer
Toward Jerusalem. And he
Was seen by one of them who thought
That Jesus was God Himself wrought.
Then shouting out with great joy he
Kept saying "Our God comes to see!"
He reached the city and stirred all
By telling them and to enthral,
"Our God arrives, Jerusalem!
Get ready to receive the gem!"
And he bore witness he had seen
Jesus beside the Jordan keen.

3 Then everyone, both small and great,
Went out from the city to wait
On Jesus, so the city stayed
Without a soul for the parade,
For women bore children in arms,
And forgot to take food for harms.
When they saw this, the governor
And the high priest rode out on shore
And sent a messenger before
To Herod, who also rode out
To find Jesus and still the rout
Of the folk. And for two days
They looked for him in the desert ways
Near to the Jordan, and the third
Day they found him and undeterred
About noon, when he purified
Himself for the prayer to abide
By the Book of Moses beside.

Barnabas sees canonical prayer here
As commanded by Moses and with fear.
Now Muslims seem to think prayer was invented
By Allah in the time Muhammad vented.
Rejection of the former Scriptures make
Of that faith called Islam a false mistake
Come lately on the earthly night in pale
Among the superstitious to prevail.
Beloved, even the Ottomans required
Their high muftis to know it or be fired,
To have by heart the Bible so all men
In town could have recourse to them again
For knowledge of the Scriptures spoken when
The light by Moses should light their dark den.

4 Jesus was then greatly surprised
To see the crowd as he surmised
Cover the earth with folk and he
Said to his disciples freely,
“Perhaps Satan has raised a row
In land of Judaea somehow.
May it please God to take away
From Satan the dominion’s sway
Which he has over sinners’ way.”
And when he had said this, the crowd
Came near, and when they knew him bowed
They started to cry out, “Welcome
To you, our God mighty in sum!”
And they began to bow down there,
To worship him as God in share.
Jesus gave a great groan and said
“Go away from me, madmen led,
For I fear earth shall open and
Devour me with you where you stand
For your abomination spoken!”
At this the people were all broken,
Filled with fear, and wept at the token.

Note now, Beloved, what happened at the time
Jesus denied divinity and crime.
The people were all broken down in fear
And wept for the sin coming to appear.
Now when that Roman heresy's exposed
To those chained to that error and enclosed,
They only defend arrogantly now
That doctrine of their devils to allow.
Beloved, break every heart that sets on high
A god other than You beneath the sky
And bring bitter tears into every eye
Who by idolatry denies the way
That only You in heaven and earth bear sway.
O my Beloved, fire humankind today.

Barnabas 93

1 Then Jesus lifting up his hand
For silence, said “I understand
You have erred greatly, Israelites,
In calling me, a man in sights,
Your God. And I fear that God may
For this send heavy plagues today
Upon the holy city, and
Give it over to strangers’ band.
A thousand curses on Satan,
Who gave to you this wicked plan!”

2 And having said this, Jesus struck
His face with both hands and a muck
Of weeping rose with such a sound
That no one could hear on the ground
What Jesus said. With that he raised
His hands again for silence dazed,
And the folk silenced from their crying,
He spoke to them once more with sighing.
“I confess before heaven, and call
To witness everything in thrall
Upon the earth, that I am a stranger
To all the things you’ve said for danger,
Since I’m a man born of the plight
Of mortal woman in your sight,
A subject of God’s judgement here
And to the suffering to appear,
One eating, sleeping, feeling cold
And heat like other men from old.
So when God shall come to judge men,
My words like a sword pierce again
Each one who believes me to be
More than man of mortality.”
Having said this, Jesus then saw
A great crowd of horsemen to paw,
And so he knew the governor
And Herod and high priest in score
Were coming. Then Jesus said “They
May also be mad in their way.”

This is the true reason why scholars bound
To say that Barnabas was never found
In truth in ancient time upon the ground,
But is invention of some folk around.
If it were scholarship, it would relate
Objectively objections to it great,
Show what's effect of editing and more
Of translation upon objective score.
Instead they merely ridicule, ignore
The fact a text could underlie the text,
Or it could be produced my men perplexed.
They must deny the witness Jesus gave
That he was not God but only God's slave.

4 When the governor arrived there,
With Herod and the priest in share,
They all dismounted, and they made
A circle around Jesus stayed,
So much the soldiers could not keep
Back all the people who would peep
At Jesus speaking with the priest.

Jesus came near the priest in awe
And courtesy, but the priest saw
Him and wished to bow down to him
And worship, but Jesus cried out:
Beware of what you are about,
Priest of the living God! Sin not
Against our God as you are taught!

Jesus acknowledges the priest was taught
The truth, but now is tempted to be caught
In Romanish belief that men become
Gods to be worshipped by both king and scum.
He calls the priest back to the ancient way
Of faith of Abraham and not to stray.
Priests of the living God may sometimes sway
And topple from the right. Just look around.
How many faithful priests here can be found?
There's hardly one denies the fallacy
That Jesus is both man and God to see.
Jesus says to each priest, O man, beware
Of what you are about to do and share,
And worship only the true God and fair!

5 The priest replied, "Now is the land
Of Judaea moved to a stand
Over your signs and what you teach
And so cry out that you are God.
That's why, at the folk and their prod,
I come with Roman governor
And King Herod. We beg therefore
From our heart that you will see fit
To stop the sedition at pitch
That has arisen on you score.
For some say you are God, some say
You are the son of God in sway,
And some a prophet in this way."

6 Jesus replied, "And you, high priest
Of God, why have you not at least
Quieted this sedition? Are
You also perhaps, gone afar
Out of your mind? Have prophecies,
With God's law, so passed from cities,
O wretched Judaea, deceived
Of Satan and the unreprieved!"

The priest blamed Jesus for the tumult made
And at the same time let the ones who prayed
To him affect his own mind and belief.
No priestly concept is without its grief
And contradiction to reason unblind.

Priest-craft will corrupt the very best mind.
Knowing that God is one and never man,
The priest should have quieted every plan
To make Jesus a god, instead of wait
For Jesus to deny the lying rate.
Every priest is responsible today
To speak the truth and hold justice in sway
That God is one and all men must obey,
And not just pussyfoot around the fray.

Barnabas 94

I Having said so, Jesus again
Said "I confess before heaven,
And call to witness everything
That dwells upon the earth *in wing*,
That I'm a stranger to all that
Men have said of me as they sat,
That is, that I am more than man.
For I'm a man, born of the plan
Of woman, subject to judgement
Of God; that live here as one sent
Among men, subject to the same
In miseries. As God in fame
Lives, in whose presence my soul stands,
You've greatly sinned, O priest, in saying
What you have said. May it by hands
Please God that there come not upon
The holy city vengeance drawn
For this sin or some other slaying."
Then said the priest, "May God forgive
And do then pray that we might live."
Then said the governor and Herod:
"Sir, it's impossible, not mere odd,
That man should do that which you do.
That's why we do not understand
What you have told the waiting band.
Jesus replied, "What you say's true,
For God works good in man to do,
Just as Satan works evil view.
For man is like a shop in which
Whoever enters with his pitch
Works and sells there by his consent.
But tell me, governor *unbent*,
And you, king, you say this because
You both are strangers to our laws.
For if you read the testament
And covenant of our God you
Would see that Moses with a rod
Made water turn to blood, the sod
To fleas, the dew into a storm,

The light into darkness in form.
 He made the frogs and mice to come
 Into Egypt on ground noisome,
 He killed the first-born, and made dry
 The sea, where he drowned Pharaoh sly.
 These things I've not begun to try.
 2 Of Moses, all confess that he
 Is a man dead now and truly.
 Joshua made the sun stand still,
 And split the Jordan to a rill,
 Which I have not yet done for spill.
 Of Joshua all confess he
 Is a man dead now and truly.
 Elijah made fire visibly
 Come down from heaven for all to see,
 And rain, which I have not done. And
 Of Elijah each one in band
 Confesses he's man out of hand.
 And so a crowd of prophets and
 Saints and friends of God came to stand
 In power of God to do such things
 Which cannot be grasped by the rings
 Of those who do not know our God,
 Almighty, merciful, whose rod
 Is blessed and to everlastings."

Sweet Jesus himself rejects argument
 That miracles prove that a man is sent
 To be God and Almighty on the earth.
 He takes such arguments as of no worth.
 If Moses and Elijah both can work
 Great miracles, and neither of them shirk,
 But are both men, and men alone, then he
 Too is a man, though he do splendidly.
 Beloved, I work no miracles with power
 Despite occasional desire in hour.
 The sick remain sick where I pray and those
 Who wait for signs and wonders in their rows
 All wait in vain. I touch my hat to show
 Respect for all the men grouped in a row.

Barnabas 95

1 Accordingly the governor
 And the priest and the king before
 Begged Jesus that in order to
 Quiet the people he should view
 Them from a higher place and speak
 To them. Then Jesus went up sleek
 On one of the twelve stones that made
 Joshua the twelve tribes' parade

Take from the Jordan's bed, when all
Israel passed over at the call
Dry shod, and he said with a loud
Voice, "Let our priest go from the crowd
To a high place where he may stay
To confirm all the things I say."

I doubt the twelve stones Joshua had laid
Where still existing and known in parade
When Jesus lived and died or not for gain.
Barnabas makes, I think, a claim in vain.
But Jesus was wise when he thought to bring
The priest in witness of his righteous thing.
The confirmation of a priest at church
Is helpful when one's caught in such smirch.
Beloved, a man must find a pulpit high
And be seen by the crowd to whom to cry
If he'd be heard and taken at his word
To influence the world in what occurred.
I stand rather among the hiding trees
And preach to green finch and to passing breeze.

2 So the priest went up there and then
Jesus spoke clearly to the men.
"It's written in the testament
And covenant living God sent
That our God has no beginning,
Nor shall He have an end on wing."
The priest replied, "Even so it
Is written in the book and fit. "
Jesus said "It is written there
That our God just by His word's share
Has created all things that be."
"Even so," said the priest freely.
Jesus said "It is written too
That God never comes into view
But is hidden from mind of man,
Since He's without the body's ban
And without composition's stay,
And without change *from day to day*."
"It's so indeed," said the priest then.
Jesus said "It's written again
How heaven of heaven's cannot contain
Him, since our God's not limited."
"So Solomon the prophet said,"
Echoed the priest, "O Jesus *sweet*."
Jesus said "It's written to meet
That God has no need, forasmuch
As he does not eat, sleep, or touch
Any deficiency at all."

The Priest said "You are on the ball."
3 Jesus said: "It is written there
That our Lord God is everywhere,
And that there is no god but he,
Who strikes down and makes whole and free,
And does all by His pleasure's fee."
"So is it written," said the priest.
Then Jesus lifting hands increased
His words: "Lord our God, this is my
Faith and by which one day shall I
Come to Your judgement, and bear witness
Against every man for unfitness
Who shall believe the contrary."

The attributes that Barnabas has found
In Jesus' words are those upon fair reason's ground:
He is eternal, He has made all things
By His word only, He raises no wings
In sight of men but is invisible,
And changeless, though with things the earth is full;
The heavens cannot contain Him, He's without
Such limits; our God has no need to eat
Or sleep or touch contingency. He is
Omnipresent, there's no god in the biz
But He alone, who destroys and heals all
By sovereign will. And he shall never fall.

4 And turning towards the folk, he said
"Repent, for from all that instead
The priest bears witness written in
The Book of Moses store and bin,
Eternal covenant of God,
You can see well your error's clod.
For I'm a man that can be seen,
A piece of clay that walks between
The earth, mortal as other men.
I've had a beginning, and then
Shall have an end, and I am such
As cannot create a fly much."
5 At that the folk raised in one voice
Of weeping and not to rejoice,
And said "We have sinned, Lord our God,
Against You; have mercy, not rod,
Upon us." And they begged Jesus,
Each one, that he would pray, not curse,
The safety of the holy town,
That our God in His wrath and frown,
Should not let it be trodden down
By the Gentiles. So Jesus raised
His hands, prayed for the city praised

And for God's people, every one
Crying amen when he had done.

The call of fair repentance on the earth
Touches first how men think and of what worth
They hold God in concept as well as mind.
Repent of thought and belief unresigned.
There is sin of the thought and will I find.
The first and greatest sin's to disobey
The first commandment given by Your sway,
That we should hold none to be god but You,
And all sin rises from loss of that view.
It's from the mind that one must first repent
And not from the mere deed of heaven unsent.
The thought is what plunges the soul in hell
And not the hand or eye uncut in spell.
Keep, my Beloved, my thoughts and I am well.

Barnabas 96

1 When the prayer was ended, the priest
Said with a loud voice, "Stay increased,
Jesus, for we here need to know
Who you are to settle the show."
Jesus replied, "I'm Jesus, son
Of Mary, of David's seed won,
A mortal man who fears God and
I seek God's honour in the land
And God's own glory by my hand."
2 The priest replied, "In Moses' Book
It's written that our God by hook
Must send us the Messiah, who
Shall come proclaiming what is true
Divine will, and shall bring the world
The mercy that our God unfurled.
So I beg you to tell us true
Are you God's Messiah in view?"
3 Jesus replied, "It's true indeed
That God has promised you such seed,
But truly I am not that one,
For he is made before me done,
And shall come after me to stun."
The priest replied, "But word and sign
That you bring to light in a line,
We do believe that you must be
A prophet and God's saint to see,
So I beg you in name of all
Judaea and Israel in thrall,
That you tell us how he will come,
Messiah we await in sum."

Unlike the priests in Matthew, Mark and Luke
This priest remains unlikely sort of fluke
Who speaks to Jesus with awe and respect
As though among the chosen and elect.
The priest asks Jesus to reveal the plan
Of God to bless each woman and each man.
He holds him to be sent of God and true,
One who's vouchsafed with revelation new.
Beloved, the enigma of prophet's reign
And prophet's son is always something vain.
No one can answer truly, since the thing
Is hidden and with inconsistent ring.
The word of God's not heard at all, it seems,
Except through prophets, angels, and in dreams.

Barnabas 97

I And Jesus answered, "As God lives,
In whose presence my soul He gives,
I'm not the Messiah whom all
The tribes of earth await and call,
Just as God promised our ancestor
Abraham, telling the investor,
"In your seed all the tribes of earth
Shall be blessed and brought to their berth."
But when God shall take me away
From the world, Satan will in sway
Raise again this accursed way,
By making the impious think
That I am God and son on brink
Of God, so my words and my teaching
Shall be contaminated preaching
To the extent there scarce remain
But thirty faithful and unvain.
Then God will have mercy upon
The world and send upon its spawn
His Messenger for whom He's made
All things, and who shall then appear
Out of the south with power and gear
To destroy idols and those who
Worship such idols in their crew.
He'll remove Satan's power on man.
He'll bring with him God's mercy's span
For the salvation of those who
Shall believe in him: blessed is he
Who'll believe his words and agree.
Though I'm unworthy to untie
His laces, I've come to rely
On God's grace and mercy to see
Him." Then answered the priest and the
Governor and the king to say

“Do not distress yourself that way,
 O Jesus, holy one of God,
 For in our time this wayward pod
 Of such sedition shall not be,
 Since we shall write now faithfully
 To the holy Roman senate
 So that by imperial decree
 No one shall any more relate
 To call you God or son of God.”
 Then Jesus said “By your words I
 Am not consoled, where you rely
 On hoped-for light darkness will fly.
 My consolations rather lie
 In coming of the Messenger,
 Who shall destroy every false fer
 Who holds false opinions of me,
 And his faith shall spread and shall take
 Hold of the whole world faithfully,
 For God’s promised for Abram’s sake,
 Our ancestor. And that which gives
 Me comfort is that his faith lives
 Without end, kept by God is stake.

The prediction is true, or after fact,
 The report of the way people would act.
 Indeed already in the third century
 Men rose to talk about the Trinity
 And Constantine with heat and hearty will
 Made council of a few bishops to fill
 The earth with vain conceits than man is God
 Or as like God as a pea in the pod.
 The prediction is true that one would rise
 To regain truth without a compromise:
 That the Furqan once given in Moses' hand
 Remains on earth and comes all to command.
 Beloved, I take the Decalogue to be
 The gauge of divine promises to me.

2 The priest replied, “After the day
 Of God’s Messenger come in sway,
 Shall other prophets then arise?”
 Jesus replied, “There in no wise
 Shall not come after him in guise
 True prophets sent by God, but there
 Shall come a great number in share
 Of false prophets, which makes me sad.
 For Satan will raise them up bad
 By the just judgement God has had
 And they will hide themselves behind
 The pretext of my Gospel lined.”

Herod replied, "How can it be
A just judgement from God in fee
That such impious men should be?"
3 Jesus replied, "It's a just thing
That he who'll not believe on wing
In the truth to salvation's king,
Should then believe a lie in sting
To his damnation. That's why I
Tell you that the world will defy
The true prophets as always done,
And love the false, as can be seen
In the time of Micaiah's dream
And Jeremiah. For each kind
Loves his own type as though refined."

Beloved, I love each prophet that comes here
Proclaiming that the Decalogue is dear,
Whether he can live by its light or not
Or whether I am skilled in virtue caught.
I claim no righteousness or good in me,
I claim no earthly nor heavenly degree,
I only claim Your promises in stake
And beg to taste their delicacies' cake.
False prophets are the ones who may be great
And good and powerful and heal a rate,
But if they do deny the sacred word
That You pronounced on Sinai to the herd,
They are as false as money can be made,
False prophets bought and sold and always paid.

4 Then said the priest, "How shall be called
Messiah and what sign installed
Will show his coming on the go?"
Jesus replied, "Messiah's name
Is admirable, for God in fame
Gave him the name Himself when He
Created his soul, and placed it
In heavenly splendour to be fit.
God said 'Wait, Muhammad, for you
I shall create paradise too,
The world, and a great multitude
Of creatures I give as your brood,
So that the one who blesses you
Will be blessed and who curses you
Will be cursed. When I send you to
The world, I'll send you then and spun
My Messenger of salvation.
Your word will be true though the sky
Should fall and the earth lie
In failure, but your faith not die.'

Muhammad is his blessed name.”
Then the crowd lifted up their voices,
Saying "O God send us for choices
Your Messenger: O Muhammad,
Come quickly for salvation had
In store for the world to be glad!”

If Jesus did predict by name the man
To come after him in the divine plan,
It was no trick to quote the lovely Psalm
One hundred six and make of it a balm.
It was no trick, and yet all men deny
The truth that the name's written there to try,
And written outright, not a hidden thing.
The Christian will deny both black and white
While Muslims are not satisfied to spring
On something obvious, but have for spite
Sought every convolution full of doubt
Ridiculous to discredit and spout
Against the prophet clearly named and true.
Beloved, I seek my refuge just in You.

Barnabas 98

1 After he said this, then the crowd
With priest and governor allowed
With Herod left discussing loud
Jesus and what he taught unbowed.
So the priest begged the governor
To write to Roman senate's shore
The whole thing, which the governor
Accomplished. So the senate had
Compassion on Israel in pad
And so decreed upon death's pain
That none should ever call in vain
Jesus the Nazarene their God
Or son of God upon the sod.
The decree was posted in view
In the temple and engraved too
On copper tablet *in his pew*.

If such a thing did happen in the past,
And Roman senate made decrees to last
About the son of God and Jesus known,
There's not a trace of it in book or throne.
But history is a funny thing to see,
And always seems distorted by the free
And after harsh repression and the gall
Of poverty's forgotten by men all.
I frankly doubt the accuracy here
Of Barnabas' report, and so I fear

It's wishful thinking on the humble part
Of someone with a burning, fervent heart.
But doctrine's true, as every mind must know:
No man is God, no matter how he glow.

2 When the greater part of the crowd
Had left, there remained and unbowed
About five thousand men, excluding
The women and the children feuding,
Who wearied by the march and yet
Without food two days on the set,
Since in their rush to see the man
Jesus they had forgotten can
And store, and so they tried to eat
Raw herbs they found about their feet.
When Jesus noticed this he had
Pity on them and asked the lad
Philip: Where shall we find food for
These people famished at death's door?"
Philip replied, "Sir, two hundred
Pieces of gold could not buy bread
For each to taste, say not be fed."
Then Andrew said "Here is a child
With five loaves and two fishes wild,
But what is that in such crowd styled?"
3 Jesus replied, "Make the crowd sit.
And they said down on the grass fit
By fifties and by forties' number.
So Jesus did not stay to slumber,
But said "Bismillah, in God's name!"
And thus he spoke and not in vain.
He took the bread and prayed to God,
And broke the bread and gave in pod
To the disciples, and they gave
It to the multitude as brave,
And so they did with fishes too.
All ate and were filled in the crew.
Then Jesus said "Gather the rest."
So the disciples tried their best
To gather the fragments and found
Twelve baskets filled up on the ground.
4 So everyone put hand to eye
And said "Am I a wake or try
To see a dream?" And they remained,
The whole crowd for an hour gained,
Incredulous that he attained.
After that, Jesus, when he had
Thanked God (*as well as little lad*),
Sent off the crowd, but stayed behind
Seventy-two men of the kind

Who would not leave him in the bind.
So Jesus seeing faith they had
Took them for followers and glad.

Some follow You, Beloved, and those You send
For bread and bread alone and not to spend.
And yet without the bread, my prayer to You
Would not sound long here in my hearth and pew.
Some follow for the sound of gold that clinks,
Some follow for the bound of old that sinks
Into tradition of their fathers' winks.
Some follow for self-interest and on cue.
Beloved, let me not follow Christ at all,
Or any prophet sent to stand up tall.
Let me not seek beneath crozier or throne
The status and the wealth of weary bone.
Let me cling to You, though all goes amiss:
Let me seek nothing but the divine kiss.

Barnabas 99

1 Jesus went aside to a place
In the desert of Tiro's trace
Near to the Jordan in its race,
And summoned there the seventy-two
Along with the twelve in their crew
And sat down on a stone in view
And had all of them sit there too.
He opened his mouth with a sigh
And said: "Today we've seen come by
A great evil in Judaea
And in Israel so that my heart
Quakes in my breast fearing God's dart.
I say to you indeed God's part
Is jealous for His honour and
He loves Israel with lover's band.
You know when a guy loves a girl,
And she loves just another churl,
He's moved to wrath so he might kill
The rival of his hand to chill.
I tell you God is just like that.
For when Israel's loved one out flat
So as to forget where God's at,
God's sunk that one as quick as bat.
2 Now what thing is more dear to God
Here on earth and on its sod
Than priesthood and the temple broad?
In prophet Jeremiah's time
When the folk forgot God in rhyme
And just bragged of the temple grime
That there was nothing like it in

The whole world, God raised up in din
Of anger Nebuchadnezzar,
The king of Babylon and star,
Who with an army made him take
The holy city and in wake
To burn it with the sacred house,
So that the holy things that mouse
Of God's prophets trembled to drowse,
Were trampled under faithless feet
Filled up with wickedness complete.

The theories of why You let Babylon
Destroy the temple now that it is gone
Are many. So said it was for the way
The people in town often came to pray
To idols and false deities around.
Some say the real reason's to be found
In sabbath-breaking year by fateful year.
Barnabas minds the thing he came to hear
From Jesus that the reason was the folk
Were too proud of the temple's strength of oak.
I have no temple with a rising spire,
I have no laura nor room to inspire.
I only have a humble, sinful heart
That bears no reason for pride from the start.

3 Abraham loved his son Ishmael
A little more than was right well,
So to destroy that evil spell
Out of Abraham's heart, God gave
Command to lay his son in grave,
Which he would have done to the brave
Had the knife cut obeying slave.
David loved Absalom greatly,
So God allowed his son bravely
To rebel against his dad's see,
And he was hung up in a tree
By his hair and killed in the spree
By Joab. O feared stroke of God
That Absalom loved his hair's pod
Above all things and this was changed
Into rope to hang him estranged.

The fact is that the story of the ram
Caught in the thicket that saved Abraham
From slaying his son is a mild report
Of rite of passage of Van Gennep's sort.
How any fail to see that fact to me
Seems most incredible in what I see.
The hair of Absalom was cut each year

And is the only token in the gear
Of early Scripture of the way in state
That pilgrims cut their hair by Makkah's gate.
Beloved, the ignorance of Barnabas
Is typical of writers who would gas
About things long before their time, for they
Are too far from the facts to know their way.

4 Innocent Job came near to love
His seven sons and three daughters' glove,
When God delivered him into
The hand of Satan, Satan who
Not only deprived him of sons
And riches in one day, but tonnes
Of grief and illness laid on him,
So worms came out of his flesh grim
For seven years upon his buns.
Our father Jacob loved Joseph
More than his other sons, not deaf
God caused him to be sold, and left
Jacob to be deceived by sons bereft,
So he believed wild beast consumed
His son, and so mourning assumed
For ten years as the sorrow loomed.

The thought that love in Job's and Jacob's heart
Resulted in the evil done in part
To their sons may be true, I do not know.
But if it's true, it is a thing to show
You to be unjust and to lay the arm
On offspring for the father's fateful harm.
The Bible says that none shall come to die
For father's sin and that no price can buy
Another's grace atoned. So see the lie
That Barnabas fathers on Jesus' lips.
I demand of You now with hand on hips.
Explain this foul injustice written down
In letters plain to read in black and brown
And I shall understand or at least try.

Barnabas 100

1 As God lives, brothers, I fear God
Will be angered against my prod.
So you must go through Judea
And Israel, preaching with awe
The truth to the twelve tribes, that they
May be undeceived in this way."
The disciples answered with fear,
Weeping: "We will do and with cheer
Whatever you tell us in tear."

2 Then Jesus said: "Let us make prayer
And fast for three days, and from there
On every evening when first star
Comes out, when prayer is made to God,
Let us make prayer three times in laud,
Begging Him for mercy three times:
Because the sin of Israel's crimes
Is three times worse than other sin."
"So be it," said his folk in din.

3 When the third day was ended, on
The morning of fourth day at dawn,
Jesus called the disciples and
Apostles and said to the band:
"Barnabas and John stay with me:
You others go through all the lea
Of Samaria and the land
Of Judaea and Israel stand,
Preaching penitence: since the axe
Is laid up to the tree in stacks,
To cut it down. And make prayer for
The sick, because God's given store
Of power to me on sickness' door. "

4 Then he who writes said: "O Master,
If your disciples be asked how
They ought to show penitence now,
What shall they answer at the stir?"
Jesus replied: "When a man lose
A wallet, does he only use
His eye to see it, or his hand
To take it, or his tongue's command
To ask if it's somewhere at hand?
No, but he turns body and soul
Back to make its search his whole goal.
Is this true?" And the one who writes
Replied, "It's truer than all sights."

Repentance, my Beloved, I truly wish
Were daily placed upon my supper dish,
But in fact I've no strength here to repent
Of what I've thought and said and done to vent.
Though my sin may be three times less than that
They perpetrated in the divine vat
In calling a man God, still where I sat
There is no good deed pure to hand to You
In gratitude for all the things You do.
There is no time when grace can stand aside
And see me harnessed up to give a ride
Of righteous bill and come back to my stall
Having shown how good I am to them all.
I need the power to do and not just guide.

Barnabas 101

1 Then Jesus said: "Penitence is
Reversing of evil life's biz.
For every sense must be turned back
To the opposite way in stack
From what is sinful and in slack.
Instead of joy, there's mourning and
For laughter, weeping comes to stand,
Instead of partying, a fast,
Instead of sleeping, vigils cast,
Instead of leisure, work in fee,
Instead of lust, just chastity,
And story-telling be turned in
To prayer, and avarice in bin
Of giving alms instead of sin."
Then he who writes replied: "But if
They are asked, how are we made stiff
To mourn, and how are we to weep,
How are we to fast, how to keep
Busy and how to remain chaste,
How are we to make prayer and haste
To do alms; what answer to make?
And how shall they make penance stake
If they know not how to repent?"
2 Jesus replied: "You have not lent
A question without thought and sense,
O Barnabas, and my intent's
To answer all completely if
It so please God in a word stiff.
Today I'll tell you all about
Repentance in general rout,
And what I say to one I say
To all. Know then repentance sway
More than anything else must be
Done for pure love of God sweetly.
Otherwise it's vain to repent.
I'll tell you a parable lent.
Each building with foundation lost
Falls into ruins to its cost.
Is this true?" The disciples cried
In answer, "It is true beside."
3 Then Jesus said: "The foundation
Of our salvation's what God's done,
Without whom no salvation's won.
When man sins, he's lost foundation
And gauge of his own salvation.
So he must start from foundation
Again. Tell me if your slaves come
To offend you, and you in sum

Knew they did not grieve for the act,
But only for having been smacked,
Would you forgive them what they lacked?
Certainly not. I tell you that
This is what God will do out flat
To those who repent having lost
Their place in paradise. Satan,
The enemy of all good plan,
Has great remorse for having lost
His place in paradise and tossed
In hell. Yet he will he never find
Mercy. Do you know why? Because
He does not love God or His laws;
No, he hates his Creator blind.

I turn my joy to mourning, that's a fact,
But still I never know how I should act,
And while my laughing soon may turn to tears,
My actions show that I'm still without fears.
Though party turns to fast and sleep to toil,
I still find I am caught in sinful coil,
And though my burning lust turns chaste with age,
I see that I have never turned a page.
But I have one thing that repentance needs
If I have nothing good in word and deeds:
I burn with love to You, Beloved, and glow
With coals of fire and ash on altar slow.
Your action only can create and save,
Whether I be commodious or brave.

Barnabas 102

I Truly I say to you, each beast
By its own nature so increased,
If it loses what it desired,
Will mourn the loss until it's tired.
Accordingly, the sinner who
Will truly join penitent crew
Must have a great desire to pluck
Out of himself opposing muck
To his Creator, so that he
In prayer does not dare to pray he
May enter paradise of God.
Or that God will free him from prod
Of hell, but confused in his mind,
Prostrate before God, and remind
Him in his prayer and so resigned:

Indeed, Beloved, I do not dream that I
Might enter paradise when I should die.
But my soul at Your throne where it may be

Bows to You for all its eternity.
Give me not paradise, give me no hell,
Give me nothing deserving I can tell,
But let me in prostration serve You well,
If service is to await groaningly.
I may be a beast like each beast I know,
And yet I mourn no loss of gain and show,
Of tinsel and of crepe among the fields
Of iron and brass the human life here yields.
I mourn only the glimpse and cry I find
Of You because of heart and eye that's blind.

2 'Behold the guilty one, O Lord,
Who has offended You adored
Without excuse and at the time
He ought to have served You from crime.
Here he seeks the just punishment
By Your hand, not by Satan's sent,
Who is your enemy, so that
The ungodly may not raise hat
And cheer over your creatures' mat.
Chastise, punish as it please you,
O Lord, for You'll not bring in view
So much torment as this one here
In wickedness deserves to fear.'

See, my Beloved, how I know how to pray
Like unrepentant in the earthly way!
I think that I beg rightly when I beg
Neither for hell or heaven for a peg,
When I should beg such punishment from You
As is for sinful life my justice due.
I beg for justice on the other man
For wickedness in outreach and in span,
But for myself I beg Your hopeless room
Instead of my deserving and my doom.
Let me not beg at all, but simply stay
Beneath the footstool of Your earth and say
No words of pray nor have greater desire
But that You put me in eternal fire.

3 The sinner in this way will find
Mercy with God to way and kind
As he craves justice. Truly he
Who sins and laughs commits only
A horrid sacrilege since this
World's rightly called by David's bliss,
Our father, tearful vale to miss.

A tearful vale this world is, it is true,

Despite the comfort of my golden pew.
A tearful vale, with moments of reprieve,
And in those moments too my soul may grieve.
I eat and drink and I am marry too.
I watch the living spectacle in view,
With a foreboding of the things to come
Resulting from the way that people hum.
Beloved, if You have mercy that will be
Reason enough for gladder minstrelsy,
And shouts of joy upon a street of gold..
Until then into mourning I am sold
And packed beside the train toward the east
With only promises of love and feast.

4 There was a king who took a slave
Of his as his son and then gave
Him power over all he possessed.
Now it occurred he was addressed
By the deceit of a bad man
And wretchedly fell under ban
Of the king, and so suffered great
Affliction, not just in the fate
Of property, but in the state
Of reputation, and deprived
Each day of his profits contrived.
Do you think such a man would laugh
For any time after the gaff?"
"No," answered the disciples, "for
If the king should have known it more
He would have had him slain, since he
Laughed at the king's displeasure's fee.
It's far more likely in his sight
That he would weep both day and night."
5 Then Jesus wept saying: "Woe to
The world, for they surely accrue
Eternal torment. O mankind
In wretchedness and so made blind,
That God has chosen you as son,
Granting you paradise when done,
At which you, O wretched one, by
The working out of Satan sly,
Did fall under dislike of God,
And were cast out of garden's sod,
And condemned to the unclean world,
Where you receive all things unfurled
With toil and each good work's deprived
From you for the sins you've contrived.
The world just laughs, and what is worse,
The greatest sinner's laugh's a curse.
So it will be as you've declared:

God will give the sinner unspared
Eternal death, who just derides
His sins and does not weep besides.”

Beloved, I do not laugh at all my sins,
But only at the small one when it wins.
Send an eternal death on wickedness,
Even the mediocre craftiness.
Send an eternal death on what I do,
But have mercy on all else in Your view,
For what You have created must be good
If You make the deeds for the soul that should.
Beloved, I weep enough for two or three
Because of my own lone infamy,
And cross the bridge of doubt and see the fire
Below me shrieking with human desire.
If I grow faint and falter, let the hand
That made me take me up and make me stand.

Barnabas 103

1 The weeping of the sinner ought
To be like that of father brought
To weep over his son who's near
To death. O madness of man's leer,
Who weeps over the body done
From which the soul has fled and gone,
And yet does not weep for the soul
From which God's mercy's taken toll
Departed because of sin won!
Tell me, if sailors, when the ship
Has been wrecked by a storm to flip,
Could get back of the lost with tears,
What would he do, and without fears?
It's certain he'd weep bitterly.
But I say to you and truly,
That men sin in all things they weep,
Except for sin when weeping deep.
For every fate that comes on man
Comes on him by the divine plan
For his salvation in a span,
So he should rejoice while he can.
But sin comes from the deil to damn,
But man's not sorrowful in clam.
You can well see that man seeks loss
And never profit at a toss.”
2 Bartholomew said: "Lord, what then
Shall he do who cannot again
Weep, since his heart's not set to do?"
Jesus replied: "Not all those who
Shed tears weep, O Bartholomew.

As God lives, there are found men from
Whose eyes no tear has ever come,
And they have wept more than a stand
Of thousand of those who in band
Shed tears. The weeping of a sinner
Is shedding earth's desires like winner
Vehement in sorrows in hand.

3 Just as the sunshine keeps safe from
Rot what is uppermost to come,
So this shedding preserves the soul
From sin. If God should grant more tears
Than is the sea to him who steers
Repentant, he would want the more,
And that desire consumes before
That little drop that he would shed,
Like blazing fire brought to a head
Consume a drop of water's store.
But those who're quick to burst in tears
Are like the horse faster with gears,
Since it's lightly loaded at core.

The one thing that can be regained I see
Is divine compassion and Your mercy
If sinner weeps for his sin and freely.
No other loss is regained by the sight
Of tears spent on the loss and in the night.
What good news, I should say for every man
Who knows to weep instead of work and plan!
Your mercy is an easy thing and light.
The rub is that true weeping does not shed
Mere salty tears from eyes that glow instead,
But in the shedding of the world's desire
And shedding from the feet the earthly mire.
These I can shed alone by grace profound
From You, Beloved, cast down upon the ground.

Barnabas 104

1 'Truly there are men who have both
The inward affection and quoth
The outward tears. But he who's so,
Will join in Jeremiah's woe.
In weeping, God measures the more
The sorrow than the tears in store.'
Then said John: "O master, how then
Does man lose in weeping again
Over things other than his sin?"
Jesus replied: 'If Herod give
You a mantle to keep and live
For him, and afterwards should take
It away from you for a break,

Would you have cause to weep at stake?'
2 "No," said John. Then Jesus replied:
'Now has man less reason he cried
When he's lost anything or yet
Does not get that on which heart's set,
For all comes from the hand of God.
So shall not God have power on sod
To do what He will with His own,
O foolish man? For you alone
Have of your own your sin, no more.
For that you ought to weep and score
And not for any other store.'

Ah me! What truth lies in the face I see,
That I have naught in store nor symmetry
Of beauty, wealth, intelligence and rate
Of great accomplishments before my fate,
But what I've been provided by the world
That bore me from a womb foetus uncurled!
The only thing a man may own is sin,
And that's a truth methinks that all might win.
Some things are close intuited and known
By heart and mind as graven in the stone.
That's why men build for fame in infamy
In monuments of wickedness to see.
They know the good is not their own, and so
They take the bad to make a better show.

3 Matthew said: "O master, you stated
Before all of Judea rated
That God's not like a man at all,
And now you've said beyond recall
That man receives from God's own hand.
Since God has hands He comes to stand
In some ways like a man in stall."
Jesus replied: "Your error's clear,
Matthew, and many too would steer
In the same error, since they do
Not know the sense of words that's true.
For man ought to consider not
The literal meaning in plot
But what's intended on the spot,
Since human speech comes to make clear
The divine message to us dear.
Do you not know that when God came
To speak to our ancestors fame
On Mount Sinai, that they cried out:
"Speak you to us, Moses, in shout,
But let not God speak to us, lest
We die?" And what God then confessed

By Isaiah the prophet dressed,
But that so far as the sky stands
Above the earth, so are commands
Of God above the ways of men,
And God's thoughts from men's thoughts again?

The question is sectarian in gross
And may show that the writing is a dose
Come after Imam Hanbal with fame great
For the divine hand and foot in his state.
Even today theology in rate
Materialist has its adherents still,
And the divine gets tired to foot the hill.
I am a doubter in my way, I know,
And doubt the insubstantial divine glow
As well as the material gods that go
On Mount Olympus in a blessed row.
If Jesus takes position in a way
Against the Taliban-Wahhabi sway,
I too refrain from such in what I say.

Barnabas 105

1 'God is so immeasurable
That to describe Him I tremble.
But it is necessary I
Make you a proposition why.
I tell you, then, the heavens are nine
And they are distant and in line
From one another as the first
Heaven is distant from the earth burst,
Which is distant from the earth five
Hundred years' journey if you strive.
Wherefore the earth is distant from
The highest heaven as you come
Four thousand and five hundred years'
Journey. I tell you without fears,
That as the earth is in proportion
To the first heaven without contortion,
As the point of a needle's size,
And the first heaven in like guise
Is in proportion to the one
To follow as a point is done,
And similarly all the skies
Are lesser to each other's prize,
But all the size of earth with that
Of all the heavens laid out flat
Is in proportion just a point
Compared to paradise in joint,
As just a grain of sand, and so
Is this greatness not in the row

Of the immeasurable's blow?'
2 And the disciples then replied:
'It surely is, and more beside.'

The numbers that Barnabas uses here
According to modern science appear
Naïve at best. I throw them on my ear.
The Narnian Lewis himself once made hell
A pinpoint on the edge of wishing well
And even there established a fine school
Of Christian theology for the ghoul.
Let me now stop and wait and shed a tear.
Beloved, You may be great while I am small,
And yet You set upon a throne in thrall
Within the stony chamber of my heart,
So great is Your capacity and art.
A grain of sand is great for a lifetime
Of contemplation and a song in rhyme.

3 Then Jesus said: 'As God so lives,
In whose presence my soul's life gives,
The universe before God is
Small as a grain of sand in fizz,
And God is as many times greater
Than it as it would take a satyr
Grains of sand to fill all the skies
And paradise before your eyes
And more. Now consider you if
God has any proportion stiff
With man, who is a little piece
Of clay that stands without increase
Upon the earth. Beware, then, that
You take the sense and not the fat
Of bare words, if you wish to get
Eternal life.' They answered yet:
'God only can know himself, and
Truly it is as said in the stand
Of Isaiah the prophet: "He
Is hidden from what men can see."

None can know You, Beloved, but You,
And yet You made the worlds to be in view
That You Yourself might be known to be true.
Philosophizing of the great and small,
The good and bad, the light upon the ball,
Began with John and has not finished yet.
It is a dreary waste and toil, you bet.
That's why You do not find me in my pew.
Instead I roam the wooded hill and seek
The beauties and the charms where Your tents peek

Beneath the dully grey of sky and on
The earth and lake against the coming dawn.
Only You Yourself can know what You are,
But I can follow in Your guiding star.

4 Jesus replied: 'So is it true;
Wherefore, when we are come into
Paradise we shall know God too,
As here one knows the sea from just
A drop of salt water on dust.
Returning to my discourse, I
Tell you that for your sin to spy
Alone one ought to weep, because
By sinning man forsakes the laws
Of his Creator. But how then
Shall he weep who attends again
Parties and feasts? He will weep just
As ice will give fire from the crust!
You must turn feasting into fasts
If you will rule your senses' blast,
Because even so has our God
Lordship over both heaven and sod.
So Thaddaeus said: 'So then God
Has sense over which He maintains
His lordship over mounts and plains.'
5 Jesus replied: 'Do you return
To saying now then, "Can God earn,"
And "God is such"? Tell me then truly
Doe man have sense?' And they said duly:
'Yes.' So Jesus asked: 'Can a man
Be found who has life in his span
And yet in him sense does not play?'
No's what his disciples could say.
'You so deceive yourselves,' then he
Replied, 'for one that cannot see,
Is deaf, and dumb and mutilated,
Where are his senses then related?
And when a man has just passed out?'
Then the disciples were in doubt.
So Jesus said: 'Three things remain
To make up a man: that is reign
Of the soul and the sense, and flesh,
Each one is separate from mesh.
Our God created both the soul
And the body as heard in toll,
But you've not yet heard how He made
The senses. So as on parade
Tomorrow, if God will, I then
Will tell you all of it again.'
And having said this Jesus gave

Thanks to God, and prayed for the brave
Salvation of our folk, and then
For each of us saying: 'Amen.'

Philosophizing always makes return
To the beginning for the things we earn.
The answers to the questions about God
Are pitiful when compared to the pod
Of wonder in creation and in life.
Philosophy's another form of strife,
And caught in gross theology it's rife
With darkness of the mind and violence.
It is too much for man to make some sense
Of thought and future. Let my heart go free
And find the wonders of eternity
In moments passed upon the grain of sand.
So I shall find a place beneath Your hand
And maybe even someday come to stand.

Barnabas 106

1 When he had finished the dawn prayer,
Jesus sat down in the shade there
Of a palm, his disciples came
Near and Jesus spoke to the same:
'As God lives, in whose presence stands
My soul, many deceived in bands
Think on our life. For closely are
The soul and the sense joined in star,
So most men think the two are one,
Distinguishing by what they do
Rather than by their essence too.
They call it the soul of the sense,
The vegetative soul intense,
And the soul of the intellect.
But I tell you the soul select
Is one, which thinks and lives abroad.
O foolish ones upon the sod,
Where will they find the intellect
Without life? Truly none inspect.
But life without the senses stays,
As in the unconscious of rays
When senses leave him.' Thaddaeus
Replied: "O master, then tell us,
When the sense leaves the life without,
A man does not have life, no doubt."
2 Jesus replied: "This is not true,
Because a man loses on cue
Life when the soul departs, because
The soul does not return in pause
To the body, except in time

Of miracle after the crime.
But sense departs for fear alone,
Or by great sorrow of its own.
For God's made senses for the pleasure,
And by that only lives its treasure,
Just as the body lived by food
And the soul by knowledge and brood
Of love. This sense is now rebelling
Against the soul, through its own swelling
Frustration that it is deprived
Of pleasure that has been contrived
Of paradise through sin. Wherefore
There is the greatest need in store
To nourish it with spirit's pleasure
Not to live in just carnal treasure.
Do you then comprehend this thing?
Indeed I tell you God did spring
It into hell having created
It and condemned to snow and ice
Because it claimed once in a trice
To be God; but when He took back
Its nourishment, before the lack
It did confess that it was slave
To God and work of His hands brave.
And now tell me, how does sense work
In the ungodly? Without quirk
It is as God in them, since they
Follow sense and forsake the sway
Of reason and the Law of God.
So they became a withered pod
And wretched on the earth without
Any good work to speak about."

The soul and body and the sense aground
Make up the human being, I have found,
In Jesus' argument. It seems to me
That Hellenistic thought patterns run free
Throughout this writing, which is no strange thing,
Since even canonical Gospels sing
To the same tune or similar in score.
John is the best example of such store.
Beloved, I've read philosophy the while,
The Plato and the Aristotle's smile,
And now I've learned to love it for the way
It makes the human mind a place to play.
But never have I thought that it could stay
To describe God or man in what they say.

Barnabas 107

1 'So the first thing that follows grief

For sin is fasting for relief.
For he that sees a certain food
Makes him sick and to fear the crude,
After grief that he's eaten it,
Forsakes it to keep himself fit.
So should the sinner do as well.
Perceiving that pleasure casts spell
Of sin against God his Creator
By following senses like satyr
In the better things of the world,
Fasting needs to be first unfurled.
So let him start to mortify
The senses and know God thereby
As his Lord. And when he sees sense
Abhorring fasting, let him thence
Consider hell, where there is no
Pleasure at all but total woe;
Let him consider paradise
And its delights, where does suffice
One grain of one of its delights
To outweigh all the worlds insights.
So he shall gain a quiet mind.
For it's better to be resigned
To little to receive back much,
Than to be free in little touch
And be deprived of all and stay
In torment an eternal day.

There are three kinds of the saved in this place,
Who are plucked from damnation by Your grace:
Those who flee sin for fear of hell, and they
Are those whose nature bears the cruel in sway;
Those who sin not for hope of heaven's reward,
And they are such as have greed as their lord;
And those who for the love of You in heart
Attain through lust a great and noble part.
Such are the three heart motives of all men
And such are the types that arise again.
Beloved, I am all three indeed, the cruel,
The greedy and the lustful sort of fool,
Who pray to You from time to time to take
My soul into Your bosom in faith's wake.

2 'You ought to mind Dives at feast
In order to fast well at least.
He wanted to live on the earth
Deliciously for all he's worth
Each day, but was deprived at last
Eternally of water passed
Or just a drop, while Lazarus,

Content with crumbs on earth in curse
 Shall live eternally and well
 In paradise and not in hell.
 Let the penitent be cautious;
 For Satan tries to take from us
 Every good work, and more from those
 Who are penitent as they chose
 Than from others, because such ones
 Rebel against him and his guns.
 So Satan tries to keep him from
 Fasting, by pretext that may come
 From sickness, and when this shall fail,
 He'll venture on him a hard fast
 To make him ill, and he at last
 Will afterword live for the spoil.
 If he can't catch him in this coil,
 He'll try to make him set his fast
 On just the bodily in cast,
 In order to make him become
 Just like Satan himself in sum,
 Who never eats a thing he wins,
 But always lives in joy of sins.
 3 As God lives, it is a sad thing
 To deprive the body of food
 And fill the soul with pride in brood,
 Despising those who do not fast,
 Holding oneself better at last.
 Tell me, will any sick man boast
 Of the diet that is imposed
 On him by the physician, and
 Call them mad who are not so planned?
 Oh, not at all, but he'll be sad
 For the illness that makes the lad
 Be put on a diet, not fad.
 So I tell you, the penitent
 Ought not to boast about the scent
 Of his fast, and despise the true
 Who do not fast at all in crew,
 But he ought to be sad about
 The sin for which he fasts in rout.
 Nor should the penitent that fasts
 Buy fancy food, but like outcasts
 Be satisfied with courser fare.
 Now will a man give fancy fare
 To the dog that bites and the horse
 That kicks? No, surely, but of course
 The contrary. Let this do well
 For you about your fasting spell.'

How rich in psychological insight

Is Jesus in the faster and his plight.
 Some fast too much, led by Satan's fair touch,
 And then fall ill, and are excused for such.
 Some fast in body, but live in sin's joy,
 Some fast from food, but eat pride till it cloy,
 Disdaining those who are true, but fast not,
 But only from the evil thing in plot.
 In fact, my son-in-law will give the dog
 The finest scraps of ham and hock of hog,
 Despite the fact the dog is quick to bite
 Even the hand that feed's him recondite.
 I eat the coarser fare, the heady crust
 Of rye bread and repent me in the dust.

Barnabas 108

1 Hear then what I tell you about
 The vigils performed without doubt.
 For there are just two kinds of sleep:
 That of body and the soul deep.
 So you must take care as you wake
 In body the soul never take
 Its sleep. For this is a mistake.
 In parable now tell me this:
 A man stubs his foot not to miss
 On a rock, so to keep away
 Of stubbing his toe more that day
 He beats his head against the rock.
 What is the state of such a block?'
 "It's miserable," said the men,
 "A man like that's insane again."

2 Then Jesus said: "You answer well,
 For I indeed am here to tell
 You that a man who wakes in flesh
 And sleeps within his soul in mesh
 Is truly insane. Since the soul
 Sickness is worse to take a toll
 Than sickness of the body, which
 Is the foot of the life in pitch,
 While he does not notice at all
 His fault in soul sickness in pall,
 Which is the head of life in stall?
 The sleep of the soul's to forget
 God and His fearful judgement set.
 The soul, then, that watches is that
 Which in everything out of bat
 And in every place perceives God,
 And in all and through all on sod
 Gives thanks to Him in majesty,
 Aware that always faithfully
 Grace comes from God and in mercy.

The two great practices of prayer and life
That for the centuries repair from strife
Are fasting and the vigil of the night,
Awake and weeping for one's sin shown rife.
But Jesus bears no respect for the two
If they are of the body in its pew.
He wants the fasting of the soul though flesh
May still be eating at the feast afresh.
He wants the vigil of the soul though sleep
May overcome the eyelids where they peep.
Beloved, Your sent one's right, by all I know
Of fast and vigil on the prayer I show.
With plaint and penance and petition I
Bring praise by fast and vigil to the sky.

3 So in fear of His majesty
There always resounds in the ear
That angels' speech one comes to fear:
"Created things, come to judgement,
Till your Creator implement
Judgement on you." For one abides
In God's service and never hides.
Tell me, if you don't with the more,
To see by the light of a star
Or by the light of sun by far?"
Andrews replied, "By light of sun,
For by the light of star is won
No sight of nearby mountains done,
And by the light of sun we see
The smallest grain of sand there be.
That's why we walk with fear by light
Of stars and wandering in the night,
But by the light of sun we go
In safety either fast or slow".

A star-walker am I, and I serve You,
Beloved, by fear and cruelty on cue,
And by my greed and lust, I have no more
To bring in offering to the crystal shore.
So take this star-walked fellow in judgement
And judge him by the grace that You have sent
Until his croaking hymns rise by the sea
Of glass instead of earthly Galilee.
I walk by guiding star now in this night
Of winter by the tundra of Your sight,
But in the age to come and after spring
The sun will never set on heavenly thing,
And I shall walk no more, but stand to sing
Upon a silver shore in Your delight.

Barnabas 109

1 Jesus replied: "Even so I tell
You that you ought to watch a spell
With the soul by the sun of justice
Which is our God, and not to trust us
In boasting of the vigils kept
In body. Truly the adept
Will avoid bodily sleep while
He can, but it is just in guile
The claim is made it can be done
Forever, and the senses are
Burdened with flesh and food in scar
And the mind with business afar.
So let the one who hopes to keep
A vigil and have little sleep
Avoid glut of affairs and food.
As God lives before whom's my soul,
It's lawful every night in toll
To sleep, but it is never right
To forget God and fearful sight
Of His judgement, and the soul's sleep
Is such oblivion to keep."

2 Then answered he who writes: "O master,
How can we always have the faster
God in our memory? Truly,
It seems impossibility."
Jesus said, with a weary sigh:
"This is the greatest misery
That man can suffer, Barnabas.
For man cannot here on the grass
Of earth have God his maker stay
Always in memory for pay;
Except the saints, for they can keep
God always in their memory deep,
Because they have in them the light
Of the grace of God to keep bright,
So they cannot forget God here.
But tell me, have you seen appear
Those who carve quarried stones, how they
By constant practice in the way
Have learned to hit the iron tool
Upon the stone and still keep cool
And talk with others while they work
Without looking at it to shirk,
And still do not hit thumb or hand?
Do just like that is my command.

3 Desire to be holy if you
Wish to overcome all in view
Of misery of forgetfulness.

The water truly to confess
Wears down the hardest stones with just
A single drop that strikes the dust
In the same place and over time.
Do you know what has been your crime
That you have not conquered this ground?
Because you don't see it is found
To be a sin. I tell you men
That it's an error done again
When a prince gives you gifts and then
You shut your eyes and turn your back.
Just so they err who are so slack
That they forget God, who each breath
Receive God's mercies till their death."

The way to heaven is not by fearful deed
And the heroic mounting up for speed,
But by the patient sowing of life's breath
Each moment breathed until the dusk of death.
Though I am like Reuben unstable as
The water, I have the same way he has
To dampen the hard and dry heart each day
With tears that after years holding in sway
Cut their path through the granite to run down
Into the fertile earth from sin's renown.
Beloved, I live now in the day of clown,
And walk the streets with feather in my crown
Instead of sober dress, awakened there.
So keep me doubly in Your grace and care.

Barnabas 110

1 Now tell me, does our God always
Grant you His bounty in your days?
Yes, surely so: unceasingly
He gives you breath to live and be.
Indeed I tell you, every time
Your body gets your breath in rhyme
Your heart should say "To God be thanks!"
Then John said: "It's truer than banks
What you say, master, so teach us
How to attain the virtuous."
2 Jesus replied, "Truly I say
To you, one cannot any way
Attain to such condition by
Human attempts, but rather by
The mercy of God our Lord nigh.
It is true indeed that man ought
To desire the good that he sought
So God may give him without blot.
Tell me, when you're at table, do

You take the dishes in your view
Detestable? No, surely not.
So I tell you you will not get
The thing that your desire's not met.
God can, if you want holiness,
Make you holy in a time less
Than twinkling of an eye to bless,
But so men might acknowledge it,
Both gift and divine Giver fit,
Our God wants us to wait and ask,
Which is not too much of a task.

Or then it is the twinkling of an eye,
And not the patience watering and cry.
Jesus says every breath in dhikr spent
Should sigh al-hamdu lillah till it's bent,
And then denies that any human act
Can raise the soul to heaven as a fact.
Your mercy only comes to make the choice
Within the heart, truly make it rejoice.
It comes in timeless seconds split in two
Like atoms split to shimmer on the dew.
Beloved, crash through my futile dhikr now
And strike me dead while living where I bow,
And I shall rise in the next breath to find
A heavenly repast before which I've dined.

3 Have you seen those who practice well
At shooting at a mark a spell?
You can be sure to miss the spot
On many tries and tries a lot.
And yet they never hope to miss
But always try to hit in bliss.
So do the same, if you desire
To keep God in remembrance' fire.
And when you forget Him, then mourn;
For God shall give you grace in borne
Well to attain all I have sworn.
Fasting and vigil are so close
Entwined in spirit and in dose
That if you break the vigil then
The fast is broken too again.
For when he sins a man will break
The fasting of the soul at stake,
And so forget God for its sake.
To watch and fast in soul are true
Necessities for all the crew,
Since none has right to sin in view.

Sin is to break the soul fast and forget

You in the dhikr of the holy met.
I may recite Your names remembered well
While all the while treading the path to hell.
But I keep shooting at the target set,
Though lazily, I trow, but do not let
Remembrance fail forever. I keep on
With a bow taut and arrow with a yawn.
Though I have never hit the target's eye
In all the many years I try and try,
And sin results from my every good deed,
Still I draw back the bow and in my greed
Let fly another arrow in the bank
To be lost in the bushes where it sank.

4 But fasting of the body and
Its vigils, believe my command,
Are not at all times for all men
To be kept sacredly again.
For there are sick and aged folk,
Women with child, and every bloke
Put on a diet, children, and
The rest of weaker strength to stand.
For everyone, just as he chooses
His dress for the right size and looses
Not sight of the appropriate,
So each should choose then what he ate.
For just children's clothing do
Not match a man of thirty-two,
Just so are the vigil and fast
Of one not suitable to last
For others in the storm and blast."

So true are the words of dear Jesus here,
But surely by these words that here appear
He damns all faith traditions in the lurch
And closes fast the doors of every church.
For institutions make one size for all,
And it may be true in the end and pall
The great majority are of one fit.
But I at least find no place my heart's lit
Among the crowd. The given liturgy
Though grave and beautiful is not for me.
The priestly pattern of fast and of wake
Are deadly to my soul, and so I take
My lonely way up to the mountaintop
And find my narrow laura where I stop.

Barnabas 111

1 'Beware that Satan will use all
His powers to keep you on the ball

Of wakefulness in the night's stall,
And then make you sleep in the day
When by command you ought to pray
And listen to God's word and call.
Say, would you be pleased with the friend
Who ate the meat and in the end
Gave you the bones to chew and bend?"
Peter replied, "No, master, no,
But such a one is rather foe
And mocker than a friend in tow."
2 Then Jesus answered with a sigh,
"You have well said the truth thereby,
O Peter, for truly each one
That watches in the body won
More than is meet, and then will sleep
With heavy head in slumber keep,
When he should be about his prayers,
Or listening to God's Word's repairs,
Such a wretch mocks God his Creator,
And so is guilty of such greater.
Moreover, he's a thief, since he
Steals the time that he ought to be
Giving to God, and spends it when
He takes his pleasure on again.

Jesus in dealing with the exercise
Of soul still keeps the Decalogue for prize
Ever and anon before wondering eyes.
There is no sin but breaking the command
Of Decalogue upon an iron strand.
Sin is so simple that ten words can show
Its very depths and keep soul in the know.
The complications of the liturgy
In round of days and weeks and as we see
In years and years of seven and forty-nine,
These are a weariness of bread and wine.
All is reduced at once to theft at last
And in ten words sinks down before the blast
Of worship and restraints, and fly and cast.

3 In a vessel of the best wine
A man gave his enemies fine
To drink so long as the wine stayed
At its best, but when the wine made
Down to the dregs, he gave his lord
To drink, as to the unadored.
What do you think his master then
Will do to his servant again
When he finds out about the thing,
And the servant stands by the king?

He'll meet him and he'll beat him and
He'll kill him in his wrath to stand,
According to the laws that keep
The world in slumber and in sleep.
Now what will God do to the man
Who spends the best of his time's plan
In business and the worst in prayer
And study of the Law with care?
Woe to the world, because with this
And greater sin in its heart's kiss!
So when I said to you that laughter
Should be turned into weeping after,
And feasts to fasting, and your sleep
To vigils in the night to keep,
I said in three words all the thing
That you have heard on earth to ring
That one ought always here to weep,
And weeping should come from the keep
Of the heart, since God our Creator
Is one offended by us later;
That you ought to fast so to be
The master of your senses free,
And so to watch and not to sin;
So bodily weeping in din
And bodily fasting and such
Vigils should be taken as much
As everyone can bear to touch."

It sounds good, but the fact is that the fast
Does not make one the chief iconoclast
Of his own senses, no, and not at all.
It's rather opposite in hell and hall.
The fast will force awareness sharp and clear
Of hunger as the sense that all hold dear.
It heightens every sense to feel the pain
And drawing out of everything that's vain.
It's rather luxury, the well-filled plate
That opens up opportunity to wait
For spiritual and elevated things
Come in the heart with sweet, untiring wings.
The fast makes faster think only of bread
And how he may the sooner be one fed.

Barnabas 112

1 Having said this, Jesus replied:
"You need to seek the fruit beside
The field which will sustain our life,
For it is now eight days of strife
That we've eaten no food at all.
That's why unto our God I'll call,

And will wait for you here indeed
With Barnabas as we've agreed."
2 So all the disciples as well
As the apostles left a spell
By fours and by sixes to go
Their way as Jesus said to flow.
The one who writes this stayed behind.
Jesus in tears said "Please don't mind,
Barnabas, that I need to tell
You greater secrets as a knell,
Which after I have gone away
From this world, you will come to say
Them openly clear as a bell."
Then he who writes answered to say
With tears, "Let me weep as you stay,
Master, and other men the same,
For we are sinners and to blame.
And you, saint and prophet of God,
It's not fitting you weep abroad."
3 Jesus replied, "Believe me now,
Barnabas that I cannot bow
To tears enough and as I ought.
For if men had not called me God,
I should have seen God on the sod
As He will be in paradise,
And should have been safe not to fear
The day of judgement will appear.
But God knows I am innocent,
Because I never here have lent
A thought to be held other than
A poor slave serving and a man.
No, I tell you that If I had
Not been called God, a thing so bad,
I should have been carried on high
Into paradise by and by,
Whereas now I shall not go there
Until the judgement come in share.
Now you see I have cause to weep
Because of the judgement I keep.

The teaching of the Gospel does belie
The canon with the doctrine sent to fly
That Jesus was one slated not to die
But be caught up to Paradise to sing
With angels on the shimmering of wing.
But the result of people saying he
Was God Almighty meant the plan to be
Was changed so that he too must wait his share
When day of judgement comes to judge the fair.
That does suggest the writing came in sign

After the canon was closed with its wine.
It is no proof. What strikes me to the bone
Is that is so right that You alone
Sit above all upon the sovereign throne.

4 Know, Barnabas, that for this I
Must have great persecution's cry,
And shall be sold by one my own
For thirty bits of silver drone.
Then I am certain that the one
Who shall sell me shall be undone
And slain in my name, for God will
Take me up from the earthly spill,
And shall change the face of that man
To look like me down to a span.
But when he dies an evil death,
I shall stay in dishonour's breath
For a long time in this dark world.
But when Muhammad is unfurled,
The sacred Messenger of God,
That infamy shall hit the sod.
And God will do this because I
Have confessed the truth to the sky
Of the Messiah who shall give
Me this reward by which to live,
And not be taken by that death
Of infamy that caught his breath."
Then he who writes said in reply,
O master, tell me who's that sly
Wretch, for I'd choke him by and by."
"Be still," said Jesus, "God so wills,
He cannot do other than swills.
But when you see my mother come
To suffer at that death of bum,
Tell her the truth so that she may
Be comforted at last that way."
Then he who writes made this reply:
"Master, I'll do all this or die."

Jesus in secret tells the whole plan to
Barnabas face to face with just the two.
The miracles involved and convolution
See to me not an elegant solution.
Truth is that in matters of history
The things that seem important here to see
Are always muddied by some who are sure
Another truth is revealed to the pure.
I am a doubter. Such was I when born,
And I hold certainty of mind in scorn.
The Decalogue I take as certain true,

Not for its history, but good things to do.
The crucifixion or not, I let go.
But I'm glad for sweet Mary's sake to know.

Barnabas 113

1 When the disciples had returned,
They brought the pine cones to be burned
And by God's will plenty of dates.
After the noon prayer at the gates
They ate with Jesus what they'd earned.
Apostles and disciples saw
The one who writes downcast in awe,
And so they thought that Jesus soon
Might depart from the world in boon.
So Jesus comforted them saying,
"Do not fear, because I am staying
Here for a little time still weighing.
So I must teach you now so you
May go as I have told you to
Throughout the land of Israel
To preach repentance for a spell,
So that God may have mercy on
The sin of all Israel's spawn.
Let each beware of sloth and more
So he that does penance in store,
Because each tree that does not bear
Good fruit shall be cut down with care
And cast into the furnace door.

The sin that Jesus the Saviour has come
To save his folk, the fold of Israel from
Is the sin of calling him Son of God,
That is, the God Almighty come on sod.
The words of all the Gospels here are lent
To contradict that gross heresy bent.
What I doubt above all is that the Jew
Of any time could err so greatly too.
No Roman soldiers suffice to make them
Think a man is a god and sovereign gem.
But that may simply be my biased view
That foists off on the former priest and dolt
The same doctrines they espoused in revolt
After Islam influenced mare and colt.

2 There was a landsman who possessed
A vineyard in which he had dressed
A garden with a fine fig tree
Which bore no fruit after full three
Years passed. Since every other tree
Bore fruit, the owner told the guy

Who kept the garden to be spry
 To cut down the tree that stood by
 To take of room and ground thereby.
 The gardener came to reply,
 "Not yet, sir, it's a pretty tree."
 The owner said, "Don't speak to me,
 I do not care for such beauty.
 You know that palm and balsam are
 Both finer trees than figs by far.
 I planted these both in my yard,
 With walls expensive round them barred,
 But when they bore no fruit, just leaves,
 That piled up and rotted by eaves,
 I'll have them both cut down at last.
 So how shall I forgive one fast
 That grows far from the house and stays
 To cumber up my garden ways
 And block my vineyard, when the rest
 Of my trees bear fruit with the best?
 I'll not put up with it for days."
 3 Then said the gardener, "Sir, see,
 The soil is too rich on the lea.
 Wait one more year and I will prune
 The fig tree's branches and I'll soon
 Take off the rich soil and replace
 It with a poorer mix in trace,
 With stones, and so it will bear fruit."
 The owner answered, "Well then shoot.
 I'll wait for the tree to bear fruit."
 So do you understand the way
 Of things in this I mean to say?"
 The disciples replied in kind,
 No, sir, so make it clear in mind."

See how poor I am at the draw and stick!
 I dibble and produce not one stalk thick,
 Because I would have thought the richest soil
 Merited more and more of farmer's toil.
 My lack of farming skill and knowledge show
 Why I am no success with plough and hoe.
 I would have been like the landowner brief
 Whose ignorance would have brought him to grief.
 I need a gardener, that is one thing true,
 If I expect my garden without rue
 To bear the herb and onion and the pear,
 The cherry and the chard, rose and aster.
 But I am far too stingy to hire one
 To come and correct the mistakes I've done.

Barnabas 114

1 Jesus replied: "Truly I say
To you, the owner is God, hey,
And the vinedresser is His Law.
So God had in paradise awe
Of the palm and of the balsam;
For Satan is the palm to slam
And the first man the balsam tree.
Then He cast them out since you see
They did not bear fruit of good acts,
But spoke false things as they were facts,
That brought the condemnation on
Many angels and men withdrawn.
So God has placed man in the world,
Among His creatures that have swirled
To serve God, all of them indeed,
According to His law with speed.
And man, I say, bearing no fruit,
God would cut him down to the shoot,
And send him into hell since he
Punished angel eternally
Without pardon, and the first man
He punished for a certain span.

The reason I was born into this world,
The reason any human is uncurled
From out the womb, is just for this one cause
And for this purpose: to obey Your laws.
The futile preacher says it can't be done,
But that is foolish to complain and run,
For no one tells his child that he must do
The thing that he cannot, unless for rue,
That parent is too stupid to take note
Of the capacity of child in rote.
I shall not call You stupid, my Beloved,
When You tell me to do the things I've shoved
Into the game of my neglect and stow.
You say to hoe, and so I hoe the row.

2 So the Law of God says the man
Has too much good in this life's span,
So he must needs be tried by trouble
And be deprived of earthly bubble,
So he may attain to good deeds.
So God expects men in their weeds
To be repentant. Truly I
Tell you, our God's condemned the sly
Man to work, so that, as said Job,
The friend and prophet in a robe
Of God: 'As the bird's born to fly,
And the fish to swim, under sky

Was humankind born here to work.'
So David our dad did not shirk,
But as God's prophet says: 'As we
Eat the labours of our hands, we
Shall be blessed and well shall it be
With us.' So let us every one
Work according to what he's done.
Now tell me, if David our dad
And Solomon, his son not sad,
Worked with their hands, then what ought we
As sinners do to set us free?"

The implication is that David and
Solomon his son obeyed Your command
And were not mischief-makers in the land.
The Jew and Christian read the Bible to
Claim with the Muslim it says that for rue
Both David and son Solomon were great
At sinning long and loud before the gate.
I think that is a mischief-making state.
Beloved, let me sin as much as Your good
And bold, both David and Solomon could,
And I shall be glad that my hand's attained
To all the things a human being's gained.
Let me work while the day is bright and I
Fail not to find a task to do or try.

3 Said John: "Master, to work's a thing
Fitting, but this ought to be fling
Of the poor only on the wing."
Jesus replied, "Yes, for they can
Never do any other plan.
But don't you know that a good thing
In order to be good must sing
Without necessity to bring?
So the sun and the planets too
Are strengthened by the laws to do
That God gave so they cannot be
Otherwise, so there's no degree
Of merit. Tell me, when God gave
Command to work, did He make slave
By saying: 'A poor man shall live
By the sweat of his face to give?'
And Job did not say 'As a bird
Is born to fly, so in a word
A poor man's born to work'? Absurd.
But God said to man: 'In the sweat
Of your brow you shall eat bread yet.'
And Job said that a man is born
To work. And so all men are sworn

To work if they are humans born.
That's why all things on earth cost much,
But there's many a lazy touch.
If these worked too, some to attend
The ground and some to fish and spend
Their time upon the sea, there would
Be plenty in the world or could.
And of the lack of such good things
It will be needed to give strings
In explanation on the day
Of dread account coming our way.

Jesus here recognizes to employments
Given by God to humans for enjoyments:
The task of farmer ploughing up his field,
And task of fisherman to find the yield
Of sea and lake and stream upon the earth.
Two professions are here held up in worth.
I have fished little, so I'm not one praised
For having worked at task, so be amazed.
I've grown a little more in herb and fruit
Than I have fished, for harvest and its boot.
But if we count just farming and poor fishing,
Then I'm more lazy, Beloved, than You're wishing.
To think I've counted men gone out to fish
As lazy and not worthy of the dish!

Barnabas 115

1 Let man say somewhat more to me.
What has he brought into the free
World, by insisting that he live
In idleness, nothing to give?
He truly was born naked here,
Helpless as any would appear.
That's why of everything he's found
He's not the owner on the ground
But simply the user around.
He'll have then to give an account
On the dread day of judgement's fount.
2 Abominable lust, that makes
Man like the brute beasts in their wakes,
Ought to be feared, feared very much;
For the foe is of one's own touch,
So that you cannot get away.
How many people lust will slay!
Through lust came the great Flood one time
So the world perished in its crime
Before God's mercy, so were saved
Only Noah and those who braved
It with him, numbered eighty-three.

For lust God felled three cities fair
In wickedness. Escaped from there
Only Lot and two children left.
For lust the tribe of Benjamin
Was almost destroyed in its sin.
Truly I say, should I tell you
How many perished in lust's view,
I'd talk on for five days or more."
James spoke up: "Oh Lord, tell us now
What lust signifies anyhow."

Of the three motivations in men's heart,
Lust may be the most pure, for it has part
To keep the race in population's cart
So that humanity will not die out.
And so I take these words with salt and doubt.
It was not lust destroyed the earth that day
When Noah joined the animals in sway
Within the ark to save them from the flood.
It was not lust but cruel lust for blood.
Lust, cruelty and greed, these are the three
Motivations, but Jesus speaks truly
That all are lust: lust for pleasure to see,
Lust for blood and lust for wealth on the tree.
Keep me, Beloved, from lust in lust in mud.

3 Jesus replied: "Lust is the way
Unbridled and in desire's sway
For love, not led by reasons, so
The limits of man's mind in show
Burst with affections, so that man,
Not knowing himself in the span,
Loves the thing which he ought to hate.
Believe me, when man loves a thing,
Not because God has shed the wing,
But as its owner, he is then
A fornicator among men.
He has united then his soul,
Which ought to stay in God as goal
Which is its Creator, with that
Which was created and set flat.
So God complains by Isaiah,
The prophet, saying "Without awe
You've fornicated with a lot
Of lovers, still return as sought
And I shall take you back in plot.

Idolatry is fornication bent,
And that is lust, desire and a love spent,
But You've created humankind to be

And do and propagate, produce freely,
And none of this is done without the lust
And desire to acquire the things that rust.
Lust brings to propagation, cruelty Prevents the competition in the spree
From taking the wealth needed to survive,
And greed is needed to keep self alive
By coveting the fruit and nut and date.
So You have made mankind here at the gate.
Beloved, give me enough of lust, my share
Of cruelty and greed to take a care.

4 As God lives in whose presence my
Soul stands, if there were not in sly
Lust in the heart of man, he would
Not fall in the external wood.
For if the root is cut away,
The tree soon dies, it is that way.
So let a man be satisfied
With the wife given to abide
With him from the Creator's side,
And forget other women's ride."
But Andrew answered and replied:
"How can a man ever forget
Women when his own home is set
In the city where such are met?"
Jesus replied: "O Andrew dear,
The one who lives in cities' fear
Is surely harmed, because such places
Are sponges drawing wicked faces.

Ah! Here's the rub between Abram and Lot:
The one chose to live in the city plot,
The other was left on the land to rot
In barrenness. Beloved, see what they got!
It's true that Sodom's like the city found
In every sort of plain and mountain ground,
Where men are wicked and evil in sound.
I see the thing in sight and all around.
But bold necessity may make men fly
To town to find the work to live and try,
And even Lot, though greedy in his choice
Did not go after other women's voice,
But stuck to his own wife until she turned
Into a cake of salt while Sodom burned.

Barnabas 116

1 A man should always live in town,
As does the soldier with a frown
When he has foes around the fort,
Defending himself from their sport

And fearing treachery to rise
From any citizen in guise.
So I say let him hold his own
Against sinful enticements grown,
And fear the sense, because it claims
Supreme desire for impure flames.
But how shall he defend himself
Unless he hides his eye from elf
Which is the start of fleshly sin
Of every kind in every bin?
As God lives before whom I stand,
The one who does not have the eyes
Of flesh is safe on every hand
Not to be punished in the rise
Except to the third in degree,
While the one who has eyes shall be
Punished to the seventh degree.

The nomad Rechabites went into town
To live when the armies came marching down
And there took refuge from the dangers that
Threatened the wild tents where they always sat.
So Jesus notes that every man of right
Should fortify himself against the night
Of sin that threatens heart and mind and soul
As well as every action that's their goal.
Beloved, between the town and forest I
Look out on tranquil lake and empty sky
And wonder that the peace has lasted long,
Among the folk who still know not the wrong
From right, but stand without a thought to shoot
Any invader in the heart or boot.

2 In the time of the prophet sweet
Elijah it happened to meet
That Elijah saw a blind man
Weeping, a man of a good scan,
And asked him: "Brother, why now weep?"
The blind man answered question deep
"I weep because I cannot see
Elijah the prophet to be
A holy one of God to me."
Elijah chided him to say:
"Stop crying, man, you sin that way."
The blind man answered: "Now tell me,
Is it a sin for me to see
A holy prophet that God sent
To raise the dead, make fire spent
From heaven falling from the sky?"
Elijah answered in reply:

You do not speak the truth, but lie,
 Elijah cannot do at all
 The things you claim he can install,
 Because he's just a man like you.
 For all the world's men cannot make
 One fly to be born for their sake."
 The blind man said "You say this thing
 Because Elijah came to sting
 You for some sin of yours so you
 Hate him to come back in your view."
 3 Elijah answered: "May it please
 God that you speak the truth in ease,
 Because if I should come to hate
 Elijah, then I should love God;
 And the more I cast on the clod
 Of hate on Elijah, the more
 I should come to love God in store."
 So the blind man in wrath replied;
 "As God lives, you're a man to chide,
 Impious too! Can God be loved
 While one hates the prophets He shoved
 Into the world? So go away,
 I'll not listen to what you say."
 Elijah answered: "Brother, now
 You may see with your mind and brow
 How evil is the fleshly sight.
 For you desire with all your might
 To see Elijah, yet you hate
 Elijah with your soul in mate."
 The blind man answered: "Go away,
 You are the devil come to say
 Such against God's own holy one
 And make me sin when you have done."

The prophet with disciples is the one
 Co-opted by the devil who has spun
 Such guru worship under moon and sun
 That the elect of God turn from the throne
 To worship at altar of flesh and bone.
 No prophet's accepted in his home town,
 Said Jesus when he met Nazarene frown,
 And yea he spoke the truth, but prophet met
 A year's journey from his birthplace will get
 The welcome of hyena in the camp
 And the name of jackass for forehead stamp.
 Beloved, I'm fortunate that I'm none sent
 To anyone with message to prevent
 Your speaking to the heart in frantic vent.

4 Elijah gave a sigh, and said

With tears: "You've spoken the truth led,
O brother, for my flesh, which you
Desire to see, separates you
From God." Said the blind man: "I do
Not wish to see you; no, if I
Had my eyes, I would not be shy
To close them so as not to see."
Then said Elijah: "Brother, know
That I'm Elijah on the go!"
The blind man answered: "You do not
Speak what is true and what is sought."
Elijah's disciples then said:
"Brother, he truly is in stead
Of God's own prophet known by name
Elijah, he's the one and same."
Said the blind man: "Let him tell me,
If he's the prophet, who I be
And of what certain family
And how I came never to see?"

The church-goers will always make demands
Evaluating preachers on their sands
And they'll reject the meek and lowly heart
With pompous revelations on their part.
St. Francis is my hero from the start,
And the beast of the field without a cart
A better congregation in this world
Than human listener to the word unfurled.
Beloved, all those you've sent into this place
Have been rejected to their very face.
You would be wiser far to send instead
An angel with a bright halo of dread
To waken those who slumber and give sight
To those caught in the love of flesh and might.

Barnabas 117

1 Elijah answered: "You were born
To the tribe of Levi; for scorn
In coming to God's temple you
Looked lewdly on a woman's view,
For which our God removed your sight."
Then the blind man weeping outright
Said: "Pardon me, O holy man,
Prophet of God, for without plan
I've sinned in speaking here with you;
I had not done so, had I view."

Only by the revealing secret sin
Did the prophet finally come to win
The confidence of the man with blind eye.

He would not hear the doctrine or the sigh
Of truth to cleanse him from the sinful cry.
A miracle of knowledge without fruit
Is what the careless crown bends down to root.
And so unknown, unseen heaven passes by.
Beloved, look what the man admits for wrong:
The error in not recognizing song
Of guru as he passes in the throng,
And that he blames on lack of fleshly sight.
Nothing will penetrate the human blight.
I ponder my own species, ponder long.

2 Elijah answered: "May our God
Pardon you, brother, on the sod,
Because I know you've told the truth
About me, for the more I hate
Myself the more I love in state
My God, and if you saw me you
Would quash your own desire to view,
Which is not pleasing in God's view.
For Elijah is not your maker,
But God; which is why in your acre
I am the devil," and so cried
Elijah with tears come undried,
Because I turn you from the way
Of your Creator on this day.
So weep, O brother, because you
Have not the light which would make you
See instead of the false the true,
For if you had had that, you'd not
Have despised my doctrine when taught.
That's why I tell you, many hope
To see me and come on the lope
From far to see me, who despise
My words. It would be better far
For their salvation popular
If they had no eyes, because each
Finds pleasure in created peach,
Whoever he may be, and will
Not seek to find his pleasure fill
In God, and has made in his heart
An idol from the very start
And so forsaken God apart."
Then Jesus spoke up with a sigh:
"Have you understood all that dear
Elijah said as well as why?"
And the disciples without fear
Replied: "Indeed we understand,
And we are shocked to know the band
Here on the earth who do not pray

To idols is so few in sway.”

The very prophets that You send to men
Become the idols they worship again
When turned from stone and silver and from gold,
They grasp at the rod pointed, the word told,
Instead of finding the divine face where
The prophet had directed them to stare.
The wisest of men will admire the frame
Of looking glass and before it exclaim
Of its grace and its beauty, and not see
His own face in the glass. Immunity
From truth is the strength of the human race.
Of wonder and insight there is no trace.
Beloved, have pity on disarming crowd
And on my poor soul too among the loud.

Barnabas 118

1 Then Jesus said: "You speak the truth,
For now was Israel from his youth
Wilful to take idolatry
That they have in their hearts to see,
In holding me for God, and so
Many of them are on the go
To despise my teaching and show,
Saying that I could raise myself
To lord of all Judaea's shelf,
If I confessed myself to be
God, and that I am mad to be
Living here in such poverty
In desert places, not to stay
Among the princes in their way
Of living in delicacy.
Oh driven man who loves to see
Light common to flies and to ants,
And yet despises and recants
Before the light common to see
By angels and prophets and those
Of God His friends, the ones He chose.

What nonsense is this thing I read and see,
That the folk wanted Jesus then to be
God and then they would make
Him king of all the country and the stake?
It's king they wanted, one to set them free
From Rome and Roman sort of butchery.
A human hero is a rare thing while
New gods come dime a cousin on the smile.
Beloved, I find that human life is blessed
With many incongruities unguessed

In youth and which make the thing worth the bit
Between the teeth and every flailing fit
It takes to stay alive. Beloved, give me
Another lifetime in this wizardry.

2 If, then, the eye shall not be guarded,
O Andrew, I tell you uncared
That it's impossible for you
Not to fall headlong in the pew
Of lust. That's why the prophet came,
One Jeremiah for his name,
And said in truth: "My eye's a thief
That robs my soul and puts to grief."

Jesus warns that to guard the eye one must
If one would escape falling into lust.
I say that shows a lack of trial in life.
It's not the eye that draws one to the wife,
But rather something closer in the breast.
It seems lust was not well known by the guest
Of humankind two thousand years ago.
The increases in populations show
We are more expert in lust in this day
Than they were when Jesus talked in that way.
Beloved, let lust remain, for otherwise
There will be no folk left on earth to rise
Before Your throne to give You all the praise
That You deserve for giving lustful days.

That's why our father David said
In prayer of greatest longing bred,
Toward God our Lord that he would turn
Away his eyes not to discern
All vanity. For truly all
That has an end is vain to call.
Tell me, then, if one had two pence
To buy bread, would he lack such sense
To buy smoke? Surely not, but see
As smoke just hurts the eye's degree
But gives the body not a whit
Of nourishment or any fit.
So let man do, for with outright
Sight of his eyes and inward sight
Of his mind he should seek to know
God his Creator and the show
Of the good pleasure of his will,
And should not make the creature fill
His end, which causes him to lose
Sight of creator and refuse.

It only Jesus could see the world now,
After invention of tobacco, how
Much smoke is bought and paid for by the young
And old and rich and poor men on the rung,
He would be one amazed himself and stand
Like his own shocked disciples on the sand
Before his words. The greater century,
The era of the great society,
In which I've spent the greater part of life
Is era of tobacco and of strife.
As I enter a new age with my wife,
I hope to see a change, with far less smoke
And warfare on which men and women choke.
I am a senseless, hopeful sort of bloke.

Barnabas 119

1 For truly every time a man
Beholds a thing and in the scan
Forgets God who's made it for man,
He has then sinned. For if a friend
Of yours should give you something to
Keep safe for him, and you should do
Him wrong by selling it and then
Forgetting your friend among men,
Then you have offended your friend.
Just so does this man in the end.
For when he sees the creature and
Has no mind to Creator's hand,
And who for love of man creates,
It's God his Creator he hates
By the ingratitude he prates.

This radical Sufism is too much
I swear for Arab as well as for Dutch.
Sin rises as soon as the dhikr ends
And fills with wickedness all Sufi friends.
If dhikr is a window on disgrace,
The only moment for the human race
That is without sin, then let me appear
From morning till the new dawn in Your fear
Reciting every exquisite divine
Name that is known to men who drink the wine.
Beloved, though I may slumber at the task
And eyes close behind my revealing mask,
Let me not depart from the sacred name
That burns my soul with love from flame to flame.

2 So the one who sees women and
Forgets God who by His own hand
Created woman for the good

Of man, will love her and he should
Desire her. So greatly will lust
Break out that everything that must
Remind him of her he will wish.
So sin shameful to see in dish
Arises that one should not mind.
If men put bridle on their eyes,
To rule the senses and the prize,
He could not then desire the thing
That he could not see on the wing.
So should the flesh be under rule
Of spirit and stay in its school.
Just as the ship cannot go far
Without the wind on every spar,
So the flesh without sense cannot
Sin in the mesh where sin is caught.

If things were so simple, Beloved, as that,
The blind would never come up to the bat
And enter in the unfaithful pretence
That condones the adultery's offence.
But faith is that the blind are as adept
At fornication in a mind unswept
And in a heart unfaithful and confined
In spirit. So too is each one born blind.
Beloved, the only thing keeps any man
From sin is the grace of eternal plan,
The sovereign word that falls from heaven above
And so changes the heart from lust to love.
I watch the passing stream of human waste
In lives swirled by the currents that You've placed.

3 Reason alone without command
Of God shows that repentance stand
Should make story-telling a prayer.
For in each idle word man sins,
And God blots out sin and begins
To do so by reason of prayer.
For prayer's advocate of the soul;
And prayer's medicine of the soul;
Prayer is the defence of the heart;
Prayer is the weapon of faith's part,
Prayer is the bridle of the sense;
Prayer is the salt of the flesh tense
That keeps it uncorrupted by
The sin that tempts men on the sly.
I tell you pray the hands of life
By which the man who prays in strife
Shall thus defend himself the day
Of judgement come upon his way.

For he shall keep his soul from sin
Here on the earth and thus shall win
His heart that it shall not be touched
By the desires of wicked clutched;
And so offending Satan more
Because he shall keep his sense door
Within the Law of God, and yet
His flesh shall walk where only's met
God's righteousness, and so receive
From God all he asks in reprieve.

The secret of my weak faith and my doubt
Is the fact that prayer is one thing without
Which I have lived from decade to decade,
If prayer's the sincere, heartfelt accolade.
I've prayed the prayers prostrated that the great
Islamic scholars insist on to date.
I've prayed in congregation of the vile
Who love not to keep Your law all the while.
But I have not knelt in the gathered way
The Evangelical folk come to pray,
Nor have I much enjoyed the circle bound
In prayer by holding hands and all around,
As the charismatics do on the ground.
Perhaps I need a glossalalic sound.

4 As God lives, before whom we are,
A man without prayer cannot star
In good works more than a dumb man
Can plead his cause to a blind scan;
Than a fistula can be healed
Without an ointment plied and sealed;
Than a man can defend himself
While sitting quietly on shelf;
Or attack others without gun;
Or sail without a rudder spun;
Or preserve dead flesh without salt;
For truly one without hand's vault
Cannot receive a gift for fault.
If man could change dung into gold
And clay to sugar in his hold,
What would he do if he were bold?

If I could change dung into gold, I would.
Dung's a problem for disposal for good.
Also, the price of gold would drop in fact
As soon as my dung on the market smacked.
But then gold is not very useful here
As substance. Just think what to do with tear
With all the gold turds lying round the door.

The house would fill with gold in golden store.
Even the edging on the flower beds
Would overflow before long with such dreads
Of golden excrement instead of stone
Or brickbats lined up against spread of groan.
Beloved, let my stool stay in excrement.
It's worth more than the gold in gardens sent.

5 So Jesus being silent, then
The disciples answered again:
"No one would do anything but
Make gold and sugar to the glut."
Then Jesus said: "Now why does not
Man change foolish stories in plot
To prayer? Is time perhaps to him
Granted by God that he may trim
Offence to God? For what prince would
Give a town to his subject good
So that the subject might make war
Upon him with the gift in store?
As God lives, if man only knew
How the soul's changed by the vain brew
Of talking, he would sooner bite
Off his own tongue with his teeth white
Than talk and prattle of the right.
O wretched world! For today men
Do not come together again
For prayer, but in the temple porch
And in the temple come to scorch
Is Satan by the sacrifice
Of vain talk, and the greater vice
Of which I cannot talk or name
Unless I bear the thing for shame.

The sermon and the skit in the church frame
Is what's important to religious game,
And rousing singing sung to a rock beat
Is praise enough for every sly deadbeat.
I've seen the prayer of many gathered round
With hands upon the head and feet on ground,
And all the music ringing and the voice
Of shouting as to thank You and rejoice.
I turn from prayer to prayer, Beloved, and know
That there is something other than the show.
The prayer of a small voice and still will go
Much farther in my heart and in the sky
Than the thrill of prayer shouted by and by.

Barnabas 120

1 The fruit of vain talking is this,

That it weakens the mind with bliss
Unready to receive the truth;
Just as a horse brought up from youth
To carry just an ounce in load
Of cottonflock cannot be stowed
With carrying a hundred pounds
Of stone. But what is worse in grounds
Is the man who spends time in jest.
When he's about to pray the best,
Satan will bring to mind those same
Jokes so that when he should lay claim
To weeping for his sins in hope
That God will have mercy and scope
Of some forgiveness for his sins,
By laughing he provokes with grins
His God to anger; without doubt
He'll chastise him and cast him out.

The Chisti knows that jokes are just a way
To weep for one's own sin rather than play
The hypocrite or the fool for a day,
For on the morrow we must die, they say.
One can flee heart conviction with the sound
Of laughter and of merriment around,
And that is the most common sort that's found,
And so Barnabas is right on his ground.
But still the Chisti knows that laughter can
Open the heart to the Beloved One's plan
And show the sore of sin and bring remorse.
A cotton load too can bring down a horse.
Beloved, I laugh to tears as I repent
Before the words of life that You have sent.

2 Woe, therefore, to the ones who joke
And talk vainly in what they spoke!
But if our God abhors the folk
That joke and talk vain things, how will
He hold them that murmur and still
Bring slander on their neighbour's hill,
And in what plight will they be who
Deal with sinning as though they too
Must do so for business in view?
Oh impure world, I cannot know
How grievously you'll not be slow
To get your punishment from God!
He who would take penance by rod
Must give out his words at the price
Of gold and measured slice by slice.

I do rebel against that providence

In every church and mosque that slander's dense
Upon the hardened heart of sinner laid,
And for slander the greatest price is paid.
See those who have no other power to show
But to weep and give plaint on their hard row
For what the wicked hypocrites have done
To them under the brazen, burning sun.
Community of faithful always take
The poor oppressed and call their plaint the rake
Of slander of the saints. Beloved, I cry
Against all those who preach under the sky
That slander is a sin. It is a prayer
To You, Beloved, to take the oppressed's share.

3 His disciples replied: "Who will
Buy a man's words at gold's price still?
Surely no one. And how shall he
Do penance? He's certain to be
One covetous!" Then Jesus said:
"You have your heart so heavy bled
That I can't lift it up instead.
So I must explain every word.
And tell you the meaning conferred.
But thank God who has given you
Grace to know God's mysteries too.
I don't say that the penitent
Should seal his talking where he went,
But I say that when he speaks loud,
He ought to think that he has ploughed
With gold. For truly doing so,
As gold is spent on things for show,
And for the necessary stow,
He'll only talk what's needed though.
And just as no one spends his gold
On a thing that should not be sold
That hurts his body, so let him
Not talk of anything thing that's dim
To cause hurt to his soul out cold.

The chatter of the spirit in the heart
Keeps me from harsh repentance for the part
Of what my hands and feet have done of ill.
Talk is a lovely thing with which to fill
Condemning silence. Let me take my tongue
And chatter up the ladder's final rung
Until the voice of conscience silenced by
My noisy chatter lays me down to die.
Or then, Beloved, have mercy on my soul
And give me of the gold of what I stole
From my own heart and house, and show me where

The silent part's better than words of prayer.
I'll take a cup of tea from those sent out
From the church to the homeless ones in doubt.

Barnabas 121

1 When the ruler's arrested some
Prisoner to examine him,
While the clerk writes everything down,
Tell me, how does such a man frown
To talk with care? So then replied
The disciples: "He speaks to hide
Superfluous and talks in fear
And to the point, it would appear,
So as not to give room to doubt
And wonder what he is about,
And carefully avoids the case
That might displease the ruler's face,
But tries to say something to get
His freedom from the stroke he met.
Then Jesus answered: "So indeed
Ought the penitent to give heed
To do and so not lose his soul.
For God's given two angels by
Each man to write what they may spy,
The one writes down the good he sees,
The other the evil degrees
Of wickedness the man has done.
So if a man seeks what he's won
In mercy, let him measure well
His speech more than his gold to sell.

Islamic belief's evident again
In the two angels writing down what men
May do and say. I do not doubt that word,
But do believe two angels have been stirred
To write down both the good and evil act
As well as word that humans do in fact.
The record then is sure and pure and fine.
The record's straight, I need no defence signed.
So I am grateful to those who are free
To slander and to gander about me.
I'm grateful what they say is not the truth,
I'm grateful that they gloss over my youth,
And praise me with a faith damnation's glaze,
When they might have told truly my sin's maze.

Barnabas 122

1 As for avarice, that must be
Changed into alms-giving for free.
Indeed I say as the plumb line

Has for its goal the centre fine,
So has the greedy many for goal
The fires of hell and stoked with coal.
For it's impossible to take
One's greedy gain to paradise.
Do you know why? Then I shall make
It plain to you. May God suffice,
In whose presence my soul does stand,
The avaricious, though his tongue
Keep silence, his hand in the dung
Proclaims "There is no god but I."
For all he has he loves to spend
From his own pleasure not to bend,
Without regard to his own end
Or to his start, that he was born
In nakedness and dies forlorn.

There is no god but I's become the creed
Of every man I know with clock and speed.
There is no I but god is true, I know,
With mind, but my own heart tells me not so,
But I too must compete with I to go
Through maze of fame and fortune in the show.
Let me, Beloved, come in the faith of choice,
The true faith in which the humble rejoice,
And proclaim to the empty air and crown
That there is no I but God on the town.
There is not I but God be my fast hymn,
And let it light my heart and come to trim
My wick till I burn down in ecstasy
And fly up a spark glowing momentarily.

2 Now tell me; if Herod should give
You a garden to keep and live,
And you acted as if you owned
It and sent no goods to the throned
Herod, and when Herod sent for
Produce you turned out from the door
His messengers, tell me, would you
Be setting yourselves up in view
As kings of that garden and true?
Now I say that the greedy man
Makes himself god over the span
Of the wealth God gave him in plan.
3 Greed is a thirst of the sense, which
On losing God through sinful pitch
By life of pleasure, can no more
Delight itself in godly store
Which hides from it, but must surround
Itself with earthly things and ground

Which it holds as both good and sound.
It just increases in the way
Deprived of God and divine sway.
And so conversion of the sinner
Is from God only, who's the winner
Providing the grace to repent.
As said our father David: "This
Change comes from God's right hand, don't miss."
I need to tell you of man's way,
If you would know repentance' sway.
And so today let us return
Thanks to God, who gives not to spurn
The grace to us to make known here
His will by my work spoken clear.

Let all men rave, Beloved, for Barnabas,
Some shouting it's a forgery to pass
And others saying it's the only one
Among the Gospels that You gave for fun.
This Gospel is above all the one which
Enlightens me and draws me from the ditch.
There is no clearer word in all the way
Of revelation than this golden ray
That tells me that all is grace, grace alone,
And by grace only I stand at Your throne.
Contentions pass in dim retreat as I
Turn back to drink this bounty from the sky
And leave the wealth of all faiths at my back
And in Your grace eternal find no lack.

4 At that he lifted up his hands
And prayed in solemn words' commands:
"Lord God Almighty, merciful,
Who in mercy created us,
Made us the rank of men to pull,
Your servants with faith in the true
Messenger You send, we thank You
For all Your benefits beside,
Desire to worship You and bide
All the days of our life as we
Confess our sins and prayerfully
Give alms, fast, and study Your word,
Teaching those who have not yet heard
Your will, as we suffer the world
For love of You even to death
To serve You till our final breath.
Do You, Lord, save us from the claw
Of Satan, from the flesh and maw
Of the world, even as You save
Your chosen from sin and the grave

For love of Your own self and for
Love of your Messenger in store
For whom you did create us, and
For love of all Your holy grand
Saints and prophets upon the land.”
And the disciples made reply
“Amen, amen, Lord of the sky,
Amen, God of mercy at hand.”

Of the five pillars of Islamic faith
Jesus makes a caricature in wraith.
There's prayer and alms and fasting writ out right,
But everything else glows in different light.
Instead of crying oneness on the way
To pilgrimage, I see another sway:
To study the word instead of walk round,
And love your Messenger to Allah bound.
I've done my pilgrimage, but no doubt I
Have with my sins since then annulled the try.
I've hailed from day to day one God alone,
But failed no doubt to pay due to Your throne.
I take all seven pillars as my pill,
Repenting, my Beloved, for all I spill.

Barnabas 123

1 When it was day, a Friday morn,
Early Jesus, and without scorn
After the prayer, assembled his
Disciples and told them the biz:
"Let's sit down here; for as God made
Man of the clay of earth waylaid,
So I shall tell the algebra
Of what man is, in sha Allah.”
When all were seated on the ground,
Jesus repeated the profound:
“To show His creatures goodness and
Mercy as well as His power grand,
Justice and generosity,
God composed salvation in fee
Of four contrasting elements,
And joined the four in complements
To make the one, which is a man:
Earth, air, water and fire in plan
That each may temper in its span
Its opposite in Eden's gan.

The elements of Aristotle take
A meaning of the spirit for the sake
Of every dervish come in memory
Of Your name, my Beloved, in purity.

The four gates enter on the way of life
And open the bright visions beyond strife
To heaven above and to the divine throne
Until the dervish makes Your name his own.
I walk the ways of earth, water and fire
And air up to the portals of desire
And find the words of Jesus are still true
In everything I find to think and do.
In every way I turn upon the earth,
I find new visions of Your divine worth.

2 And he made of these four things caught
A vessel, which is body wrought
For man, of flesh, and bones, and blood,
And marrow, and skin, and with flood
Of nerves and veins, and inward parts;
And there within God's stops and starts
He placed the soul and senses' arts
As two hands of this life; to give
A lodging to the sense to live
In every part of body's whole,
Diffused therein like oil in roll.
And to the soul he gave to dwell
Therein the heart, where in the spell
Of both united, soul and sense,
It should rule all life's recompense.

The anthropology of Barnabas
Is made of many parts solid and gas.
The body is the most complex with skin
And many organs more placed there within.
The soul and senses work in dual pair
To be diffused within the body's share.
And then within the soul is found the heart.
All of these things united do their part.
Beloved, philosophy of introspection
Is not so bad a thing for my selection.
I touch the things I can, I see and feel,
And with my soul and senses take the wheel,
But deep within my heart, a cavern deep,
I lean upon Your breast and there I sleep.

3 God, having thus created man,
Put into him a light to scan,
Called reason; which was to unite
The flesh, the sense, as well as sight
Of soul for the purpose to work
For God's employ and not to shirk.
Then He set this finished task done
In paradise, under the sun.

But reason was seduced by sense
Through Satan's coming in pretence,
And the flesh lost its rest and sense
Lost the delight of life until
The soul lost its beauty to fill.
Man having come to such a plight,
The sense not having rest in sight
Through labour, but seeks the delight
Not curbed by reasons, follows light
With the eyes show to it for spite.
But since the eyes see nothing more
Than vanity upon the shore,
It so deceives itself to be
In choice of earthly things' degree,
And sins from which it must set free.

Sin is, according to the divine word
That Barnabas records in the hearts stirred
Of the disciples on a far-flung day,
Seduction by the senses of the way
Of reason, which was the last gift You set
Within the human body, soul and net.
That truth is overwhelming, for I see
Abuse of reason and seduced to be
Accomplice of all wickedness on earth.
Men always find a reason for their mirth.
I find it in my own excuse to say
That what I do is right beneath the sway
Of logic, and I find it in the speech
Of those who contradict me when I preach.

4 So by God's mercy man must be
Enlightened in his reason's fee,
To know the good from wicked spree,
And to see what is true delight:
For by the knowledge come in sight
The sinner's changed to penitence.
Therefore I tell you to make sense,
That if God our Lord not make light
The heart of man, the recondite
Reasonings of men fail to meet
The needed to stand on their feet."
John answered: "Then why should men speak,
And what serves anything they seek?"

Mercy's the antidote for that foul breath
That comes on the forbidden fruit of death,
The choice to settle by one's own heart blind,
Devoid of reason, what is right and kind,
The good and bad. The tree of life instead

Is locked within the garden to men's dread.
But mercy opens up a better way
Enlightening the reason in its sway.
Beloved, enlighten now my reason here,
Which I see tossed by senses and appear
In the false light of vain desires and hopes.
Give me the guidance, not of priests and popes,
But of Your mercy's light, and light again
Unreasoned hearts of all my fellow men.

5 Jesus replied "Man has no strength
As man to bring man back at length
To penitence; but man's as means
God uses to convert the scenes;
So because God works secretly
In man to fashion him to be
Within salvation, one should hear
Every man be so in such fear
All may be taken up in him
In whom God speaks to us not dim."
James answered: "O Master, what if
There come a false prophet and stiff
And lying teacher in pretence
To give instruction without sense,
What should we do in such a case
Confronted by such face to face?"

The follower of Jesus will indeed
Doubt whether any to come in the seed
Of Abraham after Jesus is gone
Is likely or not to be Satan's spawn.
So I hear all about me of the creed
That Satan taught Muhammad in his greed
And dictated the noble Qur'an too.
I hear the blasphemy of such a crew.
Beloved, I find some detail in the book
That contrasts with the former divine look,
And yet when set in history and plot
I see it is consistent, is it not?
With a reform and a return to find
The faith of Abraham among the blind.

Barnabas 124

1 Jesus answered in parable:
"A man goes to fish and to pull
With a net, and in it he'll catch
Many fishes. Those that don't match
The market, he will throw away."
A man went out to sow one day,
But only the seed that will fall

On the good ground will grow at all.”
So you should do, listen to call
Of everyone, but keep the truth,
Since it is known to age and youth
That only the truth can bear fruit
To life eternal in the suit.”

What is the truth that is criterion
To judge whether a prophet is spot on
Or whether false? I take the book in hand
And start at the beginning for to stand.
The first criterion, is that he must
Distinguish God Creator from the dust
Of things created. The second must be
Affirming the first command that we see
To multiply and flourish in the land.
The third criterion will be outspanned
In our dominion, that is, what we eat
And what we leave for animals in treat.
The fourth criterion is Sabbath met
Each week. These four define the judgement set.

2 Then answered Andrew: "Now how shall
The truth be know inimical?"
Jesus replied: "All that conforms
To Moses' Book, receive with storms
Of truth; because our God is One,
The truth is one, and when all's done
It follows that doctrine is one
And the meaning of dogma's one;
Therefore the faith is one when spun.
I tell you well if truth had not
Been deleted upon the spot
Of Moses' Book, God would not then
Have given David among men
Our ancestor a second book.
And if the book in David's nook
Had not been spoiled, God would not then
Have given the Gospel among men
By me, because the Lord our God
Is not one to change on the sod.
He's only spoken among men
One message for all in the den.
So when God's Messenger will come,
He'll cleanse away all of the scum
Ungodly men have cast upon
My book from the darkness till dawn.”

I guessed right, though I am a man outcast
Like all before me from Your reason's past.

Conformity to Moses' book I took
And started with Your unity forsook.
But I doubt that Barnabas is informed
By Jesus rightly that David was stormed
To write the Psalms because the Torah stank
And bred worms without grace and without thank.
I doubt the Gospel rose because the two
Before it were corrupted in men's view.
All four books are one book of revelation
And all four still bear witness with elation
Of the truth and the faith that men should follow
Instead of staying in their doubt to wallow.

3 Then answered he who writes this down:
"O Master tell us with a frown
What we shall do when the Law's shown
Contaminated, overthrown,
And the false prophet speaks alone?"
Jesus replied: "That question's good,
O Barnabas, therefore I should
Tell you that in a time like that
Few are saved seeing men out flat
Do not consider of their end,
Which is God after all they send.
As God lives by whom my soul stands,
Every doctrine that turns all hands
Aside from their end, which is God,
Is a most evil teaching odd.
That's why there are three things that you
Should consider in dogma's view,
Namely love towards God and compassion
Towards one's neighbour, and in fashion
Hatred of self that offends God
Each day despite the warning rod.
So every teaching that's contrary
To these three points, of them be chary,
Because it is most evil glary.

Let this be my fair Trinity of faith
To take me away from belief in wraith:
To love You, my Beloved, above all things
With all my heart and mind and strength that sings
Upon the barren earth and in the way
Of teeming movement in creation's sway;
To have compassion on the folk around
Me that are blind and sunk upon the ground;
And finally obliterate the nafs,
That self that would rise up in fateful gaffs
In competition with Creator Lord.
Beloved, let this Trinity be restored

In everything I come to think and do
And say until I once return to You.

Barnabas 125

I'll speak again of avarice:
And tell you that when senses kiss
The vain desire to get a thing
Or keep it fast, reason must ring:
"Such a thing will come to its end."
It's sure that if it has an end,
It's madness to love it like friend.
So it's better to love and keep
What has no ending coming steep.
Let avarice be changed to alms,
Distributing for right the heap
That has been got by greasing palms.

The motive for giving out alms at last
Is that the treasure fails before the blast
And disappears in any case, and so
It's best to use it while it may give glow
Of some relief to the hungry and poor.
That motivation does not seem one sure.
And yet I mind that motivation brought
By the desire to help the oppressed lot
Smacks of such a paternalistic air
That it is one that's very hard to bear.
I'd rather take my charity in fine
From cynical and ready to resign
The cloying, passing wealth as of no worth
Than be helped by the grand upon the earth.

2 Let him be sure that what the right
Hand gives the left hand has no sight.
The hypocrites, when they give alms,
Want to be seen and praised with palms.
But truly they are vain, for true
It is that for whom one in crew
Works, from him he receives his pay.
If a man would get aught of stay
From God, he must serve God today.

I've given gold and silver in days past
When I had gain and massed my money fast,
But now I lift my hand up to the pen
Without the salary of grateful men.
My alms are empty words cast on the wind
By a soul less in righteousness than sinned,
But with the hope of praise from fellow guys
And honour for my poetry, a prize.

Instead I find a better ground and hill
After my struggle to ascend the spill.
I find my prize in secret and alone
Before the glory of diviner throne
And in the hidden chamber of Your heart,
Beloved, a better recompense than art.

3 When you give alms, make sure that you
Consider that you're giving to
God all you give for love in view.
So do not be slow to give good,
And give of the best that you could,
For love of God. Tell me, do you
Want to receive from God a brew
That is bad? Surely not, though you
Are dust and ashes! Then why do
You think you have faith if you give
The bad for love of God in sieve?

To give for love of God and know that I
Am dust and ashes is better to try
Than to give in a Christian will and way
Pretending to be helpful for a day.
It once was sweets thrown from the moving coach
To urchins scrambling with the rat and roach,
And now it's bright celebrities who fling
A copper to some charity then sing
Their praises for the tax break they achieve
For all the hunger their coins may relieve.
Beloved, give me my wayward pride intact
To take from Your hand only and Your act
A leaf, a berry, or a single weed
To feed me till I have no more the need.

4 Better to give nothing than give
A bad thing, for in giving you
Shall have some excuse by the view
Of the world; but in giving wrong
And worthless things, and keeping strong
For yourselves, what shall be excuse?
And this is all I have of use
To say to you of penitence.”
Barnabas answered: “How long ought
Penitence to last when it's sought?”
Jesus replied; “As long as man
Is in a state of sinful span
He always ought then to repent
And do penance for what he spent.
That's why since human life does sin
At all times, so it's out to win

Penance; unless you'd make account
More of your shoes than of the fount
Of your soul, since each time your shoes
Wear out, you mend them where you choose."

Beloved, that's as may be, the mass of men
May well indeed mend shoe and shirt again,
Although consumer social sense is best
To just replace the broken with the rest.
But I am such a slothful sort of guy
That I neither repair the old nor buy
The new, but just go on my broken way
In rags and clogs and calmly eat my hay.
I rest upon my laurels. I am here
Without repair and without merchant's gear,
To whirl about like dervish dog to see
If whirling will make of the sloth dizzy
Enough to sit down in repentance where
The forty cut the grape, divide and share.

Barnabas 126

1 Jesus called his disciples near
And sent them two by two in fear
Through all the land of Israel,
Saying: "What you've heard go and tell."
They bowed down and he laid his hand
Upon their heads to make them grand,
And said "In the name of our God
Give healing to the ill and odd,
Cast out their demons and reveal
The truth about me for the weal
Of Israel, and let them know
What I told the high priest for show."
2 So they went out, both each and all,
Except this writer on the call,
And James and John; they went around
All Judaea and preached the ground
Of penitence as Jesus bade,
Healing all sorts of illness made,
So that in Israel were confirmed
The words of Jesus that he spurned
To be God, but that God is one
And Jesus God's prophet when done,
When they saw such a multitude
Do at Jesus' example stewed
To heal the sick of all the brood.

The fact that the disciples went and healed
The people in both cities and the field
Was proof enough that Jesus was not God,

Or then that there were many gods in pod.
That should have been enough for every man
To see the truth and know the divine plan,
But wait, Beloved, and You will be surprised
What devils have invented and devised.
I repent of the way that wondered signs
Have distracted my mind from Your designs
And made me bow in worship almost lent
To things created, bright and redolent.
But God is one and Jesus is one sent
By Him to cry repentance down the lines.

3 But the sons of the devil found
Another way to bring him round
In persecution of Jesus,
And these were the priests on the bus
As well as the scribes with a fuss.
They started then to say Jesus
Wanted to be king over all
The land of Israel in call,
And so they plotted against him
In secret for fear of the vim
Of common folk who trusted him.

The accusation that a man seeks power
Is rarely lifted in the awful hour
When it is true. It's made against the good
For simply doing many things they should.
When man seeks power the accusation's stayed
And all the populace join the parade
And give him every honour that the crass
Are able to produce in tinsel glass.
Beloved, it may surprise You then to know
That I too have been on that end of show
And once accused of seeking leadership
By those who were suspicious of my lip.
The ignorant love well their accusations.
That's why they gather themselves into nations.

4 After they went through all the land
Of Judea, disciple band
Returned to Jesus, who took them
As a father receives in hem
His children, saying: "Tell me, how
The Lord our God has quelled the row?
Surely I have seen Satan fall
Under your feet trampled in caul
As vinedressers tread out the grapes!"
The disciples replied with gapes:
"O Master, we have healed the sick

In droves, and cast out demons thick
 That tormented men for a kick."
 5 Jesus said: "God forgive you all,
 O brothers, for you've sinned like gall
 In saying 'We have healed the sick.'
 It's God alone has done the trick."
 Then they said: "We've talked foolishly;
 So teach us how to speak justly."
 Jesus replied: "In each good act,
 Say 'God has done the thing in fact,'
 And in each bad one say 'I've sinned.'"
 "So shall we do," they said and grinned.
 6 Then Jesus said: What's left to say
 In Israel, who's seen day by day
 God do by hands of many men
 What God's done by my hands again?"
 But his disciples then replied:
 "They say there's one God, none beside,
 And that you're God's prophet and pride."
 So Jesus answered with his face
 Full of joy: "Blessèd in this place
 Is God's own sacred name to trace,
 Who's not despised my own desire,
 His servant and His lonely crier!"
 And when he'd said this at the test,
 They all went to their sleep and rest.

The prophetship of Jesus is a thing
 That Christians oft deny upon the wing,
 Despite the fact that Luke does well to note
 That Jesus was a prophet. Let men gloat.
 If many people do the things that make
 Men think a man is God, they see mistake.
 But if I look around today, I find
 That the disciples claiming Jesus wined
 And breaded rarely can produce a thing
 Like healing people caught in illness' sting.
 That may be why the fault again arose
 That Jesus was a god down to his toes,
 And so he ought to send us out to heal
 The people for a good rate and good deal.

Barnabas 127

1 Jesus departed from the place
 Of desert and desertion's trace
 And came into Jerusalem;
 So all the people ran in hem
 Of the temple to see him there.
 Then after reading of the psalms,
 Jesus climbed up above the palms

Up to the pinnacle to where
The scribe used to go up to share,
And signalling for silence by
The gesture of his hand to cry,
He said: "Blessed be the name of God
Of holiness upon the sod,
Who has created us of clay
Upon the earth, and not of ray
In flaming spirit. For when we
Sin we find before God mercy,
Which Satan never finds, because
Through his pride he before all laws
Is never corrected, but he
Maintains his own nobility,
For he's a flaming spirit here.

Like great Iblis, I hold the grand truth dear
That You, Beloved, are one and only one
Despite the wise men who agreed when done
That You are three in one and one of three,
Which thing the noble Qur'an won't agree.
Of all the tales of woe, that is the worst,
To have the vision blurred so by the cursed
That when I look upon the divine throne
I see three figures instead of one lone.
But whether I find grace or not, I know
Not but that in my favour I'm not slow
To find repentance in the worldly show.
All others are so sure that they are right,
But I find every reason for tears plight.

2 Have you heard, brethren and friends dear,
What our ancestor said with fear,
David, of our God, that He minds
That we are dust, our spirit finds
Its going forth not to return,
So He had mercy not to spurn?
Blessed are those who know of these words,
For they'll not sin at all for curds
Against their Lord eternally,
Because after sin they are free
In their repentance, so their sin
Does not remain with them in bin.
Woe to those who extol themselves,
For they shall be humbled like elves
To the coals burning there in hell.
So tell me, brethren, what's the cause
Of self-exaltation in claws?
Is there perhaps any good thing
Here on the earth for the earthling?

No, surely not, for Solomon,
The prophet of God says when done:
“All is vanity under sun.”
But if the things of the world do
Not give us cause to praise our due
In our heart, much less then in view
Does our life give us cause to do;
For it is burdened soon and late
With many miseries of fate,
Since all creatures below mankind
Fight against us in struggle blind.
How many faint before the heat
Of summer and in winter treat
Themselves to death by frost and cold;
How many have been killed though bold
By lightning and by hail once told;
How many’ve been drowned in the sea
By the rage of the winds’ degree;
How many’ve died of pestilence,
Of famine or without a fence
Against wild beasts devouring them;
Bitten by serpents, choked by phlegm
At table by food to condemn!

One thing I'm good at for the practice told,
And that's repentance, repenting I'm bold.
I have no other thing to vaunt of and
That too is something that I have in hand
Of grace, Beloved, repentance is Your own.
Grant me one good deed too beside Your throne
Before I breathe my last in flesh and bone.
One thing I'm good at and one thing I hold.
I have no praise here in the world at all,
Not one word for achievement on the ball,
But I deserve praise for repentance fair,
Or I should deserve such were it my share.
I thank you for that one grace and one gift
As I look round the mess and try to shift.

3 O hapless man extolling self,
Having so much to weigh on shelf,
The victim of all beasts that lie
In wait in every place to try!
But what shall I say of the flesh
And the sense that desire in mesh
Only iniquity to find;
Of the world that offers in kind
Nothing but sin; of wicked men
Who serving Satan, once again
Come persecuting everyone

Who would live by God's law when done?
It's certain, brothers, that if man,
As says our father David's plan,
With his eyes should see and make known
Eternity, he would have flown
Away from sin and with a groan.

My persecution is not so severe
That I can blame the devil for my fear.
I'm left in peace to multiply my sin
And repent daily for the mess I'm in.
I must be blinder than a bat the way
I fail to know and see and fly away
From sin and with a groan to meet the day.
There is no other excuse I can say.
There are just two kinds of men in the world:
Those who brag of the achievements unfurled
And those who brag of their iniquity.
Beloved, from both kinds You have set me free.
I boast in nothing here except Your grace,
And leave both heaven and hell to cast their dace.

4 To extol oneself in one's heart
Only shuts out the divine part
Of God's own pity and mercy,
So He does not forgive freely.
Our father David says our God
Remembers that we are but sod
And that our spirit goes abroad
And never to return again.
Whoever praises among men
Himself, denies that he is dust,
And so not knowing of his crust
Of need, he begs no help at all,
And so brings wrath from God on stall
Who is his only help and aid.
As God lives before whom I've stayed,
God would forgive Satan if he
Should know of his own misery,
Beg mercy of his Creator,
Who is blessed for evermore.

Indeed, I beg of You, Creator mine,
For mercy in this state of clandestine
Pretence of holiness and of success.
Have mercy on the way I fail to guess
Where the right path extends in a straight line.
My uncle used to try to speak aloud
To Satan while he milked his bovine crowd,
And preach to him repentance in a word.

I wonder if the devil's heart was stirred.
He saw him at the barn door, on the path,
Beside the house, and warned him of Your wrath.
So far as I know it was vain attempt.
It is my family's fate to be unkempt
And from success with devils quite exempt.

Barnabas 128

I And so, brethren, I who'm a man,
And walk upon the earth, tell you:
Do penance and acknowledge true
Your sins. I say, brethren, Satan,
By means of Roman soldiers' clan,
Deceived you when you said that I
Was God. Wherefore, beware the sly
So that you do not believe them,
Since they have fallen to condemn
Under the curse of God, to serve
The false and lying gods that swerve;
Just as our father David could
Invoke a curse upon them good
By saying: The nations' gods are
Of silver and of gold, the star
Of their own hands at work to make;
They have eyes that see not in stake;
They have ears that hear not at all;
The have noses but smell no stall;
The have a mouth but do not eat;
They have a tongue but for a feat
Say not a word; and hands that touch
Nothing at all or ever clutch;
They have feet but they cannot run.
So David our father to stun
Said praying to our living God,
Those who make them to stay in pod
Are like what they themselves have made
They and all those whose trust is stayed.

I'm glad to know who's laid the wicked plot
And so deceived Your humankind a lot
That Jesus is a God of gods and fine.
It's Satan the accuser of the vine.
It's Satan came up with the thought that You,
Beloved, though God of all I have in view,
Is just another man like me and mine,
Made up of three or six or even nine.
The trinities of trinities he bears
To all the priestly families he shares.
Beloved, I do my penance that I take
So many men for gods against the stake.

I do it in my actions unawares.
But let me turn from breath to breath from cares.

2 O pride unheard of, pride of man,
Who being created by plan
Of God out of earth must forget
His own condition as a pet
And rather would invent his God
According to desires in pod!
Wherein he silently mocks God,
As though he should say: There is no
Use in serving God here below.
For this is what their works still show.
Satan tried to diminish you
To this, O brothers, making you
Believe me to be God of Might;
Because I cannot make in flight
A singly fly, and because I
Am temporal and mortal guy,
I can give you nothing of use,
Because I myself am set loose
In need of everything. How, then,
Could I help you in things of men,
As it is right that God should do?
Shall we then who have for God true
The great God who's created all
Things and the universe and ball
By His word, mock at the Gentiles
And their puny gods in their wiles?

Though Jesus could not make a single fly,
Since he was not god at all there to try,
You, My Beloved, were not ashamed to take
So small a thing as a gnat for the sake
Of signs and wonders to the men below
Who love to worship things that shine and glow.
The gods of great and bold and men of war
Are wrecks upon a far deserted shore.
But You, O my Beloved, Creator of
All things below on earth, in heaven above,
By the word of Your mouth, I find in You
The shine and glow of everything that's true.
I let go of the puny gods of style
And everything that conquers with a smile.

3 There were two men who came up here
Into the Temple to appear
In prayer: the one a Pharisee
The other publican's degree.
The Pharisee came near the place

Of holiness, and with his face
Lifted on high, said: "I give thanks
Lord God, that I don't do the pranks
Of other men, such sinners they
Who do wickedly every day,
And specially like this man here,
This publican, a sinner clear;
For I fast two times in the week,
And give tithes of all things I seek."
The publican stayed far behind,
And bowed down to the earth enshrined,
And beat his breast in sorrow's kind,
And said with head bent down: "Lord, I
Am not one worthy to look high
On heaven or temple in Your sky,
For I've sinned much, but O Lord try
To have mercy on me!" Truly,
I tell you that the one you see
To be in publican's degree
Went down from the temple to be
In better state than Pharisee,
Because our God justified him,
Forgave him for what he did grim.
But the Pharisee went away
In a worse state and disarray
Than even such a publican,
For our God rejected the man,
And held his works of good and plan
To be abomination's ban.

I too in times past, if no longer now,
Have acted in good faith and beat my brow
In doing things that some men claim are good,
The feeding of the poor, clothing as should.
But worse than that, I too have failed to do
Some crimes that critical ones keep in view,
And having failed of crime, rejoice to know
That in that thing at least I sinless go.
Beloved, I'd rather have the shame repenting
Than pride of having not sinned in my venting.
Give me the grace to repent of the best
Of my works as well as the shameful zest
Of the wrong that I foster in the mind
Even if I resist with hand resigned.

Barnabas 129

I Shall the axe, perhaps, boast itself
For having cut forest like elf
Where a man's made a garden shelf?
No, surely not, for man's done all,

Made even the axe in his hall.
So you, O man, shall you too boast
Of doing any good as host,
Seeing our God's created you
Of clay and works in all you do
Of good? So why do you despise
Your neighbour? Do you not likewise
Know that if God had not preserved
You from Satan you would have swerved
Worse than Satan himself has curved?

Maybe I should not decry my own sin
So much for having crowded wine and gin.
If I should not despise the neighbour for
His share of wickedness and even gore,
Then I should not despise myself scapegrace
In any sort of hopelessness or place.
Love neighbour as oneself, it was the rule,
So hate one's neighbour as oneself at school
Ought to do just as well, and love oneself
As well as every neighbour troll or elf.
Beloved, I thank You for the grace You take
In giving me my status of less rake
Than what I might have been without Your care
To keep me sometimes in the narrow share.

2 Do you not know one single sin
Changed the fair angel into bin
Of the most repulsive demon?
And that the most perfect man won
That has come into this fair world,
Which was Adam, became uncurled
In wretchedness, and so brought down
To all we suffer in the town,
And all his offspring just as well?
So by what proclamation can
You live in your own pleasure's span
Without fear? Woe to you, O clay,
Because you've exalted your way
Above God who created you,
You shall be trampled by the crew
Of Satan who lays wait for you."

Avast! Await! I surely have not taken
Myself above my Lord Creator shaken!
Woeful I may be in the paunch and action
But hardly that far gone in the contraction.
But accusation that I live in pleasure
Instead of fear is accurate in measure.
Beloved, give me the grace of fear abounding

And I shall take more accurate a sounding.
See how the devil and his marvelled crew
Lay wait for me in the very next pew
And sing their Gospel songs with lusty cheer
As though You were a God willing to hear.
I fall into the clutches of their singing
Because of entertainment in faith's winging.

3 And having said this, Jesus prayed,
Lifting up his hands as displayed
To the Lord, and the people said:
"So be it! So be it!" When he
Had finished his own prayer, then he
Went down from the pinnacle free.
Then there were brought to him the sick
Whom he healed all he came to pick,
Then went out of the temple court.
Then Simon, a leper in sort
Whom Jesus healed, invited him
To have lunch with both fat and slim.
The priests and scribes who came to hate
Jesus, reported, came to state
To Roman soldiers what he said
Against their gods while eating bread.
They were all out to get him killed,
But secretly have it fulfilled
Because they feared the folk with dread.

The canonical Gospels would pretend
The Jewish elite had come to contend
With Jesus for upsetting status quo,
And Roman rulers were among the slow
To come against Jesus in murderous glow.
But Barnabas contends the Roman crew
Of soldiers started the rumours untrue
That Jesus was a god, and when it came
To the revealing of the facts in shame
They were offended by Jesus' words new.
Whatever happened, the message is clear:
Be good and true and right, it will appear
That those who rule the game on earth will find
Excuse to slay or at least be unkind.

4 Jesus came into Simon's villa
And sat at table on a pillow.
And while he ate a woman came,
And Mary was her given name,
A public sinner was her fame,
And prostrate at his feet she would
Wash Jesus' feet with tears and should

Anoint them with the finest lotion,
And with her hair wiped off the potion.
Simon was scandalized and so
Were all the guests who saw the show,
And they kept their thoughts deep and low:
“If this man were a prophet he
Would know what kind of wench was she,
And would not let her touch him free.”
Then Jesus said: “I have a thing,
Simon, to say to you on string.”
Simon replied: “Just say the word,
O Master, because I am stirred
By what you say and what I’ve heard.”

In human social networks we must find
That the most important of every kind
Is prostitute. She rules society,
Whether by puritan hypocrisy
In those who look down on the one they use,
Or by the libertine social amuse.
Observer outside our own species might
Think the thing ludicrous at the first sight.
Beloved, there may be reasons that we think
That propagation's the important link
To spirit and to flesh and at a blink.
I hope that You are amused by the tale
We represent when healthy and when hale.
Otherwise, there's no use in the whole gale.

Barnabas 130

1 And Jesus said: "There was a man
Who had two debtors he could ban.
The one owed to his creditor
Fifty pence, and the other fer
Five hundred. It happened that both
Were without wherewithal and growth
To be able to pay their debt.
The master with compassion met
Them and forgave the debt to each.
Which of them thought he was a peach?"
And Simon answered: "He to whom
He forgave the most in his doom."
Jesus replied: "You got it right.
And so I tell you in that light
This woman as compared to you,
You were both debtors it is true
To God, the one for leprosy
Of the body, the other's plea
For leprosy of the soul, which
Is sin. God our Lord in a pitch

Of mercy through my prayers in goal
Has healed your body and her soul.
2 You therefore love me less since you
Received a little gift and few.
And so when I came in your place
You did not kiss me on the face
Nor anoint my head. But this wench,
Came straight away up to my bench
And washed my feet with her own tears
And precious ointment in her fears.
So I tell you the many sins
Of hers are cancelled in the bins
Because she's loved much." And he turned
To the wench and spoke to the spurned:
"Depart in peace, for the Lord God
Of each of us upon the sod
Has pardoned all your sins, but see
You do no more iniquity.
Your faith has saved you in the spree."

The parable is set in a context
New to my soul, though a soul not perplexed
To see new meaning in the age-old tale.
That is the true worth of Barnabas' wail.
To whom You have, Beloved, forgiven much
Is also given grace to love as such
More than the one to whom You forgive less.
You must have forgiven me much, I guess,
Because my love to You grows day by day
As I turn more and more my face away
From tinsel and the sellers on the beach.
I turn away and to the sparrows preach.
So like the prostitute of old, let me
Go out and do no more iniquity.

Barnabas 131

1 His disciples came near unto
Jesus after the night prayer due,
And said: "O Master, how must we
Do to escape pride's travesty?"
Jesus replied: "And have you seen
A poor man invited as keen
To the house of a prince to eat?"
John answered: "I have eaten bread
In Herod's house and in his seat.
For before I knew you instead
I went to fish, and used to sell
The fish to Herod's family well.
One day when he was feasting there,
I brought a fish, one fine to share,

And he made me stay and eat there.”
Then Jesus said: "Now how did you
Eat bread with infidels in crew?
God pardon you, O John! But say,
How did you act at table, say?
Did you seek to have the best place?
Did you ask for the best food's grace?
Did you speak when not spoken to?
Did you hold yourself in the crew
As better than the others there?"

I've rarely eaten with the worldly great,
But when I have, I was not such a mate
As John, who acted with respect and steel.
I've always played the fool for woe and weal.
No doubt that is one reason the great do
Not take a chance in inviting me to
Their board of luxury and reparté.
I'm likely to say something that will be
Embarrassing to the crowd in good train.
But I am not so bad as Ahmedayn,
Who addressed the archbishop not with vous
But with the toi again and once again
In the must vulgar language of the street.
The archbishop looked shocked as it was meet.

2 John answered: "As God lives to care,
I did not dare lift up my eyes,
Since I was the one to despise,
A fisherman, poor and ill-clad,
Sitting beside the king's own lad.
So when the king gave me a piece
Of meat, I thought the world's increase
Had fallen on my head, so great
Was the favour of the king's state.
And truly I say, if the king
Had been of our Law in our ring,
I should have been ready to serve
Him all my life and never swerve.”
Jesus cried out: “Be silent, man,
For I fear, John, lest God should scan
Us for companions of the fire,
Like Abiram, for our pride's quire!”

I love Your sent one Jesus for the choice
He makes to drown or put down any voice
That shows a deference for human pride
And sets men on a pedestal beside.
It's fine to be polite and cause no row
Before the ruler of the folk somehow,

But there is just one who deserves my rate
Of praise and worship, and that's You, the great
One true God who deigns ever to create
All creatures who are set in kingly state.
Beloved, crown me with humble diadem
Of dandelion instead of the gem,
And I shall shine with gold, if for a day,
And then I'll disappear, withered to fray.

3 The disciples trembled with fear
At the words of Jesus to hear;
When he said again: "Let us fear
God, that He cast us not into
The abyss for our pride in view.
O brethren, have you heard of John
What is done in the house updrawn
Of a prince? Woe to every man
Who comes into the worldly plan,
For they live in unholy pride,
But die in contempt to abide,
Gone in to their confusion's ride.
For this world is a house where God
Feasts men, wherein upon the sod
Have eaten all the holy ones
And God's prophets and prophets' sons.
And truly I say to you, all
A man receives, he gets it all
From God. So man ought to remain
Humble and know he's vile and plain,
While God is great, with bounty great
By which He nourishes our state.
So it is not lawful a man
Should say: 'Ah, what is this for plan,
And why is this done and said in
The world for wickedness and sin?'
But rather he should count himself
As he is: unworthy as elf
To stand in the world at God's board.
As God lives, in whose presence stored
Is my soul, there's nothing so small
Received here on the earthly ball
From God, but that man in return
Should spend his whole life so to burn
With love for God more than to earn.

Breath is the greatest gift, and mentioned well
In Genesis two as life-giving spell
That made of mere clay body in Your hand
A living soul under divine command.
And so I thank for breath, Beloved, and stay

To thank with one more breath and day by day.
Though I should have all power of pope and king
And banker and the money-changing wing,
Though I should have the best in French cuisine
And mansions with security unseen,
Without the breath of life, all would sink down
Into the dark before the joyous town.
Beloved, I give You thanks once more for breath
Before I go down to the bed of death.

4 As God lives, you sinned not, O John,
In eating with Herod as drawn,
For it was so ordained of God
For you to receive on the sod,
So you might be our teacher now,
And of each one God's fear avow,
So do," said Jesus to his friends,
"That you may live in the world's ends
As John lived in king Herod's room,
When he ate bread with him in bloom,
For so shall you in truth be free
From all pride and from vanity."

The sins that I confess are no doubt those
That I regard as sinful as I chose,
But are indeed the ways mysterious
By which You've led me in the omnibus.
The sins both venial and deadly rise
In secret places hidden from my eyes,
The good I think I do and so repent
Not at all from the evil and the bent.
Beloved, give me not better sight to see
The folly of my goodness on the spree,
But rather simple the grace and mercy
That You would share with an ignorant me.
The golden calves that I have made for You
Crush in the drinking water that spew.

Barnabas 132

1 Jesus walking beside the sea
On the seashore of Galilee
Was surrounded by a great crowd,
So he went when he was allowed
To a little boat off the shore,
Anchored near the land what is more
So that Jesus' voice might be heard.
Then they all came near like a herd
And sat on the beach to hear what
He might say and not keep mouth shut.

The microphone and the loud speaker are
An innovation that is popular
As an apostasy across the map
Of all religious characters that flap.
Poor Jesus had to go out on the sea
To get a hearing in his company,
Which may explain why so many of those
Did not hear exactly the words he chose.
If there had been a microphone, no doubt
No one would every have mistaken lout
For God Almighty in a Trinity
Or supplanted the Sabbath with decree
Of Sunday as the eighth day's blessing kept.
Without a microphone, Jesus has wept.

2 "See, the sower went out and sowed,
And the seed fell upon the road,
And people stepped on it and birds
Ate the seed up and left the words.
Some seed fell on stones and sprang up,
But had no water in its cup,
And it was scorched under the sun.
Some fell in the bushes when done,
And when it grew was choked by thorns.
Some seed fell on ground without scorns,
The good ground, and produced a crop,
Thirty and sixty, not to stop,
A hundredfold before its bornes."

I cast the seeds of poetry or verse
In lines of blessing with hardly a curse,
To see if it will sprout upon the shore.
It may be far too sandy for the spore.
I listen for an echo on the sand,
As many before me here in the land
Have done and found a murmur and a voice
Of one or two who've made the better choice.
For entertainment, there are better things
With flashes of light and the sable wings
Of every sort of mad celebrity.
It is no day of blessed harmony.
The cacaphonic worship of the great
Is constant in its sobbing to be late.

3 Again Jesus said: "See, a dad
Of a family sowed seed not bad
In his field, but then in his sleep,
His enemy came in to creep
And sowed tares over the good seed.
So when it sprouted, there indeed

Were tares too grown abundantly.
The servants came to their lord, said:
'O Sir, did you not sow good bread?
Then whence came in so many tares?'
The master answered: 'Unawares,
I sowed good seed, but while we slept
The enemy in the field crept
And sowed tares here among the wheat
So we should have nothing to eat.'
4 Said the servants: "Do you want us
To go pull up the tares with fuss
Out of the wheat?' The master said:
'No, you'll pull up the wheat instead.
Wait till the harvest comes at last.
Then pull the tares up and then cast
Them in the fire, but keep the wheat
And store it in my barns to eat.'"

How many enemies besiege my soul!
There are the ones who plant in evil goal
The sights and sounds and thoughts of discontent
To make me buy the tinsel to present
Instead of truth on judgement day, I'm bound.
Then there are those who come with bitter sound
To take those advertisements from my heart
With violence at every turn and start.
Beloved, as I look up from murky deep
Of stagnant ponds of buy and sell and cheap,
My lily pads shed their quicksilver slips
As my blooms open up their shining lips
In praise to You, despite the temple set
Around me for the idols of their pet.

5 Again Jesus said: "There went out
Many men to sell figs about.
When they came to the market-place,
People were buying fig-leaves lace,
And not good figs to eat at all.
A wicked man who saw this said:
'I can get rich here now instead.'
So he called his two sons to say:
'Go gather leaves in bad figs' spray.'
They sold these for their weight in gold,
Because the public had been sold.
But then on eating the bad figs,
They fell as sick as sick as pigs."

The leaves that honour faiths imperial
Are costly, costly, costly in their hall.
But the figs that the common faith displays

On platters gold and silver to their praise
Are not fit for the stomach, though it's true
That humans can eat almost any brew.
Such faiths are always ploy and plot to make
A buck or two for the dear clergy's sake.
Beloved, give me the grace to see
Behind the forms of faith in treachery,
And taste only the manna that You send
Upon the barren desert where I wend.
Then when I feel my stomach in and out,
I shall not have a reason for my doubt.

6 Again Jesus said: "See, a man
With a good spring sells as by plan
To all his neighbours water to
Wash their bodies from dirt too,
But the owner of the spring lets
His own clothes rot away in nets."

It's true, Beloved, I send these verses out
To many who are in misery of doubt
And some are gladdened by the sprightly word
And seek You out instead of wicked herd.
But I remain in rags and crippled shoes
Complaining that I haven't got my dues,
And swelter in the sun instead of taking
Its light for joy and gingerbread a-baking.
The spring that sits beneath the lilac trees
Beside my door enjoying flighty breeze
Is mine to sip. And yet I have been known
To drink a soda with a burp and groan.
The heart of man's a wonder and a war
With all the things that never should be gore.

7 Again Jesus said: "There went out
Two men to sell apples about.
One sold the apple peelings for
Their weight in gold, if not for more,
Without a care for apple core.
The other man just gave away
His apples and for little pay,
Just enough bread to pay his way.
But those who bought the apple peel,
Despised the one who came to deal
Out freely the fruit for appeal."

That is familiar too, Beloved, indeed.
I give my verses out to every creed
And never take a cent back for my pay
Of singing of Your praises day by day.

But I am still disdained by all around
Except the one or two upon the ground
That stop to listen with a heart of gold.
The mess of men love only what is sold.
Beloved, You in Your heaven above cast down
The light and air and manna on the town,
But rarely is there one who takes the gift
With an awareness and a heart to lift.
I too am of those who forget to pray,
Forget to love, forget to grasp the day.

8 And thus on that day Jesus spoke
In parables to all the folk.
Then sending them away, he went
With his disciples to Nain spent,
Where he'd raised up the widow's son
To life, and there mother and son
Welcomed him to the house again
And served him and his travelling men.

Those who receive the blessing rare today
Of resurrection from the deathly sway
Of tomb and urn and flower bed are those
Who are most grateful for the daily dose
Of mercy from Your hand, Beloved, and thank.
The rest of us just sit around and bank,
Though banking does not bring a resurrection,
It provides for posterity's selection.
Be careful of the mother and the son,
Beloved, for all the things that You have done,
As he may grow to be upon the tree
A pod to bear a witness in degree
That resurrection is the hope of men
And women caught on earth and caught again.

Barnabas 133

1 His disciples drew near to ask:
"O Master, tell us what the task
Of these stories you're telling means?"
Jesus replied: "Look on the scenes,
The time of prayer approaches so
When evening prayer will come and go,
I'll tell you what my stories show."
At the end of the prayer they came
To Jesus and called him by name.
He told them: "The man who sows seed
Upon the road and stones to feed
The thorns, and upon the good ground,
Is he who teaches God's word sound,
Which falls upon men all around.

The man who scatters seeds may represent
The preacher of the Word that You have sent,
Beloved, but I see few of those around,
If any sowing good seed on the ground.
The preachers I know all mix truth and error,
And I myself may even be a terror
Of that kind, though, Beloved, I truly try
To tell the truth and never tell a lie.
Whether immoral or mistaken men,
All preachers should be thrown into the den
Of Daniel and his lions. You could save
The good and true as well as all the brave.
And then the pulpits might be cleared for cheer,
And every minbar hope in joy and fear.

2 It falls on the road in the ears
Of sailors and merchants as peers,
Who for the long trips that they make,
And the many folk for their sake
They deal with, have God's word removed
From memory by Satan reproved.
It falls upon the stones when it
Comes to the ears of courtiers fit,
Who're anxious as they serve a king,
So God's word does not do a thing.
They have some slight memory of it,
But as soon as troubles in kit
Appear, it goes right out of mind,
For they serve not God, but their kind,
So they cannot hope help from God
To meet them under divine rod.

Truck drivers, businessmen and lobbyists
Have no hope of salvation, since they kissed
Good-bye to Your Word for the ways of men
In the distraction of good deeds again.
A passing memory is all I have
Of the divine Word to the Jew and Slav,
To Arab and to Zoroastrian.
A moment's concentration's all I can
Maintain in the rush of the sweet and sour.
I am a student, but I am one dour
To sit and whittle in the last row seat,
Or set fire to the dust balls for a treat
The blow out from under the heaters set
Under the windows where the sun is met.

3 It falls among the thorns as ears
Of those who love life that appears,

Though the word of God grow on them,
When carnal desires are their gem,
They choke the good seed of God's word,
For carnal comforts make men leave
The word of God for its reprieve.
The seed that falls on the good ground
Is when the word of God does sound
In ears of him who does fear God,
And so it bears fruit on the sod
Of life eternal. I tell you,
No matter what the state or view,
If a man fears God, it is true,
The word of God bears good fruit too.

I fear God on a moment now and then,
But mostly carnal desires come again
To choke my fears aside. I do mind one
Sweet lass in London, dressed and decked for fun,
Who said that in the midst of copulation
And frantic movement of her fornication
She could and did repent and raise a prayer
That You would have mercy upon her share.
Beloved, my whole life bowing in prostration
Is just carnal abuse without castration.
So have a mercy on body and soul
That never exits from the wicked toll
Of living in a body and a world.
Or then the soul is a worse thing uncurled.

4 'Of that father of family,
I say he's God our Lord truly,
Father of all things He has made.
But He's not nature's father made,
For he's no motion in parade
To generate biology.
It is our God who owns in fee
This world and the field where he sows
Is humankind. The seed that grows
Is God's word. So when teachers are
Neglectful in preaching word's star,
As they're busy with this world's rate,
Satan sows error in the state
Of human hearts, and that is why
There are so many sects to spy
Each with a wicked doctrine by.

I've seen the error sown in every sect
That I have been around and to inspect.
Some have small errors only while the rest
Have blunders larger in stock to invest.

If I judge them by the good Decalogue,
Which is the rule of thumb I have vogue,
There is not one that's perfect in its way.
Even by the brief trinity to say
That You are one alone, and You demand
The Sabbath rest and to refrain the hand
From killing other people is enough
To show all sects remaining in the rough.
None stick to all three and some of them rate
A zero out of three in well-filled plate.

5 The saints and prophets come to cry:
"O Sir, did you not give the good
Doctrine to men, have faith as should?
So why so many errors here?"
God answers them though with a tear:
"I have given good doctrine to men,
But while men seek vain things again,
Satan has sowed errors to bring
To nothing my Law and its sting."
The saints reply: "O Sir, we'll take
Away these errors for men's sake."
6 God answers: "Do not do so now,
For the faithful are kin somehow
To infidels by ties that bind,
So the faithful will go in kind
And be lost with the infidel.
But wait until the judgement well
And then my angels shall take all
And gather them against the wall,
And the unfaithful shall be cast
Out with Satan in hell at last,
While the good faithful ones shall be
In my kingdom eternally.'
Surely many unfaithful dads
Shall beget many faithful lads,
For whose sake God is waiting still
For the world to repent its fill."

It's wrong to uproot every wrong sect here,
Although they are a product and appear
By Satan's doing. Let them all stay well
To be places to bind men meant for hell.
My own sect is to keep the Decalogue
In life and worship and in faith for log.
If that is vain, then left me burn away
In hell for my mistaking night for day.
Let all others keep to what law they like
Or to what lack of law gives right to strike.
I have only disdain for other men

And women who expound again, again
Their matchless virtues bubbling from the heart.
Let them gyrate to their rock as they fart.

Barnabas 134

1 They that bear good figs are the true
Teachers who preach good doctrine too,
But the world, which will love a lie,
Seeks from them leaves, fine words to spy
In flattery. This Satan sees
And joins with flesh and sense in sprees
And brings a large supply of leaves;
That is, earthly things; he deceives
By hiding sin, and man receives
And becomes ill, ready for death
Eternal. The one by whose breath
Water's bestowed to others well
To wash off their soiled stains in spell,
But lets his own clothes stay in dirt,
Is the teacher willing to squirt
Others with repentance, but stays
Himself still in his sinful ways.
O wretched man, whose own tongue writes,
And not the angels of his spites,
Upon the air his punishment,
One fitting on him to be sent!

No one produces so many leaves here
As I, Beloved, so I begin to fear
That I am of those who produce in words
But not in faith and truth beyond the curds.
The tree that bears no figs will be cut down
And thrown in fire of hell outside the town.
Burn all that is mere leaves in me, my Lord,
And leave only the figs sweet and well stored.
True doctrine is as rare today, I find,
As anything upon the deaf and blind.
Keep my deafness intact, but for Your voice,
And keep me blind to any other choice
But Your fair doctrine in the way to go.
Let me not pole upstream against Your flow.

2 If one had an elephant's tongue,
And the rest of his body young
Small as an ant, just think of it!
Indeed I tell you that the kit
Who preaches repentance to those
Who hear and yet he himself chose
Not to repent's more monstrous still.
Those two men that sell apples will

Be of the ones who preach for love
Of God, and flatter none above.
He preaches in the truth and takes
Only the share of poor man's stakes.
As God lives, in whose presence I
Stand, such a man's not received by
The world, but rather one despised.
But the one who sells peels apprised
For their own weight in gold, and gives
Away the apple's one who lives
To please men: and so flattering
The world, he ruins under wing
The ones who follow flattery.
Ah! how many have perished, see,
For this cause!' Then the one who writes
Said: "How should one listen for rights
To the word of God; and how should
One know him that preaches for good
And love of God and to shed lights?"

O my Lord and Beloved, I am an ant,
And yet I have a trunk of elephant!
I preach repentance to the good and wise
And to the sinners that all men despise,
To everyone in season and yet out,
And back my words with Your own divine clout.
And yet my own repentance is so light
That few can even see it come in sight.
The only thing that's seen is my great trunk
Of elephant attached to ant that's sunk!
Beloved, remove my trunk, for I am weak,
An ant beside that monstrous thing, I seek
Your grace and mercy to cut off my nose
Before the time of repentance may close.

3 Jesus replied: "One ought to hear
The preacher as though God in ear
Were speaking, when he preaches good
Doctrine; because God speaks or should
Through his mouth. But he that reproves
Not sins, having respect behoves
Of persons, flattering such men,
Should be avoided as a den
Of vipers, for in truth he spoils
The human ear with poison coils."
Do you understand now the word?
Truly I say to you as spurred,
Even as a wounded man has need
Of no fine bandages to plead
For binding up his wounds, but yet

Rather of good ointment once set,
So too has a sinner no need
Of fine words, but rather with speed
Reproofs, in order to succeed
Ceasing to sin in lusty greed.'

There are so many wonders in the world
That scintillate with such goodness unfurled,
That overwhelm with vision of Your power,
Your greatness and Your beauty for an hour,
That I am tempted to relent my task.
To call one to repent is all You ask
Of preacher, poet, singer, scholar caught
Up in the webs and wonders of life wrought.
Beloved, teach me to preach no tales to jerk
The tears from eyes of sweet Christians that lurk
In pews before the drum-set bought for perk.
Beloved, teach me repentance on the tongue,
And in the heart and hand while I am young,
And still have all my powers of mind and lung!

Barnabas 135

1 Then said Peter: "O Master, tell
Us how the lost shall be in hell
And how long tormented a spell,
So man may many sins repel."
Jesus replied: "Peter, it's great
That you've asked, if God please in state,
I'll answer you. Know that hell's one,
Yet has seven centres one on one.
So even as sin's of seven kinds,
As hell's seven gates Satan reminds,
So there are seven punishments
Within the place without relents.
2 For the proud, loftiest in heart,
Shall be plunged in the lowest part,
Passing through all centres above,
And suffering all their pains in shove.
As here he would be higher than God,
Desiring to do his own prod,
Against what God Himself commands,
Not wanting that another stands
Above him, even so there he
Shall be put under the feet free
Of Satan and his devils there,
Who trample him as the grapes' share
When wine is made, and he shall be
Derided by devils freely.

There is just one in all the universe

And outside it that has right to disperse
The proclamation of being I known
Or unknown before or upon the throne.
There is just one who has the right divine
To claim to be I without drinking wine
And speak the true and fail not in the task.
This is just one if any person ask.
Beloved, there is no I but You to stay
As Sovereign of the night and of the day.
All others who say I received by grace
Of the Creator the gift of the race
To be reflection of that one I true
That is my Lord and Saviour, that is You.

3 'The envious, who here is sad
At the good that his neighbour had,
And rejoices at any bad
That comes on his neighbour unclad,
Shall go down to hell's sixth part mad,
And there be tormented by fangs
Of myriads of serpents with clangs
Of all hell to rejoice to see
It seems the envious' agony,
And mourn that he has not gone down
Into the seventh centre's frown.
For although the damned cannot be
Joyful, still God justice will see
It so to seem to his envy
As when one may seem in a dream
To be spurned by another's beam,
And feels the torment of it, so
Shall the envious man's fate show.
For where there's no gladness at all,
It shall seem to him and with gall
That everyone rejoices there
To see his misfortune in share,
And mourns that his is no worse fare.

The seven deadly sins pour out their fate
On those who commit them with love or hate.
And envy is second sin on the shore:
The one that goes to hell's sixth centre's floor.
Indeed the joy that people have to see
The neighbour lie under catastrophe
Is worthy to be punished in the fire
Of hopelessness and lack of good desire.
Beloved, it is no grace that I can see
That envy is indeed insanity.
No one I know would really choose to be
Another person if he had the chance.

All are so filled with self-esteem to prance
About the dergah floor as if in dance.

4 The covetous shall go down then
To the fifth centre, and again
Suffer harsh poverty as rich
Feast suffered and to such a pitch.
The demons for greater torment,
Shall offer him his desires meant,
And when he's got it in his clutch,
Other demons will snatch as much
Away from him, and so remark:
"Remember you would never give
For love of God, so God will live
Not to allow you to receive."
O wretched man! Now he shall find
Himself in that condition's bind
When he shall pass abundance mind
And see the poverty around
Him now, and that with the goods found
Then he could have acquired delights
Eternal instead of hell's nights.

It seems the devils are Your servants, Lord,
When they snatch from the eager the adored.
The covetous are crowned with hopes to blast
And left in hell for a long time to last.
I covet peace before Your throne, Beloved,
With nothing of my own, all things I've shoved
Into the margin of my life to find
Whatever there they can be to the blind.
Beloved, my heart I lay open to You
To fill it with Your treasures in Your view,
Whatever You may need in its stone walls
Of thrones and lamps and couches to repair
When You have come into Your own to share
Your life with me who has nothing but stalls.

5 To the fourth centre shall descend
The lustful, where those who would bend
The way God gave them shall be like
Corn cooked in devil's burning spike
Of dung. And there they'll be embraced
By horrid, hellish serpents traced.
Those who've sinned with harlots, all these
Acts of impurity with ease
Are changed for them to union made
With the infernal furies paid;
Which are demons like women spoiled
Whose hair is made of serpents coiled,

Whose eyes are flaming sulphur, whose
Mouth is poisonous, and who choose
A tongue of gall, whose body's all
Covered with barbed hooks wherewithall
They catch the silly fish, whose claws
Are like those of gryphons, whose paws
Have nails like razors, genital
Of fire. So with these lustful all
Shall enjoy hellish coals of fire
Which shall be their bed of desire.

Sin is the power creative to invent
Such visions of hell that ought to prevent
The wary from the circus of lust spent.
But in the vast reality of life
Nothing can warn the sinner of the knife
And so prevent the soul gone into strife.
No vivid picture of the pains of hell
Can wake the soul under her wicked spell.
Beloved, awaken me from coils of lust
And turn my eyes to You in whom I trust.
Give me the day to pray and night to sing
Of the grace that wafts down from divine wing
Until the dawn, the narrow strand of light
That turns to prayer the burdens of the night.

6 To the third centre shall go down
The slothful who'll not work but frown.
Here are built cities and immense
Palaces, which as soon as tents
Are finished must be torn apart,
Because a single stone at heart
Is not placed right. And these great stones
Are laid on slothful backs with groans,
Who has no free hand to fan but
His body as he walks in glut,
Nor to lighten his burden shut,
Since sloth has taken from his arms
The power to react to alarms,
And his legs are chained helplessly
By fetters of serpents in glee.
And what is worse, behind him stay
Demons that push him in the way
And make him fall down to the ground
With the weight of the burden round;
Nor does anyone help him rise
And lift it up, but all despise;
And being too heavy to lift,
A double portion's laid on rift.

The Nazi work-camps, it appears to me,
Were once invented by the Christ I see
Described by Barnabas in what he heard
Of the word of the Gospel undeterred.
The Holocaust was just extending fate
Developing over the years of hate,
And was experiment in room of gloom
That has continued since that day of doom.
Beloved, though I may be more slothful yet
Than any of the servants that You get,
Still I turn to You for the grace to rise
And do a task or two beneath the skies
Each day, then I may welcome Sabbath rest
In sloth with all Your other servants best.

7 To the second centre shall go
Down the gluttonous and not slow.
Now here there is a lack of food,
So much so that only the brood
Of scorpions and live serpents there
Will serve as nourishment in share.
They give such torment that it would
Be better never to be born
Than to eat such food that's not good.
The demons offer them in scorn
Such fare in form of fine food sweet.
But since they are bound hands and feet,
They cannot reach out to the treat,
But the scorpions that he eats will
Devour his belly and then still
Come out of it and speedily,
And tear the glutton's backside wee.
When they come out foul and unclean,
Filthy as they are to be seen,
They must be eaten there once more,
And that is all their food in store.

Better than Dante is the vision wrought
By Barnabas, unless the one was taught
By other for the share of hell to see.
They both describe the glutton faithfully.
There are today, methinks, more people who
Indulge the appetite than in the crew
Of children who grew up in time with me.
We were all thin those days before the spree
Of fast foods in the lap of luxury,
Except the few with true problems to face.
Now gluttony's a most common disgrace.
Beloved, take me and tighten up my belt,
The glutton in my soul that has not knelt

Strike down and show the way out of this place.

8 The wrathful goes down to the first
Centre, where he's insulted worst
By all the devils and the damned,
Who go lower than he when scammed.
They spurn him and they strike him too,
Make him lie on the road in view
And tread upon his throat as they
Pass over, helpless in dismay
With hands and feet chained adroitly.
Beyond that he can never say
A word in answer wrathfully,
Because his tongue's caught by a hook
Like those used by a butcher's nook.
In that cursed place there's also found
A punishment for all around,
Like the mixture of grains' compound
To make a loaf. For fire and ice,
Thunderstorms and lightning suffice,
Sulphur and heat and cold and wind,
Frenzy, and terror all go binned
By justice of God in such wise
That the cold tempers not in guise
The heat nor the fire temper ice,
But each gives torment to suffice,
To every wretched soul that's sinned.

Beloved, there's hardly anyone today
Who looks out on the world in constant fray
And fails in wrath. They spread it everywhere
But on the ones who deserve their bare share.
We all go down to wrath at last, it seems,
Since the world where we live matches no dreams.
I do remember when society
Was without conscience for the things I see
Now well-known to avoid. Justice is now
Better defined than earlier somehow.
And yet there is more anger for infringement
Than in those earlier days of unhingement.
Beloved, release my outraged soul from wrath
And lead, Beloved, upon a better path.

Barnabas 136

1 In this accursed spot come to stay
The infidels day after day,
So if the world were filled with grains
Of millet and a bird took pains
To take a single grain away
Once in a hundred years at bay

To empty the world, in that day
The world was emptied, infidels
Should enter paradise in spells,
They would rest delighted to stay.
But there's no such hope, since their pain
Can never have an end again,
Since they're not willing for God's love
To put sin away from their glove.
But the faithful shall be at rest
In comfort, since their pains addressed
Come to an end.' In sudden fright
The disciples heard these words right,
And said, 'So then the faithful too
Must also enter hellish crew?'

Eternal punishment of hell may be
Rather a late development to see,
At least to this high level and degree.
That too is like to be an argument
That places this book later than one sent
To Jesus's disciple then and there
Or even in the second century fair.
And even the idea the faithful might
Enter the place of hell to have a sight
Is Dantesque above all in word and truth.
It is a place to entertain the youth.
If anyone is hopeful for a view,
No doubt sometime they will join hellish crew
Until the day, Beloved, all turn to You.

2 Jesus replied: 'Every one here
Must one day into hell appear.
But the saints and prophets go there
To see the punishment in share
And the righteous ones go there just
To be afraid of it they must.
What shall I say? I tell you true
That even God's Messenger too
Shall enter there once to behold
The divine justice and be told.
Then hell shall tremble at his touch.
Because he has human flesh much,
All those in hell with human flesh
Shall not be punished in the mesh
Of flames so long as he is there
The Messenger of God to see
The wrath of hell, but he shall be
There only the measure as long
As it takes to blink an eye strong.
God shall do this so all may know

They he's received benefit's show
From the Messenger of God low.

Perhaps the relief in length of a blink
Is infinite in value on the brink
Of hell's clear waters boiling in the sink.
But I have benefits beyond my share
In all the wonders the ayaat declare.
Perhaps the respite of a single tear
To quench the thirst of millions in hell's fear
Is worth the worlds to those who then appear
To taste the salty liquid as they go
Into the depths of darkness found below.
But I have had the benefit at last
Of my reciting the Qur'an outcast
From every mosque and tekke in the gloom.
I find in the Qur'an my house and room.

3 When he'll go there, the demons all
Shall shriek and seek to hide thereall
Beneath the burning embers there
And say to one another's care:
"Fly, fly, for here comes Muhammad,
Our enemy!" Satan the lad
Will hear it and hit his own face
With both his hands, and scream in brace:
"You're more noble than I, and this
Is unjustly done to my miss."
As for the faithful who remain
In seventy-two grades of gain,
Those of the two last grades to own
Faith only but no works are shown,
The one rejecting good works and
The other loving evil stand,
They shall abide in hell the spell
Of seventy thousand years to dwell.

4 After those years shall the angel
Called Gabriel come into hell,
Shall hear them say: "O Muhammad,
Where are the promises you made,
Saying that those who have your faith
Shall not always remain a wraith
In hell?" Then the angel of God
Shall return to paradise sod,
And going to God's Messenger
With reverence there to confer,
Shall tell him what he heard them say.
Then shall his Messenger that day
Speak to God saying: "Lord, my God,
Remember the promise in prod

Made to your servant of those who
Received my faith that they'll be crew
Not to abide always in hell."
God shall reply: "Ask what you will,
O my friend, for I'll give you still
All that you ask, as you ask well."

Anachronistic is the word I find,
If this is writ by Barnabas in kind
And if it does suggest that purgatory
Is part and parcel of the Gospel story.
It seems that hell is made in eras grand
And awful in their length of time to stand.
A thousand years may be a day to You,
But it is something far beyond the view
Of simple ones believing in the true.
Let hell well tremble, let it tremble too,
But I have other things, Beloved, to do.
The promises divine are made to grow
Up in the heart of child until the show
Of grand fulfilments come to lay them low.

Barnabas 137

1 Then shall the Messenger of God
Say: "O Lord, there are under rod
In hell for seventy thousand years
Some of the faithful. Where appears
Your mercy, O Lord? I pray you,
Lord, free them from their bitter rue."
2 Then shall God command the four best
Of God's angels; and they'll invest
To go to hell and take away
Everyone with faith in the sway
Of his Messenger, and lead him
Into paradise sink or swim.
3 And such shall be the advantage
Of the faith in God's Messenger's wage,
That those who shall have believed him,
Even though in good works they're dim,
Because they died in this faith true,
They'll go to paradise in crew
After this punishment in view.'

What good news is this to my fainting heart!
I look upon a life of stop and start
And see that no good works adorn my way.
I'm even mediocre in the sway
Of wickedness, something I hardly find
Successful in the way I've tried and whined.
Without much merit good or evil, I

At least have this one faith that I live by:
I'm certain of Muhammad on the ball
As any other prophet that You call.
I declare that Muhammad does affirm
The Decalogue to make the sinner squirm.
So my days in hell are for certain sure
To end and I shall enter gardens pure!

Barnabas 138

1 Early the next morning there came
To the house where Jesus in fame
Was with his disciples, all men
Of the city, women again
And children, and besought him there:
“Sir, have mercy on us with care,
Because this year the worms did eat
The corn: we'll have no bread for treat
This year in our land of defeat.”
2 Jesus answered: “Oh what fear
Is on you! Don't you know the cheer
Elijah, God's servant, did see
While Ahab's cunning treachery
Continued for three years, when he
Had no bread, ate berries and grass
For two years, and it came to pass
David our father prophet too
Of God, ate grass and berries too
While hunted by Saul, and he ate
Bread only twice in all that rate.”

I am among the pampered and well-dressed:
I have bread every day to eat. You've guessed.
I wear the still wrapped gift-wear of the rich
That they do not want and so they just pitch
It in the flea market, where folk like me
Can get the fashion labels almost free.
Yet I do not think David ate grass then.
Grass has too much of silica again.
But herbs no doubt, lamb's quarter and chickweed
(Upon which I too, an elite, still feed).
The bread I've eaten, which was once in price
The cheapest to be found, is now thought nice.
I chew my heavy, sour, and dark rye bread
Among those who eat cake and think they're fed.

3 The men answered: "Sir, they were men,
Prophets of God, nourished again
With spiritual delight, so they
Endured well for a year and day,
But how shall these little ones fare?"

And they showed him the band in care
 Of little children. Jesus had
 Compassion on them who were sad,
 And said: "How long is it until
 Harvest?" They said: "Twenty days fill."
 4 Then Jesus said: "These twenty days
 Let all spend in fasting and raise
 Petition to our God above,
 Who will act in mercy and love.
 I tell you God caused this dearth here
 Because the madness did appear
 Among men and as Israel's sin
 When they said I was God to win
 Or Son of God, a tale to spin."
 5 When they had fasted nineteen days,
 On the twentieth day for praise
 They saw the fields and hills spread out
 With ripe corn ready all about.
 They ran to Jesus and told him.
 And when he heard the story trim,
 He gave thanks to God, and he said:
 "Go, brothers, and harvest the bread
 Which God has given you instead."
 They harvested then so much corn
 They knew not where to store it borne.
 There was a time of plenty then
 In Israel of all again.
 6 The citizens made plans to set
 Jesus as their king, and he let
 Himself escape then quietly,
 Because of the complicity,
 And the disciples tried to find
 Him fifteen days and then resigned.

Canonical in Gospel takes the word
 Of harvest in a formula absurd
 To give colonial missionaries right
 To grasp with armies everything in sight.
 But Barnabas, sweet Barnabas, comes through
 To say that Jesus was there with his crew
 To pray and fast that harvest be enough
 And come soon to carry them through the rough
 And provide for the children all around
 Both bread and cake to make children abound.
 Beloved, I love both Barnabas and him
 You sent to feed the children in times grim.
 If he would only come back soon and give
 The ones starving today something to live.

Barnabas 139

1 Jesus was found by him who writes,
And James and John, to their delights.
And weeping they said: "Master, why
Did you hide from us? We've gone by
Seeking you weeping." Jesus then
Replied: "I fled since I knew men
And devils are preparing well
For me what in a quite brief spell
You shall see. For, the chief priests and
The elders of the folk shall stand
Against me and take power to kill
Me from the Roman ruler's will,
Because they fear that I would take
Kingship over Israel in stake.
I shall be sold and so betrayed
By one of my own students paid,
As Joseph was sold in Egypt.
2 But the just God shall see him stripped,
As says the prophet David, then:
"He'll make him fall in a pit when
He spreads a snare for neighbour's pen.
For God shall save me from their hands,
And take me out of this world's lands."
The three disciples were afraid;
But Jesus comforted and said:
Don't be afraid, for none of you
Shall betray me into such rue."
And so they took comfort as due.

Jesus predicts in secret now what he
Is sure will happen for integrity
Against rebellion. He does not support
The taking of the Romans' guard and fort.
One could make a case for oppression deep
And for the usurpation of the keep.
One could well justify rise against Rome,
But Jesus has another to drive home.
Beloved, I too would disregard the state,
But does that not make way for further rate
Of more oppression? Someone ought to check
The wickedness while lounging on the deck.
The violence implied may be the reason
That Jesus does not take hold of the season.

3 The next day there came, two by two,
Thirty-six disciples in crew;
And he stayed in Damascus town
Waiting for others to come down.
And they were sorry every one,
Since they knew Jesus' work was done

And he'd be leaving the world soon.
 So he opened his mouth to croon:
 "The one who wanders and does not
 Know where he's going, is sad lot,
 But more unhappy is the one
 Who can and knows a hotel spun,
 But wants to stay in muddy roads,
 In the rain and in danger's goads.
 4 Tell me, my brothers, is this world
 Our native country and empearled?
 It is not, since the first man here
 Was cast out in the world of fear
 In exile and suffers the pain
 Of punishment for error's gain.
 Is there an exile who does not
 Aspire to return to his plot
 Of wealthy homeland when he finds
 Himself in poverty that blinds?
 Reason denies it, and the course
 Of experience proves it at source,
 Because the lovers of the world
 Will not consider how death swirled.
 No, when one speaks to them of death,
 They'll not listen to his word's breath.

One could say sour grapes to those who wish
 To enter Paradise with spoon and dish.
 But Jesus hopes to avoid every chance
 Of falling in disgrace of pagan dance.
 It may be true that every soul that's born
 Is exiled to a barren earth forlorn,
 But none of us who may live wish to die,
 Despite the hope that when in graves we lie
 We wait a resurrection in the flesh
 In Paradise to eat and love afresh.
 Beloved, be now my Paradise and gain
 And I shall not seek to depart in vain
 From Your creation and Your lovely earth
 Just because all men are forlorn at birth.

Barnabas 140

1 Believe, O men, that I come in
 The world with benefits in bin
 That no man's had before nor will
 Even God's Messenger in till,
 Since God did not create a man
 To set him in the world by plan,
 But rather into paradise.
 No man would ever think it nice
 To leave his country and his own

Never to go back, but take loan
To live in Rome and hope to get
Something from the Romans he met.
Much less would he do so when he
Found he'd offended Caesar's see.
Yet I tell you the truth and still
Solomon, God's prophet, in bill
Joins me: O death, how bitter be
Remembrance of you to the free
Resting in their wealth gratefully!
2 I don't say this because I must
Now die and come to bite the dust,
For I'm sure I'll live even near
The end of the world to appear.
But I say this so you will learn
To die and not a good death spurn.
As God lives, everything done wrong,
Even just once, shows to be strong
That to do something well must take
Much practice to avoid mistake.
Have you seen how the soldiers go
Marching in practice for a show
In time of peace as if in war?
So how shall a man without store
Of practice make a good death's row?
3 The death of saints is precious in
The sight of the Lord without sin,
Said David the prophet aloud.
Do you know why such is allowed?
I'll tell you. It's because all things
Rare are precious, so death on wings
Died well is rare and precious too
In sight of God who made us true.
When a man starts a thing to do,
He aims not just to finish too,
But also to be careful to
Make a good end of what's in view.

I see that Jesus quoted by this man
Called Barnabas is quick in word and plan
To quote my master David in his span.
And master David ought to speak to me,
Since he's the one that I have faithfully
Been following along life's hedge and gate.
David is the one that I would instate
As king before all others on the plate.
It is prophetic quite. So Jesus hastes
To flee from kingship and its hopeless wastes.
Beloved, You are king of my heart alone,
Though it may not be flesh, but rather stone,

All the better then, grave Your name deep there
And it shall remain beyond time and care.

4 O man in misery, who loves
His garments he on body shoves
More than his own soul, for when he
Cuts cloth he measures carefully
Before he cuts it; and when cut
He sews it carefully and shut.
But his life, which is born to die,
Since only the unborn can vie
Without death, why will men not stop
To measure life by death and drop?
Have you seen builders, how they lay
Each foundation stone the right way,
And measure it straight so the wall
Will not fall down and so appal?
O wretched man! for his life's house
Will fall with great ruin to nous,
Because he does not cast an eye
To death's foundation and know why!

I guess the young think oft of death to state
A philosophic argument in rate.
The elderly in still foreboding wait
For what's inevitable soon or late.
So what's to measure? All men measure so,
Whether in faith and truth or on the go
To eat, drink and be merry. So do I.
The ruin is upon us all who die.
Beloved, let Your own measure take my tone
As I stand before Your unseen, great throne.
I do indeed see how faiths now have turned
To fashion in fine clothes and instead spurned
Repentance at the thought of coming death.
No textile faith will let one catch his breath.

Barnabas 141

1 Tell me now how a man is born?
He's born naked on earth in scorn.
And when he's buried, what has he
In advantage and in degree?
A poor linen shroud binds him round.
This is the world's reward renowned.
If the result's judged by the start
As well as the end of each mart,
Then how to evaluate what
Is the result of a man's glut
And end who desires earthly wealth?
He shall die, as David in stealth

Says as a prophet sent from God:
 "The sinner's death's evil on sod."
 2 If a man sewing cloth should thread
 Beams on the needle then instead
 Of thread, what would the work's end be?
 It would be certain vanity,
 And he'd be mocked by neighbours too.
 But a man keeps this not in view
 As he gathers the earthly bit.
 For death's the needle in his kit,
 And earthly goods cannot remain
 Threaded into it as for gain.
 Yet in his madness he still tries
 To make success, in a vain prize.
 3 If anyone doubts what I say,
 Let him take a look at what lay
 In the tombs, there's truth on display.
 The one who wishes to be wise
 Beyond all others in the guise
 Of the fear of God, let him take
 Heed to the tomb's book, in its wake
 He'll find true saving doctrine's stake.
 For he'll know to beware the world,
 The flesh and the senses uncurled,
 When he sees that man's flesh remains
 The food of worms and other stains.
 Tell me, if there were such a road
 Safe to walk in and bear a load,
 But if the edge in danger lay,
 Where he would break his head to stay,
 If you saw men, what would you say,
 If they competed there to see
 Who could get closest to the edge
 And kill himself without a hedge?
 Would you not be surprised at that?
 You surely would remark out flat:
 "They 're mad and they have lost their mind,
 And if not, they're in desperate bind."
 'That's very true, they all replied,
 All the disciples at his side.
 Then Jesus wept and said: "Just so,
 So all lovers of the world go.
 For if they lived by reason's way,
 Which holds best to the middle stay,
 They'd follow in the Law of God,
 And be saved from eternal clod.
 But because they follow the flesh
 And are caught in the worldly mesh,
 They're frenzied and cruel to their own
 Souls, striving to live to atone

In arrogance and luxury,
Above each other in degree.'

And yet that is exactly what the dream
Of men is in the marja's cunning scheme
And if the truth be told, all other men
Of every priestly craft in priestly den.
The trick's to know by verdict of the just
How close one can walk to the edge of crust
Without foot falling in perversion's dust.
Precaution rather than the marja's rule
Is smarter far than any other tool.
Beloved, let me not bear the wicked yoke
Of false freedom beneath the marja's stroke,
But rather take my nourishment from You
Instead of verdicts of renown and due.
So I shall was far from the edge in view.

Barnabas 142

I Judas, the traitor, when he saw
That Jesus fled, lost hope for awe
And gaining power in the world,
For he bore Jesus' purse, the churled,
In which was kept all given him
For love of God and hope undim.
He hope Jesus would become king
Of Israel and he a strong wing.
So having lost this hope, he said
To himself: 'If this man were bred
A prophet, he would know that I
Keep stealing his money on sly,
So he'd lose patience and cast out
Of his service, knowing my doubt.
And if he were a wise man, he
Would not flee from honour's degree
That God wills to give to him here.
So it will be better for me
To make arrangements to appear
With the chief priests and with the scribes
And Pharisees to work for bribes,
And see how to give him into
Their hands and for my profits' view.'
With this decision, he informed
The scribes and Pharisees and stormed
About what happened in Nain's town.
And they consulted for renown
With the high priest, and said: 'What now
Shall we do if this man somehow
Becomes king? It will not go well
With us, because he's like to quell

Our innovations to restore
The ancient modes of worship more.
What will happen to us at last
Under the reign of such man's blast?
We'll all go under with our kids.
For without our positions' bids
We'll end up begging on the skids.
Praise God, we now have a king set
With governor, neither which met
Our Law, but are strangers to it,
And care not for our Law a whit,
Just as we care not for their own.
So we can do as we alone
Prefer, for even if we sin,
Our God is merciful and din
Of sacrifice and fasting bring
Appeasement for our sinful sting.
But if this man becomes our king,
He'll not be appeased till he see
Worship according to decree
Of Moses; and what's worse, says he
That the Messiah shall not come
Of David's seed, as one in sum
Of his disciples has told us,
But says he'll come of Ishmael's bus,
And that the promise was first made
To Ishmael, not Isaac's parade.

I simply say that Hagar's son for sure
Is born of Abraham of a line pure,
In marriage duly made at Sarah's hand,
And strongly made secure in legal stand.
But Isaac was born after Sarah made
A visit to the hareem and parade
Of King Abimelech, and told the king
That Abraham was just her brotherling.
The evil hags around the town spoke fair
By saying that Isaac was conceived there.
I do not say that is the truth at all.
I know how often people lie and call.
But truth is Sarah did spend time alone
In harem of Abimelech to groan.

2 So what if this man's let to live,
What shall then our future days give?
The Ishmaelites will come to fame
Among the Romans, and they'll aim
To give them our land for their own,
So Israel will again be lone
In slavery as before.' That's why,

When they heard how the matters lie,
The high priest gave them this reply,
That he should deal with Herod and
With the governor of the land,
'Because the people are inclined
Toward him and without combined
Army there's nothing to be done,
But it may please God, we'll have won,
With help of the army to stun.'
So they plotted and planned to take
Him by night, when Herod in stake
Along with the governor too
Should agree to the thing in view.

The plot is sure and certain and indeed
Exactly what one might truly concede.
I can believe the Romans saw good sense
In ridding the world of Jesus for pence.
I can believe the ruling crowd was set
Against him from the outset when they met.
I only think a banal miracle
Is unexpected in the final pull.
There are examples of men resurrected
Since Elijah himself such things elected.
But when was any man changed to look like
Another on the eve of a foul strike?
Beloved, the case is open in my mind.
The evidence is to little in kind.

Barnabas 143

1 Then all of the disciples came
To Damascus, by God's will's flame.
Then Judas the traitor made show
More than the others he was low
In grief that Jesus was away,
At which Jesus said for dismay:
"Let everyone beware the man
Pretends to love you without plan."
And God made us not understand
So we'd not know what Judas planned.
When all the disciples arrived,
Jesus said: 'Let's go as contrived
Back to Galilee, because that
The angel of God said out flat
That I must go there and stay pat.'

The proof that Jesus was no prophet lay
In Judas's desires to have his way.
So every true prophet by some denied
Is rejected because of what they hide.

I take Your prophets all rejecting none
And love their words described under the sun.
From Adam to Muhammad I have done
The thousands that I know not and the one
I know like my own hand. I choose them all
And rise up, my Beloved One, at Your call.
But Judas had his proof in mercy shown
To the thief who thought hidden sins alone
Were hidden from the one that You had sent.
So is the heart and so the soul that's bent.

2 One Sabbath morning Jesus came
To Nazareth, where for his fame
Everyone wished to see again.
A publican named among men
Zacchaeus, who was very short,
And so could not see all the sport,
Climbed high up in a sycamore,
And waited for Jesus time sore,
Till he should pass by on the way
To the synagogue where to pray.
When Jesus came there he looked up
And addressed a word to the top:
“Zacchaeus, come down, for today
I shall come to your house to stay.”
The man came down and welcomed him
With gladness and to a feast trim.
3 The Pharisees murmured and said
To Jesus's disciples led:
“Why does your master go to eat
With publicans and sinners greet?”
Jesus replied: “Physicians, why
Do they enter their trade to ply?
Tell me, and I will tell you why
I've come into this house to spy.”
They answered then: “To heal the sick.”
“You tell the truth,” said Jesus thick,
“For the well people have no need
Of medicine, the sick indeed.”

Not knowing halacha of right and wrong,
I do not know if I should judge the song
Of good Zachaeus climbing up a tree
On Sabbath day and for the Lord to see.
I wonder also about all the feast
Prepared impromptu or then at the least
Without the knowing Jesus came to stay.
There may have been Sabbath breaking that day.
Beloved, I am among that stricken crew
With Zachaeus, who knew with sinful rue

His need of Your sent one to find his pew.
So I climb up a tree to see the road,
Though I'm as tall as any other toad,
To spy salvation from my heavy load.

Barnabas 144

1 As God lives, in whose presence I
Stand, God sends His prophets to spy,
And servants all into the world
So sinners may repent unhurled.
He sends them not for righteous folk,
Who had no need of penance spoke,
Just as a clean person does not
Need to take a bath on the spot.
But truly I tell you, if you
Were true Pharisees, without rue
You had been glad that I should go
To sinners for salvation's show.
Tell me, do you know from the start
How Pharisees came to take part?
I'll tell you, since you do not know,
So listen to the words I show.
2 Enoch, a friend of God, who walked
With God in truth, as well as balked
Against the world's way, was caught up
To paradise; and stay with cup
Until the judgement day, for when
The end of the world comes again,
He'll come back to help the world too
With Elijah and work in crew.
Men who knew about this thing true,
For the desire of paradise,
Began to seek God without vice,
God who's their Creator to start.
For 'Pharisee' is of such art
That means to seek God in the tongue
Of Canaan when the earth was young.
It was a way to mock good men,
Since Canaanites by stratagem
Were sunken in idolatry,
Which is human hands' worship spree.
3 That's why the Canaanites to see
Those of our folk who separately
From the world came to serve God well,
When they saw such a person, tell
In their derision: 'Pharisee!'
That is, 'He seeks God'; so to be
Saying: 'O madman, you have no
Statues of idols, so you pray
To the empty wind every day.

Think of your benefit and come
And worship our idols in sum.'
Truly I say to you," he said,
"All the saints and prophets God led
Have been Pharisees not in name,
As you are, but in deed and fame.
For in all they did they sought God
Their Creator upon the sod,
And for God's love they did forsake
Cities and their own goods in stake,
Selling their goods to give the poor
For love of God and a prize sure."

For love of You, Beloved to do all things
Is what most peace and most contentment brings.
Those who expect the people's gratitude
For their achievements and more praise imbued
Will only find their disappointment grow.
The world has nothing to give for a glow,
But calumny and a shroud at the end.
It's true that coffins nowadays though tend
To cost a pretty penny to be fair,
If that is any consolation's care.
Of course one must buy that oneself. I know
That the world's praise is always broughten show.
So let me do if I must do at all
For love of You and for no other call.

Barnabas 145

1 As God lives, in Elijah's time,
Friend of God and prophet in rhyme,
There were twelve mountains where abode
Seventeen thousand Pharisees.
In all that number not one strode
Outside the law, but all were pleased
To be God's own elect. But now,
When one hundred thousand somehow
Grace Israel's land, may it please God
To find one in a thousand shod
As the elect upon the sod!"

2 The angry Pharisees replied:
"So we're all reprobate beside
And you hold our faith in such tide!"

And Jesus answered: "I do not
Hold the faith of true Pharisees
In reprobation but in plot
Of approbation, God to please,
For which I am ready to die.

3 But let us see by your reply
If you're true Pharisees to vie.

Elijah, friend of God, was asked
 By Elisha, his follower tasked,
 To write a little book where he
 Included all wisdom you see
 Among men with God's law to be."
 Confounded were the Pharisees
 To hear Elijah's book's decrees
 Mentioned, because they knew full well
 By their traditions one must quell
 The doctrine of that book. The blame
 Was that business had higher claim.
 Then Jesus said: "If you were true
 Pharisees you would leave the view
 Of other business to attend
 To this; for Pharisees will bend
 To seek God only and to spend."
 They remained in confusion then
 To hear Jesus, who said again:
 4 "Elijah, the servant of God"
 For so begins the book in prod,
 "To all who wish to walk with God
 Their creator, is writing this:
 5 Those who desire to learn things great
 Fear God little, because those late
 Who fear God are content to wait
 And know only what things God wills.
 Those who seek fair words and their frills
 Do not seek God, who stands alone
 To reprove us of our sins' tone.
 6 Those who wish to seek God, let them
 Lock up their houses to indemn,
 Because the master's not found where
 He is not loved, and off his stair.
 7 So guard your senses, guard your heart,
 Because God is not found apart,
 Outside us in the world which hates
 Him, made of wicked reprobates.
 8 Let those who wish to do good works
 Attend to their own selves and quirks,
 For there's no profit to be gained
 In having all the world and stained
 And losing one's own soul profaned.
 9 Let those who wish others to teach
 Live better than others they preach,
 Since nothing can be learned in share
 From him who know less than we bear.
 How shall the sinner mend his life
 When he hears one worse in the strife
 Teaching him how to live and wife.
 10 Let those who seek God flee the way

Of conversation with men's sway,
 Since Moses was alone to speak
 With God on Mount Sinai and meek
 To address Him as friend to friend.
 11 Those who seek God should come out where
 Men of the world are bent with care
 Only once a month to do share
 Of business, for such seekers bear
 What he does working for two years
 Can be done in one day's arrears.
 12 When he walks, let him look around
 At nothing but his feet on ground.
 13 Let him speak only needful things
 Avoiding vanity's babblings.
 14 When they eat, let them go away
 From the table hungry to pray;
 Thinking not to attain the day
 To come, but only breath to breath
 Living and remembering death.
 15 Let one garment, one made of skin,
 Be enough for each to live in.
 16 Let the earthly clod go to sleep
 On naked earth two hours to keep.
 17 Let him hate no one but himself;
 Nor condemn any but himself.
 18 In prayer, let them stand in such fear
 As in the judgement to appear.
 19 Now do this in service to God,
 With the law God gave through the rod
 Of Moses, for in this way you
 Shall find God in each time and pew,
 And you'll feel you in God remain,
 And God in you removing stain."
 20 This is Elijah's little book,
 O Pharisees, so take a look.
 Again I say if you were true
 Pharisees, you'd have the joy due
 That I've come here and to proclaim
 That God has mercy on the same
 Sinners that you condemn and blame."

Beloved, what wealth I find here in this word
 Of Gospel that Barnabas rose and stirred!
 All wisdom's found in its few phrases cured
 And at the end the best thing recommended:
 The Decalogue that my life has defended.
 Let me hide in my heart these gracious teachings
 And know them for the best of all earth's preachings.
 Let me think on them day and every night,
 And live and breath them always in Your sight.

O sweet book of Elijah, and book fair,
That is the best that written anywhere!
Let me be found of You, and I shall know
The pleasures of Your gardens in which grow
The sweet perfumes of roses in a row.

Barnabas 146

1 Then Zacchaeus said: "Sir, behold
I'll give for love of God fourfold
Of all I've got by usury."
Then Jesus said: "This day I see
Salvation's come to this house near.
Indeed, many, many, I fear,
Of publicans and harlots dear,
And sinners shall go in God's reign,
And they that think themselves not vain
But righteous shall go down to hell
There to remain eternal spell."
When the Pharisees heard that word,
They left with hearts in anger stirred.

The Pharisees may be angry or not
To hear that sinners and harlots untaught
Will go into the Paradise of God
Why those who think themselves righteous in pod
Go down into the pit of hell to stay.
Let them be angry for the words You say
By Your sent one. I only laugh for joy
To hear the words of comfort You employ.
Beloved, if sinners and harlots are bound
For the joys of Your Paradise when found,
Then I find myself in my company,
My peers without grateful integrity.
If You bring us into that garden fair,
In our surprise we shall bow to You there.

2 Jesus said to repentant ones
And to his disciples like sons:
"There was a father with two sons,
And the younger one said at last:
'Father, give me my portion cast',
And his father gave it to him.
Having received his portion trim,
He went to a distant land grim,
Where he wasted all his goods in
Living with harlots and in sin.
Then there came famine on the land,
So the wretch took service command
Where he was set to feed the swine.
Not having wherewithal to dine,

He satisfied his hunger there
By eating acorns, the swine's share.

Acorns are very good for food, I know,
When I was just a child my dad said so,
And even taught me how to make the bread
On which the early mountain people fed.
I always said any food that could make
A hog fat and turn into luscious steak
Will keep a man alive. The acorn will
Serve well enough for board and for the bill.
You have to leach the bitter out with ash
And then you can make cakes to sell for cash.
I am a dervish dog, but I can eat
The tasty food of hog and call it treat.
Let me live in the post-harlotry pen
And feed on acorns and glory again.

3 He came to himself and he said:
'How many in my dad's house fed
In feasts abundant, while I here
Perish in hunger and in fear!
I shall arise, therefore, and go
To my father and tell him so:
'Father, I've sinned toward heaven and you,
Take me as a servant in view.'
The poor man left, in course of time,
His father saw him come and climb
From afar off, and pity filled
His heart and he started out thrilled
To meet him, came to him, embraced
And kissed him there on the road placed.
4 The son bowed himself to the ground,
And said: 'Father, in me is found
Sin against heaven and you indeed,
Do let me as a servant plead,
For I'm not worthy to be called
A son of yours, let me be thrall'd.'
The father then replied: 'Son, no,
You are my son, you shall not go
Out as a slave.' And so he called
His servants and told them out bald:
'Bring new robes here and clothe my son,
And give him new garments he's won,
Give him a ring on finger too,
And kill the fatted calf for stew
And we'll make merry for his due.
For this son of mine, he was dead,
But now's come back to life instead,
And he was lost, but now he's found

And has come back to his own ground.'

The sinner fails to come to You, Beloved,
Because he cannot think Your wrath is gloved,
And that You'll kill the fatted calf
And set him at a table where to laugh
With angels as he eats the Irish stew
With golden rings place on his hands in view.
The sinner cannot rise to such belief
Because he's used to thinking like a thief.
Beloved, I come to You in expectation
Of nothing, not even a servant's station,
Which would be great to have to salve the pride.
I come, Beloved, with nothing left to hide.
I come not of my own free will at all
But drawn by Your irresistible call.

Barnabas 147

1 During the celebration's feast,
The elder son came home like priest
And heard the din of feasting there,
And marvelled and asked of the blare
From one of the servants, and he
Replied: 'Your brother's come home, see,
And your dad's killed the fatted calf,
And they feast now and sing and laugh.'
The elder son was angry then
When he heard this and so again
Would not go in the house, and so
His dad came out to him to show:
'Son, your brother's come, so come in
And rejoice that he's left his sin.'
2 But he answered with bitter wrath:
'I've always served you in the path,
And you never gave me a lamb
To eat with friends *instead of ham*.
But for this wretch who went away
And wasted all his goods to pay
His harlots, when he comes to you,
You kill the fatted calf for stew!'"

The father answered: 'Son you are
Always with me and you're a star
And everything is yours; but this
One was dead and a thing to miss,
And is alive again to kiss,
Was lost and now at last is found;
So we must rejoice on that ground.'
The elder son more angry still
Said: 'You can go and you can fill
Your gut with celebrating will,

But I will not sit down to eat
With fornicators in their seat.”
And he departed from his dad
Without getting a farthing sad.
As God lives,” said Jesus, “just so,
There is joy where the angels go
For one sinner's repentance glow.”

Canonical story does not relate
In such detail the faithful brother's fate.
It leaves some hope that hypocrites may rise
In great repentance to go to the skies.
But now I know by Barnabas they take
In wrath the way to hell for their beefsteak.
It is a sad thing to know that the ire
Of righteousness brings one down to the fire.
Beloved, let there be no righteous wrath in
My heart and tongue and hand to fill with sin.
Let me thrill rather to the sound where weeps
The sinner in repentance for his keeps.
I know too many righteous people here.
Let me find only sinners in my fear.

3 When they had eaten, then he left,
He went to Judaea bereft.
The disciples said: “Master, no,
Do not go to Judaea's show,
For we know that the Pharisees
Have taken counsel at their ease
With the high priest against you there.”
Jesus replied: “I knew before
They did the thing, I knew it more.
But I've no fear, for they cannot
Do anything or even plot
Beyond the will of God unsought.
I do not fear them, I just fear
God only, and by His will steer.

Beloved, give me more fear upon the ground,
More fear of You to crowd out every sound
Of fear of Pharisee and priest and chief
Of state that comes into the world for grief.
I doubt not that the show of power is there,
I doubt not that destruction's everywhere,
But beyond all the games that people share
I find Your will alone brings me relief.
But still I do not enter lions' den
Presumptuously without Your word to men.
I wisely try to avoid those whose whip
Is raised against the poor. I open lip

To praise You for Your power and justice here
And that requites enough for all, I fear.

Barnabas 148

'1 Tell me now: Pharisees today,
Are they true Pharisees in way?
Are they servants of God in light?
They truly are not in my sight.
I tell you indeed on the earth
There is nothing of lesser worth
Than a man who dresses in right
Of religion to hide his spite.
I'll tell you of one in times past
Who was a Pharisee to last,
So you'll see the difference today
Between him and those on display.
After Elijah went away,
Because of idolaters' work
Of persecution in the kirk,
The holy congregation of
The Pharisees scattered in shove.
For in that very time he bode,
Elijah did and on earth strode,
More than ten thousand prophets died,
Slain in one year of those to bide
Among the Pharisees in tide.
2 Two Pharisees went in the mount
To dwell there if beside a fount,
And one lived there for fifteen years,
Not knowing of the other's tears,
Although they lived an hour apart.
See if they were curious in art!
There came a drought upon the land,
So both set out to search in hand
For water, and they found each other.
The elder spoke first to his brother,
For among them the eldest aye
Spoke first, it was a sin to vie
With the more aged, so he said:
'Where do you live, brother, and fed?'
He answered pointing out the place
With hand extended from his face:
'I live here', for they were nearby
The dwelling of the younger guy.
3 The elder asked: 'How long have you
Been living here, brother in view?'
The younger answered: 'Fifteen years.'
The elder said: 'Perhaps you came
When Ahab slew God's servants, shame?'
'Just so,' the younger man replied.

The elder said: 'O brother tried,
 Do you know who now is the king
 Of Israel after that sting?'
 The younger answered, 'It is God
 Who's king of Israel, every clod
 Idolater is no king but
 Israel's persecutor in glut.'
 'That's true,' said the elder, 'but I
 Meant to say who is the one sly
 Who now persecutes Israel's sty?'
 4 The younger answered: 'Israel's sins
 Persecute Israel on their shins,
 Because if they had not sinned, God
 Would not have raised upon the sod
 Idolatrous princes to reign
 Over Israel's land to profane.'
 Then the elder said: 'Who is that
 Infidel prince whom God in fiat
 Has sent for Israel's chastisement?'
 The younger answered: 'How should I
 Know, since as these fifteen years fly,
 I have not seen a man but you,
 And I cannot read any view
 And so no letters come to me?'
 The elder said: 'But how new be
 Your sheepskins! Who has given them to
 You, if you've had no man in view?'

I think that I'm a hermit on the hill,
 Alone after the way that good kings kill
 The righteous and the sinner for their meat.
 I think there is not anyone to greet
 After the ten thousand who gave their lives
 To Ahab for the good a vulture thrives.
 I think that no one else raises a prayer
 Of Psalms of David on the parchèd air.
 And then, Beloved, I find on every rill
 A hermit praising You beyond his fill
 For meat and pulse and other things to eat
 That grow up after rain and snow and sleet.
 I think that there are no bees in the hives
 Until I hear a buzzing of their knives.

Barnabas 149

1 The younger answered: 'He who kept
 The clothing of Israel who wept
 For forty years in wilderness
 Has kept my skins as you see dress.'
 The elder then perceived that this
 Young man was of more perfect bliss

Than he, for every year he'd made
 Dealings with men and had some trade.
 So that he might have benefit
 Of conversation with him fit,
 He said: 'Brother, you don't know how
 To read, but I know anyhow,
 And I have in my house the book
 Of David's Psalms to take a look.
 So come and I'll give you each day
 A reading and make plain the way
 To you what David says in sway.'
 The younger said: 'Let's take our way.'
 2 The elder said: 'O brother mine,
 It's now two days since by my vine
 I have drunk water; therefore let
 Us seek a little water yet.'
 The younger answered: 'Brother dear,
 It is now two months since in fear
 I have drunk water. Let us go,
 Therefore, and see what God will show
 By His prophet David: the Lord
 Is able to give water stored.'
 They went back where the elder stayed,
 And at the door a fresh spring sprayed.
 The elder said: 'O brother sweet,
 You are God's saint, for see the treat,
 God's given this spring for your sake.'
 3 The younger answered for mistake:
 'Brother, you say a humble word,
 But it is certain this occurred
 For your sake and not mine because
 God would have placed it near my paws
 So I should not have to come here.
 For I confess here in your ear
 That I sinned against you. When you
 Said for two days you sought in view
 Water without drinking a bit,
 And I'd been two months without it,
 There was exaltation in heart
 As though I were of better part
 Than you.' Then said the elder one:
 'Brother, no sin by you was done,
 You merely told the truth well spun.'
 4 The younger said: 'O Brother mine,
 You have forgotten the design
 Of what said father Elijah,
 That he who seeks God should condemn
 Himself alone. His stratagem
 Was not surely just to write it,
 But that we might observe it fit.'

The elder seeing truth and right
 In his companion in his sight,
 Said: 'It is true, and our God's just
 In that He pardoned you in trust.'
 And having said this he took out
 The book of Psalms to read about
 What our father David recites:
 I'll set a watch on my mouth's rights
 So my tongue will decline to speak
 The words of iniquity weak,
 Excusing with excuse my sin.
 Here let the aged man begin
 A discourse on the tongue, and then
 The younger departed again.
 After fifteen more years they found
 Each other on another ground.
 5 So when he found him once again,
 The elder said: 'O brother then,
 Why have you not come back to see
 Me in my dwelling's company?'
 The younger answered: 'Just because
 I have not mastered what in laws
 You spoke to me.' The elder said:
 'How can this be, when there've been led
 Fifteen years?' The younger replied:
 'As for the words, soon as I tried
 I learned them in the hour beside,
 And I have never forgot them.
 But I have not yet observed them.
 To what purpose is it to learn
 Too much and not observe and earn?
 Our God does not seek that our minds
 Should be filled up with sundry kinds,
 Or be good, but instead our heart.
 So on the judgement day He'll start
 To ask us what we did instead
 Of what we learned by heart in bed.'

How many Psalms have I learned by heart, yet
 Have failed to keep the teaching of word met
 In hand and deed! Forgive, Beloved, my way
 Of keeping in the heart Your word today
 And failing to carry out in Your sway
 The loving deeds of sacrifice that You
 Require and hope to see rise from my pew.
 I love the words of David that he drew.
 Let me not meet Your judgement here and now
 Or in the day of resurrection's brow
 And find me lacking by the way I speak
 And fail to do the very things I seek.

Grant me Your grace today and in that time,
And I shall do instead of merely rhyme.

Barnabas 150

1 'The elder answered: "Brother dear,
Do not say so, for so I fear
That you despise knowledge that God
Wills to be prized upon the sod."
The younger said: 'How shall I speak
Now so I fall not in sin weak?
For your word's true and so is mine.
I say those who know God's command
Ought first to observe what's in hand
If they would afterwards learn more.
And all a man learns to the core
He ought to do and not just know."
The elder said: 'O brother, show
With whom you've spoken, that you know
You have not learned all that I said?"

2 'The younger answered: "Brother mine,
I speak within myself and fine.
Each day I place myself before
The judgement of God at His door,
To give account of what I do.
I always feel inside my rue
Excusing my faults in my pew."
The elder said: "O brother dear,
What faults have you, so perfect near?"

The younger answered: 'Brother, do
Not say so, for I stand twixt two
Great faults: the one fault here is I
Do not know myself as I lie
To be of sinners greatest one,
The other fault I see when done,
Is that I do not wish to make
Greater penance for that fault's sake
Than do other men in my wake."
The elder answered: "How can you
Know you're greatest sinner in view
If you are the most perfect man?"

'3 The younger replied: "The first span
My master told me at my plan
To take habit of Pharisee
Was this: I ought always to see
The goodness of others and know
My own iniquity in stow,
For if I should always do so,
I should perceive myself to be
The greatest of sinners in spree.'
The elder said, 'O brother mine,

Whose goodness or faults can divine
 You on this mountain where's no man?"

The younger answered: "I should take
 In contemplation the sun's sake,
 And how each planet does obey,
 For they were their Creator's way
 Better than I. But I condemn
 Them, either because in their hem
 They give no light as I desire,
 Or they're too hot for me like fire,
 Or there's too little or too much
 Of rain upon the ground to touch."

4 'On hearing this, the elder said:
 "Brother, where have you learned and bred
 This doctrine? I'm ninety years old
 And seventy-five years I have told
 All I am a Pharisee bold."

The younger answered: "Brother mine,
 You say this in a humble fine,
 For you're a holy one of God.
 Yet I answer you that in pod
 God our Creator sees not time,
 But looks on the heart for its crime:
 So David when fifteen years old,
 Younger than six brothers more bold,
 Was chosen Israel's king to be
 And became God's prophet to see."

The reasoning sounds more to me to be
 That of Christian hermits than Pharisee,
 But do not let me sway your fine opinion
 Of the authentic book in its dominion.
 So much in contemplation of the word
 Of David has me up in arms and stirred
 To fight the foe within and praise the name
 Of my Beloved and leave off every game.
 Let me be Pharisee or hermit bright,
 Whatever may be found beneath Your sight
 That is recipient of grace untried
 Until I find the treasures at Your side.
 I read and fail to do, I do and fail
 To learn the sacred Word, but You prevail.

Barnabas 151

1 'This man was a Pharisee true,'
 Told Jesus his disciples too;
 And may it please God that we be
 Able on judgement day to know
 Him for our friend, a friend to show.'

2 Jesus then embarked on a ship,

And the disciples for their slip
 Were sorry, since they forgot bread.
 Jesus rebuking them then said:
 "Beware of the Pharisees' yeast,
 In our day, for leaven at least
 Mars a mass of meal and the dough."

The disciples then came to show
 Each other: 'Now what yeast have we,
 If we've not even bread to see?'
 Jesus said: 'Men of little faith,
 Have you forgotten then like wraith
 What God wrought in Nain without corn?
 And how many ate without scorn
 And were satisfied with five loaves
 And two fishes dressed without cloves?
 The leaven of the Pharisees
 Is lack of faith in God to please,
 And thought of self, the which has spoiled
 Not only Pharisees now coiled
 But all of Israel that toiled.

3 For simple folk who cannot read
 Do what they see them do indeed,
 Because they think the Pharisees
 Are holy ones, holy with ease.

4 Do you know what's true Pharisee?
 He's oil of human nature wee.
 Just as oil floats on liquid here,
 True Pharisee's virtues appear
 At the top of all human good.
 He is a living book as should
 God give to the world; everything
 That he says and does according
 To God's law shows the way to sing.
 For who does as he does will keep
 The law of God and will not sleep.
 The true Pharisee is the salt
 That will not let human flesh fault
 To be rotted out by its sin;
 For all who see him are brought in
 To repentance. He is a light
 To show the pilgrims' way as bright.
 For all who note his poverty
 With his penitence can well see
 That we ought not to shut our heart
 Up from the doing of our part.
 But he that makes the oil go bad,
 As rancid, corrupts the book sad,
 Putrefies the salt, puts out light,
 This man is no Pharisee right.
 So if you would not perish, then

Beware of Pharisees again
As they are today among men.

The yeast that makes the bread both soft and light
In Jesus' words becomes the sign of blight
That comes upon the righteous nation won
By Satan's fair intrigues under the sun.
The doing of the law in love and fear
Is right among all men and women here.
But if the heart is darkened by the bad,
The righteousness no longer's to be had.
Beloved, make me aware of right and wrong
And teach me not to succumb to the song
That had invaded every mosque and church
And left the thirsty comers in the lurch.
As in the time of Jesus, men once good
Have lost the salty savour that once could.

Barnabas 152

1 Jesus came to Jerusalem,
And entered on Sabbath day's hem
Into the Temple where drew near
To tempt him Roman soldiers drear,
And catch him up and so they said:
"Master, is it right to be led
To wage war?" Jesus' answer sped:
"Our faith tells us that all our life
Is on the earth in constant strife."
The soldiers said: "So would you make
Us all convert in your faith's wake,
And so make us all to forsake
The multitude of Roman gods
Of which in Rome alone in pods
Are twenty-eight thousand of them,
To follow your God who's just one
And only just a single gem,
And He cannot be seen at all,
So it's not known where is His stall,
And maybe he's just a vain call."
2 Jesus replied: "If I had been
Your creator as God did win,
I'd seek you out and so convert
You." They replied to him as curt:
"How has your God created us,
Since no one knows or sees the fuss
Where He is? Just show us your God,
And we'll become Jews under prod."
Then Jesus said: "If you had eyes
To see Him I would not disguise,
But show Him to you, but since you

Are blind, I cannot bring in view."
 The soldiers answered: "Surely this
 Honour which this people in bliss
 Pays you must have destroyed your sense.
 For each of us has two eyes, hence
 You're wrong to say we're blind and dense."
 3 Jesus replied: "The carnal eyes
 Can only see external-wise:
 You therefore can see only gods
 Of wood and silver, gold and pods
 That can do nothing. But we folk
 Of Judah have eyesight in yoke
 Of things in spirit, which are fear
 And faith of our God who is near,
 And so we see our God with cheer
 In every place." The soldiers said:
 "Beware how you speak, if you've sped
 To pour contempt on our gods, we
 Will put you in Herod's decree,
 Who will take vengeance for our gods,
 Who are omnipotent in rods."
 4 Jesus replied: "If they're so strong
 Above all things, then I've been wrong
 Not to worship them all along."
 The soldiers rejoiced at the word,
 And started praising idols stirred.
 Then Jesus said: "We don't need words
 But deeds, and meat instead of curds,
 Tell your gods to create a fly,
 And I will worship them or try."
 The soldiers heard that in dismay
 And did not know then what to say,
 So Jesus said: "Truly, since they
 Do not create a single fly,
 I'll not forsake the God thereby
 Who with a single word made all,
 Whose name alone makes armies fall."
 The soldiers answered: "Now let's see
 This, and then we will set you free."
 For they were ready to take him,
 And arrest him for his words grim.
 5 Then Jesus exclaimed: "Adonai
 Sabaoth!" Whereon the soldiers lie
 Down and roll out the temple door,
 As one rolls casks of wood on floor
 When they are washed and then refilled
 With wine, so that head and feet thrilled
 To touch the ground, though no man there
 Laid hands upon them gloved or bare.
 And they were so afraid they fled
 And were no more seen there instead.

That's very neat, that's kind indeed to make
A miracle to justify the stake
Of the one God and true, but in the wake
I stop to think if I have been one there
Caught up by Roman soldiers in the care
Of questioning, I am not one to dare
To promise miracles out of thin air.
I know You, my Beloved, that if I did,
I would expect to see a God who hid
And left me in the lurch for what I said.
I shall not succumb to folly when led.
I praise Your name that Jesus knew the word
That left the Roman soldiers with fear stirred,
But I do not presume to speak with dread.

Barnabas 153

1 The priests and Pharisees in wrath
Murmured among themselves the math
And said: "He has wisdom of Baal
And Ashtoreth, so to prevail,
In Satan's power has he done this."
Jesus opened his mouth in bliss
And said: "Our God commanded we
Should not steal our neighbour's goods wee.
But this single command's ignored
So much that all earth has been stored
With stolen goods, and shall such sin
Ever be forgiven for din?
For every other sin may be
Forgiven by repentance free
If a man sorrow and no more
Commit the offence and fast sore
With prayer and almsgiving in store,
Our God, mighty and merciful,
Forgives. But this sin terrible
Cannot be forgiven at all,
Except they restore stolen hall.
2 Then said a scribe: 'O master wise,
How has robbery in disguise
Filled all the world with sin? I'm sure
By the grace of God and to cure,
There are but few robbers around,
And they cannot show themselves found,
But they are hanged by army bound.'
But Jesus answered: Those who know
Not the goods cannot robbers show.
I tell you many people rob
But do not know it nor the cob,
And so their sin's greater for that,

For an unsuspected ill sat
Without a cure and without fat.'
Then Pharisees came near to him
And said to Jesus a word grim:
'O master, since you are alone
In Israel to know truth from bone,
Then teach us something of your own.'
3 Jesus replied: 'I did not say
That I alone in Israel's way
Know truth, for this word "alone" is
For God only, not other's biz.
For He's the truth, who alone knows
The truth. If I say so it shows
Me greater robber in my throes,
For I'd be stealing God's own rows
Of glory. And in saying that
I alone know God on the mat,
I should be falling in my share
Of greater ignorance to spare
Than all of you. So you commit
A grievous sin to say I'm fit
Alone to know the truth and sit.
And I say if you said the thing
Merely to tempt me so to sing,
Then your sin's even greater sting.'

O my Beloved, I give abundant thanks
For that great treasure store stayed in my banks!
All men and maybe women too are born
With that same treasure, a treasure forlorn,
The equal store of ignorance untold.
Some keep it safely, undamaged by cold
Or heat or robber or other abuse.
It's never damaged by untiring use.
Forgive me, O Beloved, if I remain
Among the few who think it thing insane
To keep that common birthright here intact.
Forgive me if I damage it or scratch
By intermittent hungers that distract
Me from its care, love of knowledge to hatch.

4 Then Jesus, seeing silence fell
On all of them, he said a spell:
'Though I'm not the only one here
In Israel to know truth, I fear
I only will speak it out clear.
So listen to me, since you ask.
All things created in sun bask
As property of Him who made,
So there's no other owner paid.

So soul, sense, flesh, and time and goods,
 And honour all God's own from hoods.
 So if a man receives them not
 As God wills, he's a robber caught.
 In the same way, if he spends aught
 Contrary to God's will and taught,
 He is a robber still. I say,
 Therefore, to you that, in God's sway,
 And in whose presence I still stand,
 When you take time to say in hand:
 "Tomorrow I will do this thing,
 Tomorrow I will speak or sing,
 Or I will go to such a place,"
 And not say "If God wills," in race
 You are just robbers. You will be
 Just greater robbers in the spree
 When you spend time on things to please
 Yourselves and not pleasing to God,
 And only minimum to plod
 In God's service, then you indeed
 Have become great robbers with speed.
 Whoever does sin, he's become
 A robber, no matter what sum,
 For he steals time and soul and life
 Of his own self to live in strife,
 That ought to be spent serving God,
 And gives it to Satan in rod,
 Who is the enemy of God.'

I say in sha Allah and when I do
 I really mean the thing I have in view.
 For I know that my breath's stolen from You,
 And I'm a robber in a pirate crew
 To take the sunlight without gold to pay
 And sip the rain upon a rainy day.
 I say if God will, for I do not know
 At which moment my soul caught up and slow
 Shall turn to dust again to wait the ray
 Of resurrection from the soil and fray.
 I steal time, soul, and life, indeed, but I
 Return them with repentance on the sly
 And know that serving You is better than
 The price of all the gold on earth that can.

Barnabas 154

1 'Therefore the man with honour's span,
 And life, and goods, when by some plan
 Of robber has his goods in store
 Stolen, the robber's hung for gore;
 And when his life is taken too,

The murderer caught will in view
Of all be beheaded, it's true.
And this is right, and by command
Of God Himself upon the land.
But when the neighbour's honour's gone,
Why is the robber then not drawn
And quartered or then crucified?
Are goods better than honour's tide?
Has God commanded that the one
Who steals goods punishment has won,
And the one who takes life shall be
Punished, but the robber go free
Who steals another's honour's ground?
Surely there is no such thing found.
Our ancestors for murmuring
Did not go in promised land's ring,
But only their children at last.
And for this sin the serpents' blast
Slew seventy thousand people cast.

I have been thief of this and that, I know,
Especially as a small child on the go,
And I have been robbed of thousand times more
As an adult upon a hostile shore.
I am not sure that honour is so great
As Jesus in his ponderings would state.
It is a vain thing whether human souls
Praise or condemn while moving in the shoals.
The approbation of the world around
Rather raises suspicions, I am bound,
For what I see is that most people glow
With pride for evil in the wicked show.
I have no reputation worth a hair,
Unless it be with You, Beloved, to share.

2 As God lives in whose presence I
Stand, he that steals honour by cry
Is worthy of punishment wry
Greater than he that robs a man
Of goods and even life by plan.
And anyone who listens to
Complainers is one guilty too,
For the one gets Satan on tongue,
The other in his ears he's strung.”
The Pharisees burned hearing this,
Because they could not turn amiss
His speech to condemnation's door.
Then a doctor came up before
Jesus to say: 'Good master, say,
Why did God not give in the way

Of our ancestors fruit and corn,
 Knowing they must fall as forlorn,
 Surely he should have granted corn,
 Or not let men see how it's born.'
 3 Jesus replied: 'Man, you may say
 That I am good; you've lost your way,
 For there's none good but God alone.
 You err the more not to atone
 To ask why God does not act by
 The thing your brain would come to try.
 But still I'll answer you in all.
 I tell you that God in His hall
 As our Creator in His work
 Does not conform to every quirk
 Of humankind, and that is why
 It is not lawful then to spy
 The creature's own way and his ease,
 But rather God's honour to please,
 So that the creature may depend
 On the Creator, not to lend
 Creator creature's crutch to bend.
 As God lives in whose presence I
 Still stand, if God had granted why
 And wherefore to man, man would not
 Have known himself in any plot
 To be God's servant; and so he
 Would have thought himself lord to be
 Of paradise. And that is why
 The Creator, the blessed for aye,
 Forbade him the food, so that man
 Might remain subject to His plan.
 4 Indeed I tell you, that the one
 Who has the light of his eyes spun
 Sees all things clearly, and draws light
 Even out of darkness and night,
 But the blind does not so for spite.
 That's why I say, if man had not
 Sinned, neither you nor I a jot
 Would have known the mercy of God
 And His righteousness on the sod.
 If God had made man so that he
 Could not sin, then such men would be
 Equal to God in that. That's why
 The blessed God came to comply
 Creating man righteous and good,
 But free to do the things he should
 In regard to his own life and
 Salvation or damnation's stand.'
 The doctor was surprised to hear
 And left in confusion and fear.

I love this argument for why You made
Man able to sin in creation laid.
It was not to be just in giving him
The freedom to choose right or wrong or dim.
It was instead so that man should not be
Like God Himself who cannot sin in spree.
The character distinguishing is such
That humankind can choose the sinful clutch
While You are just and cannot swerve from right.
You do not need Your freedom on the night.
But humankind judges that freedom stays
His most valued of all possessions' praise.
So every species has his own delight,
And humankind delights in wrong and right.

Barnabas 155

1 Then the high-priest called two old priests
And secretly sent them like beasts
To Jesus as he went away
From the temple and sat to stay
In Solomon's porch there to wait
The time of midday prayer in state.
Near him his disciples with great
Crowds also appeared in the way.
The priests came near Jesus to say:
'Master, why did man eat corn and
Fruit? Did God will and so command,
Or did He not? And this they said
To tempt him for if he was led
To say: 'God willed it,' they'd reply:
'Why did he forbid it, say why?'
And if he said: 'God willed it not,'
They'd answer: 'Then man in his trot
Has more power than God, since he works
Contrary to God's will and shirks.'
2 Jesus replied: 'Your question's like
A road over a mountain strike,
Which has a precipice upon
The right and on the left hand drawn.
But I'll walk in the middle lawn.'
When they heard this, the priests amazed
Perceived he knew their heart unpraised.
2 Then Jesus said: 'Every man acts
By his own needs for use in facts.
But God, who has not need at all,
Did by His own pleasure in stall.
So when He made man, He made him
Free so that he might know, though dim,
That God had never need of him;

Verbi gratia, as a king
 Does, who displays his wealth in ring,
 So that his slave may love him more,
 Gives freedom to his slaves in store.
 3 So God created humans free
 To love the Creator and see
 How measureless is His bounty.
 Although God is omnipotent,
 Needing not man nor his consent,
 After in power creating him,
 He left him free and left him trim
 To resist evil and do good.
 For although God had power and could
 Prevent sin, He would not reject
 His own bounty, for He is one
 Without any contradiction,
 So that once bounty and power shown
 In man, He should not such sin stone,
 But as I say so man might work
 The mercy of God and not shirk
 His righteousness. What I say's true,
 And proof of that is that you too
 As I know were sent by high priest
 To tempt me and try me like beast,
 And this is the result of him
 Being a priest and a priest dim.'
 The elders left and told it all
 To the high priest, who said with gall:
 'This guy has demons at his back
 To tell him answers in his track;
 For he is out to make himself
 The king of Israel on the shelf,
 But God will thwart plans of an elf.'

The Christian failure of insight is in
 The issue of good works versus man's sin.
 It is the task of humankind as made
 To resist evil and do good parade.
 Man has the possibility as such
 And can resist the evil and can touch
 The good, since he's created inasmuch.
 It is my duty to resist the wrong.
 But the capacity to choose the right
 And to reject the wrong before Your sight
 Does not imply a man gain salvation
 By anything he chooses in his station.
 To do good is a grace granted by You,
 To save is something only You can do.

Barnabas 156

1 When he had made the midday prayer,
 As Jesus trod the temple stair,
 He found one blind, born blind from birth.
 And his disciples without mirth
 Inquired of him and asked him then:
 "O Master, who has sinned of men,
 His father or his mother, so
 That he was born blind to go slow?"
 Jesus replied: "Neither of them,
 Neither father nor mother's hem
 Sinned in him, but God has made him
 For a witness to Gospel grim.
 He called the blind man up to him
 And spat on the ground and made clay
 And placed it on the eyes that way
 Of the blind man, and said to him:
 "Go to the pool of Siloam
 And wash your eyes and come to stay!"
 2 The blind man went and washed away,
 And received light, then went to stay
 At home and those who met him said:
 'If this man were one blind instead,
 I should say for certain that he
 Was the blind one who used to be
 At Temple Gate Beautiful there.'
 Others said: 'He's the one, I swear,
 But how has he gained light to share?'
 And they came to him asking why:
 'Are you the blind man that sat by
 Gate Beautiful in Temple's way?'
 He answered: 'I am he and why?'
 They said: 'Now how did you receive
 Your sight, that we may too believe?'
 3 He answered: 'Now a man made clay,
 Spat on the ground, and put to stay
 On my eyes and said to me then:
 "Go wash in Siloam's pool again."
 I went and washed and now I see.
 Blessed by Israel's God faithfully!
 When the man born blind came again
 To The Gate Beautiful the men
 In the temple talked of the thing
 To make all Jerusalem ring.
 So he was brought to the chief priest
 Who plotted with Pharisee beast
 And priests against Jesus, who asks
 Him: 'Man, were you born to your tasks
 Without your sight?' And he said 'Yes.'
 'Give glory to God', in address
 Said the high priest, 'What prophet came

To you in a dream to give flame?
 Was it our father Abraham,
 Or Moses, servant of God, lamb,
 Or some other prophet you saw?
 For others could not work such awe.'
 4 The man born blind replied indeed:
 'Neither Abraham nor the freed
 Moses, nor any prophet here
 Have I seen in a dream with fear
 And been healed by him, but as I
 Sat at the Temple gate, came by
 A man who bade me come near there,
 And, having made some clay with care
 With spittle, put some of that clay
 Upon my eyes and sent away
 To the pool of Siloam to rinse; So I went, and washed me to wince,
 And came back seeing.' The high priest
 Asked him of the man's name at least.
 The man born blind replied again:
 'He did not tell me name or den.
 One saw me and called me to him,
 And said: "Go rinse at that man's whim.
 For he is Jesus Nazarene,
 A prophet and holy one seen
 Of God in Israel, I ween."'
 Then said the high-priest: 'Did he heal
 You today, on the Sabbath's weal?'
 The blind man answered: 'Yes, today
 He healed me.' The high priest did say:
 'Behold now, how this man does sin,
 Not keeping Sabbath to begin!'

Of all the parables and stories noted
 In the canonical Gospels and floated
 In Barnabas, this is one made to be
 Closest to John as any in degree.
 I rejoice to know no one's handicap
 Is punishment for some sin of mayhap.
 I'm glad to see the folk cure does avail.
 I rejoice that the Sabbath does prevail
 For doing good works in Your lovely name.
 I thank You for the message born in shame
 That every good thing sent from You is seen
 By the churchmen and rulers with sight keen
 As part of power struggle with the great.
 That's why I set my self in a poor gate.

Barnabas 157

1 The blind man answered: 'Whether he
 Is a sinner's a mystery.

I just know that I was born blind,
 And he made me see, he was kind.'
 The Pharisees would not believe,
 And asked the high priest for reprieve:
 'Send for his father and his mum,
 They'll tell us the truth of the bum.'
 They sent, therefore, for mum and dad
 Of the blind man, and when they had
 Arrived the high priest questioned them:
 'Is this man the son of your hem?'
 They answered: 'He's truly our son.'
 Then said the high-priest to have done:
 'He says he was born blind, and now
 He sees; and can you tell us how?'
 2 The dad and mum of the man born
 Blind answered: 'He was born forlorn
 Without his sight, but how he may
 Have come to see, we cannot say.
 He'll old enough, so just ask him.
 He'll tell you the truth glad or grim.'
 So they sent them away at last,
 And the high priest turned back and cast
 His eye on the man who'd been blind,
 And said again: 'Give God glory,
 And speak the truth and you are free.'
 The dad and mum feared to speak out,
 Because of the word without doubt
 From Roman senate that no man
 Might contend for Jesus by plan,
 The prophet of the Jews, on pain
 Of death. The governor did deign
 To obtain the decree, that's why
 His parents feared not to comply,
 And said: 'He's old enough to speak,
 So ask him of the truth you seek.'
 3 The high priest then said to the man
 Born blind: 'Give glory to the plan
 Of God and speak the truth, for we
 Know this man, whom you say freely
 Healed you, that he's a sinner too.'
 The man born blind replied in view:
 'Whether he be sinner or not,
 I do not know; but this I wot,
 That I saw not and now I see.
 Surely, from the starting decree
 Of the world to this very hour,
 There has not been seen such a power
 To heal a man born blind, and God
 Would not give sinners such a prod.'
 The Pharisees replied: 'What thing

Did he do to you to give wing
To light and sight?' The man born blind
Was amazed at unbelief signed,
And said: 'I've told you, why ask then
Again? Do you wish to be men
And follow him also again?'
4 The high priest then reviled him there,
And said: 'You're born to sin in share,
And would you teach us to beware?
Get out and follow such a man!
We follow Moses, for we scan
That God spoke to Moses, but this
Man, we know not what he might miss.'
They cast him from the synagogue
And temple. They'd not let him log
In to pray with the clean among
Israel to praise God with his tongue.

I praise You, my Beloved, Jesus was made
To be sin for the lowly and unstaïd.
Though he was without sin, unless his work
Upon the Sabbath be stain to unkirk,
He brings Your grace infinite to the one
Despised by great and good under the sun.
I'm neither great nor good, and though my sight
Is not what it once was, I'm no blind wight.
So I may choose my own society.
I choose the man born blind for friend's degree.
Let me be cast from temple and from mosque
And from the kirk and from the glowing kiosk
Of synagogue and temple. I shall stand
With Christ the sinner here to take my hand.

Barnabas 158

1 The man born blind went out to find
Jesus, who comforted him in kind
And saying: 'At no time have you
Been so blessed as you are now too,
For you are blessed of God who spoke
Through David, who came to invoke,
Our father and God's prophet furred,
Speaking against friends of the world,
Saying: "They curse but I will bless";
And by Micah in his address
As prophet, he said: "I curse your
Blessing." For earth is not in store
So contrary to air, and fire
To water, light to dark in dire,
And cold to heat, or love to hate,
As is the will of God to mate

With the will of the world come late.'
 2 So the disciples asking said:
 'Lord, great are your words; say instead
 The meaning, for as yet we do
 Not understand." Jesus replied:
 "When you shall know the world of pride,
 You shall see that I do abide
 In the truth, and so shall you know
 The truth that all the prophets show.
 Know then there are three kinds of world
 Comprehended in one world curled:
 The one stands for the heaven and earth,
 With water, air and fire in berth,
 And all things set below mankind.
 This world in all things follows just
 The will of God, for so it must,
 As says David, prophet of God:
 "God's given them decree by rod
 Which they transgress not on the sod."
 3 The second stands for world of men,
 All men, as the expression then
 "The house of such and such a one"
 Stand not for the walls of house done,
 But for the family of name.
 Now this world loves God for His fame,
 Because by nature they are filled
 With longing after God instilled,
 Since by his nature every one
 Longs after God, though it be done
 In seeking with error in sight.
 And do you know why all in plight
 Seek longing after God in heart?
 Because they long each one to start
 After an infinite of good
 Without evil mixed in the wood,
 And this is God alone. That's why
 The merciful God sent to try
 His prophets in this world to give
 Salvation to this world to live.
 4 The third world is men's fallen state
 Of sinning, changed in such a rate
 Contrary as a law to God,
 Creator of the heaven and sod.
 This makes man become in his way
 Like a demon to have his sway,
 Which are God's enemies. And this
 World our God hates so much He'd miss
 Having such prophets that love it.
 Surely, if such existed, God
 Would have removed prophecies' rod.

And what shall I say as God lives,
In whose presence my soul still gives,
When the Messenger of God comes
To the world with fanfare of drums,
If he should love this evil world,
God would take from him all unfurled
That He gave him creating him,
And would make him reprobate grim:
So greatly is God one opposed
To this world wickedly enclosed.”

It is no paradox, Beloved, that I
Both love and hate the world in which I lie.
I hate the world of men perverse and neat
Where everything becomes another's treat.
But I love the world of the one's who chose
To be the sweeter mate of sweetest rose.
I love the world created from a star,
Where beauty is reflected from afar.
It is no paradox, Beloved, that You
Both hate and love the world You have in view.
The orbits of the sun and earth and moon
Obey Your voice and come returning soon.
My duty is to walk the orbit set
For me, and for that I have love I've met.

Barnabas 159

1 The true disciples answered: "Hear,
O master, great are your words near,
Therefore have mercy on us now,
We don't understand anyhow.”
Jesus said: "Do you think perhaps
That God 's created rival slaps
In His Messenger, so he'd make
Himself equal to God in stakes?
Certainly not, but rather be
His good servant in slave's degree,
Who should not will what God wills not.
You fail to understand the thing
Because you do not know sin's sting.
So listen to the words I say.
Indeed I tell you all today,
Sin cannot rise in man except
As a contradiction inept
To God, since only that is sin
That God does not will to begin:
That's why all things that God does will
Are alien to sin in bill.
2 So if our high priests, priests along
With Pharisees would do me wrong

Because the folk of Israel
 Has called me God, if for a spell,
 They'd be doing a thing right well
 Pleasing to God, for His reward.
 But because they wrong me restored
 For other reasons, such that they
 Desire me not the truth to say,
 But yet contaminate the book
 Of Moses and David forsook
 And prophets and friends of God too,
 By their traditions, and so do
 Hate me and try to kill me, so
 God despises them and their show.
 Tell me, Moses killed men as well
 As Ahab, is this murder's spell
 In both cases? It's surely not,
 For Moses killed men in the plot
 To put end to idolatry
 And to preserve the worship free
 Of the true God, but Ahab slew
 Men to destroy worship of true
 God and preserve idolatry.
 So Moses' slaying men became
 A sacrifice and not to blame,
 While Ahab's slaying turned into
 A sacrilege: so that the two
 Opposite effects come from one
 And the same kind of act that's done.
 3 "As God lives, in whose presence I
 Stand, if Satan had spoken by
 The angels to see how they loved
 God, he would not have then been shoved
 Out by God, but because he tried
 To turn them away and to hide
 From God, therefore he's reprobate."
 Then he who writes came to relate:
 "How should we then understand what
 Micaiah the prophet unshut
 Concerning the lie God ordained
 To be spoken by the mouth reined
 Of the false prophets, as we read
 Written in the book that's indeed
 About the kings of Israel?"
 Jesus replied: "O Barnabas,
 Recite in brief all that befell,
 So we can see the truth it has."

To be a sinner is to act in full
 Against Your will, Beloved, in counter pull.
 To claim to be a sinner's to assert

An ego large and grand to be alert.
To claim to be the greatest sinner here
Is to rival You as God without fear.
Beloved, let me be no sinner at all,
Much less the greatest one upon the ball!
Though I am free to sin, I set my will,
Illusory and paltry, to the hill
And have no will but Your will set alone
Within my heart of flesh and broken stone.
Then I shall find no contradiction weighs
Upon the way I go and in my stays.

Barnabas 160

1 Then said he who writes: "Daniel
The prophet, described and did well
The kings' history of Israel
And their tyrants, and he writes so:
"The king of Israel joined the show
Of the king of Judah to fight
Against the sons of Ammonite,
Sons of Belial in God's sight.
Jehoshaphat, king of Judah,
And Ahab, king of Israel, saw
When seated in Samaria,
Both on a throne, there stood before
Them four hundred false prophets' store,
Who told Israel's king furthermore:
"Go up against the Ammonites,
For God will give them in your sights
Into your hands, and you shall scatter
Ammon both the thinner and fatter."

The fact is no such story can be found
In Daniel the prophet's book all around,
Despite the fact that many brief reports
Are attached to good Daniel for his sports.
The fact is the story is perched within
The second of the Chronicles for sin
Of Ahab, which is evidence to show
That Barnabas was written in the glow
Of times before the codices prevailed
And writers quoted the names as unveiled
On scrolls instead. Such seeming errors rise
In the canonical Gospels' disguise.
This is an evidence to support those
Who would date Barnabas in early throes.

2 Then said Jehoshaphat: "Is there
Here any prophet of the share
Of the God of our fathers' care?"

Ahab replied: "There's only one,
 And he is just a wicked one,
 Because he always will predict
 Evil about me in conflict,
 And I keep him in prison slicked."
 And he said there is only one,
 Because, after all's said and done,
 The rest had been killed by Ahab,
 And those not killed, fled like Arab
 Into the hills and mountain tops
 To hide from the deserted crops.
 Then said Jehoshaphat: "Send him,
 And let's hear what he says if grim."
 So Ahab commanded again
 That Micaiah be sent by men
 To come with fetters on his feet,
 And face bewildered in retreat,
 As though between life and death meet.
 Ahab asked him, and he said: "Speak,
 Micaiah, in the name of God.
 Shall we go up against the rod
 Of Ammonites? Will God give their
 Cities into our hands to bear?"
 3 Micaiah answered then: "Go up,
 Go up, and prosper like a tup,
 And come down again better than
 You went up prospered by your plan!"
 Then the false prophets praised the man,
 Micaiah as true prophet sent
 From God, and broke the fetters bent
 From off his feet. Jehoshaphat,
 Who feared our God and never sat
 With idols or to them bent knee,
 Asked Micaiah, saying freely:
 "For the love of our fathers' God,
 Speak the truth as you see in pod
 The issue of this war on sod."
 Micaiah said: "Jehoshaphat,
 I fear your face and where you sat,
 And so I'll tell you that I saw
 The folk of Israel at the draw
 As sheep without a shepherd's paw."
 Then Ahab smiling said to him,
 To Jehoshaphat sitting grim:
 "I told you that this guy predicts
 Only evil in derelicts,
 But you did not believe of him."
 4 Then said they both: "Now how do you
 Know this, O Micaiah, is true?"
 5 "Micaiah answered: "In my mind,

I saw a council of such kind
 Where angels in God's presence stand,
 And I heard God say a demand:
 "Who will deceive Ahab, so he
 Will go against Ammon freely
 And so be slain? At that there came
 From them suggestions for the claim,
 Until one angel said: "Lord, I
 Will fight against Ahab and try
 To go to his false prophets there
 And put the lie in their mouth bare,
 So he'll go up and there be killed."
 When God heard this, he said and willed:
 "Go now and do so, and you'll win."
 The false prophets in rage begin
 And their chief struck Micaiah's cheek,
 And said: "O reprobate of God,
 When did the angel of truth leak
 From us and come to you to seek?
 Tell us when the angel arrived
 To bring us the lie so contrived!"
 6 Micaiah answered, "You shall know
 When you flee house to house and go
 In fear of being killed when you
 Are deceived by your kind in view."
 Then in his anger Ahab cried:
 "Seize Micaiah with chains to bide
 On his neck instead of his feet,
 And give him barley bread for treat
 And water until my return,
 For now I do not know or learn
 What death I'll deal him for his word."
 They went up then and it occurred
 As Micaiah predicted well.
 For the Ammonite king in spell
 Said to his servants: "See that you
 Do not fight Judah's king or do
 Harm to princes of Israel,
 But kill the king of Israel,
 Ahab, my enemy." And so
 Jesus said: "That's enough to know,
 Barnabas; it's enough to show."

I love Jehoshaphat, I always have,
 As much as Hittite or the holy Slav,
 And praise him for his patient faith in You,
 Beloved, as the One to reveal the true.
 I love Jehoshaphat for the fine way
 He fails to follow in the common sway
 Of baalim, even though the better land

And civilized is given in their hand.
Beloved, keep me true to Your righteous law
And in Your grace to abide and in awe,
Though all forsake and all may go astray,
Give me the rightful tune and rightful lay.
Let all the baalim of the kings fall down
And broken be upon their stumps in town.

Barnabas 161

1 "Have you heard all?" said Jesus then.
The disciples replied again:
"Yes, Lord." So Jesus said: "To lie
Is a sin truly, but to try
To kill is greater, for the lie
Is a sin to the speaker, while
The murder falls down in a pile
On both the perpetrator and
Destroys the dearest in the land
That God has, that is, man He's made.
And lying can be stopped and stayed
By telling the truth; but to kill
Has no repeal, since one cannot
Restore the life lost in the plot.
Tell me, then, did Moses too sin,
Though servant of God to begin,
When he killed all he killed to win?"
2 Answered the disciples: "Oh no,
God forbid that Moses should show
Sin in obeying God's command!"
Then Jesus said: "And I in hand
Say, God forbid that angel should
Have sinned deceiving for the good
Ahab's false prophets with the lie;
For even as God takes thereby
The slaughter of men's sacrifice,
So He received the lie as nice.
Indeed, I tell you as a child
Errs to make shoes by measure wild
Of a giant, just so errs he
Who would judge God and unjustly
As subject to the same law that
Is set for men to obey at.
When you believe sin only stands
In what God does not will in bands,
Then you will find the truth indeed,
As I have told you and succeed.
Because God is not composite
Nor changeable, so He has wit
Not to will any thing at all,
So as not have conflict in thrall

Of Himself and thus suffer pain,
 And fail in greater blessing's gain."
 3 Philip replied: 'How should we read
 What Amos the prophet decreed,
 That "there's no evil in the town
 That God Himself has not brought down?"
 Jesus replied: 'Now see the thing,
 Philip, how great's danger to sing
 By the letter alone as do
 The Pharisees in all their crew,
 Who have invented for themselves
 "God's predestination of elves
 Of the elect," and come to say
 In fact that God's unjust in sway,
 Deceiver and a liar too
 And hater of judgement when due,
 Which shall fall on them in their pew.
 4 That's why I say here Amos speaks,
 Though a prophet of God, and seeks
 To call evil by the world's way,
 For if he spoke by righteous sway,
 The world would not understand what
 He had to say of closed and shut.
 For all tribulations are good,
 Either for cleansing bad we would
 Have done or are good in that they
 Restrain us from the evil way,
 Or are good since they make men know
 The state of this life till we show
 Love and longing for life to come.
 So if Amos the prophet's sum
 In word was: "There's no good to see
 But what God does in the city,"
 He would have caused the poor despair,
 As they saw themselves caught in trial's snare,
 While sinners gain prosperity.
 And what is worse, many would see
 Satan to have such sovereignty
 On humankind, that they would fear
 Him and serve him with heart and gear,
 So as not to fall in the way
 Of tribulation for a day.
 So Amos did as Romans do
 Interpreting not words in view
 But speaking to sense and intent
 Not what the high priest thought he meant,
 But in regard to Jews who know
 Not of the Hebrew tongue but slow.

Though the words rise in philosophical,

Barnabas has this thing common to all
Scripture, in that some passages recall
Predestination and sovereign decree
And others do escape the sophistry
And claim that man in everything is free.
This is conundrum of men caught in thought
Since Greeks began to worry and be taught.
But I am not of these, though I admire
The systems of their thinking and desire.
I am the soul of love and desperation
Caught up in sacrifice and in elation
To find You hidden at the nearest star
Or without flight a closer avatar.

Barnabas 162

1 If Amos had said: "There's no good
In the town but what God then could,"
As God lives, in whose presence I
Stand, he would perpetrate a lie,
For the world holds nothing as good
Except iniquities that would
Be done with sin and vanity.
On which men would have in degree
Done much the more and wickedly,
Thinking that there is no sin done
But which God He Himself has spun,
Hearing of which earth trembles fast."
As soon as Jesus this word cast,
A great earthquake occurred in blast,
And everyone fell down as dead.
Jesus raised them up then and said:
'Now see if I have told the truth.
Let this be enough and forsooth
That Amos said: God has done here
Evil in the town for the gear
Of the world," speaking of the time
Of tribulations, which in crime
Sinners alone call evil mime.
But let us come at last to view
Predestination, of which you
Desire to know, and of which I
Shall speak to you again nearby
The Jordan on the other side,
Tomorrow if God's will abide.'

The question of predestined act
Is quite a different thing than the exact
Determining of whether one shall go
To hell or paradise after the show.
So there is no conflict in Barnabas

When he first shows the sovereign gas
In the decree eternal and again
Admits that sin belongs alone to men
And not to You, Beloved. I take the hint
And realize that men may in the dint
Learn to obey, for which they were created,
And then be satisfied if not elated.
Whether You send one man to hell or not
Depends on You alone and not men's plot.

Barnabas 163

1 Jesus went in the wilderness
Beyond Jordan there to address
His disciples, and when midday
Prayer was done, he sat in the way
Of a palm-tree, and in its shade
His disciples too a seat made.
Then Jesus said: 'Such mystery
Is predestination to see,
O brothers, that I tell you true,
Only one can keep it in view.
It's he whom the nations desire,
To whom God's secrets do inspire
Clear knowledge when he shall arrive
Into the world, blessed be those live
Who listen to his words, because
God shall shade them with mercy's draws
As this palm-tree shades us from heat
Of the sun, so God's mercy's treat
With protect from Satan all those
That believe the things that man shows.'
2 Replied the disciples: "O sir,
Who's that man to whom you refer,
Who shall come into the world then?"
Jesus replied with joy again:
'He is Muhammed, Messenger
Of God, and when he comes into
The world, even as rain and dew
Make the earth bear fruit after drought,
So he shall foster after doubt
Good works among men, through the grace
Abundant come before his face.
For he's a white cloud in his place
Full of God's mercy, which shall fall
Like rain upon faithful and all.'

Both scholar and the faithful in the pew
May laugh at Barnabas and laugh at You,
Beloved, for this word that poor Jesus drew,
That named Muhammad one to come in view.

But truth is that the name Hemda is found
In Hebrew Scripture as the one to sound
In hope and to be one desired to come.
So why the ridicule and mirth in sum?
It may not be true that Muhammad came
In the fulfilment of prophecy's claim,
But it is simply a fact that the name
Is found, make what one will of it in the shade
Of palms among disciples once waylaid.
Denial of the fact is foolish shame.

Barnabas 164

1 So I'll tell you what little now
God has granted that I should know
About predestination's show.
The Pharisees say everything
Has been predestined on the wing
So the elect can never be
Reprobate, and the reprobate
Cannot change into any free
Elect; and as God comes to state
Well-doing as the road by which
Elect shall walk away from ditch
Into salvation, even so
He has predestined sin to go
By which the reprobate shall walk
Into damnation and not balk.
Cursed be the tongue that has said so,
And the hand that writes it to show,
For this is Satan's faith and slow.
That's how one recognizes still
The way of the Pharisees' swill
This very day, since they fulfil
Their master Satan's fervent will.
2 What can predestination mean
But an absolute will in sheen
To make an end to everything
One has the means to do or sting?
For without means one cannot stay
To destine anything in sway.
For an example, how can one
Without stone or money get done
Any building he's planned at all,
Much less if he lacks land withal.
Certainly no man can or will.
So I say to you, for the bill,
No more's predestination's fill,
Taking away free will that God
Has given to men in bounty's pod,
The law of God, gift on the sod.

Not predestination we set
 Up thus: abomination met.
 3 That man is free as Moses shows
 In the Book, where, when our God rose
 To give the law on Sinai's mount,
 He spoke in this way and account:
 My command's not in heaven above
 To give excuse to hand in glove
 To say who shall go up to bring
 Us the command of God to sing?
 And who'll give strength to keep the thing?
 Nor is it far across the sea,
 For you to make excuses be,
 But My command is near your heart,
 So you may will to do your part.
 4 Tell me, if King Herod should tell
 An old man to be young and well,
 And a lame man to jump a spell,
 And when they did not do the thing,
 Should execute them on the wing,
 Would this be just? And so replied
 The disciples: "If Herod tried
 To give such a command, he'd be
 Acting unjust, impiously."
 6 Then Jesus, sighing, said: "These are
 The fruits of human faith and star,
 Traditions, O brothers, for in
 Saying that God's predestined sin,
 They blaspheme God impiously
 As one unjust. For he commands
 The sinner not to sin with hands,
 And when he sins, then to repent;
 While such predestination's spent
 To take the power not to sin
 Away from sinners to begin,
 Depriving him of the way shown
 Into repentance he has known."

The teaching here is that Your divine law,
 The ten commandments as we say in awe,
 Define parameters determined by
 Creation of the earth and the earth's sky.
 Many things may make limitations on
 The human soul, but when the lines are drawn,
 A man is free to conform to this word
 In ten and free to leave it token blurred.
 And yet, Beloved, though freedom is defined
 In the choice the commandments make to bind,
 I see Your words to be promises made
 In sweetness on Sinai to those arrayed,

Rather than commands of authority.
They are Your words of love that set men free.

Barnabas 165

1 But hear what says by prophet Joel
Our God before we take the toll:
"As I live, says your God, I will
Not the death of a sinner still,
But I seek that he should convert
To penitence and so revert."
Will God then predestine what
He does not will and so be shut?
Consider what God says and make
Comparison to what in stake
The Pharisees today would claim.
God say by prophet Isaiah:
"I've called: you would not stand in awe."
And how much has God called?
Just hear by the prophet installed:
All day I have spread out My hands
To people who hear not commands,
But disbelieve and contradict."
2 And Pharisees, how well slicked,
When they say that the reprobate
Cannot enter the elect state,
Just mean that God mocks men of late,
As He would mock a blind man's slate,
Or mock a deaf man when He speaks
Into his ears of what he seeks.
And that the elect one can fall,
Just hear what Ezekiel in call
Of God to his prophet would say:
"As I live, says God in His sway,
If the righteous forsake the way
Of righteousness to work or play
In such abominations stay,
He'll perish and I shall not mind
Any more of his righteous kind;
For trusting in it, it shall fail,
Forsaking him before My veil,
It shall not save him or prevail."
And of the sinner's calling, speaks
God by the prophet what He seeks,
And by Hosea, hear this word:
I'll call a people, one not stirred
By their election, but I'll call
Them the elect and keep in stall."
God is true and will tell no lie,
For God is truth, no lies reply.
But Pharisees today oppose

By their doctrine God's holy shows.

The Pharisees are not alone in that
They call the fat thin and thin fat.
All sects and faiths around the world find room
To deny the pure doctrine to their doom.
The Decalogue is firm and clear and fair,
But it seems that people found everywhere,
Although they may accept the greater share,
Always find something in the Decalogue
That must be rejected by fish and frog.
If one does not know where to start to make
Repentance on the dergah floor and stake,
One only needs to read the ten words clear
And find the one that's seems too hard to hear.
That's where repentance needs to reappear.

Barnabas 166

1 Andrew replied: "But how is that
To be understood which God flat
Out said to Moses, that He will
Have mercy on whom he wills still
To have mercy and harden yet
Whom He wills to harden and set?"
Jesus replied: "God says this thing
So that a man may not give wing
To the belief that he is saved
By his own virtue as he craved,
But may see that mercy and life
Were granted by God in the rife
Bounty divine. And He says it
So men may avoid the unfit
Opinion that there are to be
Other gods giving life than He.
2 So if He hardened Pharaoh's heart,
He did it because of his part
In the affliction of our folk,
And trying to kill every bloke
In Israel: so Moses too
Came near to lose his life in view.
So I say to you what is true:
Predestination's founded on
The law of God and free will drawn
On humankind. Even if God
Could save the whole world on the sod
So that none perish, He would not
Will to do so, if in the plot
He should deprive man of free will,
Which He preserves in him too still
To mock Satan, by making clay

Scorned by the spirit on a day,
Though it should sin as spirit did,
Might have the power on the skid
To make repentance and at last
Go to dwell from where outcast
The spirit fell. Our God so wills,
I say to pursue what instils
His mercy on man's free will, and
Wills not to forsake in the land
The creature with omnipotence.
So on the day of his judgements
None will be able then to make
Any excuse for their sins' sake,
Seeing that it will then appear
To them how much God to their fear
Has done for their conversion's sake,
And how oft He's called them to make
Repentance for sin and mistake.

It seems to hearts of living folk today
That repentance is just a foolish way.
The reason is that slavery has grown great
And few can escape slavery as their fate.
Repentance is the greatest show of all
Of freedom on the happy, earthly ball.
Since to repent is to be most free, men
Today, who are the slaves of mind in den,
Cannot repent or give repentance due
Respect and glory. Such think You,
Beloved, a tyrant monarch in the sky,
Enslaving people. So all people try
To reinvent their god in their own shape,
Either of despot ruler or of ape.

Barnabas 167

1 So if you're not satisfied now,
But still want to inquire somehow,
I shall show you a reason why.
Tell me, why does a stone not float,
And yet the whole earth like a boat
Rests on the top of floods remote?
Tell me why water puts out fire,
And earth flees from the air in quire,
So none can join earth, air and fire
And water in harmonies quire,
Yet they're united in a man
Preserved in unison and band?
2 If you don't know this, nor all men
As men do not know this again,
How shall they understand that God

Created the universe clod
 Out of nothing by just a word?
 How shall understanding be stirred
 Of the eternity of God?
 Truly there's no way they can know,
 Because finite man is too slow,
 With composite body in show,
 Which, as says prophet Solomon,
 Being corruptible when done,
 Presses down the soul, while the things
 God does are set in divine rings,
 So how shall they comprehend things?
 3 Isaiah, prophet of God, saw
 This and exclaimed saying in awe:
 Truly You are a hidden God!
 And of the Messenger of God,
 How God's created him with rod,
 He says: His generation, who
 Shall tell or bring the thing in view?
 And of God's works he says truly:
 Who's been His counsellor to see?
 That's why God human creatures tells:
 As heaven is high above earth's wells,
 So are My way above your ways
 And My thoughts high above your praise.
 So I tell you, predestination
 Is not shown to men in their ration,
 Despite the truth of the fact shown,
 As I have told you to atone.
 Should a man just because he may
 Not find out the how and the way,
 Then deny the fact and the sway?
 Truly, I've not yet seen a man
 Refuse health, though the way and plan
 Be not understood. For I know
 Not even now how God bestow
 By my touch healing on the row
 Of sick who come to me below."

The Aristotelian cosmology
 In Barnabas is something to set free
 The mind Semitic in the cosmic spree.
 It is a touch disarming that the prophet
 Seems to assume Aristotelian sofit.
 He saves himself by claiming ignorance,
 Which always is the favoured way to dance
 To keep the critic from looking askance.
 He saves himself by claiming not to know
 How You, Beloved, heal people in his show.
 If You healed anyone beneath my hand,

I think I too would take the very stand,
Denying that I know where healing's from
Since I doubt New Age energy to come.

Barnabas 168

1 Then said the disciples: "Truly
God speaks in you, for previously
No man has spoken as you speak."
Jesus replied: Believe me when
God chose to send me to the men
Of Israel's house, He gave a book
To me like a mirror to look,
Which came down into my heart's nook
So that all that I speak comes out
Of that book and is without doubt.
And when I've finished and told all
That is in that book from mouth's call,
I shall be taken from this world."
Peter replied: "Master unfurled,
Is what you now speak in it curled?"
Jesus replied: "All that I say
Of knowledge of God and the way
Of serving Him, and of the gain
Of saving men, all comes like rain
Out of that book, my gospel's train."
Said Peter: "Is there written there
Of paradise and glory's share?"

Jesus defines what he says that comes out
Of the book of the Gospel with a shout.
He neglects the Aristotelian
Cosmology, and so shows what You ban.
The knowledge of You and the way to serve
Is from which the Gospel says not to swerve,
As well as revelation how You save
Men from their sins and make them to stand brave.
These three things are the Gospel: of one God,
Of how to serve Him, and how with a prod
He saves men. I find this great trinity
Already in the Decalogue I see.
One God is sovereign and forgives all men
Who truly call repenting once again.

Barnabas 169

1 Jesus replied: "Listen, and I
Will tell you of the things that lie
In paradise, and how the saints
And faithful shall abide, no taints
And without end, for this is one
Of the greatest blessings once done

In paradise, since everything,
 However great, if it's ending,
 Becomes small, indeed nothing gained.
 'Paradise is the home God deigned
 To store delights, which are so great
 That the ground trodden by each mate
 Among the holy and the blessed
 Is so precious that one dram best
 Of it's more precious than the world
 A thousand and one times unfurled.
 2 David our father, seer of God,
 Saw these delights upon the sod,
 For God showed them to him because
 He let him see glories in pause
 In paradise: and when he came
 To himself, he as if in shame
 Covered his eyes and weeping said:
 "Look no more on this world outspread,
 O eyes of mine, for all is vain
 And there's no good thing come again!"
 Of these delights the prophet said,
 Isaiah without comfort sped:
 "The eyes of man have never seen,
 His ears have never heard the keen,
 His heart fails to imagine it,
 What things God has come to make fit
 For those who love Him." So do you
 Know why they've never had in view,
 Nor heard nor conceived such delights?
 It's because they live in these plights
 Below and are not worthy yet
 To see such things. But he was set,
 Was our ancestor David then
 To see them truly, but again
 I tell you that he saw them not
 With human eyes upon the spot,
 For God took his soul to Himself,
 And united upon God's shelf,
 He saw them with the light divine.
 As God lives, in whose presence fine
 My soul stands, seeing the delights
 Of paradise, no ends in sights,
 Are infinite and man is not
 But finite and upon one spot,
 Man cannot contain them at all;
 Just as a clay vessel in stall
 Cannot contain the sea withal.
 3 See then how beautiful's the world
 In summer-time when all's unfurled
 In bearing fruit! The farming man,

Drunken with gladness for to scan
The harvest, makes resound around
The valleys and mountains and ground
With singing, for he loves above
All things his labour's endless shove.
So lift your heart like that to see
Paradise where all things that be
Are fruitful in proportion found
To him who's laboured on the ground.
As God lives, this is just enough
To know of paradise in rough,
Since God created paradise
To set there His delighted eyes.
Do you not think infinite good
Would not have things be as they should?
Or that beauty unending might
Not have greater beauty in sight?
Beware, for you err greatly then
If you think He'd not surpass men.

I set the vision of the coming good
Aside, since I can't speak it as I should.
I am no prophet, You do not take me
In soul into Your heart to let me see
The secrets of the world's infinity,
Nor do you anyone that's born today.
Muhammad was the last prophet in pay.
But I have heard the flutter in the night
Of dreams filled with Your word and Your delight,
And I have been possessed by day to hear
The sound of the divine upon the ear.
And once while bowed upon the flowered ground
I met with one who was a human sound
Appointed by Your grace to come around.

Barnabas 170

1 God says to the man who'd serve Him:
"I know your works, they are not dim
Before me. As I live to be
Throughout all of eternity,
Your love shall not exceed bounty
Of Nine. Because you serve Me here
As God your Creator with fear,
Knowing yourself to be My work,
Ask nought of Me save grace to lurk
And mercy to serve Me the best;
Because you can no end invest
To my service, but rather want
To serve Me for ever in font;
So for that I shall reward you

As if you were my equal too,
And God yourself. Not only will
I give you paradise to fill,
But I will give you Myself too
As a gift, so even as you
Desire to be My constant slave,
I'll give infinite wages brave.”

You give to humankind a gift of love
More precious than the gold of star above.
You give to humankind, to every child
A present from the margins of the wild.
You give each man and woman that You make
An inner core of strength that none can break,
The knowledge realized and glowing fast,
Awareness of being an I to last.
You only have the right to say and be
I in the universe above the sea.
You only can encompass what it takes
To be an I before the morning breaks,
And this gift of Yourself You give to each
Of humankind created for a peach.

Barnabas 171

1 “What do you think of paradise?”
Said Jesus to disciples twice.
“Can any mind now grasp the like
Of riches and delights to strike?
Man would have to know much as God
If he would know God’s will in pod
Of what He gives His servants here.
Have you seen Herod to appear
To give gifts to his favourite ones,
How he does it in gracious tonnes?”
John answered: “I have seen it twice.”
Jesus said: “That is really nice.
But if a poor man comes to be
In presence of Herod to see,
What will he give him faithfully?”
John answered: “One or two mites then.”
“So let this be your book to men
To know of paradise again,
Because all God’s given in store
To man in this present world’s lore
To keep his body is as though
Herod should give a mite in show
To a poor man; but what God will
Give to body and soul to fill
In paradise, it is as though
Herod gave all he has in stow,

Yes, and his own life above that,
To one of his servants out flat.”

The gift of paradise and gift of I
That You give humankind who only try
Is above comprehension. Let me not
Pretend to know what I've never been taught.
Let Herod spring his trap and let priest find
The sacrifice of beef and sheep in kind,
But I turn as I turn in dervish mind
And turn into Your giving of unsought.
For none can seek, Beloved, the gift divine.
All things sought are of a much lower mine.
I leave off all my seeking, and laid bare,
Await the coming down the golden stair
The flood of divine presents to present
My empty hands in sacrifices lent.

Barnabas 172

I God says to the one who loves Him,
And serves him faithfully and grim:
“Go and consider the sea sand,
O my servant, and count the land.
Thus if the sea gave you one grain
Of sand, would it seem small and vain?
Truly so. As I come to stand
As your Creator, and live grand,
All that I've given to earthly kings
And princes in their wealthy rings
Is less than a grain of sand that
The sea would give you where you're at,
Compared to what I give you in
My paradise you'll come to win.”

The predilection with expressions that
Escape imagination of a cat
I often find in Barnabas and I
Forgive that character of pie in sky.
The grain of sand is marvellous to see
With microscope or in mystic degree
Of contemplation on the glassy sea.
The grain of sand is wealth enough for me.
But You, Beloved, perhaps in all Your power
Enjoy a wealth beyond my mental hour.
You may enjoy, while I stay on the shore
To count my single grain of sand as more.
Your paradise, I hope, contains some sand,
Enough to hold in undeserving hand.

Barnabas 173

1 'Consider, then," said Jesus, "how
 Abundant is paradise now.
 For if God's given men in this world
 An ounce of dwelling, in unfurled
 Paradise He'll give him for loads
 Ten hundred thousand in new modes.
 Think how many fruits here abound
 In this world on unlovely ground,
 How much food and much flowers found,
 And things men use both safe and sound.
 As God lives in whose presence I
 Stand soul and body as I try,
 As the sea still has sand the more
 Over the single grain in store
 That one may take, even so will
 The quality and store in fill
 Of figs in paradise will be
 Above the fig here that we see.
 So's everything in paradise.
 As much, I say, and a mountain
 Of gold and pearls in greater bin
 Is valued over shadow cast
 By an ant, so delights that last
 Are more precious than all delights
 Of this world's princes in their rights
 Which they have had now from the start
 Up to the judgement day in part
 Of God when the world ends in art."
 2 Peter replied: "Shall our body
 Which we now have go in to see
 Paradise?" Jesus answered him:
 "Beware, Peter; lest you grow dim
 And become like a Sadducee;
 For Sadducees say that the flesh
 Shall not rise up again as fresh,
 And that there be no angels here.
 'Wherefore body and soul appear
 Not in paradise, nor have they
 Service from angels on the way.
 Have you perhaps forgotten Job,
 Prophet and friend of God in robe,
 How he says: I know my God lives,
 And in the last day that He gives
 Me flesh to rise again and see
 God's my Saviour eternally.'"?
 3 But believe me, this flesh of ours
 Shall be so purified for hours
 That it shall not possess a mite
 Of the properties now in sight;
 Since it shall be cleansed of each ray

Of evil wish, and God make way
 To the condition Adam had
 Before Adam had chosen bad.
 Two men serve one master in work,
 One watching, commanding may shirk
 The effort, while the second man
 Carries out all the work in plan.
 Is it right in your eyes that he
 Who's master should reward in fee
 Only the one who watches and
 Stay there beside to give command?
 And should he cast out of his house
 The one who laboured like a mouse
 In weariness and toil to grouse?
 Surely not by a weary stand.
 4 How then shall God's justice bear this?
 The soul and body do not miss
 Serving God with sense, but the soul
 Only sees and commands the goal,
 Because the soul never eats bread,
 And so never fasts and instead
 Never walks, feels the cold and heat,
 Does not fall sick, does not retreat
 To be slain, since the soul is one
 Immortal when the thing is done.
 It does not suffer body's pain.
 Is it just that the soul should gain
 Alone paradise, while the flesh
 Which has been wearied in the mesh
 Of serving God should die afresh?"
 Peter replied: "O master mine,
 The body caused by its design
 The soul to sin, and should not be
 Placed in its paradise once free."
 Jesus replied: "Now how can be
 The body sinful without help
 Of the soul both of them as whelp?
 It's truly impossible view.
 So if you deprive body too
 Of God's mercy you condemn soul
 As well to hell and to its toll."

The conscious and immortal soul is not
 Semitic concept even in the plot
 Of Hellenistic Judaism's row.
 It's innovation later on to grow.
 That dates this book by a concept grown true
 Too late for Barnabas and Jesus' crew.
 I'm sorry to fly in the face of all,
 The Jew, the Christian and the Muslim call,

But simply stated, the eternal soul
As conscious being is late on patrol.
Beloved, my trust is in Your own design,
And in Your recreating hand benign,
And not in the Platonic doctrine stated
By all faiths now around me and elated.

Barnabas 174

1 As God lives, in whose presence my
Soul stands, our God promises by
The sinner mercy, saying true:
“In that hour that the sinner too
Shall sorrow for his sin, then I
Will not remember sin for aye.”
Now what should eat delicious things
In paradise, if not the wings
Of the flesh? Shall the soul eat it?
Surely not, since it’s spirit fit.”
Peter replied: “So then the blest
Shall eat in Paradise and rest?
How can the excrement then go
Out without causing impure show?”
2 Jesus replied: “What blessed gift
Shall the body have then to lift
If it eats not nor drinks a sip?
It’s best to give glory from hip
As fit to the thing glorified.
But you err, Peter, on your side
To think such food should needs come out
In uncleanness and with a shout,
Because this present body here
Eats meat corruptible in fear,
And so putrefied things appear.
But in paradise the flesh will
Be incorruptible and still,
Immortal and free from all pain;
And the food there in nothing vain,
Without defect shall generate
No putrefaction in its state.

At least the doctrine of the resurrection
Of body remains here in clear detection.
But that is true of every Christian creed
Down to this day, though people in their need
No longer believe in the body rising,
And this may be a thing truly surprising
But the fact is the message of the body
Arising would turn the times that are shoddy
Now into hope times and not despair.
The people I see round me in their care

Are saddened that life ends so quickly now.
If they could only believe in somehow
The resurrection of the flesh and blood,
They could be saved from pain and tears in flood.

Barnabas 175

I God says this in Isaiah who
Is one of the prophetic crew,
Pouring contempt on reprobate:
“My servants shall sit in my state
Beside my table in my house
And shall feast joyful as a grouse,
With gladness and with sound of harp
And organs, and I will not carp
Or have them needing anything.
But you who are my foes shall be
Cast out and far away from me,
Where you shall die in misery,
While every servant of my hand
Despises you in every land.”

I pour contempt of reprobate in me
And beg You from all such things set me free,
And I shall rise in flesh and blood to be
A guest once more at Your table sweetly
Set with the feast of gladness to the sound
Of harp and organs playing all around.
Of course I rather hope those instruments
Are really other than that word presents,
And turn out to be virginals in trust
And clavichords to wake me from the dust.
Beloved, I write my tokens of remorse
And call them prayers repenting from the coarse,
And with that done, I lay be down to sleep
In trust that I shall wake up from the deep.

Barnabas 176

I What use is it to say: “They feast”?
Said Jesus to disciples least.
“Surely God says the things He means.
Why are there four rivers in scenes
Of precious liquids in the place
Of paradise, and fruits in grace?
Surely God does not eat a trace,
Nor do the angels, nor do souls,
Nor do the senses in their bowls,
But rather the flesh which remains
Our bodies without sins or stains.
So the glory of paradise
Is for the body, the meats nice,

And for the soul and for the sense
 Are God and angels' in presence,
 And blessed spirits in their way.
 That gloried revelation's sway
 Shall better be revealed one day
 By the Messenger send of God
 Who knows all things better on sod
 Than other creatures, since God made
 All things for love of him and stayed.'
 2 Bartholomew said: 'Master dear,
 Shall paradise glory appear
 As equal for every man here?
 If it is equal, it's not just,
 And if it's not equal, then must
 The lesser envy those who see
 A great weight of such glory.'
 Jesus replied: 'It will not be
 Equal, for God is just indeed,
 And all shall be content in seed,
 For there shall be no envy there.
 Tell me, Bartholomew with care;
 There is a master and whose share
 Of servants is many, and he
 Clothes all of them in the degree
 Of the same cloth. Do then the boys
 Who are clothed in boys pants with noise
 Mourn because they do not receive
 Clothing of grown men as reprieve?
 The opposite is true indeed.
 If the elders desired with greed
 To put on the boys grown men's wear,
 They would be angry with the share
 Of clothing too large for their frames.
 They'd think in anger and for blames.
 Bartholomew, now lift your heart
 To God in paradise to start,
 And you'll see that all glory one,
 Although it's more or less when done
 To each, shall not produce at all
 A bit of envy in the ball.'

For me, I hardly care what I put on,
 But gladly where the pants I find at dawn
 Stuck on my chair or in my closet where
 My several shirts are hanging up with care.
 For me, the clothing is no thing to see
 With special hopes and fears in pageantry,
 But rather simply something to keep me
 As warm as weather would cause me to be.
 Beloved, give me a coat or shirt or pair

Of pants and I shall put them on to wear,
And when my body's resurrected fair
I'll glorify You in patches and spare.
Give me what You will, I am quite content
To be one naked standing in Your tent.

Barnabas 177

I Then said the one who writes these lines:
'O master, are the great designs
Of Paradise as this world's ways,
To have the sun to mark its days?'
Jesus replied: 'So God's told me,
O Barnabas: "The world you see
Where men are sinners has the sun
And moon and stars that sweetly run
For benefit and gladness too,
For which I've created the view.
Do you think that the house I've made
For my faithful ones will be laid
With lesser benefits and joys?
If so, error your thoughts employs,
For I, your God, remain the sun
Of Paradise, and the moon won
There is my Messenger, who still
Receives all from Me with a will.
And the stars are My prophets there
Which have preached My will with a care.
So my faithful, as they received
My word from my prophets believed,
Shall in the same way have delight
And joy through them too in the sight
Of Paradise also decked bright."

Pity, my Lord and my Beloved, let me
Not worship any sun eternally!
I mind not that You messenger in white
Becomes the moon to shed its lovely light.
I mind not that the stars stand in array
And represent both night and light of day
The prophets who have lived to preach Your word.
I'm glad the saints are bright and deeply stirred.
But let me not bow down before the sun
In worship, since I'm one who has begun
To worship You alone without the form
Of anything that appears bright and warm!
Your glory is enough for all to share
Before Your throne as well as anywhere.

Barnabas 178

I 'And let this be enough for you,'

Said Jesus, 'for the knowledge due
 Of paradise.' Bartholomew
 Said once more: 'O master, please do
 Have patience with me if I ask
 You one word.' Jesus to the task
 Replied: 'Tell me what you desire.'
 Bartholomew said: 'Paradise
 Is surely great: for to my eyes
 It's filled with great goods and things wise,
 So it must be larger than skies.'
 Jesus replied: 'Paradise lies
 So great none can measure it there.
 Truly I tell you and with care,
 The heavens are nine, among which set
 Are the planets, and they are met
 In distance one from other by
 Five hundred years' journey to spy,
 As a man goes; and the earth too
 Is equidistant from the view
 Of the first heaven, as the way
 Of five hundred years' journey's sway.
 2 But stop at measuring the first,
 Which is as much greater to burst
 The earth and the earth than a grain
 Of sand. So also is the plain
 Of the second than is the first.
 And each is likewise greater versed.
 The third so and so on of all.
 I tell the truth that for the thrall
 Of Paradise, it's more than all
 Combined of heavens and earth as much
 As the earth to a sand grain's touch.'
 Then Peter said: 'O master sure,
 Paradise must indeed endure
 Greater than God Himself, because
 God is seen within it by laws.'
 Jesus replied: "Be silent, man,
 Because you blaspheme without plan.'

The blasphemy of Peter lies in that
 He thought that You were bounded in the fat
 Of universe of universe as though
 You were a part of the creation's show.
 The first word of the Scripture at the least
 Pretends that You are not of bird and beast,
 But all things in the heaven and upon earth
 Are separated from You by Your worth.
 So I turn from the fair blasphemies near
 And wait upon You to find where You steer,
 And find You fleetingly from east to west

Both in and out, above, below the rest.
I turn from You to You and find the way
Is narrow and broad too, both night and day.

Barnabas 179

1 The angel Gabriel came to
Jesus and showed him shining view
Of a mirror bright as the sun,
In which he saw theses clauses done:
2 'As I live eternally, so
As paradise is great to go
Above all the heavens and earth,
And as the whole earth in its worth
Is greater than a grain of sand,
Even so I'm greater unspanned
Than paradise; and as more times
As the sea has in all its climes
Grains of sand, as has water drops,
As there are blades of grass that stops
Upon the ground, as leaves on trees,
As skins on animals with ease,
And as many times more as grains
Of sand that would fill all the plains
Of heavens and paradise to please.'
3 Then Jesus said: "Let us bow down
In reverence to our God, whose gown
Is blessed for evermore." They bowed
Their heads a hundred times unproud
And prostrated themselves to earth
Upon their face in prayer in dearth.
When the prayer was done, Jesus called
Peter and told him and installed
All the disciples what he'd seen.
And to Peter he said: "I ween,
Your soul, which is greater than all
The earth, sees through one eye to call
The sun which is a thousand times
Greater than earth in all its climes."
"It is true," said Peter impressed.
Then Jesus said: "Even so dressed,
Through paradise, shall your eye see
God our Creator in glory."
And having said this, Jesus gave
Thanks to God our Lord to crave,
Prayed for the House of Israel
And for the holy city's spell.
And all replied: "Lord, be it well."

The sun is really rather more times greater
Than just a thousand than the earth as mater.

The word is used here not to be specific
About the size of sun or the Pacific,
But merely to say a great number filling
More numbers than can count a man instilling.
The eye is really rather more the seer
Of everything other than what appear
As Your divine Self in the vision quest.
It is a light indeed, but still a guest.
Beloved, I number not Your wages nor
Your works above the sands upon the shore.
I wait no sight of physical eye blessed
Upon Your form though hidden from the rest.

Barnabas 180

1 One day, Jesus, as he received
In Solomon's porch who believed,
A scribe, one of those who would preach
To the folk, came within his reach
And said to him: "O master, I
Have many times made a reply
To this folk; in my mind there stays
A passage of Scriptural lays
Which I cannot grasp with my gaze."
Jesus replied: "And what is it?"
The scribe said: "That which God said fit
To Abraham our father, I
Will be your great reward or try.
Now how could man merit or buy?"
2 Then Jesus rejoiced in his mind,
And said: "Truly you're of the kind
Not far from the kingdom of God!
Hear me, for I'll tell you in prod
The meaning of the teaching sound.
God being infinite on ground,
And man finite, man cannot take
Merit of God and for this sake
Your doubt arises, not so, friend?"
The scribe replied, weeping to bend:
"Lord, you know my heart. Speak, therefore,
For my soul desires of your store."
Then Jesus said: "As God does live,
Man cannot merit, cannot give
Even a little breath, which he
Receives each moment secretly."
3 The scribe was beside himself then
To hear this and marvelled the men,
The disciples as well, for they
Remembered what Jesus did say,
That whatever they gave for love
Of God, they'd get a greater shove

In hundredfold. And then he said:
“ If someone should lend you instead
A hundred pieces of gold, and
You spend those pieces in the land,
Could you say to that man: “I give
You a decayed vine-leaf to live;
So give me your house, now since I
Deserve it in return reply.”
The scribe replied: “No, Lord, for he
Should first pay what he owed in fee,
And then, if he desired to do,
He should give him good things in view,
But what good's a leaf rotten too?”

The word You spoke to Abraham that day
Was indeed enigmatic in its way,
As though You could be a reward to stay
In payment for a service worth its pay.
I've read the word and wondered at the voice.
I've read it in the Hebrew text for choice.
But it's no clearer for the reading right
Nor for the matter coming into sight.
Beloved, I bring a decayed vine-leaf now
To set it as a crown upon Your brow
To see You you appear more kingly when
Described by rotten leaves raked from the glen.
The hope of human flesh is lesser than
The false imagination of a man.

Barnabas 181

1 Jesus replied: "You've spoken well,
O brother; so tell me in spell,
Who created man out of nil?
Surely it was God, who to fill
Also gave the whole world for good.
But man by sinning spent like hood
The whole, for because of his sin
The world is turned against man's din,
And man in his misery has got
Nothing to give to God but rot
Of works corrupted by his sin.
For, sinning every day to win,
He makes his own work corrupt in,
As Isaiah the prophet said:
Our righteousness is here instead
As a menstruous cloth in bed.
2 How, then, shall man have merit found,
Since he cannot provide the bound?
Does a man keep himself from sin?
God truly says by David in

His prophecy: "Seven times a day
The righteous fall out of the way."
What then of the unrighteous man?
And if our goods deeds fail in span,
How evil is our wicked plan!
As God lives, there is nothing more
A man should shun, but shut outdoor,
Than to say "I've merit in store."
Brother let a man know his works,
And he'll see right off how he shirks.
Every good thing that comes from man
Is not his own, but God's by plan,
Who works good in him, for his strength
Is in God who created length.
What man does it to contradict
God his Creator, derelict
To commit sin, so he does not
Merit reward, but torment's lot.

Like the good dervish who thanked You above
When the pot of swill landed with a shove
Upon him in the street, that he was glad
That though he deserved hell, the only bad
That did befall him was the chamber pot
Dumped on his pat, and that was not a lot
Compared to his deserts. He got by free
Or almost free from punishment in spree.
Beloved, I have no merit here, I see,
Nor any work done, that you owe to me
Reward or payment for accomplishment.
I only work by You and Your consent.
I join the dervish in his grateful glee
Before reproach and before misery.

Barnabas 182

1 'God's not only created man,
As I say, but by perfect plan.
He's given him all of the world;
After he left paradise swirled,
He's given him two angel guards
And sent him prophets come like bards,
Granted him the Torah in hand
And faith and saves him at the stand
Of Satan, and would give him more,
Even Paradise and its store,
Yet more, God would give of Himself
To humankind instead of elf.
Consider then the debt so great,
To cancel which you would need late
To have created man yourselves

Out of nothing, to have such shelves
Of prophets as our God has sent,
With a world and paradise lent,
No, more, with a God great and good
As is our God, and then you should
Have to give it all then to God.
So then the debt upon the sod
Might be cancelled, and there would be
Remaining just the first duty
To give God thanks. But since you're not
Able to create just a dot,
And since there is one God of all
Things Lord, how shall you then install
A cancellation of debt's thrall?
Truly, if a man lent to you
A hundred piece of gold new,
You'd be obliged then to restore
To him a hundred and not more.

I interrupt the discourse in this place
To note this Gospel's written in the grace
Of usury not taken from the rich
Or from the poor who borrows in the ditch.
It makes the case than once the coin is lent,
When pay-back time comes in as to prevent
The giving of some interest, it is fair
To just return exact and borrowed share.
Beloved, a cancellation of my debt
Is something I have never found or met,
But I trust that You have the better way
And will cancel all of my debts someday.
I may return exacted what You gave,
But I've no other coin then to behave.

2 Accordingly, the sense of this,
O brother, is that God, to kiss
As Lord of paradise and all,
Can say what He pleases and give
What He pleases to all who live.
So when he said to Abraham:
"I'll be your great reward, I am,"
Abraham could not stand and say:
"God is my great reward today,"
But "God is my gift and my debt."
So when you talk to people set,
O brother, you should make it clear,
That God will give to each man dear
Such things if such a man works well.
When God shall speak to you, O man,
And shall say: "Oh my servant-man,

You've done well for your love to me.
 What payment do you seek from me,
 Your God?" you'll answer, "Lord, you see
 I am the work of Your hands, it
 Is not fitting that there should sit
 Sin in me, which Satan loves here.
 So, Lord, for your own glory clear,
 Have mercy on your hands' works dear."
 "And if God say: 'I've pardoned you,
 And now I wish to reward you',
 Reply: "Lord, all that I deserve
 Is punishment the way I swerve,
 And for what you have done you should
 Receive the glory and the good.
 Punish, Lord, me for what I've done,
 And save in me what you have won."
 If God ask: "What punishment do
 You think is fitting for sins due?"
 Reply, "As much, O Lord, as will
 Suffer the reprobate in swill."
 If God asks: "Why do you seek so
 Great punishment as men most low,
 O my faithful servant to show?"
 Reply: "Because each one of them,
 If they're received from You such gem
 As I've received, they'd have served You
 More fervently than I have done."
 And if God ask under the sun:
 "When will you take this punishment,
 And for how long a time be sent?"
 Reply: "Now, and without an end."
 As God lives, in whose presence my
 Soul stands, such a man standing shy
 Would be more pleasing in God's sight
 Than all his holy angels might.
 For God loves true humility,
 And hates pride before him to see."
 3 The scribe gave thanks to Jesus then,
 And said to him, "Lord with your men,
 Come to your servant's house, for then
 Your servant shall give food to you
 And to your disciples in crew."
 Jesus replied: "I will come there
 When you promise to call me bare
 Brother and not lord, and you'll say
 You are my brother in the way,
 And not my servant as in pay.
 The man so promised, then went he,
 Jesus to his house joyfully.

You may give me Your great reward indeed,
But it is no payment for task with speed
Performed beneath my hand in what I do.
It is Your gift and my debt come in view.
There is no thing in all the universe
But what is a creation to rehearse
The power of hand and eye and voice the raise
All things into existence and in praise.
You may do with Your own by Your own will,
And You may thank or curse with Your tongue still,
And yet my hand is empty of my own,
No matter what I spend before Your throne.
So my Beloved, think on me in Your grace
And show Your mercy greater than my pace.

Barnabas 183

1 While they sat eating the scribe said:
'O master, you said God instead
Loves true humility well bred.
Tell us then what's humility,
How it both true and false can be.'
"Truly I say to you that he
Who does not become like a child,
Shall not come in heaven's kingdom mild."
All were amazed on hearing this,
Said each to the other amiss:
"How shall one become like a child
Who's thirty or forty years styled?
This saying's hard to comprehend.'
2 Jesus replied to answer send:
'As God lives, in whose presence my
Soul stands, my words are true thereby.
I told you that a man has need
To become like a child indeed:
For this is true humility.
For if you ask a little child:
"Who's made your clothing so to be?"
He'll answer: "Father" unbeguiled.
If you ask him in whose house he
Lives, he'll say: "Father's" as you see.
If you say: "Who gives you to eat?"
He'll answer: "My father," in beat.
If you ask: "Who taught you to walk
And who also taught you to talk?"
He'll answer: "My father indeed."
But if you ask: "Who broke with speed
Your forehead, that it's bandaged up?"
He'll answer: "I fell down like a cup,
And broke my forehead like a cup."
3 If you ask: "Why did you fall down?"

He'll answer with a little frown:
"Don't you see that I'm very small
And cannot run like those who're tall?
So my father must hold my hand
If I'll walk firmly on the land.
But so I'll learn to walk in strength,
My father let me go a length,
And wanting to run, I fell down."
If you ask: "Did your father frown
And say to you a chiding word?"
He'll answer: "He saw what occurred,
And asked why did I not slow down.
Don't leave my side again in town."

The ones who despise Barnabas but take
Instead the church's canon for their cake
Ought to pause and consider in a shake
If they've heard better explanation of
The words of Jesus printed like a dove,
You must become once like a little child
To enter into heaven's kingdom wild,
You must become like a child, no mistake.
Beloved, I see the word, though it's profound,
Is very simple when explained around.
Make me like the child Barnabas sets free
From Jesus' words in their obscurity,
And I shall run and fall and break my crown
And then return to You with tears and frown.

Barnabas 184

1 Tell me, is this true? Jesus asked.
The disciples answered as tasked
And the scribe too: 'It is most true.'
Then Jesus said: 'He in heart true
Recognizes God as the one
Who's author of all the good done,
And himself author of his sin,
Shall be truly humble within.
But whoever shall speak with tongue
As the child speaks and yet in rung
Of action contradict the same,
Surely he has been playing game
Of false humility and pride.
For pride's at its height when it makes
Use of the humble things at stakes,
So as not to be spurned by men.
2 True humility is of soul
In lowliness to reach the goal
Of knowing self in the truth then.
But false humility's a mist

From hell which darkens like a fist
 The understanding of the soul,
 That what a man should count his own
 He ascribes but to God alone,
 And what he ought account to God,
 That he takes to himself in pod.
 A man of false humility
 Will say he's a sinner to be
 In grievous state, but when one tells
 Him that he's a sinner in spells,
 He'll become angry at the word
 And persecute for what occurred.
 The man of false humility
 Will say that God's given him free
 All that he has, but for his part
 He has not slumbered at his art,
 But does good works. These Pharisees
 Of this present time, if you please,
 Brethren, then tell me how they walk,
 Whether in deed or just in talk.'
 3 The scribe replied with tears on cheek:
 "O master, these Pharisees seek
 At this time to wear garments and
 The name of Pharisees as grand,
 But in their heart and in their works,
 They're as a Canaanite that lurks.
 Would to God they stole not the name,
 Then they'd not bring it into shame,
 Deceiving simple ones in game.
 O ancient time, how cruel your ways
 To deal with us and so amaze
 By taking from us the true kind
 And leaving the Pharisee blind!"

I do suspect that others see my sin
 More readily than I do in my bin,
 But those who see it never come to chide,
 It's only those who think I have to hide
 A sin they in their ignorance invent.
 My outraged heart is in righteousness spent.
 Beloved, let me rather, when I'm accused
 Falsely, remember that I'm not abused,
 But that the false accuser, knowing not
 My heart and motives blacker by a lot,
 Puts a good face on the reality
 And rather than exaggeratingly
 Describes my hopeless case, with flattery
 Makes light of my sin in hostility.

Barnabas 185

1 Jesus replied: 'Brother, not time
 Has done this but the world of crime.
 For in each time there is a way
 To serve God in truth and to pray,
 But by associating with
 The world and with its wicked myth,
 Men become bad through the corrupt
 And evil manners shown abrupt.
 Do you not know Gehazi who
 Was servant in Elisha's view,
 The prophet, but he lied and shamed
 His master, took what had been blamed,
 The money and raiment bestowed
 Of Naaman the Syrian who rode?
 Yet Elisha had many more
 True Pharisees to whom in store
 God made him prophesy the more.

2 Truly I say to you that men
 Are so inclined to bad again,
 And so much does the world excite
 Then in it, and Satan with might
 Works to that end, that Pharisees
 Today avoid good works with ease
 And each holy example too:
 And the example come in view
 Of Gehazi's enough for them
 To be reprobated in hem
 Of God. 'The scribe replied as due:
 "It is most true, it is most true."
 So Jesus said: "I'd like you to
 Tell me the example that's true
 Of Haggai and Hosea too,
 Both prophets of God, so we'll see
 The matter of true Pharisee."
 The scribe replied: O master mine,
 What shall I say of the divine?
 Surely many believe it not,
 Although it's written in the plot
 Of Daniel the prophet, but in
 Obedience to you I'll begin.

3 Haggai was fifteen years old when,
 Having sold inheritance, then
 He gave it to the poor. Then he
 Went out from Anathoth to see
 Service with prophet Obadiah.
 Now the aged one Obadiah,
 Who knew Haggai's humility,
 Used him as a book so to teach
 His own disciples and to preach.
 He often gave him costly clothes

And finest food set out in rows,
 But Haggai always sent it back
 With the messenger told on track:
 "Go back to the house, for you've made
 A mistake. Shall the prophet staid,
 Obadiah send me such things?
 Surely not, for he knows my wings,
 That I am good for nothing here,
 But only commit sins, that's clear.
 4 And Obadiah, if he had
 Anything to give out that's bad,
 Used to give it to the one near
 Haggai, so it would be seen clear.
 Then Haggai when he saw the thing,
 Would say to himself on the wing:
 "Now see, Obadiah forgets
 You, since this thing in better bets
 Suits me alone, because I am
 Worse than all others and a sham.
 And there's nothing so vile that I
 Receiving it from hand and eye
 Of Obadiah by God's grace
 But I'd keep it in treasure's place."

The contrast of Haggai and Gehazi,
 Though great, assumes a certain sort of sty.
 They both fasten their eyes on wealth to make
 Their faith in firmness of the earthly stake.
 So both of them are great materialists,
 Both he who grasps the wealth with both his fists
 And he who will not touch the gold at all.
 They have the same assumption in the pall,
 That faith is based on wealth in hold and stall.
 Beloved, I have no faith at all nor fear,
 And have hardly anything I hold dear,
 Though I'm surrounded by both wealth and gear.
 I'm neither like Gehazi on the take
 Nor like good Haggai who's without a rake.

Barnabas 186

1 When Obadiah wished to teach
 Anyone to pray in his reach,
 He'd call Haggai and say: "Recite
 Here your prayer in the people's sight."
 Than Haggai would say: "Lord God of
 Israel, in your mercy and love
 Look on your slave who prays to you,
 Since you've created him in view.
 Righteous Lord God, remember too
 Your righteousness and punish then

The sins of your servant of men,
So I may not pollute your work.
Lord my God, I must surely shirk
Asking You for delights You give
To your faithful servants to live,
Because I do nothing but sin.
So Lord, when you once would begin
To give infirmity to win
One of your servants, think of me,
Your servant for your own glory.”
And when Haggai did so in prayer,
Said the scribe, 'God so loved him there
That to everyone in his time
Who stood beside him God in rhyme
Gave gift of prophecy to share.
Nothing Haggai would ask in prayer
But what God granted him to bear.'

I know by intellect that what I do
Is sin alone, and what good comes in view
From my hand is from You, Beloved, alone,
And not from me as though I might atone.
I know the thing, and yet in heart and feeling
I find myself still showing wheeling dealing.
For those who know not, in their ignorance
There is excuse for the ignoble dance.
But for myself, who know the truth in case,
My failure is a scandal of the race.
I dare not raise a profile of the prayer
Of Haggai in hypocrisy or dare,
But only echo the confession spread:
Lord, have mercy on me, sinner instead.

Barnabas 187

1 The good scribe wept as he said this,
As the sailor weeps when he'd miss
His ship broken up in the storm.
And he said then in a voice warm:
"Hosea, when he went to serve
God, was a prince and not to swerve
Over the tribe of Naphtali,
And aged fourteen years by the bye.
Having sold his patrimony
And given it to the poor to flee,
He went to be disciple of
Haggai. Hosea full of love
Gave what he had to all who asked,
And saying: 'This God gave me tasked
To give to you, O brother, so
Accept it!' That is why not slow

He was left with two things to wear,
 A tunic of sackcloth and still
 A mantle of skins without frill.
 He'd sold his heritage I said
 And gave to the poor to be bred
 And called a Pharisee as led.
 2 Hosea had the Book of Moses,
 Which he read earnestly as roses.
 One day Haggai asked him outright:
 "Hosea, who took from your sight
 All that you had?" He answered then:
 "The Book of Moses." Then again
 A disciple of near-by prophet
 Wanted to go down for the profit
 To Jerusalem, but did not
 Have a mantle. And so he sought
 The charity of Hosea
 Of whom he'd heard good things in awe:
 'Brother, I'd find Jerusalem
 To offer sacrifice in hem
 To our God, but no mantle own.
 I don't know what to do but groan.'
 3 When he heard this, Hosea said:
 'Pardon me, brother, for I've led
 Myself in great sin against you:
 Because God gave me as in cue
 A mantle to give it to you,
 But I'd forgotten it till now.
 Now therefore accept anyhow
 This thing and pray to God for me.'
 The man believed soliloquy
 And took Hosea's mantle free
 And went his way. When Hosea
 Went to the house of Haggai's law,
 Haggai said: 'Who took from your back
 Your mantle which I see you lack?'
 Hosea answered: 'Moses' book.'
 Haggai was very pleased to look,
 Because he saw the goodness of
 Hosea as well as his love.
 It happened a poor man was stripped
 By robbers and left nude unshipped.
 When Hosea saw the man he
 Took off his own tunic in fee
 To give to the man, so he had
 Only his underwear unclad.
 Since he did not go to the home
 Of Haggai, Haggai thought to roam
 Out with two disciples to see
 If Hosea was sick or free.

They found him wrapped in palm-leaves there.
 Haggai asked: Why have you not come
 To see me, you are not a bum?
 Hosea answered: 'Moses' book
 Took my tunic. I feared to look
 On you without a tunic's wrap.'
 So Haggai gave him in a snap
 Another tunic in his lap.
 5 A young man seeing Hosea
 Read the book of Moses in awe
 Wept saying: 'I would also learn
 To read if I could ever earn
 Such a book.' Hearing what he said,
 Hosea gave him it instead,
 Saying: 'Brother, this book is yours;
 For God gave me it so in stores
 I might give it to one who would
 Weep with desire of it and could.'
 The man believed him and he took
 From Hosea the sacred book.

Here is the prophet true: he neither takes
 Note of wealth for his own in comforts' sakes
 Nor bides in pride for having left the all.
 He only says that Moses' book in thrall
 Has so accomplished this or that in stall.
 Beloved, I have none near me to whom I
 Might give a cloak or mantle on the sly,
 But I now see a time when what I wear
 Is too poor for the poor to take in share.
 And yet it's better far than what I need.
 I live to thank you for the things indeed
 That keep me warm and for the things that feed
 Me with a comfort to the belly bare.
 And so I am as though clad by the sky.

Barnabas 188

1 One of Haggai's disciples near
 Hosea wished to make it clear
 Whether his own book was writ right,
 Comparing with another's sight,
 And came to see Hosea then,
 And said to him asking again:
 "Brother, take your book, let us see
 If it agrees with mine's decree."
 Hosea answered: "It is gone,
 Taken away from me and drawn."
 "Who took the book away from you?"
 Asked the disciple filled with rue.
 Hosea answered "Moses' book."

When he heard this, the other went
 To Haggai and said to him rent:
 Hosea's mad, for he proclaims
 The book of Moses without shames
 Has taken from him Moses' book."
 Haggai replied: "Would God so please,
 O brother, that all men in ease
 Were in the same manner as he
 Mad folk, like Hosea to be!"
 2 The Syrian robbers raided land
 Of Judaea, and seized in hand
 A poor widow's son who lived near
 Mount Carmel where prophets appear
 And live the Pharisees in fear.
 Hosea cutting wood one day
 Came on the woman in the sway
 Of mourning, and he straight away
 Began to weep, for when he saw
 Another laughed, he laughed guffaw,
 And when he saw anyone weep,
 He wept. Hosea stricken deep
 With sympathy asked the wife then
 Why she was mourning with tears, when
 She told him the story again.
 3 Then said Hosea: 'Sister, come,
 For God desires to give in sum
 Back to you your son whom you've lost."
 They both went to Hebron at cost
 Where Hosea sold himself and
 Gave the money in the wife's hand,
 Who not knowing its origin,
 Accepted it and went to win
 Back her son. The one who bought him
 Took Hosea on journey grim
 To Jerusalem, where he owned
 A house, not knowing the man loaned
 Was Hosea. Haggai saw
 That Hosea, nor hide nor claw,
 Was found, and so mourned for the loss.
 And angel of God came across
 Him and revealed he was a slave
 Taken to Jerusalem brave.
 The good Haggai when he heard this,
 Wept for the lost Hosea's kiss,
 As a mother weeps for her son
 Who's absent from under the sun.
 He called two disciples to go
 With him to Jerusalem's row.
 By God's will at the city gate
 He met Hosea, who in rate

Was carrying bread to those who
 Worked in the master's vineyard too.
 4 Haggai knew him and he said:
 "Son, how have you here now been led
 To leave your father, old and true,
 Who mourning has been seeking you?"
 Hosea answered: "Father dear,
 I have been sold or so I fear."
 Then Haggai in wrath answered him:
 "Who's sold you with such wicked vim?"
 Hosea answered: "God forgive
 You, O my father, so to live,
 For he who's sold me is so good,
 That if he were not, no one should
 Be holy in the world at all."
 'Who then is he?' said Haggai.
 'Hosea answered: Father tall,
 The Book of Moses was the guy."
 So Haggai was beside himself,
 And said: "Would to God that myself
 With all my offspring should be sold
 By Moses' book, if all be told."
 5 And Haggai went with Hosea
 To his master's house, who then saw
 Haggai and said: "Blessed by God,
 Who's sent his prophet on my sod."
 And he ran out to kiss his hand.
 Then said Haggai: "Brother, stand
 To kiss the hand of your slave whom
 You've bought, he's better in my room."
 And then he told him all the tale.
 At that, the master would prevail
 To give Hosea liberty.'
 And that is all you wished to see,
 O Master, that you asked of me.

I have gone mad, I am insane indeed,
 And cannot fathom this world and its creed.
 This word reported by Barnabas writ
 Is greater than all other prophets fit
 And ought to cause the hard in heart to weep
 And come to You, Beloved, humbly to creep.
 Instead, I hear no one speak of this book
 Except to deride it as a false look
 Or then to praise it for denial of
 The crucifixion and prediction shove
 Of good Muhammad. How can anyone
 Have regard for these controversies done,
 When this great narrative is brought to light?
 All men are blind, blind, blind and have no sight.

Barnabas 189

1 Then Jesus said: "This thing is true,
Because God reaffirms it new.
So that all may know this is true,
In God's name let the sun stand still
And not move twelve hours on the hill!"
And so it happened to the great
Terror of all within the gate
Of Jerusalem and the land
Of all Judaea out of hand.

The only way to hear the words that say
What Haggai and Hosea without pay
Did in the world is to react this way.
Command the sun to stand still in its path
And see it obey the word without wrath
Is only good enough to respond to
The words that tell of good Haggai in view
And of Hosea, his disciple too.
Beloved, I am ashamed to wear a coat,
Or have a tunic made of skin of goat,
But in my faith's embarrassment I lie
Upon the dergah floor and naked cry.
Beloved, bring punishment upon my soul
And on my body, burn in hellish hole.

2 And Jesus said then to the scribe:
"O brother, what would you imbibe
From me, since your knowledge is great?
As God lives, this suffices for
A man's salvation on that score.
For the humility in hand
Of Haggai, with the charity
Of Hosea, fulfils demand
Of the Law and prophets' decree.
Tell me, brother, when you came in
The temple to question and win,
Did you perchance think God sent me
To destroy Law and prophets' fee?
It's certain God will not do this,
Since He's unchangeable in bliss,
And therefore that which God ordained
As man's way of salvation gained,
He's caused all the prophets to say,
All agreed in the righteous way.
3 As God lives before whom I stand,
If the Book of Moses in band
With the book of David our grand
Father had not been blighted by

The human traditions in sly
Made by false Pharisees and those
Doctors who our God never chose,
God would not have given His word
To me. And why do I speak spurred
Of the Book of Moses and book
Of David? Each prophetic book
They have corrupted by the way
They do things now and every day
Not to seek what God would command,
But whether the doctors in band
Say it, and whether Pharisees
Observe it, as though all they please
That God says is in error found,
And men could not err on the ground.

Beloved, I too have falsified each word
In all Your Scriptures, not with a pen stirred,
But in my sinful deeds seen but not heard.
Like dervish dog, I peer at finger pointing
Instead of at the glory and anointing
To which it indicates a light in glow.
I fail to live the way that I should go.
But, my Beloved, have mercy on the blow.
I turn from self to Self and see Your way
Above the earth in horrid, shining ray
And hide my eyes upon the turba sweet.
I cannot bear to stay up on my feet.
Your word is right and holy, but I treat
It with irreverent hand and heart to beat.

4 So woe to his generation
Faithless, for upon them is done
The blood of every prophet shed
And every righteous man that's led,
With Zechariah's blood who came
The son of Berachiah's aim,
Whom they killed between temple gate
And the altar, he met his fate!
What prophet have they not brought in
To persecution by their sin?
What righteous man have they let die
A natural death in peace thereby?
Hardly one! Now they seek to slay
Me also. They boast of the way
They're Abraham's descendants too,
And have a fine temple in view.
As God lives they are Satan's crew,
And that's why they do his will too.
So the temple and city too

Shall fall in ruin, so there be
Not one stone on another, see,
Remaining of the temple's fee.

Barnabas 190

1 Say, brother, you're a doctor learned
In the Law in which is discerned
The promise of Messiah made
To our father Abraham paid,
Is it in Isaac or Ishmael
That the promise is made to spell?
The scribe replied: 'I fear to say,
Because death penalty's to pay.'
Then Jesus said: 'Brother, I'm grieved
That I in your house bread received,
Since you love this life more than God,
Who is your Creator on sod,
And so you fear to lose your life,
But do not fear the loss in strife
Of the faith and eternal life,
Which is lost when the tongue speaks wrong,
Contrary to what the heart long
Knows of the Law of God in song.
Then the good scribe wept and he said:
"O master, if I'd known instead
How to bear fruit, I should have preached
Many things I have left unreached
Lest the fold should rebel impeached."
2 Jesus replied: "You should respect
Neither the folk nor world select,
Nor all the holy ones, nor all
The angels, when it should recall
Offence to God. So let the whole
World perish rather than take toll
That might offend God your Creator,
And keep it not with sin's instater.
For sin destroys and preserves not,
And God is greater to create
As many worlds and to instate
As there are grains of sand beneath
The waves of the sea and the wreath
Of the beyond, and so I state."

It's not in fear of the world that I fail
Proclaiming the true Gospel to prevail,
But by the blindness and the disregard
Of my own spirit and a heart that's hard.
Beloved, give me the courage to own wrong
In hand and heart and then lift up the song
Of right like the green finch that still pretends

To be an angel by the snow that sends
A sprinkling from the rowan down on me
Behind the window that looks on the tree.
Beloved, the word of life is clear and bare,
But hardly anyone can see it there.
Give ears to the deaf and eyes to the blind
Until no soul on earth is left behind.

Barnabas 191

1 The scribe then said: "O pardon me,
Master, for I have sinned freely."
Jesus replied: "God pardon you,
For against Him is what you do."
2 Then said the scribe: "I've seen a book
Both old and worn for those who look,
And written by Moses' own hand
And that of Joshua to stand;
He who made the sun to stand still,
As you have done and by God's will;
Servants and prophets of our God,
Which book is true and without fraud,
The Book of Moses. In that book
Is written, in a safer nook,
That Ishmael is the father come
By which the true Messiah's from,
And Isaac is the father of
The messenger of Christ of love.
So says the book that Moses said:
"Lord God of Israel once lead,
Mighty and merciful, now show
Your servant Your splendour and glow."
3 So God showed him his Messenger
In the arms of Ishmael to stir,
And Ishmael in Abraham's arms.
Near Ishmael stood Isaac's alarms,
With a child pointing to the one
Messenger of God under sun,
Saying: "This is he for whom God
Created all things on the sod."
At that Moses cried out with joy:
"O Ishmael, you have in employ
In your arms all the world and still
Paradise too, and by God's will!
Remember me, God's servant too,
That I may find grace in God's view
By means of your son, for whom He
Has made all things eternally."

Sarah is said to have lived a long life
As princess and as Abraham's fair wife.

One hundred twenty-seven years were long
Upon her neck for right as well as wrong.
I do prefer the other wife instead,
Egyptian Hagar, so touched is my head
With foolish visions of the desert dream,
Of Ishmael riding like the wind to gleam
Beneath the crescent moon and surprise frost,
The sandy presents that his wild worlds cost.
But Sarah also had a faithful son
After her ninety years of hope had run
The gamut of despair. I wait to find
How many men and women remain blind.

Barnabas 192

1 In that Book it is not found that
God eats the flesh or eats the fat
Of cattle or sheep; in that Book
It is not found that God once took
His mercy for Israel alone,
But rather that mercy's in loan
To every man who seeks God who
Is his Creator in truth too.
All of this book I could not read,
Because the high priest there decreed,
In whose house I was, to forbid
Me, saying an Ishmaelite hid
The words in it and on the skid.'

Truth is that Your bounty, salvation cast,
Is not presented in Torah to last
For Israel alone, nor in the book
Of any of the prophets where I look
At the quick footprints of angels in black
That cross the pages right to left and back.
Your great salvation's for all those in grace
You repent of their sins before Your face.
Though I am not of Isaac's family
Nor of the race of Ishmael, it's my plea,
Beloved that in Your mercy and bounty
Of grace You might look on such one as I
And grant me Your salvation as I try
To meet Your blessings here beneath the sky.

2 Then Jesus said: "See that you do
Not ever again the truth due
Keep back, because in the faith of
The Messiah shall God above
Give salvation to men, and yet
Without it none salvation get."
So ended Jesus there his words.

So they sat down to meat and curds.
 Then Mary, who wept at the feet
 Of Jesus, entered the retreat
 Of Nicodemus, for the name
 Of the scribe was such to his fame,
 And weeping placed herself beside
 The feet of Jesus, tears to guide,
 And said: 'Sir, your servant who through
 You has found mercy beyond due
 With God, has a sister, and more,
 A brother sick to death in store.'
 3 Jesus replied: "Where is your house?"
 Tell me, for I'll come fast as grouse
 To pray God for his health regained.'
 Mary replied: "Bethany's fained
 To be the home of brother and
 Sister, for my own house at hand
 Is Magdala: my brother, then,
 Is in Bethany once again.'
 Jesus said to the woman then:
 'Go right back to your brother's house,
 And there await me like a mouse,
 For I'll come to heal him at last.
 Don't be afraid that death surpassed.'
 The woman left and made her way
 To Bethany and found that day
 Her brother dead, and so they lay
 Him in their ancestors' tomb's sway.

How many times the promises of love
 Seem to end in the death of those who stove
 To live in light and beauty in the wake
 Of dispossession for the righteous sake!
 So Mary returns to the house rejoicing
 In Jesus' promises and finds there voicing
 Laments for the new dead. I faint in view.
 Beloved, this is the sort of thing You do.
 Give me the faith to trust even in death
 Abundance of Your resurrection's breath.
 This life is just the threshold of the true,
 And in Your heart and Paradise the view
 Of glory shall make all my loves here fade
 And resurrect in the glory You've made.

Barnabas 193

1 Jesus stayed two days in the house
 Of Nicodemus without louse,
 And the third day he went away
 To go to Bethany to stay,
 And when he was near to the town,

He then sent two disciples down
Before him, to tell Mary he
Was coming as she soon would see.
She ran out of the town to meet
Jesus and weeping at his feet,
Said: 'Sir, you said my brother sweet
Would not die, and now he lies in
The grave for four days as in bin.
Would to God you had come before
I called you his health to restore,
For then he never should have died!'
2 Jesus answered and so replied:
'Your brother is not dead, but sleeps,
Therefore I come where darkness creeps
To wake him up.' Mary with tears
Replied: 'Sir, from such sleep of fears
He shall be raised on judgement day
By God's angel sounding away
His trumpet.' Jesus answered then:
'Mary, believe me that again
He shall rise before that, because
God's given me power on the laws
Of his sleep, and truly I say
To you he's not caught in death's sway,
For only one is dead who dies
Without finding mercy in guise
With God.' Mary quickly went back
To tell sister Martha in hack
That Jesus' coming was not slack.

Death is the enemy that all men fear,
Whether they will admit it or appear
To have no care about the future state.
All fear death without hope, all fear the grate.
The only thing that mitigates such fright
Is faith in soul immortal out of sight
Or faith in resurrection from the plight
Of the tomb fastened with the bars of slate.
Beloved, I see no evidence of life
Eternal in immortal soul from strife,
But I can conjure up a faith attached
To hope of resurrection of the hatched.
That power that brought me to life at the start
Can give me life again, flesh, blood, and heart.

3 There were assembled many Jews
At Lazarus' death and in crews
Many scribes and the Pharisees.
Martha heard from her sister Mary
That Jesus was coming and wary,

And she got up quickly and went
 Outside and the crowd as though sent
 Followed her to give comfort lent,
 Because they thought that she went out
 To the tomb to weep without doubt
 For her brother. But when she came
 To the place where Jesus in claim
 Spoke to Mary, Martha with tears
 Said: 'Sir, would God, as it appears,
 You had been here, for then my dear
 Brother had not died in his fear!'

Mary then came up weeping too,
 And Jesus too shed tears in view,
 And sighing said: "Where have you then
 Laid him to rest? Show me again.'
 They answered: "Come and see again.'
 4 The Pharisees said to themselves:
 'Now this man, a man among elves,
 Who raised the widow's son at Nain,
 Why did he let this man die lain,
 After he promised to come here
 And heal him instead on his bier?'

Jesus arrived there at the tomb,
 Where all were weeping by the room,
 And said: 'Don't cry, for Lazarus
 Is just asleep, and I not worse
 Come to awaken him again.'
 The Pharisees among themselves
 Said: 'Would to God that you on shelves
 Did sleep the same sleep as this man!'

Then Jesus said: 'It's not the plan
 Of God that I should go to sleep
 Yet, but when the moment comes to keep
 When I shall sleep like this, then he
 Shall waken me up speedily.'
 Then Jesus said again: 'Remove
 The stone from the sepulchre's groove.'
 Said Martha: 'Sir, he stinks, for he
 Has been dead four days in degree.'
 Jesus said: 'Why did I come here,
 Martha? Don't you believe through tear
 That I shall waken him again?'

Martha replied: 'I know that you
 Are the holy one of God true,
 Who has sent you into this world.'
 5 Jesus lifted his hands unfurled
 To heaven, and said: 'Our fathers' God,
 And God of Abraham unshod,
 And God of Ishmael, and the Lord
 Of Isaac and his One adored,

Have mercy on the sorrow here
 Of these two women that appear,
 And glorify Your holy name.'
 And everyone answered: 'Amen.'
 Jesus said with a loud voice then:
 'Lazarus, come out!' Whereupon
 He who was dead rose up like dawn.
 Jesus told his disciples then:
 'Release him.' For he was bound in
 The grave-clothes with a napkin in
 His face, just as our fathers did
 When they buried their dead and hid.
 6 A great multitude of the Jews
 And some of the Pharisees' crews
 Believed in Jesus, because he
 Performed a sign great in degree.
 Those who remained in unbelief
 To Jerusalem without grief
 Went on departing like a thief.
 And there they told the priests in chief
 About Lazarus' raising from
 The grave, how many had become
 Nazarenes, for so they called those
 Brought to repent as God so chose
 Through His word Jesus preached to those.

Barnabas notes that Jesus prayed to You,
 Beloved, to have mercy upon the two
 In sorrow. No Gospel other than that
 Thinks of the sorrow of two ladies flat.
 The human quality this Gospel shows
 Is worthy of perusal as it goes.
 But then, of course, hard-heartedness today
 Is so rampant among the churchly sway
 That this is the last Gospel in its way
 That any want to read. It might remind
 Them then to love their neighbour in the bind.
 And we could not have that, for it prevents
 Manipulating crowds for self-defence,
 Or protection of oil interests in pence.

Barnabas 194

1 The scribes and Pharisees made plot
 With the high priest to kill in lot
 Poor Lazarus, since many left
 Their traditions to take the heft
 Of Jesus' word, because the sign
 In Lazarus was so divine,
 Seeing that Lazarus alive
 Spoke with men, ate and drank to thrive.

But because he was powerful,
 And in Jerusalem had pull,
 Had his sister in Magdala
 And one in Bethany for awe,
 They did not know how under law
 They could get rid of him for all.
 2 Jesus went into Bethany,
 Into Lazarus' house to see
 Martha, Lazarus and Mary,
 And they served him. Then sat Mary
 One day at Jesus' feet to hear
 His words, and Martha did appear
 To say to Jesus: 'Sir, you see
 That my sister takes liberty
 Not to serve you nor to provide
 You with food and the ones beside
 You, your disciples come to ride?'
 Jesus to Martha then replied:
 'Martha, Martha, do you take thought
 For that which you know must be wrought,
 For Mary's chosen a good part
 Not to be denied her from start.'
 3 Jesus sat with the crowd at meat,
 Around the table for a treat
 With those who believed in his word,
 And he spoke to them as occurred:
 "My brothers, I've but little time
 To stay with you and preach in rhyme,
 For soon I must depart this world.
 I speak Ezekiel's word unfurled,
 Who was a prophet and who said:
 "As I your God live on instead
 Of dying, so I witness bear
 That the soul that sins in her share
 Shall die, but if the sinner take
 Repentance, for repentance' sake
 He shall not die but live in wake."
 That's why the present death's no death,
 But rather at the end of breath
 The end also of a long death,
 Just as the body separates
 From sense in a swoon for its rates,
 Though it still have the soul within,
 Differs in profit, not in sin,
 From the dead and buried in that
 The buried waits for God out flat
 To raise it up again to life,
 But the unconscious without strife
 Waits for the conscious to return.
 So see the present life and spurn,

For it is death because it shares
Not perception of God awares.

Indeed, Beloved, I live a living death,
For I see all creation round in breath,
And every leaf of every birch as bright
And distinct as the lightning in the night,
And yet I do not know that You are near,
And am forgetful that You do appear
Through the fog of existence grey and sere.
I live a living death, unconscious fear.
Beloved, crash through the slumber of my brain
And bring my senses into stall and rein,
So I may live before Your throne aloud,
Among the holy angels in their crowd,
And lay my hand to the plough and the stave
Before the divine vision, and no knave.

Barnabas 195

1 Those who believe in me shall not
Die eternally in their plot,
For through my word they shall perceive
God present in them for reprieve,
And so work out salvation's state.
What is death but an act in rate
That nature does by God's command?
It's like a bird held in the hand
By a cord, when the head wills it
The hand opens, the bird will flit.
The head gives hand a sure command,
And the bird flies up on the land.
The prophet David said: "Our soul's
A sparrow freed from fowler's holes,"
When man bides under God safe hand.
Our life is like the cord by which
The body keeps soul in the ditch
And in the sense of human flesh.
So when God wills, commands afresh,
The life-cord's broken, and the soul
Escapes into the angels' toll,
Borne in the angels' hands as God
Ordained to happen on the sod.
2 Let not then friends weep when their friend
Is dead, for our God's will attend.
But let him weep unceasingly
When he sins, for then by decree
The soul dies, seeing it's apart
From God and true life at the start.
If the body's a horrid thing
Without union with soul to bring,

How much more frightful is the soul
Without union with God in goal,
Who with His grace and mercy filled
And quickened it with beauty stilled?’
And having said this Jesus gave
Thanks to God. Lazarus said brave:
‘Lord, this house belongs to my God
And my Creator on the sod,
With all He’s given in my store,
For the supporting of the poor.
Wherefore, since you’re in poverty,
And have many disciples, see,
Come here to live when you may please,
Often and as long in your ease,
For God’s servant will serve you well
For love of God the needed spell.’

The spirit flits to Abram's bosom, true,
And returns to the Creator in view,
While body lies down to rest in the grave
With kings and princes and the lowly slave
In fair unconsciousness that all the earth
Continues to drive bargains of small worth.
The spirit goes back to the nostrils that
Produced it from the first from solemn vat.
Beloved, I seek the joining of the two,
The spirit and the body from the view
Of the grace so the soul may rise anew.
Till then, I find no rest from strife and care,
And lay me down by night to find a share
Of quiet till the day come to repair.

Barnabas 196

1 Jesus rejoiced when he heard this,
And said: ‘See how good it’s to kiss
Death! Lazarus came once to die,
And has learned such wisdom to vie
With all the wise men in the world
Grown old in their old books uncurled!
Would to God that each man might die
Once only and return to spy
In the world as Lazarus did,
So men might learn to live and bid.’
John answered: ‘O master, may I
Be allowed once to testify?’
2 ‘Speak up a thousand times,’ replied
Jesus, ‘for just as men abide
To give their goods in God’s service,
So also it is not amiss
But duty to dispense doctrine:

So much the more he's so bound in
 That duty as the world has power
 To raise souls to repentance bower,
 Whereas goods cannot bring back life
 To the dead with our without strife.
 So he's a murderer who's hand
 Has power to help a poor man stand
 And when he refrains from the act
 The poor man dies in hunger wracked;
 But a worse murderer is he
 Who could by Word of God set free
 A man into penitence come,
 And does not convert him in sum,
 But stands, as God says, "like dumb dog."
 Against such God says in their fog:
 "The soul of sinner that shall die
 Because you've hidden My word sly,
 I will require it at your hands,
 Unfaithful servant who just stands."
 3 In what condition, then, are now
 The scribes and Pharisees somehow
 Who have the key and don't go in,
 But hinder those who flee from sin
 To enter in eternal life?
 'You ask me, John, like whetted knife
 For leave to speak one word, when you
 Have listened to myriads in crew
 Of words of mine. I tell you true,
 I'm bound to hear ten times as much
 From you than you have come to touch
 Of my words. And he who will not
 Hear the word of another sought,
 Sins every time that he shall speak.
 For we should do and gladly seek
 For others what we ourselves wish
 For ourselves, and not put in dish
 Of others wretched, rotten fish
 We don't eat because of the reek.
 Then said John: 'O master, why's not
 God granted this to men in lot,
 That they should die once and return
 As Lazarus did not to spurn,
 In order that such men might learn
 To know themselves and their God earn?'

Beloved, grant hearing to my ears as I
 Go out alone beneath a greyer sky
 To meet the coming winter without groan.
 Grant hearing to my ears before Your throne.
 My words are thinly wisps of dire complaint

Not worthy to fall on the ear of saint,
So let me be dumb before all of those
Who preach the throbbing Gospel on their toes.
Beloved, my thousand screechings find You where
No finch before has risen on the bare.
Beloved, my hourly sermons rise and fall
Upon the heads of rabbits at the call.
Let me hear Your words rise in silence so
I can reject the babbling of the low.

Barnabas 197

1 Jesus replied: 'Tell me, John dear;
There was an householder in gear
Who gave a perfect axe to one
Of his servants so he when done
Might cut down the wood which cut off
The view of his house. But to scoff
The labourer forgot the axe,
And said: "If the master would tax
Me with an old axe I should then
Easily cut the wood again."
Tell me, John, what the master said?
He was angry and took instead
The old axe, hit him on the head,
And said: Fool and knave! I gave you
An axe to cut the wood in view
With ease, and you sought out this axe
And with great toil and sweat on backs
To spoil the wood with such dull whacks.
I wanted you to cut the wood
So that the result would be good."
Is this not what he'd say or should?'
2 John answered: 'It is true indeed.'
Jesus replied: 'As I do live,
Said God, 'I've given an axe, not sieve,
To every man, which is the sight
Of the dead being buried right.
The one who wields this axe well might
Remove the wood of sin from sight
Of his heart without pain in ease.
They get mercy and grace to please
With life eternal for good works.
But the man seeing instead shirks
Forgetting that he's mortal man,
Though time after time he should scan
The death of others, but then groans:
*If I should see the other zones
Of life, I would then do good works,"
My wrath shall fall down on his quirks,
And I'll strike him to death so he

Shall never have reward in fee.'
'Oh John,' said Jesus, 'how great be
Advantage of him who from fall
Of others learns to stand at all!'

I have an axe upon my each each time
I hear the church tower ringing with the chime
Of one now laid to rest. It comes each day
Across the busy rush of the highway.
I live beside the graveyard in a pinch
It would take me three minutes without hinch
To get among the tombstones from my door.
And yet I feel but rarely to adore
The one Creator who gave life to me
And will upon the Judgement set me free
Of all constraints to tell in liberty
The whole tale of my open treachery.
Just one more blow upon the head and I
Shall see the heavens opened from the sky.

Barnabas 198

1 Said Lazarus: 'Master, truly
I say to you, I cannot see
The magnitude of penalty
Of which he's worthy who from time
To time sees the dead borne to climb
Into the tomb and fears not God
Our Creator upon the sod.
Such a one for the things of earth,
Which he should spurn as of no worth,
Offends his Maker who gave him
All things and did not leave him dim.'

I've seen the dead laid in the grave, my Lord,
I've seen the living weep beneath the scored
Hand of the reaper, yet I too have failed
To take the implications that it nailed.
I fear You not, Beloved, because You are
Invisible upon this lonely star,
And caught in time I am forgetful when
I should see You step down to earthly men
In rainbows and in breezes and in leaves
Of birches and of aspens when life grieves.
I am forgetful, blind and deaf and feel
No motion of the wind when You appeal
To me to know Your heart. But take me in
Despite my carelessness, blindness, and sin.

2 To his disciples Jesus said:
'You call me Master as well bred,

Since God teaches by my mouth too.
 But how to call Lazarus' cue?
 Truly his masters' master here
 To teach earth's doctrine without fear.
 I've taught you truly how to live
 Well, but Lazarus came to give
 Instruction on how well to die.
 As God lives, he shall prophesy,
 So listen to his words in truth.
 So much more you should without ruth
 Hear what he says, as living's vain
 If one die badly without gain.'
 3 Said Lazarus: 'O master, I
 Thank you that you make truth to spy
 And to be prized; therefore will God
 Give you great merit in the prod.'
 Then said he who writes this: 'O dear
 Master how speaks Lazarus clear
 The truth in saying to you "You
 Shall have merit," whereas then you
 Said to Nicodemus that man
 Merits nought but punishment's ban?
 Shall you accordingly be sent
 To punishment from God as bent?'
 Jesus replied: 'May it please God
 That I receive punishment's rod
 Of men of God in this world too,
 Because I've not served him so true
 And faithfully as bound to do.
 4 But God's so loved me, by His grace,
 That every punishment in trace
 Is taken from me, in so much
 That I shall be punished in touch
 Only in another man's fight.
 For punishment was fit and right
 For me, for that men called me God;
 But since I've confessed under prod,
 Not only that I am not God,
 As is the truth, but have confessed
 Also I'm not Messiah dressed,
 Therefore God has taken away
 The punishment from me to stay,
 And will cause a wicked one here
 To suffer in my name and fear,
 So that the shame alone be mine.
 So I tell you in the design,
 My Barnabas, that when a man
 Speaks of what God shall give in plan
 To his neighbour let him say that
 His neighbour merits the good fat.

But let him take care when he speak
Of what God shall give him as weak,
He says: God will give it me."
And let him take care not to be
Claiming to have merit's degree
Because God's pleased to grant mercy
To His servants when they confess
That they deserve hell for sins' mess.

Your blessing, my Beloved, upon the soul
And body poured into the ready hole
Is not reward for merit on the glass.
It is without the human merit's pass.
The mercy that You grant me in this way
Is not a grace and mercy in my pay,
But truly undeserved from top to stern.
What I deserve, like everyone's to burn.
I burn, Beloved, in love and shame to see
That You return for naught abundantly
And leave the plate so filled that I cannot
Eat all the blessings with which I've been taught.
When Lazarus came down to see the soil
After the resurrection, what could spoil?

Barnabas 199

1 God is so rich in His mercies
The water of a thousand seas,
If so many were to be found,
Could not quench a spark on the ground
Of the flames of hell, yet a tear,
A single tear of one in fear
Who mourns having offended God,
Quenches the whole of hell by prod
Of the great mercy God in aid
Gives to the soul of one who prayed.
So God to confound Satan and
To show the bounty of His had,
Wills to call merit every act
Of goodness done under the pact
Of His mercy, and also wills
Him so to treat his neighbour's ills.
But of himself let man beware
Of claiming merit for his share,
For he'd be condemned outright there.'

I too pray like good Abraham that I
Shall not be a test for those by and by
Who do not have faith in You on the sly.
But I doubt that You will give me reply.
When I stand for the truth, I see not many

Who rally to the flag to give a penny.
Instead I see the hearts go harder still
When they are irritated by my bill.
Beloved, I have been sent into the world,
Not as a prophet leading an unfurled
Flag of truth and of justice, but to be
The one by which You harden hearts' degree.
Whether You someday have mercy on me
Or not, I stand here blessed, I stand uncurled.

Barnabas 200

1 Jesus turning to Lazarus
Said: 'Brother, I, despite the fuss,
Must stay in this world a short time
More, so when I am in your clime
I'll not go to another house,
Because you'll serve me like a mouse,
Not for love of me, but for love
Of God.' It was near time to shove
Off for Passover of the Jews,
So Jesus told to them his views:
"Let's go to Jerusalem now
To eat the paschal lamb somehow."
He sent Peter and John to town
Saying: "You'll find an ass, one brown,
And with a colt: untie her and
Bring her to me to put in hand
For I must ride her into town.
If anyone ask with a frown:
Why are you untying the ass,
Just tell them the master in pass
Has need of it," and they'll permit
You to bring her back to me fit."
2 The disciples, they went and found
All that Jesus had told them sound,
And so they brought the ass and colt.
The disciples before they'd bolt
Placed their mantles upon the colt,
And Jesus rode it. After that,
When men of Jerusalem heard that
Jesus of Nazareth drew near,
The men went out with child and gear
Eager to see Jesus. They held
Palm branches in their hands unquelled
And olive branches as they sang:
'Blessed he who comes to us in gang
In the name of God; hosanna
To son of David come in awe!'
3 When Jesus came into the town,
The men spread out their garments brown

Under the feet of the ass there,
 Singing: "Blessed be the one so fair
 To come to us in Lord God's name;
 Hosanna, son of David's claim!"
 The Pharisees rebuked the man
 Jesus, saying: 'See what in ban
 These people say? Make them be still!'
 Then Jesus said: As God lives now,
 In whose presence I stand and bow,
 If men should hold their peace, the stones
 Would cry out aloud and with groans
 Against sinners' gross unbelief.'
 When Jesus said this as in life,
 All the stones of Jerusalem
 Cried out with a great noise of gem:
 'Blessed he who comes to us in name
 Of the Lord God!" But to their shame
 The Pharisees in unbelief
 Remained, and even gathered by
 To plan to catch him on the sly.

Barnabas better than any scribe yet
 Remembers mentioning the signs that get
 Most favour in the memory, I say.
 The others might as well go out to play.
 Did the stones shout? I would want to believe
 That very stones had tongues instead to grieve.
 It truth be told, I doubt the word, but then
 I've seen the strangest of things among men.
 No doubt I am one of those here who doubt.
 It's in my name, no need to pout and shout.
 But it is still a shame that on a day
 Jerusalem heard the stones shout away,
 While church members looked on at best
 And did not raise a finger in protest.

Barnabas 201

1 When Jesus came in temple square,
 The scribes and Pharisees were there
 With wench caught in adultery.
 They said among themselves freely:
 'If he saves her, it's against Law
 Of Moses, and we've caught his paw,
 And if he condemns her, that is
 Against his own doctrine and biz,
 For he preaches mercy.' So they
 Came to Jesus a word to say:
 'Master, we found this wench to be
 Caught outright in adultery.
 Moses commanded to stone such.

What do you say about her much?'
 2 So Jesus stooped down with his hand
 Made a mirror upon the sand
 Where every one saw his own sin.
 They pressed for answer to begin,
 But Jesus rose, and pointed out
 The mirror with his finger's clout,
 And said: 'He who is without sin
 Among you, let stoning begin.'
 Again he stooped down to the ground
 And shaped the mirror all around.
 When the men saw this, they went out,
 One by one, from the eldest stout,
 For they were ashamed there to see
 Reflected their iniquity.
 3 Jesus got up and saw the wench
 And nobody else on the bench,
 And so he said: 'Woman, where are
 Those who condemned you from afar?'
 The woman answered, weeping sore:
 'Sir, they've gone away; pardon more,
 And as God lives, I'll sin no more.'
 Then Jesus said: 'Bless be our God!
 Go your way in peace under rod,
 And sin no more, for God has not
 Sent me to condemn you unsought.'
 4 Then the scribes and the Pharisees
 Came together, as Jesus sees,
 Who said to them: Tell me the truth
 If one of you, though but a youth,
 Had one hundred sheep and should lose
 One of them, would you then refuse
 To go and seek it, leaving home
 The ninety-nine that did not roam?
 And when you found it, would you not
 Lay it upon your shoulders caught
 And having called neighbour and friend,
 Say to them: "Rejoice to the end
 With me, for I have found the sheep
 Which I had lost but now to keep."?
 You would truly do so, indeed.
 Now say, shall our God stay in need
 Of love towards man, for whom He
 Has made the world? As God lives, see,
 Just so there's joy among the great
 Angels before God in their state
 Over one sinner who repents,
 Since sinners show God's mercy's sense.'

The woman may well promise not to sin,

But that is true of all of us in bin,
Who are repenting day by day of that
Which day by day catches once more out flat.
Her promise is worth nothing in the store,
It's only when the shepherd at the door
Goes out to find the lost at night
Who has no way to come back in the light
That the repentance may turn from mere word
And weeping to a righteousness unstirred.
The sheep can not contribute to the weal
Except to bleat petitions it may feel
To beg Your grace and mercy on the town,
And hope one day not to perceive Your frown.

Barnabas 202

1 'Tell me who loves the doctor more,
One who was never sick before,
Or the one who was cured by him
Of a malady painful, grim?'
The Pharisees answered the while:
'How can a well person beguile
To love the doctor for his smile?
He'll surely love him only for
The fact that he's not sick the more.
But never having been in store
Of sickness, he'll love him a bit,
But no more, without knowledge fit.'
2 Vehemently Jesus spoke then:
'As God lives, your own tongues again
Condemn your pride, since sinful men
Who repent love God then much more,
Knowing God's great mercy in store,
Than does the righteous in his way.
For the righteous knows not a ray
Of the mercy of God. That's why
There's more rejoicing in the sky
By God's angels over just one
Sinner that repents than the tonne
Of ninety-nine virtuous men.
Where are the righteous now again?
As God lives, in whose presence my
Soul stands, great is the number's cry
Of the righteous unrighteous men;
Their state is like that of Satan.'
3 The scribes and Pharisees replied:
'We're sinners, therefore will abide
The mercy of God on our side.'
And this they said for tempting him;
For scribes and Pharisees hold dim
In the height to be sinners called.

Then Jesus said, though unappalled:
'I fear that you are righteous in
Your vast unrighteousness and sin.
For if you've sinned and deny it,
Calling yourselves righteous and fit,
You are unrighteous; and if in
Your heart you say you're without sin,
And with your tongue say that you are
Sinners above and beyond star,
Then you're doubly unrighteous far.'
4 So the scribes and the Pharisees,
On hearing this that did not please,
Left the field vanquished to their knees.
So Jesus was there with his own
Disciples, and they went alone
To the house of Simon who's known
As the leper, whose leprosy
He had cleansed. The citizens free
Had gathered together the sick
To Simon's house. They were there thick,
And they begged Jesus to heal them.
Jesus knew that his time at hem
Was near, and said by stratagem:
'Call the sick as many as be,
Because God merciful's mighty,
To heal them all and set them free.'
They answered: 'We know of no more
Here in Jerusalem in store
Who are sick and lying in-door.'

Jesus begs that the sick be brought to him
And he will heal them all by power undim
From You, Beloved, and all look on in trim
And none goes out to find the sick and grim.
Beloved, we die and sigh and feel no need
To turn to You with hope for health in greed.
Turn You to us, Beloved, and in that turning
Heal every heart that fails in faith and yearning.
The present grand theology proclaims
That You have mercy only on the flames
Of those who here pretend to love Your names
And accept You as Saviour for their hopes.
In all reality there's no heart gropes
For healing. You must descend on Your ropes.

5 Jesus weeping answered them then:
'O Jerusalem, Israel's men,
I weep for you, because you know
Not your visitation in show;
Because I would have gathered you

To God's love, your Creator too,
As a hen gathers up her chicks
Under her wings, but in your licks
You would not! Therefore God says thus
To you because you are callous:

Barnabas 203

1 O city, hard-hearted, perverse
Of mind, I've lifted off your curse
To send you my servant, so he
May turn your heart back unto me
And so repent; but you, O town
Of confusion, do not bring down
To memory the things I did
In Egypt and to Pharaoh rid
For love of you, O Israel.
You often weep and weep a spell
That My servant might make you well,
And then you try to kill My man
Because he seeks to heal and scan
Your soul of every sinful plan.
2 Shall you, then, go along without
Punishment by Me with a shout?
Shall you then live eternally?
And shall your pride free you from Me?
Assuredly not, for I'll bring
Princes into your surrounding
With power, an army against you,
And that way I'll deliver you
Into their hands so that your pride
Shall fall down and into hell ride.
3 I shall not pardon the old men
Or the widows, or the children,
But I will give you all to drought,
And to the sword and to the plot
Of derision and temple house
I'll held in mercy, I will douse
In desolation with the town,
So you'll become a fable flown,
Derision and a proverb told
Among the nations where you're sold.
So My wrath stays upon you and
My anger abates not in hand."

Bring not Your wrath, Beloved, upon the face
Of so many millions here without grace.
Repentance is not the way of mankind,
Who having eyes wilfully remains blind
And having ears still fails to hear Your word.
The dead in sins can never have heart stirred.

It takes the miracle of new creation
By that same power that brought up in elation
The body and the soul at the first time.
So do not look in wrath on wickedness
But give Your grace for the final redress
That comes with the repentance You provide.
I come beneath Your wing and there abide
In trust that You Yourself are place to hide.

Barnabas 204

1 After this Jesus spoke again:
'Don't you know there are more sick men?
As God lives, in Jerusalem
There are fewer by stratagem
That have sound soul than there are there
Who have bodies in doctors' care.
So you may know the truth, I say
To you, O sick people today,
In God's name let your illness go!
When he said this, straight off in glow
Of health the whole crowd stood in sway.
2 The men wept when they heard God's wrath
Rose up in Jerusalem's path,
And prayed for grace when Jesus said:
"If Jerusalem for sins were led
To weep and to repent and walk
In My ways, said God, not to baulk,
I'd not remember any more
Her iniquities laid in store,
And not do to her by My wrath
Which I threatened upon her path.
But Jerusalem grieves her loss
And not her sins' dishonoured cross,
By which she's blasphemed My name here
Among the nations without fear.
That's why My fury's kindled more.
As I live for ever in store,
If Job, Abraham, Samuel,
David, my servants, Daniel
With Moses should pray for this folk,
My wrath on Jerusalem broke
Should not be quenched once set to stoke."
Having said this, Jesus went in
The house, while fear began to win
Over the people left in sin.

Not even prayers of six great prophets made
Can quench Your wrath once it is on parade,
Beloved, so what prayer can I raise
In quaint petition or in quainter praise?

I live within the house of wrath and I
Am doomed beneath its fury then to die
And pass to Tophet, unless by Your grace
You raise me up alive before Your face.
The freedom that You fix on humankind
Described within the Decalogue well dined
I grasp indeed, but still the fragrant air
Is heavy and as silent as if there
Were nothing beyond lizard and the moth,
Not even warnings of the divine wrath.

Barnabas 205

1 While Jesus' disciples with him
Sat eating in the interim
In Simon the leper's house, see,
Mary Lazarus sister free
Came in the house, and broke a pot
Of ointment on the head and brought
It on the clothing of Jesus.
At this, Judas then made a fuss,
Saying: 'Go sell the perfume and
Bring the money into my hand
So I may give it to the poor.'
Jesus said: 'Why hinder her more?
Leave her alone. The poor shall be
Always with you, you'll not have me.'
2 Judas replied: 'O master, this
Perfume might be sold not to miss
Three hundred coins, so then see how
Many poor folk would be helped now.'
Jesus replied: 'O Judas, I
Know your heart, have patience thereby,
And I will give you all and why.'
Everyone ate with fear as well
As sadness on disciples fell,
Because they knew Jesus would go
Away from them and not be slow.
But Judas was indignant then,
Because he knew he'd lose again
Thirty pieces of money for
The perfume not sold since the more
He stole a tenth of all the store
Of what was given in the hand
Of Jesus by the people's band.
3 He went to find the high priest, who
Assembled in a council pew
The priests, the scribes and Pharisees;
To whom Judas spoke, said with ease:
'What will you give me so I might
Betray Jesus into your sight,

Since he'd make himself Israel's king?'
They answered: 'Now how will you bring
Him into our hand?' Judas said:
'When I find out that he is led
Outside the town to stay in prayer,
I'll tell you and I'll take you there.
To seize him in the city you
Would incite a seditious crew.'
The high priest answered: 'If you do,
We'll give thirty gold pieces and
You'll see how well we treat your band.'

It was not wise of Jesus to relate
That the poor are here always at the gate,
Since from that time it has been an excuse
For leaving the poor hungry with abuse.
The poor are always with us, not because
Jesus said so, and not because of laws
Of nature that require some always be
Held down in desperation's poverty.
The poor are always with us for the greed
Of the rich who acquire beyond their need
The wealth that the poor ought to have to eat.
That is simply the reason why we meet
So many poor upon the earth. My Lord,
Reign punishment down on the greedy hoard.

Barnabas 206

1 When day dawned, Jesus went up to
The Temple with great crowds in view.
So the high priest came near to say:
'Tell me, O Jesus, say today
Have you forgotten all you said
Confessing you're not God nor bred
A son of God, nor even yet
The Messiah, one not yet met?'
Jesus replied: 'No, surely, I
Have not forgotten, this is why,
For this is my confession true
Which I'll bear before judgement's view
Of God on the last day as true.
For all in Book of Moses writ
Is true, for our Creator's God
Alone. I'm God's servant in prod
And wish to serve God's messenger
Whom you title the Messiah.'
2 Said the high priest: 'Then why do you
Come to the temple in such crew?
Do you perhaps seek to become
The king of Israel in sum?

Be careful no danger accrue.'
 Jesus replied: 'If I sought my
 Own glory and desired the pie
 Of this world, I'd not run away
 When the folk of Nain came my way
 To make me king. Believe me well,
 I seek nothing this world can tell.'
 Then said the high priest: 'We would know
 A thing of the Messiah's show.'
 Then the priests, scribes and Pharisees
 Surrounded Jesus as to tease.
 3 Jesus replied: 'What is this that
 You want to know of Christ thereat?
 Perhaps it is the lie you wish?
 If so, I'll not serve you that dish.
 For if I'd been a liar you
 Would have adored me of your crew,
 And of the scribes and Pharisees,
 With all Israel come out to please.
 But because I tell you the truth,
 You hate and would kill without ruth.'
 Said the high priest: 'Now we well know
 You have the devil in your show,
 For you're a Samaritan and
 Respect not God's priests in command.'

Though I am not Samaritan, I know
 Such people still live and are on the go.
 I even talked with one once long ago.
 Of course it was a lie, Jesus was not
 Samaritan, but Jewish with his lot.
 But I would be like Jesus, if it's true,
 That he disdained the wicked priestly crew.
 I would disdain them certainly if I
 Were better than that sinful lot to vie.
 Beloved, I seek not priest nor bishop's share,
 I seek no glory from the golden stair
 Of emperor or president in due
 Before the throne of power and might laid bare.
 I seek no grand reward, I just seek You.

Barnabas 207

1 Jesus replied: 'As God lives, I
 Have not the devil in employ,
 But I seek to cast devils out.
 That's why the devil without doubt
 Stirs up the world against me too,
 Because I'm not of this world's crew,
 But I seek God be glorified,
 Who's sent me in the world to bide.

Listen to me, and I'll tell you
Who has the devil in his view.
As God lives, in whose presence my
Soul stands, he who works to defy
God by the devil's will, he takes
The devil for his master's sakes,
Who's put the bridle on his will
And rules at his pleasure still,
Making him run in every way
Of gross iniquity in sway.
2 Even a coat will change its name
When changing its owner in claim,
Although it is all of one cloth:
So also men, though all be wroth,
Are of one make, but different be
By the works of him whose decree
Works in the man in master's fee.
If I have sinned, why do you not
Rebuke me as a brother taught,
Instead of hating as a foe?
Truly the body's members show
Aid to each other when they are
United with the head and star,
And those that are cut from the head
Give it no aid or help instead.
For the hands of one body do
Not feel the pain of what's in cue
Of another body's feet's rue,
But only of the body to
Which they're united, it is true.
As God lives, in whose presence I
Stand, he who fears, comes rely
On love of the Creator God
Has feeling of mercy in prod
Over them whom God who's his head
Has mercy. Since God is in dread
Of the death of the sinner, but
Waits for each to repent unshut,
If you were of that body which
I am a part of, for a switch,
As God lives, you would help me work
What God says instead of to smirk.

If anyone speaks clearly by the truth,
That one becomes the target of the youth
As well as elders, who cannot abide
The blinding light of truth, but they must hide.
When Hannah Arendt showed the world that all
Who fail to think but simply follow call
Of pop and pope can perpetrate great crime,

She drew the fire from those who thought that prime
Exceptions only could do wicked things.
Failure to take her word results in kings
As well as population taking part
In genocidal action at each start.
Beloved, I would have made men with a brain
And women too to become less insane.

Barnabas 208

1 If I work sin, reprove me, and
God will love you and understand,
Because you'll be doing His will,
But if none can reprove my bill
Of sin, it is a sign that you
Are not the sons of Abram true,
Nor are you under that head that
Governed Abraham where he sat.
As God lives, so greatly did love
Abraham God, he did not shove
Down idols and forsake his dad
And mum, but was willing and glad
To offer up his own son in
Obedience to God to win.
2 The high priest answered: "This I ask
Of you and I take not in task
To kill you, why don't you tell us:
Who was Abram's son fabulous?"
Jesus replied: "The zeal to give
You honour, O God, makes me live,
And I cannot now hold my peace.
Truly I say that the increase
And son of Abraham indeed
Was Ishmael, from whom is decreed
That the Messiah must descend
Promised to Abraham God's friend,
That in him should all tribes of earth
Be blessed." Then was the high priest wroth
To hear this and cried out: "Let us
Stone this fellow who's impious,
For he's an Ishmaelite and speaks
Blasphemy against Moses, seeks
Against God's Law in all he wreaks."

Convict of sin. This principle is great.
There is so much judgementalism late
That condemns people for the way they dress
Or eat or sleep or ethnic way confess
And so ignores what's really just and true,
The Decalogue for what we ought not do,
That violence becomes the civil way.

The simple Decalogue's shunted away.
Beloved, all ten can well be kept by all
Who simply sit on sofas in a hall,
Except it might not honour mum and dad.
That takes a little effort from a cad.
Keep me within the Decalogue and let
Me not convict for others things I've met.

3 So every scribe and Pharisee
With elders of the folk in spree
Took up stones to stone Jesus there,
Who vanished from their eyes in air
And went out from the temple stair.
So great was their wrath then to kill
Jesus, they blindly struck at will
Each other so there died that day
A thousand men under wrath's sway.
They polluted the temple court
With raging slaughter for their sport.
The disciples and those who there
Believed, who saw Jesus with care
Go out of the temple in sight
Unblinded and unhidden quite,
Followed him to Simon's house right.
4 So Nicodemus came to say
That Jesus should flee out of way
Of Jerusalem and abide
Beyond the brook Kedron to hide,
Saying: 'Sir, I have just the place,
A house beyond brook Kedron's race,
Where I beg you to go therefore
With some of your disciples more,
To stay there till this wrath is passed,
And I'll bring provisions to last.
The rest of them leave here to stay
In Simon's house and mine to pray,
For God will provide all the way.'
So Jesus did this, and just took
With him the first twelve called to look,
The twelve apostles in the book.

The Gospel of John makes the Jews attack
Jesus for misperceiving words to lack
Clear affirmation of Your unity,
That You alone are God eternally.
But Barnabas is no doubt right to show
The problem to be Jesus on the go
To recognize that Ishmael was the son
First-born to Abraham once he'd begun.
That is the Torah word, though many take

Marriage with Hagar as Abram's mistake.
Beloved, I love both Abraham and more,
Each son of his spoken of at tent door.
And laugh with Sarah and with Hagar weep.
I love the holy family with love deep.

Barnabas 209

1 At this time, while the Virgin Mary,
Mother of Jesus, stood to carry
Prayer to God, angel Gabriel
Came to her and told her the spell
Of her son's persecuted way,
"Fear not, Mary," he came to say,
"For God will keep him from the sway
Of the world." Mary, weeping, went
From Nazareth and came as sent
To a house in Jerusalem,
Of Mary Salome, in hem
Of her sister to find her son.
2 But since he had secretly done
An escape there beyond the brook
Kedron, she was not there to look
On him any more in this world;
Except after the deed unfurled
In shame, for then the bright angel
Gabriel, with the angels Michael,
Raphael, and Uriel, brought him
By God's command to her and trim.

The four archangels named with clarity
Come to represent every man's duty
Within the portals of grace on the earth:
The gates of law, love, and awareness worth,
And truth in all splendid reality.
The four archangels are glory to see.
Beloved, I hide beyond the brook and wait
For nourishment from You upon my plate,
And join in hidden places with the one
You sent to declare that he is no son
Divine, but that You are my God alone
Before whom I bow down before Your throne.
The four gates gather from around the world
The ones elect cast out from earth and hurled.

Barnabas 210

1 When the noise in the temple ceased
By Jesus' flight, then the high priest
Went up and waved for silence then
With his hands and said to the men:
'Brethren, what are we doing here?

Don't you see how he's made appear
Deception to all the world by
His diabolic act to fly?
How did he vanish, if not by
Magic? Truly if he were one
Of the holy prophets begun,
He'd not blaspheme against God and
Against Moses and against hand
Of the Messiah, who remains
The hope of Israel in her pains.
What shall I say? He has blasphemed
All our priesthood, and so it seemed,
Which is why I now say to you,
If he's not removed from our view,
Israel will be polluted too,
And our God will give us into
The hands of the nations for rue.
See now, by his actions this place
Of sacredness is in disgrace.'

The words of priests just serve in many ways
To reinforce the superstitious gaze
Of populace and bind them in the maze
The wicked and the wealthy come to praise.
The words of priests I shun and look to You,
Beloved, for grace and mercy as I do
Your will according to the law set down
By Sinai in the desert for a town.
Beloved, let me see clearly that those You
Send down to proclaim Your Word that is true
Dispel the superstitious ways of men
And bring them back to Your praise once again.
Then I too shall not bow to foolish tales,
But set out where Your Decalogue prevails.

2 So the high priest spoke and he made
Many forsake Jesus afraid,
So that the secret persecution
Turned in to open retribution.
The high priest himself went to see
Herod, the Roman ruler wee
Accusing Jesus that he tried
To make himself a king to bide
In Israel, and of this they
Had false witnesses bought for pay.
3 So there a public council sat
Against Jesus, because of that
They were afraid of Roman law
And held its decrees all in awe.
Twice Roman Senate sent decree

About Jesus, in the first see
 It was forbidden, pain of death,
 To call Jesus of Nazareth
 The prophet of the Jews, or yet
 God or the Son of God beset.
 In the second it did forbid
 On pain of death to talk or bid
 About Jesus of Nazareth,
 Prophet of the Jews, fear of death.
 That's why they were divided so.
 Some wanted to write more to go
 To Rome against Jesus, but some
 Said to leave Jesus a lone bum,
 No matter what he said, the fool.
 Others referred to the great school
 Of miracles that he had done,
 So much the people's hearts he'd won.
 4 So the high priest said under pain
 Of anathema none should stain
 A word defending Jesus there.
 And he spoke to Herod to care,
 And to the governor, and said:
 'In any case we have ill bred
 Crisis on hand, for if we slay
 This sinner, we've Caesar to pay,
 And if we let him live and he
 Makes himself king, how shall we be?'
 Then Herod rose in threat in view
 Of governor, and said on cue:
 'Take care of favouring that man,
 Lest this country rebel in plan,
 For I'll accuse you then before
 Caesar as a rebel in score.'
 5 The governor feared the Senate
 And made peace with Herod in rate,
 For before this they'd hated each
 Other to death. They came to reach
 Agreement for Jesus' death and
 Said to the high priest out of hand:
 'When you find out where he might stand,
 Send to us, and we shall provide
 Soldiers to take Jesus in pride.'
 So was fulfilled the prophecy
 Of David, who foretold decree
 Of Jesus, Israel's prophet when
 He said: The princes and their men
 And kings of the earth, shall unite
 Against the holy one for spite
 Of Israel, because he shouts
 Salvation to a world in doubts.

So on that day there was a search
For Jesus and where he might perch
In Jerusalem in the lurch.

The word of David does remain in view
A guiding light to show the thing that's true.
If anyone rise to support the truth
That You, Beloved, reveal to old and youth,
The enemies that catch each other's throat
Will leave their quarrels and turn back in rote
And close agreement to attack all men
Who are faithful to You, Beloved, again.
The law of nature in wicked report
Always works out that way for evil sport.
This world is not a palace where men live,
But just the staging ground, a sort of sieve
Through which men pour into hell's flaming fire
Or dribble into Paradise desire.

Barnabas 211

I Jesus in Nicodemus' home
Beyond brook Kedron under dome
Comforted his disciples then
By saying: 'The hour's near again
That I must leave this world; console
Yourselves and be not sad on dole,
Because where I go I'll not feel
Any tribulation from weal.
'Now shall you be my friends if you
Are sad to see me well and true?
No, certainly not, but instead
Enemies. When the world is led
Into rejoicing, then be sad,
Because the world's joy soon is had
In weeping, but your sadness soon
Shall be turned into joy and boon,
And no one shall take it away
From you: for the joy that's in sway
Of the heart for Creator God,
Not the whole world can take in pod.
Don't forget what God's said to you
By my mouth, for the things are true.
Bear witness for me against those
Who may corrupt the gospel rows
That I have spoken against all
The world and its lovers in thrall.

There is but one matter for sadness here:
It is the failure of a soul in fear
To live according to the Decalogue.

There is just one matter of joy in fog
Of life, and that is to come to the end
Of day and find that neither foe nor friend
Can raise an accusation by Your law
Against the heart or mind or foot or claw.
Beloved, I ask not for wealth or for power,
I ask not for fame or for glory's hour.
I ask that You give me the grace to stay
Within the bounds of Your law when I pray.
Let all the wicked world else go astray,
But keep me in Your grace beneath its shower.

Barnabas 212

1 Then lifting his hands to the Lord,
He prayed and said: 'Lord God adored,
God of Abraham and God of
Ishmael and Isaac, men You love,
God of our fathers, have mercy
Upon those You have given me,
And save them from the world set free.
I don't ask You to take them out
Of the world, since they must there shout
In testimony against those
Who shall corrupt my gospel rows.
But I pray You to keep them well
From evil, and at judgement's spell
They may come with me to relate
Witness against the worldly state
And against House of Israel
That's corrupted covenant's spell.
2 'Lord God, mighty and jealous, who
Take vengeance on the idol crew
Against sons of idolatrous
Parents to fourth generation,
Curs always every one who'll make
Corruption for my Gospel's sake
That you gave me, when they will write
That I am Your son out of spite.
I, I, mere clay and dust, remain
Servant of Your servants for gain,
And never have I thought that I
Am even a good slave to try.
I can return to You no thing
For what You've done for me to bring,
For all this belongs to Your ring.

I interrupt the divine prayer in mouth
Of Jesus looking east and west and south
To mind him that in northern clime I wait
To praise him for his message not come late.

I shall not write of You the evil thing
To make men fail to distinguish in ring
Between the God above, Creator and
The Sovereign Lord of sea and air and land,
And one whom You have sent, Beloved, in care
To proclaim Your will for humans to share.
Beloved, I interrupt Jesus who speaks
To You in accents humanity seeks
To praise You and Your sent one for the way
Marked out in grace and mercy day by day.

3 Lord God, the merciful who shows
Mercy to thousands in their rows,
Upon them who fear You, mete grace
To those who trust my words and face
That you have given me to trace.
For as You are true God indeed,
So Your word true I spoke in need,
For it is Yours, since always I
Have spoken like readers would try
To read exactly from the book,
Not changing a syllable's look.

4 Lord God the Saviour, save those whom
You've given me, so there's no room
For Satan to attack them here,
And save not only those ones dear,
But every one that shall believe
By them. Lord, bountiful, give leave
In abundance of grace reprieve,
Grant to Your servant to be in
Your Messenger's crowd and to win
On the Day of Judgement; not just
Me only, but every one thrust
On me in gift, along with all
Who shall believe me by their call.
And do this, Lord, for Your own sake,
So Satan boast not in the wake.

5 'Lord God, who by Your providence
Give all things needed in the tents
Of Your folk Israel, take mind
Of all the tribes of earth resigned,
Which You've promised to bless again
By Your Messenger among men,
For whom You did create the earth.
Have mercy on the world in dearth
And quickly send Your Messenger,
So Satan lose his power to stir
His empire.' And having said this,
Jesus said three times not to miss:
'So be it, Lord, merciful, great!'

And they replied, weeping in rate:
'So be it,' all but Judas then,
For he believed nothing of men.

Beloved, I do believe in Jesus sent,
Your prophet to the Jewish nation lent,
And so I claim his prayer belongs to me,
He prayed for those who should eternally
Believe him after he had disappeared.
I am one who takes him above the feared.
So mind his prayer and grant me grace to be
Under the wings of grace and Your mercy.
The Muslim often tells me that the man
Only who can intercede by Your plan
Is the great and last sent one, Muhammad,
In whom I also have faith like a cad.
But here I find that Jesus too can pray
For those who have trust in him and his way.

Barnabas 213

1 The day to eat the lamb arrived,
That Nicodemus sent contrived
Secretly to the garden for
Jesus and his disciples' store,
Announcing all that was decreed
By Herod, with high priest indeed
And governor. So Jesus then
Rejoiced in spirit, said again:
'Blessed be Your holy name, O Lord,
Since You've not left me out abhorred
From the number of Your slaves who
Have been persecuted in rue
By the world and slain to be true.
I thank You, my God, because I
Have finished Your work by and by.'
And turning to Judas, he said
To him: 'Friend, why stand here instead?
My time is near, and so go do
The thing that is required of you.'

I stop here to remind myself and You,
Beloved, that the lamb eaten there was due
Reminder of Your intervention once
To save Israel Your son from wicked dunce,
The Pharaoh of Egypt who slew the boys
And took away from them all of their toys.
The Paschal Lamb is never sacrifice
For sin, but a memorial of the nice.
Beloved, it is a travesty to make
The Paschal Lamb atonement for the sake

Of sinner and sinners. It should be the share
Of gratitude and praise for times You dare
To intervene in human state affairs
And for the individual caught in cares.

2 The disciples thought Jesus sent
Judas to buy something best spent
For the Passover day, but he,
Jesus, knew that Judas set free
Would betray him, and since he longed
To depart from the world unwronged,
He spoke so. Judas then replied:
'Sir, let me eat and then I'll ride.'
'Let us eat then, said Jesus, 'for
I've greatly desired now on score
To eat this lamb with you before
I'm parted from you and this shore.'

3 Having arisen, he took towel
And girded his loins without cowl,
And having put water in bowl,
He set himself to wash in toll
His own disciples' feet in share.
He started from Judas to bear
Down on Peter. Peter then said:
'Sir, would you wash my feet instead?'
Jesus replied: 'You don't know now
What I am doing, anyhow
You will know later.' Peter said:
'You'll never wash my feet outspread.'
Jesus got up and said: 'Then you
Will never enter in my crew
On day of judgement and of rue.'
Peter replied: 'Then wash my feet,
Sir, and my hands and head in treat.'

4 When the disciples, washed, were set
At table to eat what they get,
Jesus said: 'I have washed you all,
Yet you are not all clean at all,
For all the water of the sea
Won't wash him who does not in me
Place his trust.' Jesus said this thing
Because he knew who was in ring
To betray him. Sadness then fell
On the disciples for a spell
At these words, but he said again:
'Truly I tell you, one of you
Shall betray me, so at his cue
I'll be sold like a sheep, but woe
To him who shall fulfil the show,
For he'll fulfil all that he said,

Our father David, of such bred,
That "he shall fall into the pit
Which he's prepared for others fit."
5 So the disciples sat aghast
And wondered looking at each past
The other in their sorrow cast:
'Who shall be such a traitor then?'
Judas then said: 'Shall it be I,
O Master?' Jesus did reply:
You have told me who it shall be
Who shall come now to betray me.'
The eleven apostles heard
Not a word of what had occurred.
When the lamb was consumed, then came
The devil upon Judas' shame,
And he went out from the house too,
As Jesus told him what to do:
'Go quickly to your task in view.'

Betrayal of the Lord is not the strike
In hate against the right with sharpened spike,
But justifying and convincing self
That what is done is not the work of elf
But rather the right and true way to go.
Betrayal's blinded by the selfish show.
Hitler was sure that he was right and so
Was Stalin and Alexander went out
With a great mission to the world no doubt,
The civilizing with Hellenic clout.
The crafty priest and Judas did their deeds
With motives to save life and nation's needs.
The Decalogue alone can keep men's mind
Clear and the eye from being dark and blind.

Barnabas 214

1 Having gone out of the room then,
Jesus retired into the glen
To pray, according to his way
And bowing on his knees to pray
A hundred times and in prostration
Upon his face. Judas' elation
Was great to know the place where he
And Jesus and disciples flee,
Went to the high priest and told him,
And said: 'If you will give me trim
What we agreed, to night I'll give
Jesus into your hand to sieve,
For he's alone with a few friends,
Eleven only," he contends.
The high priest answered: "How much do

You want then to betray the few?"
Judas replied in what he sold:
" I just want thirty bits of gold."
2 The high priest counted out to him
The money he asked for and grim,
And sent a Pharisee to beg
The governor to fetch a leg
Of soldiers, and to Herod, and
They gave a legion in command,
Because they feared the people's wrath.
They took their weapons on the path,
With torch and lantern and with stave
Departed Jerusalem grave.

This reconstruction of the far events
Is one that wisely and clearly presents
An explanation for the need to find
Someone to betray Jesus from behind.
It also notes why such an army grand
Was sent into the field and not unmanned.
Both of these explanations fail to be
Seen in the Gospels synoptic and wee
John, but at last appear in clarity.
Beloved, I thank You for the grave insight
That Barnabas at last brings to the light.
I contemplate the ways of men on earth
And ponder Your creation's power of worth
And find that divine wisdom has no dearth.

Barnabas 215

1 When the soldiers with Judas came
Near to the place where they would claim
Jesus was, Jesus heard approach
Of many people to encroach,
And so in fear he went inside
The house. The eleven to hide
Were sleeping. Then God, when He saw
His servant in danger of claw,
Commanded angel Gabriel,
Michael, Raphael, and Uriel,
His servants to take Jesus out
Of the world and keep without doubt.
The holy angels came and took
Jesus out by the window nook
That faces to the south. They bore
Him up and placed him in the score
Of the third heaven in the band
Of angels standing on the sand,
And blessing God for evermore.

The occultation of the ones You choose
To take alive out of this world to use
Is to the third heaven where the angels praise
Your name, Beloved, throughout eternal days.
I beg the four archangels to take me
In spirit to rejoice upon that lea,
And in my visions of the gloried land
Rejoice to find the saints gathered in band.
From lion's mouth I take the coin and ring
And hide behind the heavenly crystal spring
To see the sema' of the forties there
Beyond the worried world, beyond its care.
Let all who still rejoice in revealed word
Find peace and praise within their own heart stirred.

Barnabas 216

1 Judas rushed in the room from which
Jesus had been taken in pitch
Of flight. And the disciples there
Were sleeping. So God for His share
Worked a sign marvellous in act,
So Judas was changed for a fact
To look and sound like Jesus did,
So we were fooled when in he slid
And woke us up to ask us where
The master was. But for our share
We were surprised and answered him:
'You, sir, are our master and trim.
Has your memory become so dim?'
2 And he smiled saying: 'Don't be fools,
You know me by my face and tools,
I'm Judas Iscariot true!'
As he said this, the soldiers came
And laid hands on him to their shame,
Because he was in every way
Similar to Jesus in sway.
We heard Judas' words and saw near
The crowd of soldiers, in our fear
We fled all as out of our minds.
And John wrapped up in linen binds
Awoke and fled, and when a man
Among the soldiers grasped the span
Of his cloth, he left all in hand
And fled nude out in night unscanned.
For God heard Jesus' prayer and saved
The eleven for what they braved.

The vividness of Barnabas' description
Is most disarming before conscription.
Canonical in Gospels do not reach

The detail and the natural as they preach.
It is no proof of an authentic writ,
But it is surely rhetoric to fit.
The flight of John, for instance, appears here
With all the trimmings of its truth and fear.
The waking of the disciples to find
What looks like Jesus and their answer kind
Is just what one might expect in such bind.
It's only miracle that causes doubt
In such a doubting Thomas as I pout.
Keep me, the doubter, Lord, from being blind.

Barnabas 217

1 The soldiers took Judas when bound
And ridiculed him as they found.
For he in truth denied at all
That he was Jesus at their call.
The soldiers mocked him and they said:
'Sir, fear not, for we've come here led
To make you king of Israel,
And we have tied you up so well
Because we know that you refuse
The kingdom of Judah and Jews.'
Judas replied: 'Now have you lost
Your senses! You have threshold crossed
To take Jesus of Nazareth;
With arms and lanterns in one breath
Against a robber, and you've bound
Me who guided you to the ground
As to make me king round and round!'
2 The soldiers lost their patience then
And struck and kicked him once again,
And in their wrath took him away
Into Jerusalem that day.
John and Peter followed far off
To see the soldiers hit and scoff.
And they affirmed to him who writes
That they saw all the judgement's plights
That were made against Judas there
By the high priest, and by the share
Of the council of Pharisees,
Who were assembled at their ease
To put Jesus to death's decrees.
At that Judas spoke many words
Of madness, so that all the herds
Were stirred to laughter, since they thought
That he was really Jesus brought,
And that for fear of death he tried
To pretend madness to abide.
At that the scribes put a blindfold

On him and mocked him to be bold:
'Jesus, prophet of Nazarenes,'
For so they called them in their scenes
Those who believed in Jesus then,
'Tell us who hit you on the wen?'
They pushed him all around the place
And even some spat in his face.
3 At morn there gathered in good time
A great council of scribes and prime
Elders of the people. High priest
And Pharisees sought out at least
False witnesses to testify
Against Judas, as they'd rely
On being Jesus on the sly.
But they did not find what they sought.
And why do I say the priests thought
Judas to be Jesus in plot?
All of us disciples, I too,
Who write, believed that it was true,
And the poor Virgin mother of
Jesus believed it in her love,
With all his kin and every friend.
They all believed it to the end,
And sorrow greatly did attend.

This is the real heart of the doubt for me,
This miracle of unexpected glee.
How I would love to put faith in the share
That You, Beloved, at some time and somewhere
Did intervene to save a dying Jew
From rack and ruin's diabolic crew.
The fact of history is, if the Lord,
Sweet Jesus did escape his being gored,
There were a dozen more with the same name
The Romans crucified to their own shame.
The crucifixion narrative remains
A symbol representative of pains
Poured on the faithful and unfaithful crowd
Of Jews within the empire of the proud.

4 As God lives, he who writes forgot
All that Jesus had said in plot;
How that he should be taken up
From the world, and that like a tup
Another should suffer the pain
And he should not die till the reign
Of the world's end. And so he went
With Jesus' mother who was bent
To go with John to the cross lent.
The high priest caused Judas to be

Brought before him bound so to see,
 And asked him of his disciples
 And of his doctrine, of what pulls.
 But Judas, as out of his mind,
 Answered him nothing of the kind.
 The high priest then adjured by God
 Of Israel to tell truth by prod.
 5 Judas replied: 'I've told you true
 That I'm Judas Iscariot too,
 Who promised to give in your hands
 Jesus the Nazarene and bands,
 And you, why I know not, will take
 Me for Jesus and for his sake.'
 The high priest answered: 'O perverse
 Seducer, you deceived by worse
 All Israel, first in Galilee
 And then in Jerusalem's see,
 With your doctrines and signs of woe;
 Now do you intend once to go
 Free from the deserved punishment
 By feigning to be mad and bent?
 6 'As God lives, you shall not escape.'
 Having said this, upon the nape
 He ordered his servants to fall
 And strike and shove around the hall,
 And kick him, so he might return
 To his right mind and so to learn.
 The mocking that he suffered then
 At the hands of the high priest's men
 Is beyond all belief and ken.
 They zealously invented more
 Ways to give the council in store
 Pleasure. The dressed him like a fool,
 Made him a juggler, sat on stool,
 Forced him to move his hands and feet
 So even Canaanite complete
 Compassion would have had on him
 To see the sight portrayed with vim.
 But the chief priests and Pharisees,
 And elders of the folk to please
 Had their hearts so wrought up in wrath
 Against Jesus, they took the path
 Of joy to see the man's blood bath.

The crowd is ever ready to believe
 That someone ought to suffer and to grieve
 And by that suffering will atone for sin
 And bring well-being to the nation's kin.
 The crowd is ever ready to taste blood,
 And that is what men want, and want in flood,

And that is why there's doctrine that foul death
Will save the world forever in one breath.
Beloved, I turn with darkened eye and find
My stomach churning to see humankind
In the throes of such cruelty of mind
And hand. Have pity on our instincts cold
That offer nothing of the true and bold.
The human rat's nest is with dead bones lined.

7 At last they led him bound before
The governor, who's secret floor
Was to love Jesus. So when he
Thought Judas was Jesus to see,
Took him into his chamber where
He spoke to him, asking the share
Of cause the chief priests and the folk
Had brought him bound beneath the stroke.
Judas replied: 'If I speak truth,
You'll not believe me like a youth,
For maybe you're deceived as well
As priests and Pharisees in spell.'
8 The governor answered in view,
Thinking he spoke of the Law true:
'Now don't you know that I am not
A Jew, but the chief priests have brought
You with the elders of your folk
Into my hand. So let the stroke
Of truth be known, so I may do
What is just, for I've power on cue
To set you free or put to death.'
Judas replied: 'Sir, believe me,
If you put me to death, you'll see
Great wrong, for you shall slay a man
Who's innocent, since if you can,
Know I'm Judas Iscariot,
And not Jesus, who in his plot
Is a magician and has wrought
By his art transformation here
In me to make me so appear.'

The truth when spoken in a court of law
Is rarely given credence, not for awe,
But for the fact that vested interest makes
It nigh impossible for judges' sakes
To hear the truth incredible. I know
That even truth without the gloss and show
Of miracle is difficult to glow.
The judges always prefer status quo
Of wealthy and of healthy to the rate
Of justice to the poor oppressed in state.

Beloved, help me to trust the truth when spoken
And keep it in my bosom for a token,
And never enter in injustice woken,
But always find You true both soon and late.

9 When he heard this, the governor
Marvelled greatly the more and more,
So he tried hard to set him free.
The governor therefore went out,
And smiling said without a doubt:
On one hand, he does not deserve
To die, but rather with some verve
To have compassion. This man states
That he's not Jesus, but relates
That he's a certain Judas who
Guided the soldiers in the view
Of taking Jesus, and he claims
Jesus the Galilean aims
By magic art to transform him.
If this be true and not word dim,
It would a great wrong to kill him,
Since he'd be innocent of crime.
But if he is Jesus this time
And yet denies it, certainly
He's lost his senses, it would be
Impious to kill such surely.'

10 Then the chief priests and elders of
The folk, the scribes and Pharisees,
Cried out with shouts saying above,
"He's Jesus of Nazareth, please,
For we know him. If he were not
The guilty one, we would have not
Brought him before you. Nor is he
Insane, but rather he's guilty.
And by this cunning strategy
He seeks to escape from our hands,
And the uproar at his commands
If he should escape would be worse
Than formerly he came to curse."
Pilate, for such was the brave name
Of governor, to escape blame
Of the case, said "From Galilee
This man comes, it is not for me
To judge a case, one that belongs
To Herod, who's king of those throngs.
So take the man to Herod's tongs."
So they led Judas to Herod
Who had long wished to have the clod
Come in his clutches, but because
Herod was under Gentile laws,

And worshipped false and lying gods,
Jesus would not enter the prods
Of unclean Gentiles and such sods.
Now when Judas had been led there,
Herod asked him of all things share,
To which Judas replied in vain
Denying he was Jesus sane.
Then Herod mocked him with his court
And dressed him up in white for sport,
As fools are dressed, and sent him back
To Pilate, saying in his lack,
“Do not fail to give justice to
The folk of Israel and true.”
Herod wrote this because the chief
Priests, scribes and Pharisees’ in lief
Had bribed him with money in feoff.
The governor had heard this from
A servant of Herod not dumb,
And so in order to get gain
Also, he also came to feign
That he wanted to set the man
Judas free in his greedy plan.

There's always intrigue in the proclamation
Writ by a lawyer or king to the nation,
And every seeming document in words
Fine and complex is covering its turds.
There's always some power or some lobby great
To bribe or even to intimidate
And to prevent the truth from coming out.
But You, Beloved, overcome human doubt
By providence and in the end prevail.
The powerful and rulers stay to wail.
Let heaven and hell entreat and tempt the soul,
Let bribery and greed come take their toll,
But through it all the great divine decree
With soon appear for everyone to see.

11 So he set him to be whipped by
His servants, who were then paid sly
By the scribes to kill him beneath
The scourges and the thorny wreath.
But God, who had decreed the end,
Reserved Judas at last to send
Him to the cross, so he might die
The cruel death that he would try
To sell another to in sly.
So he did not allow Judas
To die under the whips, alas,
No matter how hard soldiers beat

His body bloody in defeat.
 So they mocked him and dressed him well
 In an old purple robe a spell,
 And said "It's fitting our new king
 Should be clothed and crowned as in ring
 Of gold and gems as kings do wear
 Upon their shoulders, in their hair."
 A crown of thorns upon his head
 They set, and in his hand instead
 A reed for sceptre, and they made
 Him sit in view and on parade.
 12 And the soldiers came before him,
 Bowing down in mockery grim,
 Greeting him as King of the Jews.
 And they held out their hands to take
 Such gifts as new kings in their wake
 Are used to give, and getting none
 They struck Judas on face and bun,
 Saying "Now you've received the crown,
 Fool of a king, so with renown
 Pay your soldiers and servants down."
 The chief priests, scribes and Pharisees,
 Seeing Judas died not with ease
 By scourging, feared Pilate should let
 Him go, then came forward to set
 A bribe before the governor,
 Who when he took it at the door,
 Turned Judas over to the scribes
 And Pharisees against their bribes
 As guilty both of death and more.
 So they condemned two robbers too
 With him to the cross in full view.
 13 They led him to Mount Calvary,
 Where they used to hang criminals
 And crucified him nakedly,
 For the greater ignominy.
 Judas cried out in refusals
 "God, why have You forsaken me,
 Letting escape the one guilty,
 And left me to die unjustly?"
 Truly I say the voice and face
 And form of Judas in his place
 Were so like that of Jesus that
 His own disciples where they sat
 And the believers were convinced
 That he was Jesus and they winced.
 So some departed from the teaching
 Of Jesus, and they started preaching
 That he was a false prophet who
 By art of magic worked untrue,

For Jesus had said he should not
Die till near end of the world's lot,
While at that time he should be taken
From the world in occulted station.
14 But they that stood firm in the teaching
Of Jesus filled with sorrow reaching,
Saw him die who looked just like him,
And what Jesus said became dim.
And so with Jesus' mother they
Went to Mount Calvary to stay
At Judas' place in weeping's fuss
And by means of Nicodemus
And Arimathian Joseph
They got from governor not deaf
The body of Judas to bury.
So they took him down from the cross
With weeping so hard it was scary
And buried him they came to toss
In the new tomb of Joseph where
They wrapped him in a hundred weight
Of precious perfumes and in state.

Without a miracle in all the fuss
Reports of such a mess would make a muss
Of contradictions in the aftermath.
It's normal that so many tales of wrath
Should make appearance then and in the years
To follow as the many sects of fears
Proliferated till the time arrived
When Constantine had with motive contrived
A narrative that would support the state
And what he wanted in a uniate.
Beloved, I do not place my trust in tales
Of crucifixions or in future pales,
But in Your mercy and Your grace and law,
I grasp this trinity with tooth and claw.

Barnabas 218

1 Then each man went back to his house,
He who writes, with John and his grouse
His brother James went with the mum
Of Jesus to Nazareth come.
2 Those disciples who did not fear
God went by night not to appear
And stole the body of Judas
And hid it, spreading round alas
A story that Jesus was raised,
From which confusion greatly crazed.
The high priest ordered under pain
Of excommunication's reign

That none should speak of him again,
 Jesus of Nazareth to men.
 So there came up a persecution
 And many were stoned as solution,
 And others beaten, banished from
 The land, since they could not keep mum
 About such a matter in sum.
 3 The news reached Nazareth how that
 Jesus, their fellow citizen,
 Having died on the cross laid flat
 Had risen from the dead again.
 On hearing so, the one who writes
 Begged Jesus' mother for delights
 To stop her weeping, since her son
 Was raised up from the tomb and won.
 When she heard this, the Virgin Mary
 Through her tears said "Let us not tarry
 To go up to Jerusalem
 To find my son and only gem.
 I'll die content when I've seen him."

The many rumours that such events raise
 Are hardly any surprise in the craze.
 The rumours here depicted also fly
 Among the Gospel of the canon's try.
 The rumour of the resurrection came
 To bring hope to poor Mary in the game.
 Whether that is the true tale in the lot,
 Or whether resurrection was a plot,
 The truth is that the Bible and Qur'an
 Predict for hope and terror of the dawn
 The resurrection of the body soon
 To Judgement. I lay claim upon that boon.
 Beloved, You who saved good and killed the bad,
 I trust Your promise of awakened pad.

Barnabas 219

1 The Virgin came back to the town
 Jerusalem, town of renown,
 With him who writes, and James and John,
 The day when the decree was drawn
 From the high priest. And at the news,
 The Virgin, who feared God in views,
 Although she knew it was unjust
 Of the high priest to decree fussed,
 Commanded those who lived with her
 To forget her son in the blur.
 Then how each was affected sure!
 God who sees human hearts knows that
 Between grief at Judas' death mat,

Whom we thought was Jesus our lord,
 And the hope to see him adored
 Raised up again, we were consumed
 With the mother of Jesus roomed.
 2 And so the angels who were guards
 Of Mary went up from the shards
 To the third sky, where Jesus stayed
 In company of angels made,
 And told him all and not afraid.
 So Jesus prayed to God that He
 Would give him the power once to see
 His mother and disciples wee.
 Then the God merciful commanded
 His four chief angels and remanded,
 Who are Michael, Gabriel and
 Raphael and Uriel to stand
 And carry Jesus to the land
 And to his mother's house, and there
 Keep three days' watch on him with care,
 And let him only be seen there
 By those who believed in his share.
 And Jesus came in glory bound
 To the room where Mary was found,
 The Virgin and her sisters two,
 And Martha and the Magdalene,
 Mary and Lazarus on scene,
 And he who writes, and John and James
 And Peter also without blames.
 At that for fear they fell as dead.
 And Jesus raised his mother spread
 And others from the ground and said
 "Don't be afraid for I'm Jesus,
 And do not cry and make a fuss,
 For I'm alive and not one dead."
 They stayed in wonder long to see
 Jesus, for they all severally
 Believed that Jesus had been dead.
 Then the Virgin there weeping said
 "Tell me, my son, wherefore and why
 God who gave you the power to vie
 And raise the dead, could let you die
 And shame your kin and friends thereby,
 And shame your teaching from the sky?
 For every one that loves you here
 Has been as dead, frozen with fear."

Description of the return of the Lord
 Explains why he appeared as one adored
 Only to certain few and not abroad
 In public to be seen of all the crowd.

This too is useful to my darkened mind
As I've read in the Gospels unresigned.
I beg the for archangels also fly
To me beneath a doubting and grey sky
And show me living wonders, not the dead,
But glories of Your Word and law outspread.
Then I shall be raised up from saddened tomb
And praise You in a greater, lightened room
Until the doubts of earth have passed away
And rumours disappear in light of day.

Barnabas 220

1 Jesus replied, hugging his mother,
“Believe what I say true, my mother,
That I have not been dead at all;
For God's reserved me till the call
Of the world's ending.” At that he
Prayed the four angels made to see
And give their witness faithfully.
2 So angels appeared like four suns
A-shining, so each fell in stuns.
Then Jesus gave four linen cloths
To the four angels so like moths
They might veil themselves from their sight,
To be seen and heard in the fright
Of mother and her friends' delight.
And having lifted up each one,
He comforted them and said when done,
“These are the ministers of God:
Gabriel, who announces the rod
Of God's secrets; and Michael, who
Fights against God's enemies too;
And Raphael, who receives souls
Of those who die, and Uriel,
Who will call every one to spell
The judgement of God at last day.”
Then the four angels came to say
To the Virgin how God had sent
For Jesus, and transformed the bent
Judas to suffer punishment
For selling another astray.

This Gospel of Barnabas has its worth
Among the Gospels many on the earth
If only for the two passages where
It says Jesus hugged his mother with care.
A hug is worth a thousand words to me,
A hug sets me a thousand errors free.
No other Gospel shares that sweetness done
To mother by a tender, loving son.

Beloved, let me be human in this land
And not a theologian come to stand
In Constantine's iron bands of power and state.
Let me not succumb to the faiths of hate,
But always mind that Your Word coming here
Was sent to cast out wickedness and fear.

3 Then he who writes said "Master, may
I ask a question now as when
You lived and dwelt among us men?"
Jesus replied, "Ask what you please,
Barnabas, I'll answer with ease."
Then he who writes said "Master mine,
Since God is merciful, divine,
Why did He so torment us then,
To make us think you'd died by men?
And your mum has so wept for you
That she has been near to death too;
And you who are God's holy one,
On you God's let fall rumours run
That you were killed among the fell
Robbers on Mount Calvary's hell?"

4 Jesus replied, "Barnabas, know
That every sin, though small to show,
God punishes with punishment
Sore, since offence will not relent.
Because my mother and my true
Disciples loved me with undue
And earthly love, but little too,
The righteous God punished this love
With present grief sent from above,
So it may not be punished more
In the flames of hell held in store.
And though I've been innocent here
In the world, since men did not fear
To call me "God" and "Son of God,"
So I not be mocked at the rod
Of demons on the judgement day,
God has willed that I bear the sway
Of mocking in this world by death
Of Judas, to make in one breath
All men believe I died upon
The cross. This mocking shall go on
Until Muhammad's coming dawn,
The Messenger of God, who when
He shall come shall reveal to men
This great deception to those who
Believe in God's Law what is true."
When he had said this, Jesus said
"You are just, O Lord our God dread,

Because to You only I lend
Honour and glory to the end.”

There is no record that Muhammad came
And told the truth about this lie in blame.
A dozen theories of the crucifixion
Are found in the medieval thought and diction
Of Muslims scholars. This is not one sound
Islamic doctrine in the world and found.
But explanation that deception drowned
The mum of Jesus and disciples round
To punish them for loving him too much
Is one ridiculous for me to touch.
But O Beloved, this book's more filled with truth
Than any I have read from eager youth
Till now. I bless the word that shines from it
To make the heart and love love and heart fit.

Barnabas 221

1 Jesus turned to the one who writes,
And said “Barnabas, keep in sights
By all means to write my gospel
About all that's happened in spell
Of my stay in the world to quell.
And write what happened to the man
Judas also by faithful plan
To undeceive, so everyone
May believe the truth when it's done.”
Then he who writes replied “I will
Do so, if God wills, and fulfil,
O Master, but I do not know
What happened to Judas below,
Because I did not see the show.”
2 Jesus replied, “Here John and Peter
Saw everything bitter and sweeter,
And they'll inform you of all things
That took place in these happenings.”
Jesus commanded us to call
His faithful disciples in stall
To see him. So James and John call
Together seven disciples all
With Nicodemus and Joseph,
And many others such undeaft
Of the seventy-two, and they
Ate with Jesus upon that day.
3 The third day Jesus said “Go to
The Mount of Olives with my true
Mother, for there I will ascend
Again to heaven, and you'll bend
To see who shall take me up there.”

So they all went there and with care
 Except twenty-five of the share
 Of the seventy-two disciples,
 Who for fear had fled before griples
 To Damascus. And as they all
 Stood in prayer, at midday in call
 Jesus came with a great crowd brought
 Of angels who in God's praise sought.
 The splendour of his face made them
 Fear greatly and they fell on hem
 With their faces upon the ground.
 But Jesus lifted them up sound,
 And comforting them, said "Do not
 Fear, I'm the master that you've got."
 4 And he reproved many who thought
 That he had died to rise again,
 Saying "Do you hold me like men
 And God for liars? I told you
 That God has granted me life's view
 Almost to the end of the world.
 Truly I say to you unfurled,
 I did not die; it was Judas
 The traitor. Beware of the gas,
 For Satan will try hard to make
 Deception for you and your sake.
 Be witnesses in Israel
 For me, and throughout the world tell
 Of all you've heard and seen in wake."
 5 And having said this, he prayed God
 For the salvation on the sod
 Of the faithful, and the conversion
 Of sinners *and for their immersion*,
 And his prayer ended, hugged his mum,
 Saying "Assalaam 'alaykum,
 My mother. Rest in God who made
 Both you and me." And having said
 This, he turned to his friends and said
 "May God's grace and mercy keep you."
 Then before their eyes angels four
 Up into the heavens him bore.

Beloved, I fail to see the purpose of
 Insisting on the Judas push and shove,
 Although the narrative is beautiful
 And as consistent as any plateful.
 The story that the Romans placed Your Christ
 Upon the cross and split his side and sliced
 Is also a good warning to avoid
 The rulers of this world who've always toyed
 With justice and killed everyone they thought

Diminished of their power before he's caught.
Let me take warning from the tales and note
That Jesus is no god upon the moat
But one You grant great gifts divine and true
Until You call him once more back to You.

Barnabas 222

1 After Jesus had gone away,
His disciples scattered astray
Through Israel and all the world's sway,
Satan hated the truth for pay
And persecuted, as all way
Falsehood does in its evil ray.
For certain wicked men pretending
To be disciples preached offending
That Jesus died and did not rise
Again. Others preached in the guise
That he died in reality
But rose again on the day three.
And others preached and still so teach
That Jesus is God's Son to reach,
Among whom is Paul so deceived.
But we, as much as I've received,
We preach to those who fear God, so
They may be saved in the last glow,
The day of God's judgement again,
And so I say at last amen.

Barnabas was produced at a time when
There was a disagreement among men
On whether Jesus was one crucified
Or not and whether he was to deride
As Son of God without the slightest scent
That the Messiah's what Son of God meant.
I care not for the miracles and signs
That this or that is right in Your designs.
I care only with simple heart and sweet
To bring my love obediently, complete
To You, Beloved, and follow in Your care
Before the Decalogue in Gospel's share.
The many lessons found only here make
It's difficulties retreat for my sake.